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Approval Sheet
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Date/Signature	Date/Signature
Paul Russo	Matthew Hall
Director of Operations	Aviation Safety Inspector

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List of affected Articles

	Subject	Modified By	Modify Date
NEW	15.21 B033 IFR En Route Operations		17.03.2026
NEW	15.38 H113 Special Terminal Area IFR Rotorcraft Operations in Class G Airspace--Nonscheduled Passenger and All-Cargo Operations		17.03.2026
NEW	15.41 H122 Special Instrument Procedures for Rotorcraft Operations		17.03.2026
NEW	15.42 H123 Class I Navigation Using Area or Long-Range Navigation Systems with WAAS for Rotorcraft RNP 0.3 En Route and Terminal Operations		19.03.2026
NEW	16.4 Complete Flight PFRA (Pre-Flight Risk Assessment)		23.12.2025
NEW	16.4.1 Onshore PFRA		23.12.2025
NEW	16.4.2 Offshore PFRA		24.12.2025
MODIFIED	1.4.1 FAR Part 119/139 Managment Personnel List		23.02.2026
MODIFIED	1.4.6 Director of Maintenance		23.02.2026
MODIFIED	3.3.1 SIC Responsibility		07.01.2026
MODIFIED	6.4.1.1 Onshore		07.01.2026
MODIFIED	6.4.1.2 Offshore		07.01.2026
MODIFIED	11.5 Determining Aircraft Airworthiness/Availability for Flight or Release		05.01.2026
MODIFIED	11.6.1 Pilots Pre-Flight/Post-Flight Duties		05.01.2026
MODIFIED	13.8 Data Archiving		13.01.2026
MODIFIED	13.11 Listing of Manuals		16.03.2026
MODIFIED	13.12 EFB Program Catalog		16.03.2026
MODIFIED	15 APPENDIX A - OPERATIONS SPECIFICATIONS		19.03.2026
MODIFIED	15.4 A004 Summary of Special Authorizations and Limitations		19.03.2026
MODIFIED	15.5 A006 Management Personnel		17.03.2026
MODIFIED	15.12 A021 Helicopter Air Ambulance (HAA) Operations		29.12.2025



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0 ADMINISTRATION AND CONTROL

0.1 Preface

[14 CFR § 135.73 and 119.59(a)(b)(2)]

The HeliService USA (HSUSA) Operators Manual (OM) provides company personnel a single organized source for policies and procedures governing aviation operations of HeliService USA (certificate no. ZS0A760J). It is written to provide clear guidelines enabling all company personnel to carry out their assigned duties and responsibilities in accordance with company policies and FAA regulations.

The OM is broken into four primary sections, including an A, B, C, and D section. The OM-A and OM-D are FAA accepted manuals. Each "section" will be treated as its own separate manual in regards to approval, revision control, and distribution. A brief summary of each manual's content is listed below, but the exact details of each manual are provided in their respective table of contents.

1. Operators Manual Part A (OM-A)
 - a. General organization overview and operating procedures.
 - b. "Cockpit" or aircraft agnostic procedures.
 - c. Maintenance procedures.
 - d. Safety.
 - e. Passenger handling.
 - f. Similar to a General Operating Manual (GOM).
2. Operators Manual Part B (OM-B)
 - a. Aircraft specific guidance.
 - b. Maneuvers and procedures guide.
 - c. Aircraft specific W&B procedures.
 - d. Company specific SOP's and call outs.
3. Operators Manual Part C (OM-C)
 - a. Local area guide and procedures.
 - b. Heli-deck & vessel information cards.
 - c. Local Landing Zone (LZ) information.
 - d. Non-regulatory.
4. Operators Manual Part D (OM-D)
 - a. General overview of company training program.
 - b. Contract training partner details.
 - c. List of training syllabi.
 - d. List of training modules.

Authorized personnel from the FAA shall have unrestricted access at any time or place to make



inspections or tests (including enroute inspections) to determine our compliance with the Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and our FAA Operations Specifications.

Note 1: This OM provides what is considered the minimum standard for HSUSA operations and ensures regulatory compliance. HSUSA will often maintain more stringent standards due to either internal or customer requirements.

0.2 Manual Authority

[14 CFR § 119.43(b)(2) and 135.21(c)]

The Director of Operations (DO) is the manual authority of this OM-A and is responsible for maintaining the overall effectiveness and currency of the manual. The manual authority has the authority to establish and modify the policies, procedures, instructions, and information associated with this manual.

The OM-A must not be contrary to any applicable federal regulations, or operating certificate, or Operations Specifications (OpSepcs).

0.3 Revision Control

HeliService USA maintains all it's manuals on Fleetplan, a digital manual writing and editing system.

Note: Due to the certificate transfer and extensive manual revision and incorporating updated operating procedures, training programs and updated helicopter operations, all previous manuals written by Scottsdale Helicopters have been superseded by HeliService USA manuals beginning at Rev 0.

0.3.1 Current Revision

1. The published manuals in Fleetplan shall be the most current revision approved by the CHDO. The DO is the only one with the ability to publish an update to the OM-A in Fleetplan and has the sole authority to do so.
2. From the digital version, all revision history and changes can be seen.
3. The manuals will include the date of the last revision on each revised page.
4. All FAA inspectors assigned to the certificate will be given a password and access to Fleetplan in order to view all manuals. If requested a PDF version shall be provided. See below for distribution of PDF versions incase of browser or connectivity issues.

0.3.2 Editing and Revising

1. If requested, HeliService USA shall always send a PDF copy of manual revisions to the CHDO for approval.



2. Additionally, the Fleetplan system allows for regulatory oversight and revision approval in the Fleetplan manual system.
3. This method is as follows and is the preferred method.
 - a. All CHDO personnel have a password to access Fleetplan
 - b. They are part of the approval chain internally to Fleetplan
 - c. The DO shall submit the changes, which arrives in the CHDO's fleetplan inbox
 - d. They can either approve or decline the revisions made
 - e. The CHDO personnel may add comments to any rejected revisions
 - f. If disapproved, they are returned to the DO's inbox where the appropriate adjustments can be made
 - g. This process continues until acceptable revisions have been approved

0.3.3 Manual Review and Audit

HeliService USA will conduct a manual review with assigned management review personnel, either annually, or when an operational need arises that requires a change to the Operating Manual. The manual review process will include the following personnel:

1. Managing Director
2. Director of Ops
3. Director of Safety
4. Chief Pilot

The goal of a manual review/change is to ensure that HeliService USA remains in Compliance with regulatory updates as well as any operational changes. An operational change may include, but is not limited to the following:

1. New aircraft types
2. Change in existing regulatory requirements
3. New customer requirements
4. Change in scope of operations
5. New bases or operating locations
6. Significant safety issues

If an operational change occurs, there will be a full staff review to ensure that all operational impacts are planned for, appropriately resourced, and risk minimized to the maximum extent possible. This resourcing and risk mitigation is aligned and prioritized by individual managers.

Management Personnel will designate an individual with authority that is qualified and knowledgeable to the plan to direct and control resource(s). The management team will make the decision to change procedures and make recommendations to the Managing Director on acceptance of risk for the decisions. Throughout the process the Director of Safety will ensure that appropriate personnel



understand their safety role(s) and how their role contributes to the overall safety of the organization.

The Managing Director is the ultimate authority to ensure that proper resourcing of both financial and human resources for the safety and quality performance of the planned change.

0.4 OM Distribution

[14 CFR § 135.21(a)(b)(d)(1)(2)(e)(h) and 135.341(d)]

HeliService USA will maintain one complete and current copy of each manual, as required by 14 CFR § 135.21, at its Principal Base of Operations (PBO) located at KOQU.

Each copy of the Operations Manual will be electronic. All HeliService USA all manuals are incorporated and maintained in the web-based Fleetplan system, on which the most current revision will be maintained.

Copies of manuals not provided in printed form must be provided in a form that is acceptable to the Administrator and must be retrievable in the English language. Additionally, the current FAA approved OM's (A & D) shall be saved in PDF format and made available on the following electronic storage locations:

1. On each Electronic Flight Bag (EFB) Portable Electronic Device (PFD) (Refer to Chapter 13 Electronic Manuals).
2. Flight Standards District Office (FSDO) (PDF Format).
3. On HeliService USA Fleetplan software.
4. HeliService USA Aviation Maintenance Technicians (AMT's). One copy will be maintained by the Director of Maintenance and AMT's will have access to each base copy.
5. All HeliService USA pilots and AMT's will receive instruction and testing on the OM-A and OpSpecs during their Basic Indoctrination (BI) training. This will ensure familiarity and understanding of the applicable sections of the OM-A and OpSpecs.
6. It is the responsibility of the Director of Operations to ensure all HSUSA pilots and AMT's are aware of and familiar with changes to the OM-A/OpSpecs. The Director of Operations will distribute a summary of changes to all HSUSA pilots and AMT's via email summarizing the changes. Recent revisions and OBs will be reviewed in detail at the monthly aviation safety meeting. It is the responsibility of all HSUSA pilots and AMT's to contact the Director of Operations or their supervisor if they have any questions or concerns about revisions or OB's.
7. It is the responsibility of the manual holder to verify that all pages in the OM-A are current. The manual holder will accomplish this by cross-checking the List of Effective Pages (LOEP) after posting each new revision or Operations Bulletin.

HeliService USA Operations Specifications (OpSpecs)

[14 CFR § 135.23(c.)]



HeliService USA will maintain a complete electronic set of Operations Specifications at its Principal Base of Operations (PBO) located at KOQU. The PBO compliance and the requirements of 135.23(c.) for inclusion in the OM-A will be fulfilled by including a complete set of the HeliService USA, OpSpecs as Appendix A to this manual. OpSpecs distribution and revision will be the procedures listed above.

0.5 Abbreviations

AAIP Approved Aircraft Inspection Program

AD Airworthiness Directive

ADCUS Advise Customs

ADELT Automatically Deployable Emergency Locator Transmitter

ADS-B Automatic Dependent Surveillance-Broadcast

AFD Airport Facility Directory

AFM Aircraft Flight Manual

AFSS Automated Flight Service Station

AGL Above Ground Level

AIM Aeronautical Information Manual

ALARP As Low As Reasonably Practicable

ALT Altitude Hold (MSL)

ALTA Altitude Acquire

ALTPRE Altitude Pre-Select (captures preset altitude)

AME Aviation Medical Examiner

AMT Aviation Maintenance Technicians

ANSI American National Standards Institute

AOG Aircraft On Ground

ASOS Automated Surface Observing System

ATC Air Traffic Control

ATIS Automatic Terminal Information Service

ATP Airline Transport Pilot

AWOS Automated Weather Observing System

BC Back Course

BECMG Becoming

C.G. Center of Gravity

CBP Customs and Border Protection

CCI Compulsory Check of Installation

CDU Control Display Unit

CFIT Controlled Flight Into Terrain

CL Course Line

CMP Continuous Airworthiness Maintenance Program



CP Co-pilot

CPW Co-pilot Weather

CRM Crew Resource Management

CTAF Common Traffic Advisory Frequency

D Dual Day

DO Director of Operations

DME Distance Measuring Equipment

DH Decision Height

DP Decision Point

DPA Decision Point Altitude

EAD Emergency Airworthiness Directives

EFB Electronic Flight Bag

EGPWS Enhanced Ground Proximity Warning System

ELT Emergency Locator Transmitter

EMS Emergency Medical Services

EPIRB Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon

ETA Estimated Time Of Arrival

ETE Estimated Time Enroute

HAT Height Above Touchdown

HAZMAT Hazardous Material

HDG Heading Hold

HEDA Helicopter Enroute Descent Areas

HEMS Helicopter Emergency Medical Services

HERDS Helicopter emergency raft deployment system

HIRL High Intensity Runway Lights

HIS/RMI Horizontal Situation Indicator/Radio Magnetic Indicator

HSUSA HeliService USA

HLO Helicopter landing officer

HNVGO Helicopter Night Vision Goggle Operations

HOGE Hover Out of Ground Effect

HRR Helicopter Rapid Refueling

HSD Horizontal Situation Display

HSE Health and Safety Executive

HTAWS Helicopter Terrain Awareness and Warning System

HUET Helicopter underwater egress training

IP Instructor Pilot

IAF/IF Initial Approach Fix/Approach fix



IAP Instrument Approach Procedure

IAS Indicated Airspeed Hold

IAW In Accordance with

ICAO International Civil Aviation Organization ID Instructor day

IF Intermediate Approach Fix

IFR Instrument Flight Rules

ILS Instrument Landing System

IMC Instrument Meteorological Conditions

LAA Leaving assigned altitude

LP Localizer Performance

LPV Localizer Performance With Vertical Guidance

LRNS Long Range Navigation Systems

LZ Landing zone

MAP Missed Approach Point

MDA Minimum Descent Altitude

MDH Minimum Descent Height

MEA Minimum Enroute Altitude

MEF Maximum Elevation Figure

MEL Minimum Equipment List

MET Meteorological

MHZ Megahertz

MIA Minimum Instrument Altitude

MNT Maintenance

MSL Mean Sea Level

NAV Navigation Hold

NEF Nonessential Equipment and Furnishings

NEXRAD Weather Advisory System

NM Nautical Mile

NOTAM Notice to Airman

NR Non-regulatory

NVG Night Visions Goggles

NVIS Night Vision Imaging System

NWS National Weather Service

O&G Oil and Gas

OAT Outside Air Temperature

OCS Outer Continental Shelf

OEI One engine Inoperative

OSAP Offshore Approach Procedure

OSS Offshore Sub Station



OTAC Outside the Aircraft Check

PAR Preferential Arrival Route

PAR Precision Approach Radar

PDR Preferential Departure Route

PED Portable Electronic Devices

PFD Personal Flotation Device

PH Pilot hood

PIC Pilot in Command

PINS Point in Space

PIREP Pilot Weather Report

PLB Personal Locator Beacon

PNR Point of No Return

POI Principal Operations Inspector

QA Quality Assurance

QNE Standard Altimeter Setting (29.92" Hg)

QNH Altitude above Sea Level based on local station pressure

RON Remain Overnight

RADALT Radar Altimeter Hold

RAIM Receiver Autonomous Integrity Monitoring

RCLM Runway Center Line Markings

RCO Remote Communications Outlet

RF Radius to Fix

RFM Rotorcraft flight manual

RNAV Area Navigation

RON Remain Overnight

RP Recommended Practices

RVR Runway Visual Range

S.I.D.A. Security Identification Display Area

SAR Search and Rescue

SIAP Standard Instrument Approach Procedure

SIC Second in Command

SMS Safety Management System

SPIFR Single Pilot IFR

TAC Terminal Area Chart

TAF Terminal Area Forecast

TAWS Terrain Avoidance and Warning System

TCAS Traffic Collision Avoidance System

TDZ Touch Down Zone

TFR Temporary Flight Restrictions



TLOF Touch Down Lift-off Area

TWIC Transportation Worker Identification Credential

USCG US Coast Guard

VAP VOR Approach Mode

VFR Visual Flight Rules

VHF Very High Frequency

VIS Visibility

VMC Visual Meteorological Conditions

VOR Very High Frequency Omnidirectional Range Hold

VPN Virtual Private Network

VSI Vertical Speed Indicator

VY Best Rate of Climb Airspeed

V2 Takeoff Safety Speed

VMINI Minimum Airspeed for IFR

VTOCS Takeoff Climb Out Speed

VTOSS Takeoff Safety Speed for Category A Rotorcraft

VYSE Speed for Best Rate of Climb Single Engine

WAAS Wide Area Augmentation System

WTG Wind Turbine Group

0.6 General Regulatory Requirements

[14 CFR § 119.5] **Certifications, Authorizations and Prohibitions :**

1. HSUSA operations will be conducted in accordance with FAR 119.5 including; in common carriage; with the appropriate economic authority from the DOT, and only within the geographical areas that are authorized by the OpSpecs.

[14 CFR § 119.9(b)] **Use of Business Names :**

1. HeliService USA will ensure the "d/b/a": company name, HeliService USA is displayed on all HSUSA helicopters and be legible and visibly readable by a person standing on the ground at any time except during flight time.

[14 CFR § 91.9] **Civil aircraft marking and placard requirements :**

1. The DOM will ensure all aircraft are appropriately placarded and marked IAW with Part 45.

[14 CFR § 119.47] **Principal Base of Operations:**



1. HSUSA will establish and maintain a Principal Base of Operations (PBO) at Quonset State Airport (KOQU) located at the following address:
 - a. HeliService USA, 150 Airport St, North Kingstown, RI 02852.
 - b. HeliService USA will notify the CHDO (Portland FSDO) at least 30 days before changing the location of its principal base of operations.

[14 CFR § 119.49] **Contents of Operations Specifications (OpSpecs):**

1. HSUSA will obtain Operations Specifications containing all of the information required under FAR 119.49.
2. All HSUSA OpSpecs will be included in HSUSA OM-A Appendix A.

[14 CFR § 135.25(a)] **Aircraft Requirements:**

1. HSUSA will not operate an aircraft under Part 135 unless that aircraft:
 - a. Is registered as a civil aircraft of the United States and carries an appropriate and current airworthiness certificate.
 - b. Is in an airworthy condition and meets the applicable airworthiness requirements, including those relating to identification and equipment.
 - c. Is currently listed on the HSUSA Operations Specifications.

[14 CFR § 135.69] **Restriction or Suspension of Operations:**

1. During operations under 14 CFR Part 135, if HSUSA knows of conditions, including airport and runway conditions, that are a hazard to safe operations, HSUSA shall restrict or suspend operations as necessary until those conditions are corrected.

[14 CFR § 135.81] **Informing Personnel of Operational Info and Appropriate Changes :**

1. HSUSA will inform each pilot in its employment of the OpSpecs that apply to that person's duties and responsibilities. This will be accomplished during Basic Indoctrination Training. Additionally, HSUSA will make available to each pilot in its employment the following materials in current form:
 - a. Airman's Information Manual or a commercial publication that contains the same information.
 - b. 14 CFR Part 135 and 91.
 - c. Aircraft equipment manuals and aircraft flight manual or equivalent.

[14 CFR § 135.155] **Fire Extinguishers:**

1. HSUSA will ensure its helicopters meet all applicable requirements of 14 CFR § 135.155 for equipping HSUSA aircraft with fire extinguishers.



0.7 Voluntary Disclosure Reporting Program

HeliService USA is fully committed to maintaining the highest standards of safety, regulatory compliance, and operational excellence. As part of this commitment, HeliService USA actively participates in the FAA's **Voluntary Disclosure Reporting Program (VDRP)** and ensures full compliance with **Advisory Circular (AC) No: 00-58C**.

We abide by the guidelines set forth in AC 00-58C by voluntarily identifying, promptly reporting, and addressing any instances of non-compliance with FAA regulations. HeliService USA is dedicated to developing comprehensive corrective action plans that address the root causes of identified issues, ensuring they are resolved and prevented from recurring.

By adhering to the principles of the VDRP and AC 00-58C, HeliService USA reaffirms its commitment to fostering a proactive safety culture, continuous improvement, and full compliance with all relevant aviation regulations.

HSUSA will identify potential disclosures through SMS reports, internal audits, external audits, quality assurance inspections, flight data monitoring, employee feedback, accident incident investigations, or by any other means. The management team will decide what is deemed necessary for disclosure. Disclosures are made collaboratively by the company's compliance team, which may include the Chief Pilot, Director of Maintenance, and Director of Safety, depending on the nature of the issue. These individuals evaluate the severity of the potential non-compliance, perform a root cause analysis, and determine if the issue qualifies under VDRP criteria. The decision to disclose is guided by a commitment to transparency, regulatory compliance, and continuous safety improvement, with the goal of mitigating risks and strengthening operational practices.

The Director of Operations is ultimate authority over the VDRP but works closely with the Director of Safety to maintain HSUSA's compliance with the VDRP.

Personnel that have access to the VDRP will consist of at least:

1. The Director of Operations
2. Director of Maintenance
3. Chief Pilot



1 COMPANY ORGANIZATION

1.1 HeliService USA

HeliService USA is a helicopter services company that provides the highest standards of safety, efficiency, and customer service to its clients. While HSUSA offers a diverse set of helicopter services, its primary mission is to support the offshore wind industry in the construction and sustainment of offshore wind infrastructure.

HSUSA will support crew change operations utilizing offshore heli-decks under Part 135, but it will primarily be delivering technicians directly to the offshore wind turbines via hoist under Part 133 Class D. This is the first operation of its kind in the United States and will utilize twin-turbine helicopters operated by highly experienced crews.

HeliService USA maintains its headquarters and primary base of operations at Quonset State Airport (KOQU), located in North Kingston, RI. Additionally HeliService USA will ultimately maintain several satellite bases of operation, starting with one at Martha's Vineyard Airport (KMOV).

Note: All references to HeliService USA, certificate holder, or the company are deemed to mean Scottsdale Helicopters I LLC. d/b/a HeliService USA.

1.2 General

[14 CFR § 119.69(b)(c)(d)(e) and 135.23(a)]

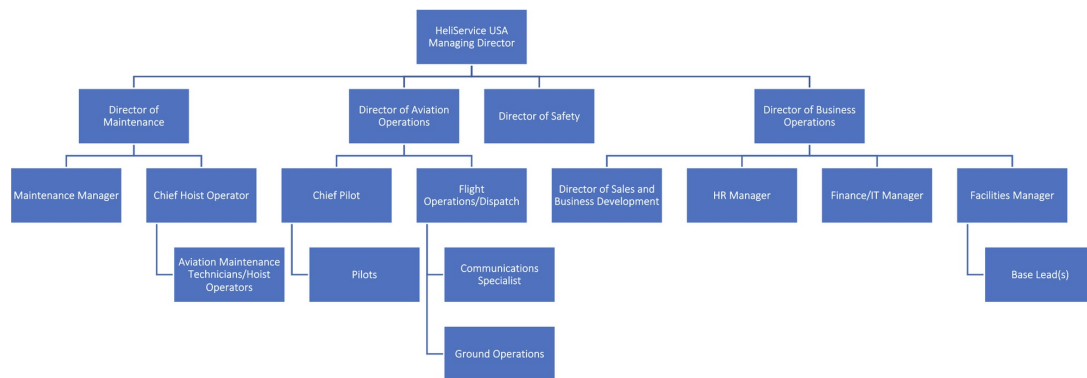
This chapter establishes organizational and management responsibilities, qualifications of management personnel (with respect to operational control) and outlines the management structure that ensures HeliService USA exercises authority over the initiation, conduct, and termination of a flight. Personnel assigned to the respective areas of responsibility will perform their duties in a professional and business-like manner in accordance with established regulatory, operational, and safety procedures. HeliService USA will notify the appropriate Portland Flight Standard District Office (PWM FSDO) within ten (10) days of any change in personnel required by 14 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) 119.69 or any vacancy of listed positions.

HeliService USA will comply the requirements of 119.69(b); 119.69(c); 119.69(d); 119.69(e); 135.23(a) to hire and assign qualified individuals as Part 119 required personnel. HeliService USA will ensure Part 119 personnel have a full understanding of the materials specified in 119.69(d)(2).

Note: Management Operational Control Authority, Process and Responsibilities are described in Chapter 6 of this manual.

1.3 Organizational Chart





1.4 Management Personnel

1.4.1 FAR Part 119/139 Management Personnel List

Position	Name	Work Address	Cell Number	Work Number
Director of Operations	Paul Russo	150 Airport St. North Kingston, RI 02582	+1 (850) 736-1756	+1 (850) 736-1756
Chief Pilot	Zachary Leggett		+1 (425) 359-0719	+1 (425) 359-0719
Director of Maintenance	Sean Williams		+1 (412) 559-9856	+1 (412) 559-9856

1.4.2 Managing Director

1. Responsibility:
 - a. All matters relating to administration, operations, maintenance, finance, and the overall administration of the company.
2. Authority:
 - a. Person with responsibility and authority to provide adequate human and financial resources.
 - b. Final authority as implementation of controls and acceptance of risk.

1.4.3 Director of Safety

1. Reports to:
 - a. Managing Director.
2. Responsibility:
 - a. The Director of Safety (DOS) plans, develops, implements, and evaluates a company-wide safety program with all entities of the transport operation, as applicable. The Director of Safety will be responsible for fostering a safety-first culture within the company. He/she will



hold the entire company accountable to this core value and to safety rules and standards through direct day-to-day operational involvement, staff education, and Performance Improvement (PI) projects. He/she will report to the Managing Director.

3. Authority:

- a. The Director of Safety is authorized to develop, implement, evaluate and amend the company's Safety Management System with input from company leadership.

1.4.4 Director of Operations

1. Reports to:

- a. Managing Director.

2. Responsibility:

- a. The Director of Operations (DO) has overall direct and overall responsibility for all helicopter operations and is responsible for all matters pertaining to operational control as required by FAR 135.77. The Director of Operations ensures that HSUSA flight operations are conducted in accordance with HSUSA authorized OpSpecs. Additionally, the DO is directly responsible to ensure all HSUSA employees comply with the requirements of this manual and the FAA issued OpSpecs, including deviations and exemptions. The DO will ensure HSUSA employees have access to the full set of the HSUSA OpSpecs, references, mandatory compliance requirements, and other information that will keep employees informed of the impact on their duties and responsibilities. The full set of the HSUSA OpSpecs are located in the HSUSA Appendix.

3. Authority:

- a. The Director of Operations has authority over all matters pertaining to operational control and over the managers and personnel that the DO supervises.
- b. The Director of Operations has the authority to establish, modify, develop instructions and enforce program policies and ensure HSUSA conformance to the Federal Aviation Regulations.

4. Duties:

- a. The Director of Operations supervises the Chief Pilot. The DO manages helicopter operational and administrative functions, general aviation security functions, and the establishment, modification and enforcement of program policies and conformance to Federal Aviation Regulations. The DO must discharge assigned duties to meet legal requirements and maintain safe operations.
- b. The Director of Operations maintains the General Operations Manual, Training Manual, Minimum Equipment Lists (MELs) and OpSpecs in a current condition. The DO is responsible for ensuring the documents in will be accessible to the pilots. The DO will



ensure that all flight publications are received on time, distributed to the bases, and put into each aircraft.

5. Primary Designee/Authority Delegation:

- a. In the absence of the DO, the Chief Pilot shall be the primary designee and shall assume those duties.

6. Qualifications:

- a. The Director of Operations will be a direct employee, will meet all of the qualifications required by Federal Aviation Regulation (FAR) 119.71(b) and a resume will be kept on file with the FSDO.

1.4.5 Chief Pilot

1. Reports to:

- a. Director of Operations.

2. Responsibility:

- a. The Chief Pilot (CP) is responsible for the overall quality of the HSUSA Training Program. Additionally, the Chief Pilot is responsible for the scheduling, supervision, training, and discipline of all pilots. The Chief Pilot must discharge assigned duties to meet legal requirements and maintain safe operations. The Chief Pilot will be responsible for scheduling pilot shifts, oversight of the Monthly Pilot Qualification List, Normal & Emergency Check Lists, and no notice ramp/en-route checks. The Chief Pilot must ensure standardization throughout the program. This is done through monthly base visits. Revisions to the training program will be directed by the Chief Pilot with input from other program check airmen and instructor pilots. These revisions will be in accordance with the guidance found in applicable Federal Aviation Regulations and Advisory Circulars. Adding or removing instructor pilots and Check Airmen will be the responsibility of the Chief Pilot.
- b. Additionally, the Chief Pilot is responsible to comply with the OpSpecs, including clearly identified excerpts, references, mandatory compliance requirements, and other information that will keep employees informed of the impact on their duties and responsibilities. The Chief Pilot will assist the Director of Operations in the establishment, modification and enforcement of all program policies.

3. Authority:

- a. The Chief Pilot has input in all pilot matters pertaining to hiring, scheduling, and disciplinary action. The Chief Pilot is authorized to exercise full operational control. The Chief Pilot has specific authority to establish, modify, and develop instructions for the HSUSA Training Program. This includes ensuring compliance by HSUSA Check Airmen, Instructors and Pilots to the HSUSA Training Program and the Federal Aviation Regulations.



4. Duties:

- a. The Chief Pilot reports directly to the Director of Operations. The Chief Pilot has oversight of the Pilots Training Program as well as the responsibility for ensuring an adequate supply of qualified pilots and the timely and professional training for all HSUSA pilots in accordance with the HSUSA Approved Training Program. The Chief Pilot is responsible to maintain current pilot training records in accordance with FAR 135.63 and shall monitor due dates for flight physicals, annual and semiannual check rides, Check Airmen, FAA observed rides, and flight and duty times. The Chief Pilot, by communicating, and through the supervision of program FAA Check Airmen, will determine that pilot training has been conducted to HSUSA Training Program standards.

5. Primary Designee/Authority Delegation:

- a. In the Chief Pilot's absence, the Director of Operations will assume the Chief Pilot's duties.

6. Qualifications:

- a. The Chief Pilot will be a direct employee and will meet all of the qualifications of FAR 119.71(d).

7. Serve as the HSUSA Aviation Training Manager:

- a. Formulate training policies, procedures, and curriculum. Prepare and maintain pilot proficiency records and files.
- b. The Aviation Training Manager is responsible for standardization through the Check Airmen and designated instructor pilots.
- c. The Chief Pilot may delegate a qualified Check Airmen as Training Manager.

1.4.6 Director of Maintenance

1. Reports to:

- a. Managing Director.

2. Responsibility:

- a. The Director of Maintenance (DOM) is responsible for the overall quality of the maintenance program and the airworthiness of aircraft operated by HSUSA. This includes their repair, inspection, maintenance and parts sparing. Responsibilities include organization of the Maintenance Department and management of its personnel. The DOM will be available and will provide direction to all maintenance personnel who are either HSUSA employees or employees of organizations who might work on the program's aircraft. The DOM is responsible for establishing maintenance policies and procedures, modifying policies and procedures and developing instructions for policies and procedures, personnel hiring, disciplinary action, training, and scheduling.



3. Authority:

- a. The Director of Maintenance is directly responsible for the continuous maintenance and constant airworthiness of all HSUSA helicopters. In the exercise of his/her responsibilities, the DOM exercises maintenance control over the daily airworthiness of aircraft. The DOM has the authority to establish, modify and develop maintenance policies and procedures, including Chapter 9 of this manual.

4. Duties:

- a. Informs all individuals with operational control responsibility and the communications center on a daily basis in regards to the airworthiness of each aircraft in the fleet.
- b. The Director of Maintenance or designee will upload a Weekly Maintenance Plan to Computerized Maintenance Tracking Program Scheduler on the first (1st) business day of every week detailing the planned Out of Service Time for the upcoming week.
- c. All pilots, Aviation Maintenance Technicians (AMT's) and management will have continuous access to the Weekly Maintenance Plan that will also include MEL discrepancies and aircraft status.
- d. Responsible for all maintenance technicians and signing of FAA correspondence and OpSpecs.
- e. Ensures all inspections, repairs and component changes are accomplished in accordance with manufacturers or FAA approved procedures.
- f. Ensures compliance with maintenance procedures, Airworthiness Directives, mandatory service bulletins, service letters and applicable 14 CFR's.
- g. Ensures all maintenance technicians are trained and current on the types of aircraft for which approved.
- h. Ensures all maintenance technicians are certificated and supervised according to the requirements specified in the 14 CFR's.
- i. Maintains a close liaison with manufacturer's representatives, parts supply houses, repair facilities and the FAA.
- j. Makes available to maintenance personnel the necessary overhaul manuals, service bulletins, service letters, Airworthiness Directives, applicable sections of this manual, and any other required technical data.
- k. Maintains all necessary work records and logbooks, including certification in the aircraft permanent maintenance records that the aircraft is approved for return to service.
- l. Coordinates replacement of an aircraft that is expected to be out of service due to scheduled maintenance.
- m. The Director of Maintenance will coordinate with the Director of Operations as to whether or not to place a backup aircraft into service.
- n. Ensures that maintenance away from home base by other than HSUSA AMTs will be performed in accordance with the guidance in Chapter 11 of this Manual.
- o. Company maintenance vendors report to the DOM and are responsible for adhering to the



policy and procedures of HSUSA and 14 CFR's when charged with correcting discrepancies or inspecting HSUSA aircraft or parts.

- p. Provides Service Difficulty Reports to the FAA per FAR 135.415. Submits the required Mechanical Interruption of Service (MIS) reports per FAR 135.417 to the FAA FSDO and provides a copy to the Director of Operations.
- q. Maintains the weight and balance records for all aircraft.

5. Primary Designee/Delegating Authority:

- a. The Director of Maintenance must discharge assigned duties to meet legal requirements and maintain safe operation.
- b. In the absence of the Director of Maintenance, a designated senior A&P (meeting Part 119 requirements) will ensure that the DOM duties are completed.

6. Qualifications:

- a. The Director of Maintenance will meet all of the requirements of FAR 119.71(e) and a resume will be kept on file with the FSDO.

1.5 Operations Personnel

[14 CFR § 61.51, 61.57, 135.245 and 135.247]

1.5.1 Check Airmen

1. Reports to:

- a. Chief Pilot.

2. Duties:

- a. Evaluate the performance and knowledge of all company pilots in accordance with FAA regulations and company policies through pilot proficiency checks as directed.
- b. Evaluate qualified pilots and observe them in the performance of their normal routine pilot duties.
- c. Provide flight and/or ground instruction on specific types of aircraft.
- d. Evaluate the knowledge, skill, and ability by observing and questioning of company pilots, and determine the degree of qualification to operate the aircraft to which they are assigned.
- e. Record findings of check flights on appropriate forms.
- f. Responsible for the safe operation of company aircraft while performing the evaluation tasks.
- g. Identify errors or shortcomings on the part of the pilot's performance, bringing them to his attention, demonstrating correct techniques or procedures as applicable.
- h. Demand skillful accomplishment of emergency procedures.
- i. Instruct Initial, Recurrent, Difference, and Upgrade Training as necessary.



- j. Recommend to management whether pilot performance, based on evaluation, is adequate enough to remain in a position as line pilot, or whether additional instruction is required.
- k. Assist the CP in reviewing and updating the Pilot Training Curriculum.
- l. Assist in creating necessary flight documents as required of the Training Department, such as checklists, etc.
- m. Keep personal copy of Operations and Training Program current.
- n. Keep personal copies of flight planning documents up to date.
- o. Guide Instructor Pilots to become check pilot.
- p. Provide ground and flight training to outside customers as necessary.
- q. Perform all other assigned tasks as directed from company officers and the CP.
- r. Review and update lesson plans and exams annually.

1.5.2 Instructor

- 1. Reports to:
 - a. Chief Pilot.
- 2. Duties:
 - a. Provide flight and/or ground instruction on specific types of helicopters.
 - b. Evaluate qualified pilots and observe them in the performance of their normal routine pilot duties.
 - c. Responsible for the safe operation of the helicopter while company or student pilots are at the controls.
 - d. Identify errors or shortcomings on the student's performance, bringing to his attention, demonstrating correct techniques or procedures as applicable.
 - e. Demand skillful accomplishment of emergency procedures.
 - f. Instruct in the peculiarities of company operation and the special requirements of the customer.
 - g. Ensure that the student is thoroughly knowledgeable of all FAA and company operating policies and directives.
 - h. Evaluate all aspects of student's performance, ability, skill, and knowledge to determine his adequacy to perform the duties of an HSUSA line pilot.
 - i. Recommend to management whether a student should be considered qualified on specific equipment, or whether additional training or disqualification is indicated.
 - j. Assist the Flight Training Manager in reviewing and updating the Pilot Training Curriculum.
 - k. Complete all required training forms neat and correct.
 - l. Keep personal copy of Operations and Training Programs current.
 - m. Perform all other tasks as directed from company officers and the CP.

1.5.3 Lead Pilot

In addition to the Duties and Responsibilities of a Line Pilot the **Lead Pilot** – is responsible for the daily



management and oversight of helicopter operations conducted from an assigned base or operational area. This position holds shared or delegated **operational control** in accordance with 14 CFR § 135.77 and ensures all flight activities comply with applicable FAA regulations, company policies, safety standards, and operational specifications:

1. Reports to:

- a. Chief Pilot. In the absence of the Chief Pilot the Lead Pilot will report to the Director of Operations.

2. Duties:

- a. Exercise operational control of assigned flights per 14 CFR Part 135, including preflight planning, flight release, and flight-following functions.
- b. Ensure compliance with all applicable FAA regulations Part 135 and or 133, company operations specifications (OpSpecs), SOPs, and safety programs.
- c. Supervise and support all personnel assigned to the base, including pilots, ground crew, and administrative staff.
- d. Coordinate with the Chief Pilot for crew scheduling, availability, and qualification management.
- e. Manage aircraft readiness in coordination with the Director of Maintenance or DOM's delegate.
- f. Participate in Safety Management System (SMS) activities, including hazard identification, safety reporting, investigations, and safety assurance initiatives.
- g. Maintain base security, facilities management, and logistics including hangar, fuel, and equipment support.
- h. Provide leadership in emergency response and serve as initial on-scene coordinator for incidents/accidents.
- i. Maintain records required for operational control and ensure all documentation (e.g., manifests, flight logs) is completed accurately and retained per regulatory requirements.

1.5.4 Line Pilot

It is the responsibility of each pilot to comply with FAA Regulations, the General Operations Manual, and any state, municipal and domestic or international government regulations that may apply to the area in which he is operating. In the event of a conflict, the more conservative regulation will apply, except where the current FAA Operations Specifications for HSUSA authorizes otherwise, and to:

1. Reports to:

- a. Chief Pilot.

2. Duties:



- a. Operate his aircraft in a safe and efficient manner, with emphasis on compliance with the OM-A, Flight Operations Policy Manual, Aircraft Flight Manual, Aeronautical Information Manual, or International Airman's Information Manual, and customer requirements.
- b. Be knowledgeable of the contents of the OM-A.
- c. Ensure all applicable qualifications and requirements found in 2.1.6 Airman, are met prior to conducting Part 135 Operations.
- d. Submit all appropriate paperwork in a neat and timely manner. Occurrence Reports, First Reports of Injury, Daily Flight Sheets and Manifests shall be submitted prior to the end of that day's work shift.
- e. Accept duty only when he is in compliance with Flight and Duty Time Regulations, and present himself rested and medically fit for flying.
- f. Maintain a logbook, or other reliable record, in accordance with 14 CFR § 61.51 to show recent flight experience requirements of 14 CFR § 61.57, 135.245 and 135.247.
- g. Assure that HSUSA has copies of his most recent airman's certificate and medical certificate.
- h. Report any major malfunctions, aircraft damage, or injured personnel to the DO or CP.
- i. Present himself in a neat and professional manner while carrying out his duties with the Company.
- j. Brief passengers of any unforeseen or unusual circumstances such as sudden descent, return to base or any event causing deviations or delays as soon as practical.
- k. Work with the customer to provide courteous, efficient, reliable, and safe service.
- l. Ensure the assigned aircraft is preflighted and flight ready prior to customer requirement.
- m. Pilot shall remain available as required so as not to delay flights during the duty shift.

1.5.5 Communications Specialist

1. Reports to:
 - a. Director of Operations
2. Duties:
 - a. Effectively schedule daily flight operations to meet customer demands
 - b. Communicate directly with airborne aircraft to ensure task completion
 - c. Provide flight following and locating services to company helicopters
 - d. Interact with Customs and Border Patrol for passenger and cargo processing
 - e. Prepare statistics and data for customers, management, and flight operations
 - f. Communicate with airport operations and fuel suppliers
 - g. Proper labeling and handling of hazardous materials (HAZMAT)
 - h. Prepare customer invoices for daily flight operations
 - i. Coordinate and schedule required customer training

1.5.6 Ground Operations

1. Reports to:
 - a. Lead Communications Specialist



2. Duties:

- a. Load and unload baggage of various weights and dimensions to and from the helicopter.
- b. Shuttle passengers via a transit passenger van to both the helicopter and terminal building.
- c. Marshal aircraft to and from parking on the ramp.
- d. Assist customers with unique needs and aid in the boarding process.
- e. Maintain cleanliness in terminal, hangar, and ramp areas.
- f. Assist with passenger check-in.
- g. Handle Passengers' Personal Protective Equipment (PPE): Cleaning, inspecting & instructing passengers on how to properly don the PPE.
- h. Other duties as assigned.

1.6 Maintenance Personnel

1.6.1 Aviation Maintenance Technician/Hoist Operators

1. Reports to:

- a. Director of Maintenance.

2. Responsibility:

- a. The Aviation Maintenance Technician (AMT)/ Hoist Operators are responsible for daily operations and performance of all program maintenance services.
- b. The Lead Mechanic functions as a leader for the maintenance team and is responsible for carrying out the mission, goals, and objectives of the company.
- c. Responsible for ensuring that all employees make safety the number one priority in all activities.

3. Duties:

- a. Coordinate with the Director of Maintenance and Maintenance Manager concerning aircraft fleet maintenance scheduling.
- b. Prioritize resources for unscheduled and AOG events.
- c. Coordinate and support all aviation vehicle maintenance during inspections and maintenance procedures serving as the point of contract for monitoring and reporting progress.
- d. Assure that the maintenance of all company aircraft is performed in accordance with the provisions of the AMM and/or the OM-A, as applicable and appropriate FARs.
- e. Act as a point of contact for technicians for day to day maintenance issues and address any maintenance department concerns.
- f. Coordinate with the Parts Logistics Coordinator for the overhaul of parts, parts repairs, required parts, supplies, tooling, and warranty claims information. Coordinate with the



Maintenance Manager to assist all AMTs in matters pertaining to the release for return to service of company aircraft.

- g. Coordinate with the Maintenance Manager on inspection packages coming due.
- h. Ensures completion of scheduled aircraft inspection packages.
- i. Work in collaboration with the DOM and Maintenance Manager to prepare the monthly Maintenance Technician on call schedule.
- j. Performs similar duties on an on-call basis as directed by the DOM and HSUSA policy.
- k. Travel to and from bases as needed or directed to assist with the maintenance needs of the flight program.
- l. May perform duties on weekends, holidays and after business hours as needed or directed by the DOM or aviation management.
- m. Complete other assigned duties as determined by the DOM.

1.6.2 Maintenance Manager

The Director of Maintenance may appoint a Maintenance Manager (MM) to coordinate maintenance activities with the Director of Maintenance and the Director of Operations, as applicable. The MM is responsible to review and perform quality control for the maintenance process and record keeping practices of aircraft operated by HSUSA. Additionally, the MM provides oversight and policy compliance for issues that pertain to aircraft records and maintenance tracking. A MM is not a required position and in lieu of a MM, the Director of Maintenance assumes all the following.

- 1. Reports to:
 - a. Director of Maintenance.
- 2. Authority:
 - a. The Maintenance Manager derives authority from and is directly responsible to the Director of Maintenance for the maintenance and airworthiness of the program aircraft under his or her control.
- 3. Duties:
 - a. The organization, and quality assurance of all maintenance performed at HSUSA's base sites.
 - b. Ensures that program aircraft are maintained to airworthiness standards prescribed by applicable regulations, airworthiness directives, company policies, and industry best practices.
 - c. Performs routine reviews of maintenance procedures and audit maintenance work completed.
 - d. Provides maintenance technical expertise and advice to maintenance technicians.
 - e. Assists the DOM as required in developing an aircraft fleet maintenance schedule.
 - f. Ensures line technicians update, comply and maintain maintenance manuals, service bulletins, parts book, regulatory updates, and other technical directives as required or



directed by conducting regular audits of these materials.

- g. Routinely reviews maintenance documentation related to work activities to assure compliance with applicable regulations.
- h. Supports the Line AMT's and aircraft to minimize downtime and reduce costs.
- i. In coordination with the DOM, schedules aircraft maintenance considering such factors as operational needs, workload, and location of equipment and facilities, tools, supplies, and job requirements.
- j. The MM maintains an effective method of receiving and inspecting incoming parts that are life limited, time-tracked component parts.
- k. Maintains current aircraft weight and balance records and aircraft equipment lists.
- l. Maintains a current status report of applicable Airworthiness Directives (AD), including the effective dated of the AD, the date and method of compliance, and the Airworthiness Directives involves recurring action, the time and date when the next action is required for all company operated aircraft, engine, propellers and appliances (FAR 135.439(a)(2)(v)).
- m. Ensures all special inspections and AD notes are complied with as required.
- n. Maintains a list of current major alterations and repairs to each airframe, engine, and appliance operated by the Company (FAR 135.439(a)(2)(vi)).
- o. Applies for and obtains any license or certificate renewals for aircraft, radios and other related equipment as required or appropriate.



2 SAFETY

2.1 Safety Statement

1. The Management of HeliService USA is committed to ensuring its aviation activities meet the highest possible safety standards. We believe in going above and beyond the regulatory requirements.
2. HeliService USA believes that safety is not just a box to be checked with a set of manuals, meetings, or FAA approved program. We believe safety needs to be ingrained into the culture of the organization.
3. Additionally, HSUSA will comply with all applicable legal requirements, meet all applicable standards, and always consider best practices.
4. Each employee, at every level, is responsible for reporting any information that may compromise the safety of the organization or potentially cause a mishap. If they feel their concern hasn't been thoroughly heard or has been inappropriately dismissed, they shall continue to bring that concern to the next level of management, all the way to the Managing Director, without fear of reprisal.
5. To promote a timely, uninhibited flow of information, HSUSA has a "Just Culture" that ensures all safety related communication to be free of reprisal.
6. HeliService understands employees can and do make legitimate mistakes. We want to hear about those mistakes and work as an organization to prevent them from occurring again. We want a free flow of information where other employees can learn from those mistakes.
7. Incidents or occurrences with elements of willful misconduct, gross negligence, or criminal acts, however, will be met with disciplinary and/or legal action.
8. HeliService USA will have a Director of Safety and maintain an SMS or Safety Management System.

2.2 Safety Standards

1. Enforce safety as one of the primary responsibilities of all departmental managers.
2. Support a "Just Culture".
3. Avoid blaming anyone for reporting something which would not have been otherwise detected.
4. Implement an effective Safety and Compliance Management System to ensure that customer and regulatory requirements are met and ensure that all employees are aware that safety and compliance is everyone's responsibility.
5. Ensure safety and risk considerations are incorporated throughout its business through a documented management of change process (MOC).
6. Establish and implement hazard identification and risk management processes in order to eliminate or mitigate the risks associated with our operations to a point which is As Low As Reasonably Practicable (ALARP).
7. Develop the skills of employees to ensure that the management system can be maintained through a process of recurrent training and an awareness program.



8. Incorporate a process of continuous improvement to ensure that customer expectations and safety standards are satisfied by setting safety objectives and performance standards.

2.3 Risk Management

HeliService USA believes risk management is an integral part of an effective safety culture. It is every employee's job to always consider risk management in their daily decision making processes. They need to ask what the potential consequences of a decision may be and take appropriate actions to mitigate. That sometimes may not be "popular" or may slow down operations, that is to be understood and conservative response to a situation should always be encouraged by management.

For Crew Change and HHO operations, HSUSA mitigates normal risk through assessment of its daily operations and integrating risk mitigation's into its normal procedures. Prior to a flight, the crew should always discuss risk and possible abnormal risk factors. If there are any non-standard tasks to be accomplished or abnormal risks identified, they shall be mitigated utilizing the FORDEC decision making process. Should there be any concerns or employees need a sounding board, they are always encouraged to contact management to discuss further.

For HAA operations, the pilots will assess risk through the HeliService USA HAA/SAR risk assessment.

Prior to the first leg of each helicopter air ambulance operation, the pilot in command must conduct a preflight risk analysis and complete the HAA/SAR risk analysis worksheet which is located in the Complete Flight application.

The pilot in command must sign the preflight risk analysis worksheet which will then specify the date and time it was completed. Based upon the risk value attained through the assessment process, the pilot will attain an appropriate approval for launch. A score of 58 or below, the pilot may self launch after reviewing and approving the risk assessment through the "Base OCC" profile. A score of 59-85 is a Moderate Risk and requires Chief Pilot or Director of Operations Approval. A score above 86 is a High Risk and requires Chief Pilot or Director of Operations Approval.

The purpose of contacting the CP or DO for Moderate and High level risk assessments is so that the risk assessment can be reviewed by a third party in which identified hazards can be discussed. If possible, risks will attempt to be mitigated to a lower level, limit exposure and if possible, reduce the possible severity of the risk assessment. For Moderate and High level risk assessment, the CP or DO will approve and digitally sign the risk assessment.

All digital risk assessments in Complete Flight will be maintained on the Complete Flight Data Server and must remain on the server for atleast 90 days from the date of the operation.



2.4 Safety Organization

The overall accountability lies with the Managing Director. He/she shall endorse the safety program and emphasize safety as one of the primary responsibilities. The Managing Director must ensure that the organization has sufficient resources available to safely perform aviation operations.

1. He/she shall endorse the safety culture. The Director of Safety is responsible of developing, maintaining, and administrating the Safety Management System of HeliService USA.

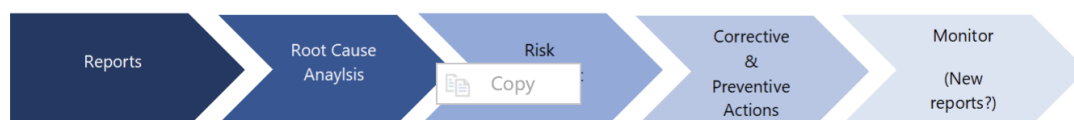
All other heads of departments must still take ownership of their department's safety.

1. Leadership of each department shall lead by example when it comes to promoting safety. The heads of departments must promote the value of a Safety Management System and ensure that all employees in their department comply with HSUSA Safety Policy.

2.5 Reporting System

1. HeliService USA believes the ability to document and record safety related issues is critical to an effective safety management system. HSUSA utilizes the web-based application Fleetplan for employees and customers to report any safety related issues.
2. While HSUSA believes in a reprisal-free and just culture, these reports can also be filed anonymously by employees or customers to remove any reticence an individual may have to reporting a safety concern.
3. Upon receipt of the safety report, the Director of Safety is able to analyze, mitigate, and close the occurrence accordingly.
4. These reports will be published company-wide on a monthly basis and discussed during the monthly safety meeting.

The following chart shall show the workflow of the reporting system:



3 PILOT QUALIFICATIONS AND REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General

[14 CFR § 135.243]

This chapter will describe the Pilot Qualifications and Duties required of all HSUSA Pilots in Command (PIC's) and HSUSA designated Second in Command (SIC's). For aircraft typed for single pilot operations, all pilots will meet 14 CFR § 135.243 VFR PIC minimums, but HSUSA will designate SIC's, the duties / responsibilities of which are laid out in the following sections.

Before being designated as a HeliService USA PIC or SIC to operate HSUSA helicopters, each pilot must have the basic qualifications and experience described in this chapter and must successfully complete the initial training requirements in accordance with the HSUSA Pilot Training Program. Thereafter, the PIC or SIC will meet the annual recurrent training requirements in each type of aircraft they are designated as PIC or SIC.

3.1.1 Pilot Certificate

[14 CFR § 135.25(d)(3) and 135.95(a)]

All pilots shall have in their personal possession a current original commercial or ATP certificate (not photocopy, except as provided for by the Exemption for Temporary Replacement of Pilot or Medical Certificate for lost certificates procedures) during the time they act as a flight crewmember. The PIC will not begin a flight unless the required appropriate photo identification, current airman and medical certificates are in each flight crewmembers' possession or readily accessible in the aircraft.

Pilots shall send a photocopy (actual size, do not enlarge or reduce) of all newly issued certificates to the HeliService USA CP within 21 days of issue. This includes both temporary and permanent issue certificates.

3.1.2 Medical Certificate

All pilots shall have in their personal possession a current, original (not photocopy) medical certificate during the time they act as a flight crewmember. All pilots shall hold at least a second class medical certificate which is renewed annually, unless the assigned customer requires a first class medical.

Pilots shall send a photocopy (actual size, do not enlarge or reduce) of their new medical certificate to the Chief Pilot no later than the 20th of the month it is due. If there is any problem in meeting this schedule, notify the Chief Pilot.

3.1.3 Flight & Duty Time



[14 CFR § 135.263(c), 135.267(b)(c)(1)(2)(3))(d)(e)(1)(2)(3)(f) and 135.271(a)(1)(2)(3)(b)]

3.1.3.1 Flight and Duty Report / Logging

Pilots will document length of duty day and flight time flown by use of the Flight and Duty application (Complete Flight). Pilots will sign into the flight and duty when arriving at a HeliService USA facility and reporting for duty, and sign out at the completion of all duties (to include paperwork, engine rinse, etc.). When your day is complete, fill in all appropriate information. Pilots may also sign in and out via phone, internal or external internet, or radio with dispatch when their duty day begins or ends when in a remote location.

3.1.3.2 Flight Time & Duty Day Limitations

HeliService USA pilots will not accept any flight assignment unless that flight assignment is in full compliance with all FAR's pertaining to flight time, duty time, and rest requirements. Regulations pertaining to flight, duty and rest are a joint responsibility between pilots and HeliService USA. HSUSA will not assign, and no pilot may accept, an assignment without complying with the applicable regulation(s).

The following list is a Duty/Flight Time Check List of the requirements. This reference is for convenience and is not to be construed as all-inclusive or relieving the pilot of the responsibility to be familiar with all applicable FAR's, policies and limitations:

1. HSUSA pilots will not exceed a 14 hour Duty Day.
2. HSUSA pilots will not takeoff or be assigned by the company any flight leg that will cause the Pilot to exceed the 14 hour duty day.
3. Duty time starts when the pilot arrives for the shift assignment at an HSUSA facility.
4. A rest period of 10 hours is required after the completion of each shift.
5. A rest period of 10 hours is required before reporting for a shift.
6. Time spent traveling on transportation provided by HSUSA to and from an assignment while on duty is not considered part of the pilot's rest period.
7. Time spent performing administrative duties and Part 91 flight operations will count toward the HSUSA Pilot Duty Day.
8. HSUSA pilots will not exceed (or be assigned by HSUSA) more than ten (10) flight hours in a 24 hour period when operating with two qualified pilots under Part 135 or eight (8) flight hours when operating single pilot.

3.1.3.3 Rest Requirements

1. Each flight assignment must provide for at least 10 consecutive hours of rest during the 24 hour period that precedes the planned completion time of the shift assignment.
2. A rest period is free of all forms of duty and company responsibility. HeliService USA will not assign any pilot to any duty during any required rest period.
3. HeliService USA will provide each flight crewmember at least 13 rest periods of at least 24



consecutive hours each in each calendar quarter.

3.1.3.4 Flight Time Limits

Pilots may not accept (or be given) assignment if flight time exceeds 14 CFR § 135.267 limitations.

Total Flight Time Limits are 14 CFR § 135.267:

1. 500 hours in a calendar quarter.
2. 800 hours in any two consecutive quarters.
3. 1,400 hours in a calendar year.
4. HSUSA pilots will not exceed (or be assigned by HSI) more than ten (10) flight hours in a 24 hour period when operating with two qualified pilots under Part 135 or eight (8) flight hours when operating single pilot.

Note:

The eight (8) hours of flying in a day is based on a continuous rolling clock. Even though the flying in the past 24 hours may comply, scheduling for the next duty period must compensate for the next consecutive duty period to ensure the proper rest requirements meets or exceeds applicable regulations 14 CFR § 135.267(c).

3.1.3.5 Exceeding Duty Time / Flight Limits

[14 CFR § 135.267

If a pilot has exceeded the daily flight time limitations in this section, because of circumstances beyond the control of the certificate holder or pilot (such as adverse weather conditions), that pilot must have a rest period before being assigned or accepting an assignment for flight time of at least:

1. Eleven (11) consecutive hours of rest if the flight time limitation is exceeded by not more than 30 minutes;
2. Twelve (12) consecutive hours of rest if the flight time limitation is exceeded by more than 30 minutes, but not more than 60 minutes; and
3. Sixteen (16) consecutive hours of rest if the flight time limitation is exceeded by more than 60 minutes.

Any HeliService USA pilot exceeding flight or duty limitations will notify the Chief Pilot immediately. The Chief Pilot will make arrangements to remove the pilot from the schedule until adequate rest can be attained.

3.1.4 VFR Currency

[14 CFR § 135.247]

1. A pilot is not allowed to operate a helicopter carrying passengers as Pilot in Command unless he



has carried out, in the preceding 90 days, at least three (3) take-offs, approaches and landings in a helicopter of the same type or class or a full flight simulator (FFS) representing that type or class. These approaches and landings do not have to be as PIC.

2. For operations during the period beginning one (1) hour after sunset and ending one (1) hour before sunrise, a pilot is not allowed to operate a helicopter carrying passengers as Pilot in Command unless he has carried out, in the preceding 90 days, at least three (3) take-offs, approaches and landings in a helicopter of the same type or class or a full flight simulator (FFS) representing that type or class.

3.1.5 Oral & Written Testing

[14 CFR § 135.293(a)]

Prior to acting as a pilot in Part 135 Operations, a pilot shall have completed a written or oral exam with a score of no less than 80 percent covering each type of aircraft and the flight operation(s) for which he is qualified. In order for a pilot to be current in Part 135 operations, the exam(s) shall have been completed within the previous twelve (12) month period.

3.1.6 Checkrides

[14 CFR § 135.293(d), 135.297(b) and 135.343]

3.1.6.1 135.293 Initial / Recurrent Check

[14 CFR § 135.293(d), 135.297(b) and 135.343]

Prior to acting as a pilot in 14 CFR Part 135 operations a pilot shall have completed a competency check flight in each type of aircraft for which he is qualified. In order for a pilot to be current in 14 CFR Part 135 operations, the competency check shall have been completed within the previous twelve (12) month period.

3.1.6.2 135.299 Line Check

[14 CFR § 135.299(a)(2)(3)]

A pilot shall have completed a Line Check which includes a flight over a least one appropriate route segment to include takeoffs and landings within the previous twelve (12) months prior to acting as PIC in 14 CFR Part 135 operations. The Line Check may be completed in any type of aircraft in which the pilot is qualified. The check pilot conducting the Line Check shall complete the appropriate documentation. Log the successful completion of this check in the front of this manual. Pilots may review qualifications on pilot events.



In the event of an unsuccessful check, during a revenue flight, that crewman shall be removed from service at the next HSUSA facility.

3.1.6.3 135.297 Instrument Proficiency Check

[14 CFR § 135.297(a)(b)(c)(2)(d)(e)(g)(3) and 135.299(a)(1)]

1. Prior to acting as PIC under IFR with an SIC, a pilot shall have completed an Instrument Proficiency Check within the previous six month period.
2. Prior to acting as PIC under IFR with an autopilot and without an SIC, a pilot shall have completed an Instrument Proficiency Check within the previous six (6) month period and demonstrated the ability to pilot the aircraft (without a second in command) with and without the aid of an autopilot. The autopilot check (14 CFR § 135.297(g)) must have been completed within the proceeding twelve (12) month period.
3. If the PIC is assigned to pilot more than one type of aircraft the Instrument Proficiency Checks must be conducted in each type aircraft in rotation.
4. The check pilot conducting the Instrument Proficiency Check shall complete the appropriate documentation. Pilots may review qualifications on Pilot Events.

3.1.6.4 Crewmember: Tests and checks, grace provisions, training to accepted standards.

[14 CFR § 135.301]

1. If a crewmember who is required to take a test or a flight check completes the test or flight check in the calendar month before or after the calendar month in which it is required, that crewmember is considered to have completed the test or check in the calendar month in which it is required.
2. If a pilot being checked fails any of the required maneuvers, the person giving the check may give additional training to the pilot during the course of the check. In addition to repeating the maneuvers failed, the person giving the check may require the pilot being checked to repeat any other maneuvers that are necessary to determine the pilot's proficiency. If the pilot being checked is unable to demonstrate satisfactory performance to the person conducting the check, the certificate holder may not use the pilot, nor may the pilot serve, as a flight crewmember in operations under this part until the pilot has satisfactorily completed the check.

3.2 PIC Authority, Responsibilities, and Qualifications

3.2.1 PIC Authority

The PIC is directly responsible for and is the final authority for the operation of the aircraft.

3.2.2 PIC Responsibility



[14 CFR § 135.19(a)(b)(c), 135.69(b), 135.123(b)]

1. No PIC may allow a flight to continue toward any airport of intended landing unless, in the opinion of the PIC, the conditions that are a hazard to safe operations may reasonably be expected to be corrected by the estimated time of arrival or, unless there is no safer procedure. In the latter event, the continuation toward that airport is an emergency situation under 14 CFR § 135.19.
2. In an inflight emergency requires immediate action, the PIC may deviate from any CFR or company procedure to the extent required to meet that emergency.
 - a. In the event a PIC deviates, the pilot shall submit a written report to HSUSA within 24 hours.
 - b. The Chief Pilot will be responsible for submitting a deviation report to the FAA.

3.2.3 PIC Qualifications

[14 CFR § 135.243]

All HeliService USA PIC's shall meet the minimums in 14 CFR § 135.243. Additionally they will have the following:

1. FAA Class I Medical issued within the past 12 months.
2. FAA ATP Helicopter (or attained within one year of hiring date) .
3. FAA Instrument Rating.
4. 2000 Total Hours (1500 in helicopters).
5. 1000 Hours PIC Helicopter.
6. 50 Hours PIC in Type (HSUSA preferred).
7. 100 Night Hours.
8. 350 Multi-Pilot (MP) Hours (HSUSA preferred).
9. 350 Offshore Hours (HSUSA preferred).

Note:

The Director of Operations may waive certain of the preceding requirements as long as the pilot meets insurance, client, and 14 CFR § 135.243 requirements.

3.2.4 Recency Requirements

[14 CFR § 135.247]

1. A pilot is not allowed to operate a helicopter carrying passengers as Pilot in Command unless he has carried out, in the preceding 90 days, at least three (3) take-offs, approaches and landings in a helicopter of the same type or class or a full flight simulator (FFS) representing that type or class. These approaches and landings do not have to be as PIC.



2. For operations during the period beginning one (1) hour after sunset and ending one (1) hour before sunrise, A pilot is not allowed to operate a helicopter carrying passengers as Pilot in Command unless he has carried out, in the preceding 90 days, at least three (3) take-offs, approaches and landings in a helicopter of the same type or class or a full flight simulator (FFS) representing that type or class.

3.2.4.1 Offshore Helideck Day/Night Recency Requirements

No HSUSA pilot will operate an HSUSA aircraft to an offshore installation unless:

In the previous 60 days:

- Has logged 15 hours in make and model. (See Note i and vi)
- Completed 3 cycles to an offshore helideck. (See Note ii, iii, iv, and vi)

For Night Operations:

- In the previous 90 days completed 3 night offshore cycles in the make and model or equivalent simulator. (See Note iii, iv, v, and vi)
- In the previous 365 days completed 3 actual offshore cycles to a helideck in the make and model. (See Note iii, iv, and vi)

Note:

If these requirements cannot be met the following shall be accomplished:

- i. If hours are not met, a recency check on the make and model (a dedicated flight or a normal revenue flight) is conducted by a LTC (Line Training Captain). The flight includes at least a sector flying as PM and another sector as PF. Successful completion of a recency check reestablishes recency for 60 days. The Company Aviation Advisor is to be notified each time a recency flight was required.
- ii. If the day cycles are not met between 60 and 90 days, an offshore recency training flight (which may be a revenue flight) with a current LTC is made to regain offshore recency. Successful completion of a recency check re-establishes recency for 60 days.
- iii. If the day and/or night cycles are not met within 90 days (and 365 days for night offshore cycles), a non-passenger carrying line training flight with a current LTC is made to regain the appropriate offshore recency.
- iv. One cycle consists of a take-off, approach and landing on the aircraft type.
- v. Use of a simulator of the same make and model being flown is acceptable to meet the night recency requirements, provided this is acceptable under national legislation, and it has the visual fidelity to replicate landing on an offshore facility under the typical spread of local weather conditions. The simulator recurrent training sessions are to be supervised by a Simulator Flight instructor.
- vi. The recency training flights, or line checks as mentioned in note i, ii and iii above are to determine proficiency for the environment and operations carried out. They are not intended to be



conducted routinely at the end of a recency period. In the cases where the recency requirements are regularly missed due to low contracted flight operational hours, a risk assessment with appropriate mitigation is presented to the Company Aviation Advisor.

3.2.4.2 IFR

[14 CFR § 135.297(a)(b)(c)(2)(d)(e)(g)(3) and 135.299(a)(1)]

1. Prior to acting as PIC under IFR with an SIC, a pilot shall have completed an Instrument Proficiency Check within the previous six (6) month period.
2. If the PIC is assigned to pilot more than one type of aircraft (i.e., AW169, AW139, etc.) the Instrument Proficiency Checks must be conducted in each type aircraft in rotation.
3. The check pilot conducting the Instrument Proficiency Check shall complete the appropriate documentation. Pilots may review qualifications on Pilot Events.

3.2.4.3 IFR Without SIC

[14 CFR § 135.297(a)(b)(c)(2)(d)(e)(g)(3) and 135.299(a)(1) and 61.57]

Prior to acting as PIC under IFR with an autopilot and without an SIC, a pilot shall have completed an Instrument Proficiency Check within the previous six (6) month period and demonstrated the ability to pilot the aircraft (without a Second in Command) with and without the aid of an autopilot. The autopilot check (14 CFR § 135.297(g)) must have been completed within the proceeding twelve (12) month period.

3.3 SIC

3.3.1 SIC Responsibility

The person designated as SIC is responsible to act as a fully qualified and competent pilot. The SIC shall participate in the decision making process by offering timely suggestions, and opinions. Furthermore, he shall critique a faulty decision, or advocate a different position if necessary to ensure the safety of the flight.

Note for AW-169 operations: As the type certificate does not require an SIC, the term "SIC" is used in this context as an HSUSA internal designation. There will be an HSUSA designated PIC assigned to every flight who meets the requirements listed in OM-A Chapter 3.2 and will act as the final authority for the operation of the aircraft.

While HeliService USA SIC's meet 14 CFR § 135.243 (VFR) PIC minimum hour requirements and will be trained / certified to the same level as PIC's, they shall not do the following:



1. Act as PIC while conducting IFR flight.
2. Log PIC time while not the primary manipulator of the flight controls.
3. Conduct hoist operations from the right seat (unless in a training syllabus).

3.3.2 SIC Qualifications

All HeliService USA PIC's shall meet the minimums in 14 CFR § 135.243. Additionally they will have the following:

1. FAA Class I Medical issued within the past 12 months.
2. FAA Commercial Pilot Certificate.
3. FAA Instrument Rating.
4. 500 Total Hours.
5. 100 Hour Cross-Country.
6. 25 Night Hours.

3.3.3 Checkride Requirements

Despite the limitations listed in OM-A chapter 3.3.1, pilots designated as SIC's by HSUSA are still required to meet the checkride requirements laid out in OM-A chapter 3.1.5. While some of these checkrides or portions thereof are not regulatory in nature, HSUSA believes in maintaining the highest of standards for all its pilots.

Note 1 (AW-169): Unless the HSUSA designated SIC meets 14 CFR § 135.243(c) IFR (PIC) minimums, the instrument portions of the 14 CFR § 135.293 check are not regulatory in nature and will be logged only as internal training.

Note 2 (AW-169): The 14 CFR § 135.299 check is not required from a regulatory perspective for an HSUSA designated SIC, but completion of this check allows said SIC to log PIC time.

Note 3 (AW-169): Unless the HSUSA designated SIC meets 14 CFR § 135.243(c) IFR (PIC) minimums, the 14 CFR § 135.297 check is not regulatory in nature and will be logged as internal training only.

Note 4 (AW-169): Should the HSUSA designated SIC fail the 14 CFR § 135.297 check or the non-regulatory (instrument) portion of a 14 CFR § 135.293 check, the same procedures would be followed (internally) as if it were a regulatory requirement, but it will not be reported externally.

3.3.4 Requirements for IFR Flight

[14 CFR § 135.101, 61.57(c) and 135.343]

Prior to acting as an SIC under IFR a pilot shall have either of the following:

1. Recent IFR Experience:



Within the previous six (6) months, performed and logged at least six (6) instrument approaches, as well as holding procedures, and intercepting and tracking courses through the use of navigation systems.

2. Instrument Proficiency Check:

Completed an Instrument Proficiency Check within the previous six (6) months. The check pilot conducting the Instrument Proficiency Check shall log the successful completion of the appropriate documentation. Pilots may review qualifications on Pilot Events.



4 FLIGHT LOCATING AND DISPATCH RESPONSIBILITIES

[14 CFR § 135.79]

4.1 HeliService Communications Center & Responsibilities

The HeliService USA communications center is the focal point for all helicopter operations, linking together maintenance, ground operations, flight operations, all while interfacing with the customer to satisfy their requirements in a timely manner. Anytime HSUSA aircraft are flying under 14 CFR Part 135, or with customers onboard, the communications center will be manned with at least one communications specialist. Communications specialists will be trained IAW with the curriculum outlined for them in the OM-D.

HeliService USA communications responsibilities include (but are not limited to) the following:

1. Receive and process customer requests.
2. Assess viability of request by factoring in the following and confirming with an on-duty pilot:
 - a. Weather.
 - b. Weight & Balance.
 - c. Crew availability & duty day.
 - d. Maintenance factors including aircraft availability.
3. If unable to complete a flight as requested, offer a solution to the customer (estimated next available time, multiple trips, etc.).
4. Flight following. HSUSA uses Spider Tracks to track and communicate with aircraft.
5. Initiation of the emergency action plans.
6. Processing of flight follow-ups and keeping relevant flight operational statistics.

4.2 Personnel

HeliService USA communications specialists and ground personnel are the face of the company and will strive to provide the best customer experience possible. At all times, they will display the following attributes:

1. Professionalism.
2. Courtesy.
3. Helpfulness and willingness to explain.
4. Be solutions and customer service oriented.

4.2.1 Communications Center

HeliService USA's communication center is the connection between HeliService USA customers and our flight and ground crews. The information that communications collects and disseminates to HSUSA crews is vital to the successful and timely delivery of passengers and equipment to their destination. Tasks that communications personnel will conduct daily are:



1. Maintain awareness on aircraft/aircrew status.
2. Disseminate/Communicate flight requests to aircrews.
3. Track location and progress of individual flights, communicate changes to aircrews as required. (Utilizing Spider Tracks)
4. Conduct invoicing after completion of flights.
5. Initiate overdue aircraft procedures if required.

4.2.2 Ground Operations

Ground Operations are the logistical connection between our customers and aircrews. They can be either dedicated, or dual role, also serving as a dispatcher, hoist operator, or mechanic. Ground Operators work in conjunction with Dispatch to make sure that all customers and equipment are prepared to safely embark and debark HeliService USA aircraft.

Daily responsibilities include:

1. Reception of Passengers.
2. Handling/Screening of cargo and Dangerous Goods.
3. Ensuring Passengers watch Safety Briefings.
4. Assist Passengers with Donning of PPE.
5. Inspect PPE prior to boarding aircraft.
6. Guide passengers for onloading and offloading.
7. Assist in loading and securing cargo.
8. Assist in moving and refueling aircraft.

4.3 Flight Dispatching/Booking

Minimum information that Dispatch collects from a customer request is:

1. Date of the request.
2. Expected block time, requested departure, or arrival time.
3. Requested departure location and delivery location.
4. Properly filled out manifest to include total number of passengers and equipment.
5. Declaration of any hazardous cargo (HAZMAT/dangerous goods).

4.3.1 Aircraft Assignments

Assignment of aircraft by dispatch will be coordinated with the Director of Maintenance or their designated maintenance representative. Generally this will be provided by maintenance the evening prior via an electronic briefing (or email) which includes the following:



1. Which is the primary aircraft(s) for each base.
2. If there is a spare aircraft available for each base.
3. Current seating/hoist configuration of all available aircraft.
4. Potential hour limitations on each helicopter due to required inspections or schedule maintenance.

Note: If an aircraft is dispatched on a request and not currently in the correct configuration, maintenance will be notified and the aircraft configuration will be annotated to ensure that the aircraft is correctly configured prior to departure.

4.3.2 Crew Scheduling

The DO or CP shall provide the communications center with a schedule of current and qualified duty pilots via CompleteFlight. Scheduling of crews to given flights on a particular day will be done by the communications center in accordance with the current pilot duty roster provided to them by the DO or CP.

1. Pilots/HHO's will be notified of a preliminary flying schedule the evening prior to their shift either by phone or when they check out for the day, but shall not be contacted within 10 hours of the beginning of their duty day to allow for FAA mandated crew rest.
2. Dispatchers should be aware of and consider pilot duty day requirements prior to assigning a flight.
3. Pilots/HHO's are expected to show up to shift at their assigned duty time to confirm paperwork, status of the aircraft, handle any administrative work, and see if there's any pending flights.
4. Once pilots/HHO's have checked in and if there are no current/pending flights, they are permitted to leave the base at CP/DO discretion, but must be reachable via phone at any time during their duty day and able to return to base within 45 minutes in case of an ad-hoc flight.

4.4 Manifests

4.4.1 Customer Manifest

Customers declare a flight to HeliService via an e-mail no later than one day prior the flight, inclusive of the filled manifest. The manifest is proprietary to HSUSA and kept on file.

HSUSA customers are instructed to fill out all necessary information about the passenger(s) flying, including the following:

1. Last name.
2. First name.
3. Date of birth.
4. Passport number (if customs is required).
5. Nationality.



6. Requirement for customs.
7. Weight if already known.

The communications center is responsible to fill out the additional data in the header (if not yet completed by the customer) and will check the manifest for completeness.

Prior to departure:

1. This shall be provided to the pilot(s) prior to departure enabling them to properly fill out the flight manifest and ensure customs is alerted if needed.
2. Communications will fill out the initial leg manifest passenger information and weights.
3. Pilots are responsible to confirm and verify the passenger names, locations and weight and balance calculations for accuracy.

4.4.2 Flight Manifest Storage

The manifest for the current leg (not to be confused with the customer manifest) required IAW 14 CFR 135.63 (c) shall be on the aircraft at all times (via electronic means) and at the primary base of operations (KOQU).

Manifest data will be electronically updated each leg and saved via the Complete Flight Application and saved on the Complete Flight servers. Manifests shall be saved for a minimum of 120 days and will only be deleted from the Complete Flight server at the discretion of the Director of Operations.

Manifest data will include:

1. The number of passengers.
2. The total weight of the loaded aircraft.
3. The maximum allowable takeoff weight for that flight
4. The center of gravity of the loaded aircraft
5. The registration number of the aircraft or flight number
6. The origin and destination
7. Identification of crew members and their crew position assignments.

4.5 Prior to Departure

1. In case of irregularities during the Check-In process (e.g. a pax did not show up, unannounced cargo), HeliService USA Dispatch will be informed (by ground operations) and will clarify with the customer.
2. One hour prior to scheduled departure, the platform, vessel or coordination center will send a weather/helideck report via mail to dispatch. This report will be forwarded to the crew of the respective helicopter as it is essential for the correct flight planning of the aircrew.
3. During their flight preparation, pilots will calculate the amount of fuel required and will inform dispatch of the required amount. Dispatch will order fuel via the internal radio or the contracted



FBO. It is critically important this is accurately communicated as an in-accurate load of fuel may require de-fueling and significantly delay the process.

4. It is the responsibility of HSUSA dispatch to confirm and clarify whether PPE will be required or not for customers:
 - a. Passengers that depart from an HSUSA primary base of operations will be equipped with PPE during the standard check-in-process.
 - b. For inbound passengers or passengers that will fly from remote bases, it is essential to clarify the demand of required PPE prior to initial take-off (as it may be necessary to load the PPE onto the aircraft). The PPE order has to be send to HeliService USA Check-In to be assembled / loaded onto the aircraft.
5. The flight declaration must be updated in case of a delay or changes to the manifests (i.e. a change of passengers or additional dutiable goods).
6. If the flight is delayed, the flight plan needs to be updated to the new estimated time of departure.

4.6 HAA/SAR Communications Alert/Dispatch

The initial HAA/SAR Alert/Dispatch process is a simple process to give the pilots/crew enough information so to ensure a timely and efficient launch process.

Communication Center Notification. The communication's center is notified by the requesting user that they are in need of a HeliService asset in support of a HAA/SAR tasking.

Communications to Pilot/Crew Notification. Communications will notify the pilot via handheld radio or telephone the following information.

1. Requested Asset (i.e. Wind 11)
2. Type of request (SAR, HAA Interfacility, or HAA Scene)
3. Tentative request with locations. (Quonset to USS Ship to Rhode Island Hospital)
4. Whether or not the transport request has been turned down by another asset or operator.

Example notification:

"Wind 11, requested for HAA Interfacility request from USS Ship to Rhode Island Hospital." or

"Wind 11, HAA scene request town of Woonsocket, LZ 2 to Rhode Island Hospital."

"Wind 11, requested for HAA Interfacility from Martha's Vineyard to Mass General, declined by Boston MedFlight due to Weather."

Simultaneously communications will create a flight dispatch in Complete Flight with the route of flight, type of HAA request and send the pilot the Complete Flight request.

Pilot Readback and Acceptance/decline. Upon completion of the radio notification, the pilot will readback the radio call to communications verifying the type of transport and route of flight. Upon



receipt of the complete flight dispatch, the pilot will review applicable weather, NOTAMS and TFR's to ensure that they can complete the flight within all applicable HeliService Manuals and FAA Regulations.

If the pilot determines that they can complete the transport request, they will notify communications that they "accept" the transport request. At that time the crew will conduct a quick brief about the type of transport and the route of flight and any updated weather that might have changed throughout the projected window of the transport.

If the pilot determines that they cannot complete the transport in accordance all applicable HeliService OM's and FAA Regulations, then the pilot will "Decline" the transport request. Simultaneously, the pilot will annotate in Complete Flight why the transport was declined.

Example: Acceptance: Wind 11 accepts.

Decline: Wind 11 declines due to Wx below minimums.

Completion of Risk Assessment. Prior to departure, the PIC must have a completed, signed and approved risk assessment that has an electronic signature and time stamp. If the risk assessment is a Medium or High Risk, the appropriate approval authority must sign the risk assessment prior to departure.

All to "Go", One to say "No" . If at anytime during the HAA/SAR operation ANY member of the crew feels that something is overlooked, unsafe or just simply out of their level of comfort, the crew member has the right to speak up to the crew and discuss their concern. At that time the crew will come to a consensus as to whether they will continue or cancel the request. If a consensus cannot be reached then the PIC will decline the requested tasking.

4.7 Flight Locating & Radio Procedures

If a VFR or IFR flight plan is not filed, the HeliService USA communications center shall provide flight locating services IAW 14 CFR 135.79. HSUSA will utilize a combination of satellite tracking software (Spider Tracks) and radio calls to provide a complete picture of each flight. When providing flight location HSUSA communications center shall at all times maintain the following information:

1. Aircraft Callsign or Registration Number
2. Type of aircraft
3. Full name of the pilot
4. Point and time of departure*
5. Destination and ETA*
6. Fuel on board*
7. Souls on board*



Note: As explained later in this section, the asterisked items shall be provided to the HSUSA communications center by the crew prior to, during departure, or anytime a VFR/IFR flightplan is cancelled.

4.7.1 Radio Communication Procedures

The HeliService USA communications center will be staffed with at least one dispatcher anytime local flying operations are underway. HeliService USA dispatch will be known as "HeliService Ops" or "Ops" on the radio. For the sake of both safety and efficiency of operations, communications will remain in constant contact with the aircraft. This will be done with one or more of the following:

1. Discrete company frequency (VHF).
2. Satellite radio communication.
3. Satellite Tracking Software.
4. Through a relay with a customer dispatcher.
5. Relay with offshore vessel or heli-deck operators.

HeliService communications specialists will maintain disciplined and professional aviation radio communication utilizing the following guidelines:

1. Speak clearly and concisely.
2. Limit communications to the minimum required and avoid being unnecessarily verbose.
3. Keep all communications professional, with no joking or inappropriate comments.
4. Minimize communications with helicopters when they are in a critical phase of flight (landing/takeoff/hoisting).

When calling the helicopters, the communications specialists should always use the following method:

1. Say the unit or helicopter you're talking to (Wind XX) .
2. Say who you are (Ops).
3. Pause until the helicopter crew responds.
4. If there's no response, wait at least 30 seconds (crew may be task saturated or in a critical phase of flight) before attempting again.
5. Once positive communications are made, pass whatever message as required.

Example

Dispatch: "Wind 11, Ops."

Aircraft: "Ops, go for Wind 11."

Dispatch: "Wind 11, Ops with an update on manifest."

4.7.2 Departure

Prior to departure, or as soon as possible the crew will contact dispatch via radio with the following:

1. Callsign.
2. Off time (actual).



3. Souls onboard.
4. Estimated time en route.
5. Destination.
6. Fuel on board.

Example

Aircraft: "Ops, Wind 11, lifting 35 past, 4 souls onboard, 30 minutes out, WTG 15, 2+15 Fuel on board"

Dispatch: "Wind 11, ops copies, lifting 35 past, 4 souls onboard, 30 minutes out, WTG 15, 2+15 of Fuel"

4.7.2.1 HAA/SAR Medical Update

After the departure call is completed, at an appropriate time, the pilot or medical crew will contact communications to receive initial information regarding patient status and relevant medical care information.

4.7.3 Flight Locating/Position Reporting

When performing flight locating duties the HeliService USA communications center will utilize the following means of tracking aircraft location in this order:

1. Satellite Tracking (Spider Tracks/Skytrac/Outerlink/etc.)
2. ADS-B Tracking (FlightRadar/FlightAware/etc.)
3. Position Reporting
 - a. Position reports will be made every 15 minutes
 - b. Position reports will include: **Aircraft Call Sign - Position - Altitude.**
 - c. If on the ground a call or text shall be sufficient
 - d. If communication is lost or the aircraft is overdue, refer to the overdue procedures

In addition to monitoring the location of the aircraft, HeliService USA communications will also provide updates and alert the crew of potential hazards, like inclement weather, or company traffic. This does not absolve the crew of their duties and maintain primary responsibility, but is intended to help communications center time and workload permitting.

4.7.4 Arrival

On return to a HeliService USA base of operations, the crew shall contact dispatch 10-15 minutes before the current ETA. The helicopter crew contacts dispatch as "HeliService Ops" to provide the estimated landing time. Dispatch will then inform the appropriate ground handling and check-in personnel know the aircraft is "ten minutes out" via phone or radio to enable them time to prepare.

4.7.5 Overdue aircraft procedures

The HeliService USA communications center shall continually monitor all HeliService USA aircraft when operating in the local area. Should anything appear out of order (course deviation, unexpected stop, loss



of tracking, odd radio transmission, etc.) the dispatcher shall immediately contact the crew. If anything is out of order or the aircraft fails to respond after multiple attempts, the emergency action plan (EAP) shall be initiated.

If the aircraft fails to report landing assured at its destination or make a required position report after 15 minutes, the HeliService USA communication center shall do the following:

1. Attempt to contact the aircraft via radio, satellite or tertiary.
2. Attempt to contact members of the crew via cell phone.
3. Contact the vessel or agency controlling the area of intended landing.
4. Contact any other HeliService USA aircraft in the area and see if they can make contact.
5. If after ten minutes contact is not made and all other means have been exhausted, the appropriate EAP shall be initiated. This will include the following:
 - a. Alert appropriate SAR assets.
 - b. Contact one of the following HeliService USA managers (MD/CP/DO/DOM)

4.8 In-Flight Emergencies FAR 135.19

In the event of a known in-flight emergency, precautionary landing, or lost communications, the dispatcher tracking the aircraft will:

1. Immediately notify the Director of Operations. In the event the Director of Operations is not available, one of the following individuals will be contacted in this order: the Chief Pilot, Director of Safety, or Managing Director.
2. The Communication Center will initiate the appropriate EAP. In the event that the Director of Operations is not available, the Chief Pilot, Director of Safety, or Managing Director will initiate calls to the NTSB and the FAA if required. In the event that one of these managers is unavailable, CC shall assess the situation and contact the FAA and NTSB as appropriate. Telephone numbers for the FAA and the NTSB are located in the HeliService USA EAP.



5 WEIGHT AND BALANCE PROCEDURES

5.1 Load Manifest

[14 CFR § 135.63(d)]

The PIC is responsible for preparing a current and accurate Load Manifest, in duplicate (if completed on paper), before each flight in accordance with 14 CFR § 135.63(c). HeliService USA load manifests are recorded in CompleteFlight and always available on either than aircraft or principle operating base.

The CompleteFlight manifest will be the document HeliService USA uses to comply with 14 CFR § 135.63(c), which requires the following information be included on the manifest before each takeoff:

1. The number of passengers.
2. The total weight of the loaded aircraft.
3. The maximum allowable takeoff weight for that flight
4. The center of gravity of the loaded aircraft
5. The registration number of the aircraft or flight number
6. The origin and destination
7. Identification of crew members and their crew position assignments.

Note: All manifests will be maintained locally at each bases admin office or digitally for at least 30 days.

5.2 Aircraft Specific Procedures

PIC's are permitted to use any of the following methods to calculate weight and balance for a given flight:

1. HeliService USA issued electronic flight bag (EFB), CompleteFlight, or integrated aircraft computer system.
2. Long hand computation or appropriate aircraft specific excel sheet.
 - a. The master spreadsheet for each HeliService USA helicopter will be stored on the HeliService USA SharePoint. Each aircraft will have a designated folder labeled by tail number to store the spreadsheet. Access will be limited and controlled by the HeliService USA IT department and the Director of Operations. All HeliService USA pilots and mechanics will have access rights to this area. Edit rights will be restricted to the Director of Operations and Chief Pilot.
3. Aircraft loading schedule located in the RFM or Flight Operations Procedure Manual (FOPM).

5.3 Responsibilities

5.3.1 Director of Operations



The HeliService USA Director of Operations has overall responsibility for the operations aspect of the HeliService USA weight and balance program. This includes, but is not limited to the following:

1. The accuracy and currency of the HSUSA master weight and balance spreadsheet for each HSUSA Aircraft.
2. Ensuring the continual update and accuracy of the specific aircraft methods utilized by PIC's including both CompleteFlight and the aircraft specific excel sheet.

5.3.2 Director of Maintenance

[14 CFR § 135.185(a)]

HeliService USA aircraft shall be weighed every 36 months. Aircraft will be weighed in accordance with the aircraft manufacturer's instructions. This weight will be used to update the aircraft specific procedures described in the OM-B. The weighing reports shall be kept in the maintenance files in accordance with the Maintenance and Inspections chapter of this manual, as well as in the weight and balance section of the RFM. The Director of Maintenance will provide the updated empty weight to the Director of Operations for WB Master Spreadsheet revision.

5.3.3 PIC

The PIC shall ensure the aircraft is within Weight and Balance Limits by using one of the following methods listed in OM-A Section 5.2.

The Flight Manifest will be updated with all appropriate information prior to each flight leg. For 14 CFR Part 135 flights the following will be calculated and recorded on the Manifest for each leg:

1. Takeoff weight.
2. Actual CG.
3. CG range.

The Manifest with the above W&B data will be stored either digitally or on paper a minimum of 30 days at the aircraft's primary base of operation.

Note: There may be atmospheric conditions (i.e. high density altitudes) that affect the maximum gross takeoff limits for a particular day. The Pilot must be familiar with performance data and operating limitations in the RFM. While the aircraft may be in the envelope for CG and max gross weight, it may be over weight for optimal flight performance during high power demand situations. The pilot shall always make a conservative decision and adjust as necessary (remove fuel, adjust flight profile, lessen cargo, etc.) to stay in a safe / legal operating envelope.

5.4 Determining Weights



OpsSpec A096 states that actual passenger, baggage, and cargo weights shall be utilized when determining weight and balance. Customer manifests listing actual weights may be accepted as complying with this requirement. All HeliService USA scales will be calibrated as per manufacturer recommended intervals.

5.4.1 Passenger Weights

Actual or "asked" passenger weights shall be used on all flights. Pilots will advise customers of the need for a passenger weight list along with the manifest. If no weights are given on the manifest the pilots shall ask each passenger their weight. If asked weights are used, an additional ten (10) lbs will be added.

5.4.2 Crew Weights

Actual crew weights shall be used. A list of all crew member weights updated yearly will be maintained by HeliService USA and stored on the CompleteFlight software.

5.4.3 Baggage Weights

1. Each piece of cargo offered for transport by air is weighed separately and recorded in the manifest.
2. The contents of each piece of cargo is verified against the manifest by its packing list or by visual inspection.
3. Weighing scales are calibrated as per manufacturers recommended intervals.

5.4.4 Aircraft Operational Empty Weight (OEW)

[14 CFR § 135.187]

Prior to being placed into service, it shall be determined that each HeliService USA aircraft has current weight and balance data available in the appropriate approved Rotorcraft Flight Manual (RFM). If the information is found to be outdated and/or inaccurate, the aircraft will be weighed, and the empty weight and CG location established. Aircraft will be weighed per the appropriate RFM or appropriate aircraft Maintenance Manual (MM) for that make and model aircraft. The weight and balance record will be kept in the approved RFM and shall be on board the aircraft during all operations.

In addition to the guidance given in the aircraft MM, the following equipment (as appropriate) shall be included in the OEW.

1. Dual controls installed.
2. Other equipment as appropriate / installed.

14 CFR § 135.187 requires all HeliService USA aircraft be weighed every 36 calendar months. Aviation personnel may determine whether an aircraft complies with this regulation by checking the aircraft



maintenance logbook in the aircraft.



6 OPERATING PROCEDURES

6.1 Operational Control (OC)

[14 CFR § 135.77]

The ultimate responsibility for HeliService USA operational control rests with the Managing Director, Director of Operations (DO), Chief Pilot, or in select cases, the Director of Maintenance. Since it is impractical for the above listed personnel to directly control and monitor every flight conducted by HeliService USA aircraft, certain elements of operational control may be delegated to the HeliService USA communications center. Anyone exercising full operational control shall be qualified through training, experience, and expertise and have a full understanding of the following material with respect to the certificate holder's operation:

1.
 - a. Aviation safety standards and safe operating practices;
 - b. 14 CFR Chapter I (Federal Aviation Regulations);
 - c. The certificate holder's operations specifications
 - d. All appropriate maintenance and airworthiness requirements of this chapter (e.g., parts 1, 21, 23, 25, 43, 45, 47, 65, 91, and 135 of this chapter); and
 - e. The HeliService USA operating manual

For communications specialists exercising limited operational control, they must be familiar with and trained in their delegated duties and as laid out in Chapter 4 of this manual.

Note: Operational control does not supersede the authority of the Pilot in Command to initiate, conduct, or terminate a flight based on current conditions or other situations affecting the flight. Operational control should not be confused with the authority of the PIC who always retains the authority and responsibility for the safe conduct of a given flight.

6.1.1 Operational Control Procedures

[14 CFR § 135.77]

1. Operational Control resides with the Managing Director, Director of Operations, Chief Pilot and Director of Maintenance.
2. Operational Control will include the following:
 - a. Scheduling aircraft by type and location to meet the customer's needs.
 - i. The DOM or his representative (designated A&P) shall provide a list of available and compliant aircraft to the communications center allowing them to schedule customer flights.
 - b. Scheduling pilots in such a manner to ensure all regulatory requirements and checkrides are current and ensuring duty times are not exceeded.
 - i. The DO or CP shall prepare and publish pilot work schedules, providing them to the



communications center who will contact on-duty crews with flight requests.

- c. Work with customers to accomplish their helicopter transportation requirements to the best of our ability with flight safety as first priority.
 - i. The MD, DO, and CP will delegate customer communications and flight coordination to properly trained communications specialists.
- d. Supervise flight following and the dissemination of existing and forecasted weather.
 - i. The MD, DO, and CP will delegate this to properly trained communications specialists and PIC's.
- e. Set up new operations and coordinate with other departments to provide fuel, heliports, aircraft, pilots, flight following, and maintenance to provide a safe operation.
 - i. This is the responsibility of the MD, DO, CP, and DOM.
- f. The Director of Maintenance will only retain Operational Control on Part 91 maintenance flights.

6.2 General

6.2.1 FAA Admission

[14 CFR § 135.75(a)(b) and 135.76(a)(b)]

1. When an FAA inspector presents an Aviation Safety Inspector credential, FAA Form 110A, or 110B, the pilot shall allow him free access to the aircraft cockpit. The Inspector should not interfere with the crew during operations.
2. When an FAA Inspector requests to perform a route check, he shall be given a seat on the flight deck (single pilot aircraft) or forward passenger seat (two pilot aircraft) with a headset if possible.
3. If the Inspector will displace a passenger scheduled on the flight, the PIC shall inform the Inspector of this situation and allow the Inspector to decide if he will continue with the route check. The PIC shall agree with the FAA Inspector's decision.

6.2.2 Intra-Aircraft Communications

When practical, pilots will monitor the helicopter common frequency (123.025) with their spare radio. While dispatch and MCC should provide advisories regarding company or area working traffic, PIC's are the final authority to maintain de-confliction and situational awareness with other helicopters operating in the working area.

6.2.3 Altitude Alerts

Prior to takeoff, the RA based alert shall be set at the following:

1. Day VFR and IFR flights - 300 ft AGL.
2. Night VFR and IFR flights - 500 ft AGL.



After takeoff, the RA based alert shall remain as set for takeoff, except for the following conditions:

1. In preparation for an instrument approach, crews shall adjust the RA based alert to the appropriate MDA or DA/DH for the approach.
2. Following transition from IFR to VFR prior to landing (cancelling IFR), the setting shall be returned to the takeoff setting.
3. Or as deemed necessary by the crew to emphasize other important altitudes that contribute to safety and are unique to the current flight. This is meant to be a temporary setting and should be returned to the above parameters as soon as safely practical.

6.2.4 Dropping of Objects

[14 CFR § 91.15]

The intentional dropping of any object from an aircraft requires permission from the DO or CP. The DO or CP shall ensure the PIC is briefed on all aspects of the flight to include:

1. Object(s) to be dropped.
2. Aircraft configuration.
3. Location of drop.
4. Areas to be avoided during drop.

At the time of the drop, the PIC must use his judgment to ensure that the drop will not cause injury or damage to persons or property. If any doubt exists, do not drop the object(s).

6.2.5 Operating Near Other Aircraft

Pilots shall not conduct formation flight with passengers for hire onboard the aircraft.

All formation flights shall be approved by the Chief Pilot or DO. Formation flights shall be thoroughly briefed by all pilots involved. Formation flights shall not be conducted any closer than one rotor diameters distance based on the largest rotor diameter.

6.2.6 Flight Plans

[14 CFR § 91.153(b), 91.169(d)]

When a flight plan has been activated, the pilot in command, upon canceling or completing the flight under the flight plan, shall notify an FAA Flight Service Station or ATC facility.

6.2.7 Compliance with ATC Clearance and Instructions

[14 CFR § 91.123]



When an ATC clearance has been obtained, no pilot in command may deviate from that clearance unless an amended clearance is obtained, an emergency exists, or the deviation is in response to a traffic alert and collision avoidance system resolution advisory. However, except in Class A airspace, a pilot may cancel an IFR flight plan if the operation is being conducted in VFR weather conditions. When a pilot is uncertain of an ATC clearance, that pilot shall immediately request clarification from ATC.

Except in an emergency, no person may operate an aircraft contrary to an ATC instruction in an area in which air traffic control is exercised.

Each pilot in command who, in an emergency, or in response to a traffic alert and collision avoidance system resolution advisory, deviates from an ATC clearance or instruction shall notify ATC of that deviation as soon as possible.

Each pilot in command who is given priority by ATC in an emergency, shall submit a detailed report of that emergency within 48 hours to the manager of that ATC facility, if requested by ATC.

Unless otherwise authorized by ATC, no person operating an aircraft may operate that aircraft according to any clearance or instruction that has been issued to the pilot of another aircraft for radar air traffic control purposes.

6.2.8 Compliance with Rotorcraft Placards

[14 CFR § 91.9]

HeliService USA pilots and crewmembers will operate in compliance with the operating limitations in the approved Rotorcraft Flight Manual, markings, and placards.

6.2.9 Transfer of Controls

HSUSA crews will always use three way transfer of controls. "you have the controls," "I have the controls," "you have the controls."

6.2.10 Guarding of Controls

HSUSA crews will have a crew member guarding the controls anytime an aircraft is running. Further, extra attention will be paid during cockpit entry, exit or anytime anyone is beneath the rotor disk.

6.2.11 Overwater Operations

[14 CFR § 135.168]



Required equipment. Except when authorized by the certificate holder's operations specifications, or when necessary only for takeoff or landing, no person may operate a rotorcraft beyond autorotational distance from the shoreline unless it carries:

- (1) An approved life preserver equipped with an approved survivor locator light for each occupant of the rotorcraft. The life preserver must be worn by each occupant while the rotorcraft is beyond autorotational distance from the shoreline, except for a patient transported during a helicopter air ambulance operation, as defined in § 135.601(b)(1), when wearing a life preserver would be inadvisable for medical reasons; and
- (2) An approved and installed 406 MHz emergency locator transmitter (ELT) with 121.5 MHz homing capability. Batteries used in ELTs must be maintained in accordance with the following—
 - (i) Non-rechargeable batteries must be replaced when the transmitter has been in use for more than 1 cumulative hour or when 50% of their useful lives have expired, as established by the transmitter manufacturer under its approval. The new expiration date for replacing the batteries must be legibly marked on the outside of the transmitter. The battery useful life requirements do not apply to batteries (such as water-activated batteries) that are essentially unaffected during probable storage intervals; or
 - (ii) Rechargeable batteries used in the transmitter must be recharged when the transmitter has been in use for more than 1 cumulative hour or when 50% of their useful-life-of-charge has expired, as established by the transmitter manufacturer under its approval. The new expiration date for recharging the batteries must be legibly marked on the outside of the transmitter. The battery useful-life-of-charge requirements do not apply to batteries (such as water-activated batteries) that are essentially unaffected during probable storage intervals.

ELT standards. The ELT required by paragraph (b)(2) of this section must meet the requirements in:

- (1) TSO-C126, TSO-C126a, or TSO-C126b; and
- (2) Section 2 of either RTCA DO-204 or RTCA DO-204A, as specified by the TSO complied with in paragraph (d)(1) of this section.

6.2.12 Operating areas

HeliService USA will only operate within the authorized areas of en route operations and in compliance with any limitations, provisions, and special requirements listed in OpSpec B050.

6.2.13 Single Pilot vs. Dual Pilot Operations

HeliService USA operates both single-pilot and dual-pilot aircraft under 14 CFR Part 135. Assignment of flight crew to either configuration must reflect appropriate qualification, training, and competency for the specific operation type. A pilot qualified for single-pilot operations is not automatically authorized to serve as PIC in dual-pilot operations without undergoing company-approved differences or transition training that includes crew coordination, multi-crew procedures, and applicable aircraft systems. Similarly,



a dual-pilot-qualified PIC must complete single-pilot-specific training, including workload management and emergency procedures, to act as PIC in single-pilot operations. Flight crews must adhere to training and checking provisions established in OM-D and comply with 14 CFR §135.293, §135.297, and §135.299, as applicable. No crossover between these operational modes shall occur without documented training and evaluation, as defined in the approved training program. This policy ensures the safe and compliant conduct of operations while aligning with the FAA's expectations for pilot proficiency and operational standardization.

6.3 Preflight & Postflight

6.3.1 Preflight - Duty In

All Pilots, Aircrew, and Maintenance Engineers will login to Complete Flight and "Duty In" either on the web based version or the app available on the EFB. At the conclusion of the day each are to "Duty Out" via the same process.

6.3.2 Preflight - Maintenance Log and Forms

[14 CFR § 135.439(a)(2)(iv), 135.21(f)]

HeliService USA PIC's will check helicopter maintenance records at the beginning of each shift. PIC's are responsible to ensure the airworthiness of their assigned helicopter and may not begin a flight unless they determine that the airworthiness inspections required by 14 CFR § 135.71 are complied with.

Refer to Chapter 11 of this manual for detailed procedures on checking maintenance records.

6.3.3 Preflight - Planning

The following are considered approved sources of weather:

1. Sources approved by the FAA such as DUATS.
2. Weather Reporting facilities operated by the United States National.
3. Weather Service (USNWS). Example: Aviation Digital Data Service (ADDs).
4. A source approved by the USNWS.
5. FAA Flight Service Stations.

Note: For VFR operations, the Pilot in Command may, in the absence of approved weather sources or obvious inaccuracies with those sources, use weather information based upon that pilot's own observations (including live web cameras / other broadcasts) or those of other persons competent to



supply appropriate observations.

6.3.3.1 Fuel Planning

[14 CFR § 135.209(a)(1)]

Crews shall utilize the below fuel planning:

1. Helicopter fuel planning for Visual Flight Rules (VFR) offshore flights includes:
 - a. Fuel used during start-up and taxi
 - b. Fuel required for the route to the first point of intended landing
 - c. Fuel required for ground running on helideck or helipad
 - d. Fuel required for the route to an onshore alternate heliport or offshore helideck, plus 30 minutes
 - i. A 20 minute reserve may be used where alternate landing areas are available within 30 nm of the destination.
2. Helicopter fuel planning for an IFR flight includes:
 - a. Fuel used during start-up and taxi
 - b. Fuel required for the route to the first point of intended landing
 - c. Fuel required for ground running on helideck or helipad
 - d. Fuel required for the route to onshore alternate heliport or offshore helideck
 - e. Contingency fuel as defined by the FAA

6.3.4 Preflight - Briefing

Prior to a PIC's first flight of the day, they shall conduct a briefing with the crew (SIC/HHO) to include no less than the following:

1. Overall plan for the flight.
2. Weather and NOTAMS.
3. Aircraft maintenance status and any applicable MEL's.
4. Weight and balance calculations.
5. Performance calculations.
6. If NVGs are to be utilized:
 - a. NVG Preflight complete.
 - b. Crew Compliment (2 pilots or 1).
 - c. Crew members to utilize NVGs on flight.
 - d. MP / Hoist Operator duties and responsibilities.
 - e. Unimproved landing site.
7. Route of flight.
8. Hoist operations (to be conducted under Part 133 Class D) if applicable.
9. Required minimum fuel and bingo fuel.
10. Risk and mitigations.



On any subsequent flights, the PIC shall brief / discuss any items that have changed from the original brief. If there's a new crewmember added or substituted the PIC shall re-brief the crew.

6.3.5 Preflight - Aircraft

[14 CFR § 135.71, 135.21(f)]

Preflight Inspection

1. HeliService USA PIC's will ensure a thorough preflight inspection of the helicopter has been completed in accordance with (IAW) the helicopter Rotorcraft Flight Manual (RFM).
2. Remove the entire tie-down kit if the aircraft is tied down.

Inlet Cover Policy

Due to the possibility of FOD entering the engine inlet area after preflight, the following policy shall be followed when inlet covers are used:

1. The required 360 degree walk around (by both pilots if dual pilot) must be accomplished after removal of the engine inlet covers, and prior to every start.
2. After maintenance is performed forward of the engine intake and above engine deck level, or prior to the first start of the day, the engine intake area, surrounding deck, and cabin roof shall be checked by the pilot for any foreign objects (possible FOD), or damage.

Subsequent Starts

All flights after the first flight of the day until the last flight of the day. A 360 degrees (or as close to 360 degrees as space allows) walk around check shall be performed prior to each start, consisting of, but not limited to the following:

1. Aircraft and rotor tie-downs removed.
2. General condition of the aircraft.
3. Check fluid levels.
4. Check cowling security.
5. Baggage door secured and locked.
6. Fuel cap secured.
7. Check for leaks.

Note: This includes anytime the rotors are stopped and on APU mode.

They will also confirm the following are onboard the aircraft during flight:

1. Minimum Equipment List (including NEF).
2. Airworthiness Certificate.
3. Aircraft Registration.
4. Radio Station License.
5. Aircraft Flight Manual (AFM/RFM) with appropriate supplements.



6. Weight and Balance Information.
7. Passenger Briefing Cards (one available for each passenger seat).
8. Portable Electronic Devices (PED) listing.
9. Aircraft Normal Procedures & Emergency Check List(s).
10. Hazardous Materials Acceptance Guide.
11. Pilot Notification Form (HAZMAT).
12. Emergency Response Guidebook.
13. Charts and maps appropriate to the route to be flown.

Note 1:

The use of a checklist is required for all pre-flight, in-flight, and post-flight operations. Only the approved RFM checklists or Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) reviewed company checklists may be used.

Note 2:

HeliService USA PIC's must ensure their helicopter is equipped with the instruments and equipment required by 135.149 (Baro Altimeter) and will not begin a flight carrying passengers under VFR at night without an adequate flashlight.

Note 3:

No person may operate a helicopter in helicopter air ambulance operations unless it meets the equipment requirements of 135.605 Helicopter Terrain and Warning System (HTAWS) and 135.607 Flight Data Monitoring System (FDMS).

6.3.6 Preflight - Fuel

1. Confirm that the aircraft's daily fuel sump sample has been taken and is clear and bright.
2. Complete the Daily Fuel Sample Log if not already completed.

Note 1: All aircraft fuel samples will be drawn and stored by maintenance personnel.

Note 2: If a sample has not been drawn by maintenance during the daily, then the PIC is responsible for obtaining and logging the required fuel sample.

6.3.7 Preflight- oxygen use



[14 CFR § 135.89(a), 135.157]

Unpressurized aircraft. Each pilot of an unpressurized aircraft shall use oxygen continuously when flying -

1. At altitudes above 10,000 feet through 12,000 feet MSL for that part of the flight at those altitudes that is of more than 30 minutes duration;
2. Above 12,000 feet MSL

Passenger Oxygen Requirements in an Unpressurized aircraft. No person may operate an unpressurized aircraft at altitudes prescribed in this section unless it is equipped with enough oxygen dispensers and oxygen to supply the pilots under 135.89 and to supply, when flying at altitudes above 10,000 feet through 15,000 feet MSL, oxygen to at least 10 percent of the occupants of the aircraft, other than the pilots, for that part of the flight at those altitudes that is of more than 30 minutes duration; and above 15,000 feet MSL, oxygen to each occupant of the aircraft other than the pilots.

6.3.8 Postflight

1. Perform walk around with emphasis on aircraft general condition, fluid leaks/ levels, loose cowlings.
2. Install tie-down kit as required.
3. Install engine inlet covers as required.
4. Ensure engineering logbook has appropriate entries.
5. Notify management of any discrepancies.

6.4 VFR Operations

6.4.1 Weather Minimums

[14 CFR § 91.155, 91.157, 135.205(b)(1)(2), 135.207]

These sections will detail the VFR minimums applicable to all HeliService USA operations. The minimums are not meant to be construed as launch minimums or imply any pressure to fly in those conditions. A pilot may choose to use higher weather minimums than listed due to changing atmospheric conditions, Minimum Equipment List (MEL) status, fatigue, newly-hired pilots, overall crew experience or any other reason that in the pilot's judgment is a safer alternative and is consistent with sound Aeronautical Decision Making (ADM).

Airspace	Flight Visibility	Distance From Clouds
Class A	N/A	N/A
Class B	3 SM	Clear of Clouds



Class C	3 SM	500 Below
		1,000 Above
		2,000 Horizontal
Class D	3 SM	500 Below
		1,000 Above
		2,000 Horizontal
Class E		
Less Than 10,000 MSL	3 SM	500 Below
		1,000 Above
		2,000 Horizontal
At or above 10,000 MSL	5 SM	1,000 Below
		1,000 Above
		1 SM Horizontal
Class G		
At or below 1,200 AGL	1/2 SM Day	Clear of Clouds
	1 SM Night	Clear of Clouds
Above 1,200 AGL but less than 10,000 MSL	1 SM Day	500 Below
		1,000 Above
		2,000 Horizontal
	3 SM Night	500 Below
		1,000 Above
		2,000 Horizontal
Above 1,200 AGL and at or above 10,000 MSL	5 SM	1,000 Below
		1,000 Above
		1 SM Horizontal

6.4.1.1 Onshore

Day Operations:

1. Ceiling 300 ft and one (1) SM visibility.



Night Operations:

1. Ceiling 500 ft and two (2) SM visibility.

Note:

Customer Specific Weather minimums may be utilized. Check applicable customer requirements and / OM-C.

6.4.1.2 Offshore**Day Operations:**

1. Ceiling 300 ft and two (2) SM visibility.

Night Operations:

1. Cross Country: Ceiling 1000 ft and three (3) SM visibility.
2. Within ten (10) NM of an HSUSA base of operations (local area): Ceiling 700 ft and three (3) SM visibility.

Note:

Customer Specific Weather minimums may be utilized. Check applicable customer requirements and / OM-C.

6.4.2 Visual Reference Requirements

Pilots flying VFR shall maintain sufficient visual surface reference, or at night, visual surface light reference, for:

1. Navigation and control of the aircraft to the surface without the aid of aircraft instruments.
2. An emergency descent and landing without the aid of aircraft instruments.
3. Terrain avoidance.

If unable to maintain any of the above criteria or there is no discernable horizon, pilots shall file IFR or pick up an enroute IFR clearance.

For enroute and landing operations, pilots should always be situationally aware of Flat Light, White Out and Brown Out conditions.

6.4.3 Enroute Altitudes

Listed in the following sections are the minimum permitted en route altitudes permitted by HeliService USA, however, PIC's should consider all of the following when setting their enroute cruise altitude:

1. Flight safety.
2. Regulatory guidance.



3. Client requirements.
4. Air traffic control (ATC) requirements.
5. Published procedures.
6. Specified routes (e.g. standard offshore routes as described in OM-C).

Note: If a crew finds themselves flying near minimum altitudes to avoid weather / ceilings, they shall consider the procedures for deteriorating weather in 6.4.5.

6.4.3.1 Minimum Altitudes

[14 CFR § 135.203(b)]

Except when necessary for takeoff and landing, no HSUSA pilot may operate under VFR below the following altitudes.

1. Below 300 ft AGL during the day.
2. Below 500 ft AGL at night.

6.4.3.2 Flying Neighborly

HeliService USA believes in being a good neighbor to the surrounding communities and minimizing noise signatures when practical. As such, HSUSA encourages pilots to fly over 1,000 ft AGL when practical.

Note: Pilots shall never compromise safety or let noise abatement considerations cloud good aeronautical decision making.

6.4.3.3 Bird Avoidance Procedures

Purpose:

To minimize the risk of bird strikes during helicopter operations by establishing flight procedures that reduce bird strike exposure and enhance safety.

Scope:

This policy applies to all HeliService USA flight operations conducted under 14 CFR Part 133 and Part 135, and it aligns with FAA guidelines and HeliService USA safety protocols.

Policy:

1. Flight Planning Considerations:

- Pilots shall review known bird activity areas using FAA NOTAMs, advisory publications, and local hazard briefings during preflight planning.
- Avoid low level flights during peak bird activity hours—typically one hour after sunrise and



one hour before sunset—when possible.

2. Airspeed Restrictions Below 1000 Feet AGL:

- When overland or within 3nm of the shoreline, all HeliService USA pilots shall maintain an airspeed at or below 100 knots indicated airspeed (KIAS) when operating at altitudes below 1000 feet above ground level (AGL), except when:
 - Conducting emergency procedures.
 - Required by ATC instructions.

3. Altitude Considerations:

- Whenever operationally feasible and safe, pilots should maintain altitudes at or above 1000 feet AGL when transiting areas known for high bird activity.

4. In-Flight Avoidance Techniques:

- Maintain vigilant visual scanning for bird activity, especially near bodies of water, coastal areas, landfills, or agricultural fields.
- Use anti-collision lights and landing lights in high-risk areas to increase aircraft visibility.
- Report all bird strikes to the Director of Safety and enter events into the SMS reporting tool.

5. Training and Awareness:

- All flight crews shall receive annual training on bird strike hazards and mitigation strategies.
- Bird strike events shall be reviewed in Safety Review Board (SRB) meetings as part of safety assurance and continuous improvement.

6. Reporting Requirements:

- Any bird strike incident, regardless of damage, must be reported per HeliService USA's SMS protocols and to the FAA using Form 5200-7.

6.4.4 Deteriorating Weather

If deteriorating weather conditions are encountered while conducting VFR operations, one of the following procedures will be followed:

1. If weather and regulations permit, continue flight under IFR.
2. Return to departure point, if practical.
3. Divert to an alternate suitable landing location.



4. Land (if overland / practical) and notify HSUSA dispatch.

HeliService USA pilots will use the "Enroute Decision Point" concept to determine whether or not deteriorating weather conditions exist. The definition follows:

1. Slowing the helicopter 30 kts from cruise speed to adjust to declining ceiling and visibility conditions.
2. Descending to the Minimum Altitude for VFR listed in paragraph 6.4.3 specific purpose of avoiding declining weather.
3. Lack of ground reference as required by paragraph 6.4.2 Helicopter surface reference requirements.

6.4.5 VFR Over-the-Top

Multiengine aircraft certified for IFR flight and piloted by an IFR crew may operate above a ceiling provided:

1. Visual surface reference as described in paragraph 6.4.2 can be maintained.
2. VFR flight can be maintained if its critical engine fails.
3. The point of departure and destination are forecast to allow descent under VFR and to remain so one hour after the ETA.

6.5 IFR Operations

[14 CFR § 135.78]

All 14 CFR § 135.297 qualified PIC's and 14 CFR § 61.57(d) qualified SIC's employed by HSUSA will follow the IFR procedures and rules outlined in this OM-A, the FAR's, HeliService USA OpSpecs (Appendix A), the applicable OM-B and the Flight Training Manual (OM-D).

The PIC is required to obtain an IFR clearance from ATC prior to operating in actual Instrument Meteorological Conditions (IMC).

1. All 14 CFR Part 135 IFR operations will be conducted over Federal Airways, Off Airway Routes and in controlled airspace under radar coverage as authorized in the HeliService USA OpSpecs.
2. Pilot Flying (PF) and Pilot Not Flying (PNF) duties and responsibilities for dual Pilot IFR operations are described in detail in the HSUSA Training Program and OM-B.
3. There are multiple references for the PIC to refer to as part of the IFR planning process. This paragraph will include a Cross Reference Guide listing a selection of OpSpecs applicable to HeliService USA IFR operations. It is for convenience and is not to be construed as relieving the PIC of the responsibility to be familiar with all applicable FAR's, OpSpecs and OM-A policies for IFR Operations.

Note: HeliService USA PIC's are responsible to ensure their helicopter meets the IFR equipment, system,



navigation and communication requirements of 14 CFR § 135.163, 135.165 and HSUSA MEL's prior to conducting IFR operations.

6.5.1 Authorizations

HeliService USA is authorized to conduct terminal operations in controlled or uncontrolled airspace at airports/heliports/helidecks with approved instrument approach procedures and weather reporting, or in accordance with authorized deviations listed in this section.

6.5.2 Autopilot Use In-Lieu of Second in Command

HeliService USA pilots are authorized to use an AutoPilot in lieu of SIC in helicopters listed in HSUSA Operations Specifications A015. The pilot must have completed the proficiency check requirements of 14 CFR § 135.297(g) and ensure the installed autopilot is operational.

6.5.3 Terminal IFR Operations in Class G Airspace

1. HeliService USA is authorized to conduct IFR flights in class G airspace given:
 - a. Facilities and services that are required, are operational during the periods that the flights occur.
 - b. Pilots operating IFR in Class G airspace and not in direct contact with ATC will make position calls in the blind on the air-to-air frequency (122.75 MHz).

6.5.4 Departure

[14 CFR § 135.215(c)(2)(3)]

6.5.4.1 Planning Requirements

[14 CFR § 135.215(d), 135.217, and 135.225(g)(h)(i)(1)]

6.5.4.1.1 Destination Airport Weather Minimums

[14 CFR § 135.219]

No HSUSA Pilot may take off an aircraft under IFR or begin an IFR or over-the-top operation unless the latest weather reports or forecasts, or any combination of them, indicate that weather conditions at the estimated time of arrival at the next airport of intended landing will be at or above authorized IFR landing minimums.

6.5.4.1.2 Alternate Fuel, Alternate Airport, and Alternate Airport Weather Requirements

[14 CFR § 135.223 (a)(1)(2)(3)(b)(1)(2)(3)]



1. Except as provided in paragraph 2 of this section, no HSUSA Pilot may operate a helicopter in IFR conditions unless it carries enough fuel (considering weather reports or forecasts or any combination of them) to -
 - a. Complete the flight to the first airport of intended landing;
 - b. Fly from that airport to the alternate airport; and
 - c. Fly after that for 30 minutes at normal cruising speed.
2. Paragraph 1(b) of this section does not apply if part 97 of this chapter prescribes a standard instrument approach procedure for the first airport of intended landing and, for at least one hour before and after the estimated time of arrival, the appropriate weather reports or forecasts, or any combination of them, indicate that -
 - a. The ceiling will be at least 1,500 ft above the lowest circling approach MDA; or
 - b. If a circling instrument approach is not authorized for the airport, the ceiling will be at least 1,500 ft above the lowest published minimum or 2,000 ft above the airport elevation, whichever is higher; and
 - c. Visibility for that airport is forecast to be at least three miles, or two miles more than the lowest applicable visibility minimums, whichever is the greater, for the instrument approach procedure to be used at the destination airport.

6.5.4.1.3 IFR Alternate Planning Requirements

[14 CFR § 135.221(b)(2) and 135.223(a)(1)(2)(3)]

Flight crews are authorized to derive alternate airport weather minimums as follows and in no case shall use an alternate airport weather minimum lower than any applicable minimum derived from the following procedure and OpSpec at the estimated time of arrival:

1. Ceiling: Derived by adding 200 ft to the published HAT or HAA for the approach to be flown rounded to the nearest 100 ft.
2. Visibility: 1 SM or as published, whichever is higher.

In determining alternate airport weather minimums, the flight crew shall not use any published instrument approach procedure which specifies that alternate airport weather minimums are not authorized.

Note: Use of an authorized GPS alternate approach is approved provided, at the estimated time of arrival, a conventional land-based approach is anticipated to be operational and available. For WAAS approved aircraft, a conventional land-based approach is not required and LNAV minimums must be used for deriving alternate WX.

6.5.4.1.4 Required Aircraft Performance

6.5.4.1.4.1 Overland

With the critical engine inoperative, climb at least 50 feet a minute when operating at 5,000 ft MSL or the



MEA, whichever is higher. Overland means both departure point and destination are onshore.

6.5.4.1.4.2 Overwater

With the critical engine inoperative, climb at least 50 feet a minute when operating at 1,500 ft MSL or the MEA, whichever is higher. Offshore means either the departure point or the destination is offshore.

6.5.4.2 Departure Minimums

[14 CFR § 91.175 (f)(2)(iii) 135.215(d), 135.217, and 135.225(g)(h)(i)(1)]

IFR takeoff minimums from all airports are governed by the following criteria:

1. When RVR reports are available, they shall be used for all takeoff and landing operations on that runway.
2. If a takeoff is made from an onshore IFR heliport, offshore helideck, or airport with less than landing minimums, an IFR departure alternate airport/helideck must be available within one hour flight time.
3. HeliService USA Pilots will not takeoff under IFR unless the weather conditions at time of takeoff are at or above the weather minimums for IFR takeoff prescribed for that airport under FAR Part 97. However, at no time will a HeliService USA depart under IFR from an airport unless the visibility is at least: 1/2 statute mile or Runway Visual Range (RVR) 2400.
4. No pilot may takeoff under IFR from a civil airport having published obstacle departure procedures (ODPs) under part 97 of this chapter for the takeoff runway to be used, unless the pilot uses such ODPs or an alternative procedure or route assigned by ATC. Prior to performing an ODP the pilot must ensure aircraft can meet the required climb gradient.

6.5.4.2.1 Standard

[14 CFR § 135.225(f)(1)]

Standard takeoff minimums are 1/2 SM or 2,400 RVR.

6.5.4.2.2 Lower than Standard

[14 CFR § 61.57 and 135.297]

Not authorized until OpSpec H116 is issued.

6.5.4.2.3 Higher than Standard

[14 CFR § 135.225(h)]



When higher than standard takeoff minimums are published for a runway those higher than standard minimums must be used if taking off from that runway.

6.5.4.2.4 Equal to Landing

Takeoff may be made at a minimum equal to the lowest authorized straight-in IFR landing minimum for that airport. Visibility, not ceiling, minima apply. Not authorized for single-pilot IFR operations.

6.5.5 IFR Communications

[14 CFR § 91.183]

Unless otherwise authorized by ATC, the HeliService USA PIC of each helicopter operated under IFR in controlled airspace must ensure that a continuous watch is maintained on the appropriate frequency and must report the following as soon as possible:

1. The time and altitude of passing each designated reporting point, or the reporting points specified by ATC, except that while the aircraft is under radar control, only the passing of those reporting points specifically requested by ATC need be reported.
2. Any unforecast weather conditions encountered.
3. Any other information relating to the safety of flight.

6.5.5.1 Operation under IFR in controlled airspace: Malfunction reports

[14 CFR § 91.187]

The pilot in command of each aircraft operated in controlled airspace under IFR shall report as soon as practical to ATC any malfunctions of navigational, approach, or communication equipment occurring in flight.

The pilot in command shall include;

1. Aircraft identification.
2. Equipment affected.
3. Degree to which the capability of the pilot to operate under IFR in the ATC system is impaired.
4. Nature and extent of assistance desired from ATC.

6.5.6 Arrival and Approach

6.5.6.1 Landing Minimums

[14 CFR § 135.225(f)]

1. A crew cannot begin the final approach segment unless the visibility is at or above approach



minimums (ceiling must be considered but does not prevent them from commencing the approach).

2. If after crossing the final approach segment, the visibility decreases below landing minimums, the missed approach shall be executed.
3. Landing minimums are predicated on visibility unless otherwise specified.
4. Approach lighting, visibility, and altitude limitations, as defined in the OpSpec, are observed based upon the approach speed of the helicopter.

6.5.6.2 Approach Procedures

[14 CFR § 135.215(c)(1) and 135.225(i)(2)(3), 91.175(c)]

HeliService USA is authorized to conduct terminal operations in controlled or uncontrolled airspace at airports/heliports/helidecks with approved instrument approach procedures and weather reporting, or in accordance with authorized deviations listed in this section. All instrument approach procedures except for contact, MLS and CAT II or III precision approaches are authorized and must be conducted in accordance with the procedures listed in the OpSpec.

HSUSA pilots may not operate an aircraft at any airport below the authorized MDA or continue an approach below DH unless:

1. The aircraft is continuously in a position from which a descent to a landing on the intended runway can be made at a normal rate of descent using normal maneuvers;
2. That descent rate will allow touchdown to occur within the touchdown zone of the runway of intended landing; and
3. The flight visibility is not less than the visibility prescribed in the standard instrument approach being used;
4. The the pilot being able to see and identify the visual references for the intended runway.

6.5.6.2.1 Straight-In Approach Procedures

[14 CFR § 135.225(f)(2) and 135.611(a)(4)]

Provided the fastest approach speed used in the final approach segment is less than 91 knots, straight in landings are authorized with the following limitations:

1. The published Category A minimum descent altitude (MDA) or decision height (DA), shall be used.
2. 1/2 the published visibility/RVR minimums is authorized, but never less than the minimums prescribed in the non-precision/precision lighting tables.

Note: Copter approach visibility shall not be reduced.



6.5.6.2.2 Circle to Land Manuvers

The following limitations apply:

1. The circle to land maneuver shall not be flown at less than minimum IFR airspeed.
2. Less than 91 kts: Published circling minimums shall be used, but never less than HAA 350 and one (1) SM visibility.
3. 91 to 120 kts: Published circling minimums shall be used, but never less than HAA 450 and one (1) SM visibility.

Note 1: The weather minimums for a circling maneuver are a 1,000 ft ceiling and three (3) SM visibility if the PIC has not been trained or flight checked in this procedure.

Note 2: Circle to land visibility shall not be reduced.

6.5.6.2.3 RNAV Approaches

HeliService USA is authorized to conduct RNAV instrument approaches using only those aircraft and RNAV systems authorized in the Operations Specifications.

Prior to conducting instrument approaches using area navigation systems:

1. The PIC must successfully complete the Operator's approved training program on the equipment and special procedures to be used.
2. The PIC must be certified as qualified (by one of the Operator's check airmen or an FAA Inspector) for instrument approaches using area navigation.

Note: If a NAV flag or integrity annunciation is displayed anytime during the approach the crew must execute a missed approach.

6.5.6.2.4 Contact approaches

HeliService USA will not conduct contact approaches at this time.

6.5.7 IFR to VFR Transition

If at any point after filing and departing IFR it becomes more practical for a crew to complete a flight under VFR crews are permitted to cancel their IFR clearance.

1. Ensure 14 CFR § 91.155, 91.157, and 135.205 weather minimums can be maintained.
2. Request cancellation of IFR with current controlling agency (ATC).
3. Confirm cancellation with ATC and retain flight-following if desired or necessary.
4. Reset to a VFR or appropriate company squawk code.
5. Set RA alerts appropriately for VFR flight (day or night).

6.5.8 Offshore IFR



6.5.8.1 OSAP (Offshore Standard Approach Procedure) Procedures

HeliService is authorized to conduct offshore standard approaches at locations greater than 5 NM from land. These locations must meet the weather reporting requirements listed in this section, as provided in the Operations Specifications.

6.5.8.1.1 Equipment

Airborne radar, RNAV, and radar altimeter is required. Radar altimeter may be inoperative given the barometric altimeter is operative and functioning. If radar altimeter is inoperative See section 6.5.8.1.2.

6.5.8.1.2 Landing Minimums

Landing Minimums:

1. RA 200ft and $\frac{3}{4}$ SM visibility for the Delta 30°.
2. Barometric altitude 250 ft MSL and $\frac{3}{4}$ SM visibility.
 - a. Barometric altitude 250 ft MSL: When radio altimeter is not available. When the barometric altimeter setting is received from a source that is more than 5 NM from the landing site, increase the MDA by 5 ft for each mile in excess of 5 NM. The maximum distance for a remote altimeter setting source from a landing site is 75 NM.

6.5.8.1.3 Weather reporting

OSAP's will only be authorized at locations that meet the weather reporting requirements of this chapter. For each approach target listed, the weather observation facility must be reporting weather at or above landing minimums.

6.5.8.1.4 Flight Crew/PIC Qualifications

All IFR pilots must receive OSAP ground training. Notwithstanding the provisions of AC 90-80C or as revised, pilots meet the minimum training requirements upon the completion of 5 training OSAPs.

1. Pilots must pass an OSAP proficiency flight check before being authorized to conduct actual instrument operations. After a pilots initial proficiency check they will record a additional 10 procedures at 300ft ceiling and 1SM visibility minimums before being approved to utilize 200ft ceiling and $\frac{3}{4}$ SM Visibility. Each pilot's OSAP training record will then become a part of their training record.
2. Ten hours of flightcrew experience operating IFR (at either crew station) in the offshore route structure.
3. A minimum of ten OSAPs for each type of navigation receiver with at least five for each type of procedure (HEDA,OSAP) and at least four from each crewmember position. Each type of navigation receiver will be recorded in HeliService USA's Single Line Entry form.
4. Following initial OSAP training each pilot will perform an OSAP proficiency check during their annual recurrent training.



6.5.8.1.5 Operating Limitations

The pilot shall not begin or continue the final approach segment of an OSAP unless all of the following conditions and limitations are met:

1. Precipitation Limits: The OSAP shall not be executed in precipitation that results in rain echo attenuation on the radar display, and nothing less than 120 degrees antenna sweep shall be used.
2. Approach Airspeed Limits: Approach airspeed shall be flown not to exceed 70 knots groundspeed after FAP (Final Approach Point).
3. Obstruction Limits: All obstructions which are observed on radar are avoided by at least 0.5 NM when below 900ft MSL
 - a. For operations in and around windfarms pilots shall adjust altitudes to be 200ft higher than the highest obstacle.

6.5.8.1.6 Landing Minimums [14 CFR § 135.225(a)(2)]

Day: $\frac{3}{4}$ SM & MDA of 200 ft.

Night 1 SM & MDA of 300 ft

6.5.8.1.7 Destination Coordinates

Flightcrews are provided with the current observed coordinates for the landing site. Before departure, the flightcrew enters the observed landing site coordinates into the navigation system flight plan. This action designates the landing site as a "waypoint".

6.5.8.1.8 Intermediate Segment

Intermediate Approach Fix (IAF) OSAP: The IAF for an OSAP may be a DME fix (based upon VORTAC) or a waypoint based upon an approved RNAV system. The pilot will select the IAF no more than 40.0 NM (approximately) from the OSAP but descent below the MEA to 900ft MSL is not authorized until offshore and within 20.0 NM of the approach target.

NOTE:

ADS-B direct clearance to an offshore destination: The intermediate fix for OSAP or HEDA operations will be 10 NM from the destination coordinates on the "direct to course."

Upon reaching the IAF the Flight crew/PIC will:

1. Obtain the current weather, then
2. Resets the RNAV to either the approach targets observed coordinates, or to the GPS Transition Waypoint.
3. Once within 10 NM you can descend to 900ft.
4. Select a final approach course within 10 degrees of the reported wind.
5. Begin pre-selecting the clear area during this phase of the approach.



6. The PIC sets RNAV CDI sensitivity to 1NM (If applicable).
7. Ensure that the RNAV, radar, and radar altimeter are operating properly.
8. Ensure that the RADAR is in the MAP MODE, prior to reaching the FAP.
9. Depending on the reported winds, execute one of the following:
 - a. **Straight-In (Wind Angle within 10°):** Approach within 10 degrees of the reported wind, continue to the FAP.
 - b. **Overhead Course Reversal (Wind Angle >90°):** Determine the reciprocal of the wind direction. Fix the "over the rig" position when the RNAV reads 0.0 NM, then make the shortest turn to the outbound heading. Use either a 10° teardrop and fly outbound 7.0 to 8.0 NM, or (high proficiency) use a 15° teardrop and fly outbound 5.0 to 6.0 NM prior to commencing the turn inbound.
 - c. **Overhead 2 Waypoints (Wind Angle >90°):** You can use the 2 Waypoint transition in lieu of Overhead Course Reversal procedure. By using 2 temporary waypoints to get turned into the wind. Determine the reciprocal of the wind direction and by using P/D/B function of the aircraft inserting 2 temporary waypoints 10° apart.
 - d. **GPS Transition Waypoint (Wind Angle <90°):** Use the GPS Transition only if your intermediate segment course is 90 degrees or less from the final approach course. Create the GPS transition waypoint 8.0 NM downwind from the approach target. Fly direct from the IF to the GPS transition waypoint, then turn inbound.

6.5.8.1.9 Final Approach Point (FAP)

Copter Delta 30 OSAP

1. At the FAP the Flight crew/PIC verifies the approach target on radar versus the RNAV is within 0.2NM
2. Confirms which side the clear area is on.
3. Departing the FAP inbound, the flight crew/PIC must stabilize approach airspeed, and may descend to 500ft.
4. During this phase, the aircraft may be maneuvered to avoid obstructions closer than 0.5 NM or may remain at 900ft (or higher if adjusted for taller obstacles) until clear of any obstructions. In either case, the aircraft MUST be established on the final approach course and be at 500ft prior to the DPA (Decision Point Altitude - 500ft but not lower than the MDA adjusted for RASS) . Heading changes to avoid obstacles are not permitted after the DPA. A missed approach is required if a minimum lateral separation distance of 0.5 NM from obstructions cannot be assured.
5. Before beginning descent at the DPA, the Flight crew/PIC selects the appropriate scale on the radar, cross checks the radar and RNAV to confirm agreement and accuracy and confirms a minimum lateral separation of 0.5 NM throughout the final and missed approach course.
6. When the Flight crew/PIC arrive at the DPA they can descend to the MDA.
7. When appropriate the Flight crew/PIC will select the 2.5 scale on the radar.



8. At 1.1 NM from the approach target a 30-degree turn is made to the clear area located to the left or right of course.
9. When visual reference with the approach target is established, the helicopter may proceed to the desired destination.
10. If visual contact with the approach target is not established at 0.6 NM of the approach target, a missed approach must be executed.

NOTE:

When using the Delta 30 procedure in high wind conditions, the target may be lost from the radar screen without attaining 0.6 NM on the GPS. This is due to the high cross wind which is moving the aircraft away from the target. A missed approach must be executed when the target is lost from the radar screen.

6.5.8.1.10 Missed Approach Procedure

The missed approach procedure is for both approaches and is accomplished by climbing to 900ft MSL (or higher if needed) via missed approach course, then climbing turn to 2000ft MSL and hold 3 NM legs on inbound course to approach target at 100KIAS. Remain within 10 NM of OSAP or HEDA coordinates or as directed by ATC. Execute missed approach when:

1. Failure of the GPS, or airborne radar.
2. The approach target is lost from the radar display for 1 full sweep.
3. Radar contouring.
4. GPS and radar differ by 0.2NM when identifying approach target
5. Un-stabilized approach.
6. When visual reference with the landing site is not made at the MAP.
7. When the track will not avoid all obstacles by 0.5 NM.
8. When the RNAV indicates 0.6 (Delta 30) without visual contact.

Missed Approach Point – MAP – DELTA 30 degrees OSAP

A point on the final approach course where a missed approach is initiated. It is a point located on the Delta 30 degrees turn heading at 0.6 NM. A helicopter is at the MAP when the RNAV distance indicates (0.6 NM Day) (1.0 Night) or anytime the primary target is lost from the radar screen, whichever occurs first.

6.5.8.1.11 Takeoff and Departure

IFR departures from all OSAP locations will be:

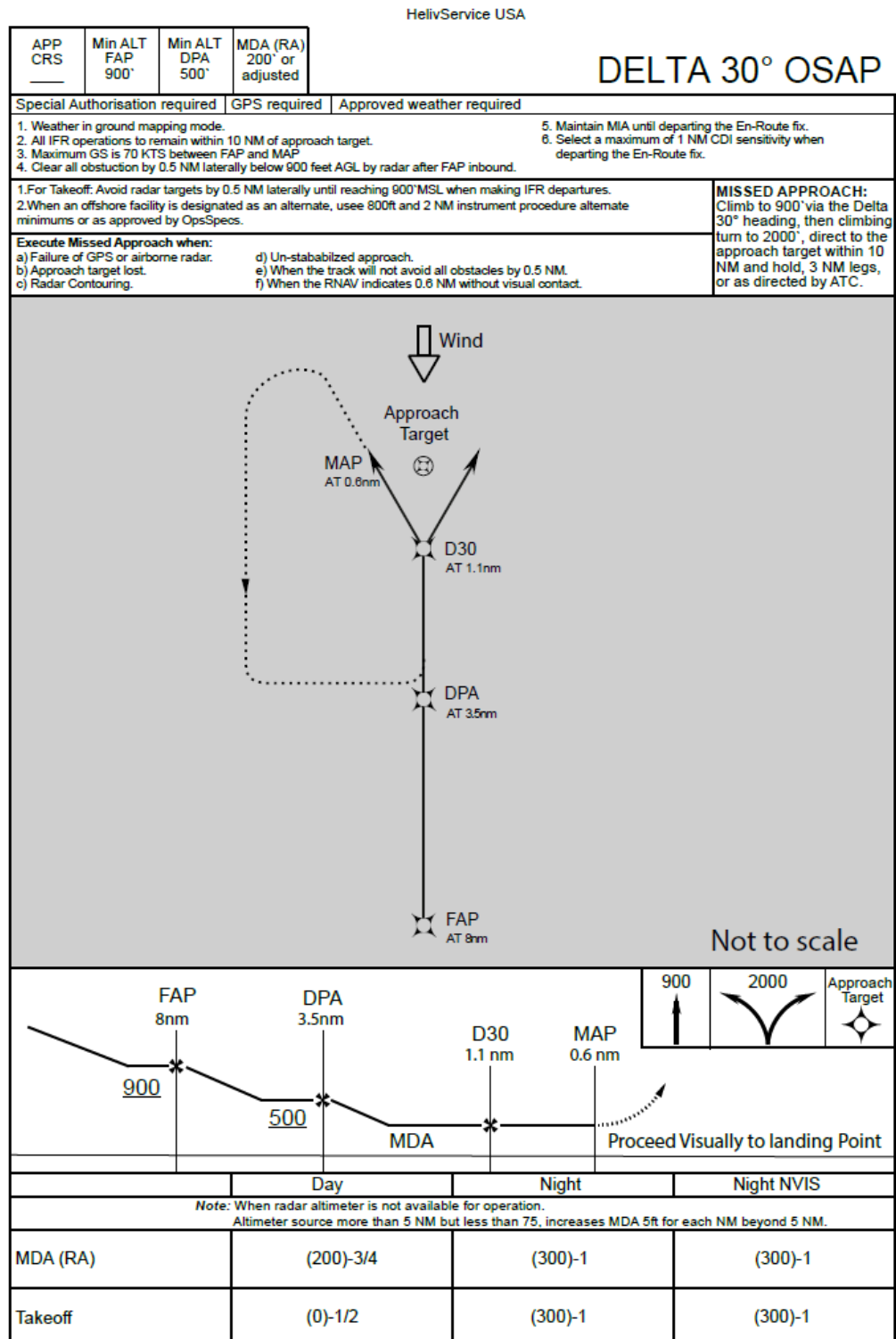
1. Day: ½ SM
2. Night: 300ft and 1 SM

For all operations below 900ft or adjusted higher for obstacles avoid all obstacles by .5 SM.



6.5.8.1.12 OSAP Charts

Copter GPS OSAP charts can be found on HeliService's EFB.



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Copter GPS OSAP



6.5.8.2 HEDA (Helicopter En Route Decent Area)

HeliService is authorized to conduct IFR helicopter operations using Helicopter Enroute Descent Area (HEDA) procedures to approved offshore locations.

New HEDA locations may be used if the following the conditions are compiled while conducting HEDA operations:

6.5.8.2.1 HEDA Locations

FAA Approved Helicopter Enroute Descent Areas (HEDA) are listed on the approved EFB.

Since the HEDA procedure is not an instrument approach, terminal weather reports are not required. As a safe, prudent practice, the weather stations in the area should be checked prior to dispatch and letdown.

Pilot's may dispatch to any of the HEDA locations posted on HeliService's EFB. Or new locations if the correct information is sent to the Chief Pilot's office.

6.5.8.2.2 Weather Reporting

HEDAs must use the appropriate area forecast or local weather to determine if the weather is at or above descent minimums.

6.5.8.2.3 Flight Crew/PIC Qualifications

All IFR pilots must receive HEDA ground training. Notwithstanding the provisions of AC 90-80C or as revised, pilots meet the minimum training requirements upon the completion of 5 training HEDAs.

1. Pilots must pass a HEDA proficiency flight check before being authorized to conduct actual instrument operations. After a pilots initial proficiency check they will record a additional 10 procedures at 500ft ceiling and 2SM visibility minimums before being approved to utilize 400ft ceiling and 1SM Visibility. Each pilot's HEDA training record will then become a part of their training record.
2. Ten hours of flightcrew experience operating IFR (at either crew station) in the offshore route structure.
3. A minimum of ten HEDAs for each type of navigation receiver with at least five for each type of procedure (HEDA,OSAP) and at least four from each crewmember position. Each type of navigation receiver will be recorded in HeliService USA's Single Line Entry form.
4. Following initial HEDA training each pilot will perform an HEDA proficiency check during their annual recurrent training.

6.5.8.2.4 Intermediate Segment

Obtain the current weather if applicable, then upon arrival at the IF (Intermediate Fix) the Flight crew/PIC resets the RNAV to the HEDAs published coordinates. Once within 20 NM you can descend to 900ft or



higher altitude for adjusted for obstacles. Begin confirmation that the HEDA is clear of obstacles during this phase of the descent. The Flight crew/PIC will ensure that the Radar, and Radar Altimeter are operating properly prior to descending into the HEDA. The heading from the HEDA coordinates to the destination should be confirmed at this time.

Note:

For operations in areas with windfarms the Intermediate Segment altitudes should be adjusted to remain above the tallest obstacle by 200ft. For example if flying to a windfarm with 1000ft wind turbines, the Intermediate Segment altitude should be adjusted to 1200ft.

6.5.8.2.5 Final Descent

Descent below Intermediate Segment altitude begins at the FAP within 4.0 NM of the HEDA coordinates. The Flight crew/PIC verifies the clear area on radar and starts a descent. Descent below 900ft is not authorized unless a 1.0-mile lateral clearance can be maintained from any target in the HEDA.

The Flight crew/PIC continues descent to the MDA. When VMC is established, the helicopter may proceed to the desired destination. If VMC is not established upon arrival at the HEDA coordinates, an immediate climb must be executed in the HEDA.

6.5.8.2.6 Special Limitations

1. The descent area must be entirely over water.
2. Descent below Intermediate Segment (900ft or Adjusted) is not authorized unless a 1.0-sm lateral clearance can be maintained from any target in the HEDA.
3. Descent below 700ft above the surface is not authorized whenever any of the following conditions exist:
 - a. Any obstruction is detected in the HEDA.
 - b. A radar altimeter is inoperative.
 - c. Surface mapping radar is inoperative.
 - d. The lowest altitude used for IFR flight in any HEDA shall not be lower than 300ft above the surface.

6.5.8.2.7 Missed HEDA Procedure

A missed procedure must be executed by making an immediate climb in the HEDA to 900ft MSL anytime one of the following occurs:

1. Failure to obtain VMC conditions at the HEDA coordinates.
2. Failure of the Airborne Radar or appearance of a radar target in the HEDA below 700ft.
3. Failure of the Radar Altimeter below 700ft.

Procedure: After climbing to 900ft continue a climbing turn to 2000ft and hold, 3.0 NM legs on the final approach course or as directed by ATC at 100KIAS. Remain within 10.0 NM of the HEDA coordinates.



6.5.8.2.8 HEDA Chart

GPS HEDA charts can be found on HeliService's EFB.



Copter GPS HEDA

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Copter GPS HEDA

6.5.8.3 PNR (Point of No Return) Procedures

Prior to proceeding beyond the PNR, the Flight crew/PIC shall:

1. Determine that the weather is at or above authorized IFR landing minimums.
2. Ensure that the current observed weather at the offshore IFR alternate is reporting at or above 800ft ceiling and 2 SM visibility.
3. Confirm that all required OSAP equipment is operating.

6.5.8.4 Offshore IFR Alternates

An appropriate onshore or offshore IFR alternate is required for each IFR offshore destination when, either:

1. The reported weather at the destination, at the time of departure is less than:
 2. 2000ft ceiling; or
 3. 3 SM visibility, or
4. From at least one hour before and after the estimated time of arrival, the appropriate weather forecasts indicate weather at the destination will be less than; 2000ft ceiling; or 3 SM visibility.
5. IFR flight: When an IFR alternate is not required on an offshore IFR flight enough fuel must be carried in order to:
 6. Complete the flight to the offshore destination, and,
 7. Fly from that offshore destination to another suitable landing site utilizing HeliService VFR weather minimums and fly after for 30 minutes at normal cruising speed.
8. Alternate must be filed when a HEDA is the destination.

NOTE:

Fuel planning shall take into consideration holding, run up, taxi, and any delay requirements if anticipated.

6.5.8.5 Offshore Weather Deviation

Air crews may file IFR to or depart from an offshore destination without an approved weather station provided that one of the following weather reporting criteria is met.

NOTE:

14 CFR 135.213(b) Deviation authorized in accordance with the guidance contained in FAA Order 8900.1, Volume 3, Chapter 26, Section 2, Paragraph 3-2073(D) and AC 90-80C.

1. One Station



- a. The approach coordinates shall be within 10 NM of an approved weather reporting station.
2. Two Stations
 - a. The approach coordinates shall fall within an observation area defined by the location of two approved weather reporting stations:
 - i. The observation area centerline is established by the actual distance between the two stations, not to exceed 40 NM, plus ten at either end.
 - ii. The lateral width may not be greater than 40 NM either side of the established observation area centerline.
 - iii. The maximum observation area is a rectangle 60 NM by 80.
 - iv. For Operations in the Gulf of Mexico the maximum observed area may be expanded to a rectangle of 100 x 80nm.
 - b. A list of landing areas which meet these criteria is posted to the EFB folder **OSAP/HEDA Locations**. If a proposed offshore IFR destination does not appear on this list, utilize the procedures of 6.5.8.12 New HEDA/OSAP Request and Maintenance to determine its eligibility to submit a new OSAP/HEDA Request.
3. Alternate HEDA Weather
 - a. For HEDAs a TAF (Terminal area forecast) may be used for determining your location weather. If a TAF is used for location weather, sufficient fuel will be carried to comply an onshore/offshore alternate requirements.

6.5.8.6 Offshore IFR Dispatch Weather

1. OSAPs are approved approaches with visibility as the primary approach weather minimum. For dispatch, the following ceiling and visibility minimums apply:
 - a. OSAPs (Day): if the reported (current observation) weather is 200 feet and $\frac{3}{4}$ SM or better (or as adjusted for equipment or pilot qualifications) you may dispatch to that location.
 - b. OSAPs (Night): if the reported (current observation) weather is 400 feet and 2.0 SM or better (or as adjusted for equipment or pilot qualifications) you may dispatch to that location.
2. HEDAs are approved enroute descent areas. For dispatch, the following ceiling and visibility minimums apply:
 - a. HEDAs (Day): if the appropriate Area Forecast is 400 feet and 1.0 SM or better you may dispatch to that location.
 - b. HEDAs (Night): if the appropriate Area Forecast is 700 feet and 3.0 SM or better you may dispatch to that location.

6.5.8.7 Offshore IFR Arrival Weather

After completing an OSAP/HEDA and the flight is to continue to another destination VFR, the following weather minimums apply:

1. OSAP: Within 5 NM of the approach target, landing minimums are authorized. When the landing platform is between 5 and 10 NM of the approach target, 300 feet ceiling and 1.0 SM for daytime



operations and 700 feet ceiling and 3.0 SM for nighttime operations are authorized. When the landing platform is beyond 10 NM of the approach target, standard HSI. VFR minimums apply (day/ night, or customer requirements, as appropriate).

2. HEDA: Within 10 NM of the HEDA coordinates, 400 feet ceiling and 1.0 SM for daytime operations and 700 feet ceiling and 3.0 SM for nighttime operations are authorized. When the landing platform is beyond 10 NM from the HEDA coordinates, standard HSI. VFR minimums apply (day/night, or customer requirements, as appropriate).

6.5.8.8 Night IFR Weather Minimums

Special Instrument Approach Procedures: Takeoff or approach is not authorized with less than 300 feet ceiling and 1.0 SM visibility.

6.5.8.9 Offshore Missed Approach Lost Communications Procedures

In the event of lost communications while executing a missed approach procedure, comply with the following:

1. Route of Flight: Direct to alternate
2. Altitude: Minimum Instrument Altitude (MIA) (1500 feet offshore)
3. Transponder: Squawk 7600

6.5.8.10 Offshore IFR Alternates

An appropriate onshore or offshore IFR alternate is required for each IFR offshore destination when, either:

1. The reported weather at the destination, at the time of departure is less than:
 - a. 2000ft ceiling; or
 - b. 3 SM visibility, or
2. From at least one hour before and after the estimated time of arrival, the appropriate weather forecasts indicate weather at the destination will be less than; 2000ft ceiling; or 3 SM visibility.
3. IFR flight: When an IFR alternate is not required on an offshore IFR flight enough fuel must be carried in order to:
 - a. Complete the flight to the offshore destination, and,
 - b. Fly from that offshore destination to another suitable landing site utilizing HeliService VFR weather minimums and fly after for 30 minutes at normal cruising speed.

NOTE:

Fuel planning shall take into consideration holding requirements if anticipated.



6.5.8.10.1 Deriving Offshore Alternates

Authorized offshore IFR alternates are listed on HeliService's EFB. Weather reports and forecasts shall indicate that the weather at the IFR offshore alternate will be at or above a ceiling of 800ft and a visibility of 2 SM or greater at the estimated time of arrival.

Offshore IFR alternates shall only be used for flights terminating at offshore destinations unless you are departing an offshore location, with less than landing minimums, and your destination is an onshore location. The reliance on offshore installations as alternates should be avoided wherever possible and is only acceptable in certain circumstances when the onshore alternative is equally unacceptable. When operating offshore, any spare payload capacity should be used to carry additional fuel if it would facilitate the use of an onshore alternate.

6.5.8.10.2 Offshore Alternate Fuel Requirements

When an offshore IFR alternate is required, sufficient fuel shall be carried to:

1. Complete the flight to the offshore destination, and;
2. Fly from that offshore destination to an authorized offshore IFR alternate reporting at least 800ft and 2 SM and Fly after that for 30 minutes at normal cruising speed.

6.5.8.11 Offshore Departure Procedures

6.5.8.11.1 Offshore Destination

When departing from an offshore helideck/vessel and an offshore IFR alternate is specified, the flight crew must complete the following:

1. Determine that there is sufficient fuel to fly to the offshore destination, then to an authorized offshore IFR alternate, and fly after that for 30 minutes at normal cruising speed.
2. Obtain the current reported weather for the destination area and determine that the weather is at or above authorized IFR landing minimums.
3. Ensure that, at the time of departure, both the current Area Forecast and the current observed weather at the offshore IFR alternate are reporting at or above 800ft ceiling and 2 SM visibility.
4. Confirm that all required OSAP/HEDA equipment is operating.

6.5.8.11.2 Onshore Destination

When departing an offshore location for an onshore destination, onshore alternate requirements shall be utilized. If you are departing an offshore location with less than landing minimums, then offshore IFR alternates may be utilized as your takeoff alternate.

NOTE:

If you want ATC to know your Alternate, it should be listed in the Remarks section of your Flight Plan.



6.5.8.12 New HEDA/OSAP Request and Maintenance

Pilot(s) may submit new OSAP/HEDA locations for approval by sending the following information to the Chief Pilot, approval is not required prior to use the OSAP/HEDA. This information may be transmitted via scan, email, or fax.

1. **Location:** Pilots will enter name (Coast Guard/Customer name) of OSAP/HEDA location.
2. **Geographic Coordinates:** Pilot(s) will enter GPS coordinates of the OSAP/HEDA target location. When entering coordinates for West please insert "0" prior to the coordinate if appropriate.
3. **Weather Station 1:** For HEDA the area forecast to be used. For OSAP pilot(s) will enter the identifier of the Primary Weather Station (one closest to location). If the weather station is co-located or within 25 NM of the OSAP target location, then only one station is needed.
4. **Weather Station 2:** Pilot(s) will enter the identifier of the secondary weather station if one is required.
5. **Signature:** Signature of the PIC is required in the request.

NOTE: All information included must be complete and legible. Signature is required.

After approval the OSAP/HEDA locations will be entered onto the approved OSAP/HEDA list maintained on HSUSA's approved EFB. The locations will be date stamped and will be an approved OSAP/HEDA location for 12 calendar months or until pilots report a change or update to the Chief Pilots office.

6.6 HAA

6.6.1 Purpose

This section outlines the operational procedures, safety protocols, and regulatory requirements for Helicopter Air Ambulance (HAA) operations under HSUSA. To ensure safe, efficient, and compliant air ambulance flights by providing detailed guidance on hazard identification, crew briefings, risk analysis, flight planning, landing zone safety, medical equipment handling, and emergency procedures. The annex serves as a comprehensive reference for pilots, medical crewmembers, and communications specialists, emphasizing the importance of teamwork, regulatory adherence, and continuous training to maintain high standards of safety and patient care in HAA missions.

6.6.2 Hazard Map - Local Areas

Purpose



To ensure flight crews maintain current awareness of known local hazards and to flag items that are not already shown on the map through both physical and digital mapping resources.

Policy

Each HeliService USA base shall maintain a Local Area Hazard Map, prominently displayed and regularly updated by the PICs or designee. This map includes terrain, obstacle, airspace, and operational hazard data relevant to the base's local flying area. When a new Hazard is identified by the PICs, Med Crew, Local First Responders or other means the PIC or Lead Pilot shall ensure the Hazard Map is updated in a timely fashion.

In addition to the physical chart, HeliService USA maintains digital versions of the Local Area Hazard Maps in ForeFlight, which are updated with the same information and are accessible to all flight crews during preflight planning and in-flight operations. The Lead Pilot or Program Manager will send updated Hazards to the EFB Manager and Safety Department after review and or any internal audits.

Responsibilities

- Base PICs are responsible for ensuring the accuracy and currency of the wall-mounted hazard map.
- All PICs are required to reference the most current Local Area Hazard Map as part of their preflight planning and CRM briefings.
- The Safety Department may conduct periodic reviews to ensure hazard map consistency across both physical and digital formats.

6.6.2.1 Local Areas of Operation

HeliService USA has designated several Local Areas to support efficient and safe operations within defined geographic boundaries. These areas are utilized for standard operations including training, maintenance, ferry, and positioning flights, as well as mission-specific work, consistent with FAA regulatory requirements and company procedures. The currently approved Local Areas are listed below:

Local Flying Area Base	Description	Coordinating Geographic FSDO
Urbana, OH [174] (Careflight 3)	50nm Radius of Base	Columbus



Versailles, OH [VES] (Careflight 4)	50nm Radius of Base	Columbus
Lebanon, OH [I68] (Careflight 2)	50nm Radius of Base	Columbus
Martha's Vineyard, MA (KMOV)	50nm Radius of Base	Portland
North Kingstown, RI (KOQU)	50nm Radius of Base	Portland

1. 174 (Urbana, OH) – 50nm Radius
2. KVES (Versailles, OH) – 50nm Radius
3. I68 (Lebanon, OH) - 50nm Radius
4. KMOV (Martha's Vineyard, MA) – 50nm Radius
5. KOQU (North Kingstown, RI) – 50nm Radius

6.6.3 Passenger and Medical Crewmember Briefing

[91.517, 91.519, 135.23, 135.117, 135.127, 135.621]

6.6.3.1 Passenger Briefing

When any conscious and coherent patient, passenger, or non-HSUSA employee is being transported, the PIC will be responsible to ensure that they or a trained medical person will orally brief them.

The PIC shall ensure that the briefing is completed before taxi or takeoff. The briefing may be supplemented by a HSUSA approved passenger briefing card for the make and model of aircraft operated and shall be available to each passenger.

The following items shall be included in the briefings.

- No smoking within 50 feet of the exterior of any aircraft, nor at any time within the interior of any company aircraft



- Use of seatbelts
- Use of personal electronic devices (PED)
- Upright positioning of all seat backs (if available) before takeoff and landing
- Location and operation of passenger entry doors and emergency exits
- Location of survival equipment
- Location and operation of fire extinguisher
- If over water, instructions and location for flotation gear and pyrotechnic devices
- For rotorcraft flights operated beyond autorotational distance from the shoreline as defined in 14 CFR 135.168(a), use of life preservers, ditching procedures and emergency exit from the rotorcraft in the event of a ditching; and the location and use of life rafts and other life preserver devices if applicable
- Normal and emergency use of oxygen if the flight is above 12,000 feet MSL

6.6.3.2 Required Medical Crewmember Briefing and Training

As stated in §135.621(a), the PIC or other flight crewmember must ensure that all clinicians receive and complete a Helicopter Air Ambulance (HAA) medical personnel-specific safety briefing before each HAA operation in which they participate, or as authorized by §135.621(b), have completed the certificate holder's approved medical personnel safety training program within the previous 24 months. This training is required by HSUSA every 12 months.

Medical Personnel who have not received the certificate holder's training in the previous 12 months must be briefed on the following:

- Passenger briefing requirements in § 135.117(a) and (b)
- Physiological aspects of flight
- Patient loading and unloading
- Safety in and around the helicopter
- In-flight emergency procedures
- Emergency landing procedures
- Emergency evacuation procedures
- Efficient and safe communications with the pilot
- Operational differences between day and night operations, if appropriate.

6.6.4 Pre-flight Risk Analysis

[135.617 135.619]



All HSUSA HAA flights must complete a Pre-flight Risk Analysis. The company utilizes unique software for this purpose. If there is a delay in getting airborne, a new PFRA must be submitted if the original PFRA for weather, fuel or crew stress factors etc. has materially changed.

The following are to be completed:

- The PIC must conduct a Pre-flight Risk Analysis (PFRA) and complete the PFRA worksheet prior to the first leg of each HAA operation.
- The PFRA application will log the date and time a specific worksheet is completed by a PIC.
- The PFRA application will retain completed PFRA worksheets for at least 90 days from the date of the operation.
- Med Comm will determine from the HAA task requester whether another HAA operator has refused or rejected a flight request and inform the PIC of any such occurrence.

Purpose

To ensure the safety of HeliService USA (HSUSA) HAA operations by identifying and mitigating risk factors prior to each mission.

Policy

All HSUSA Helicopter Air Ambulance (HAA) operations must complete a Pre-Flight Risk Analysis (PFRA) prior to departure. HSUSA utilizes a company-approved software application for this purpose.

Procedure

- The Pilot-in-Command (PIC) is responsible for conducting and submitting the PFRA prior to the first leg of each HAA flight.
- The PFRA must consider the following operational risk factors:
 - Weather conditions
 - Fuel planning
 - Crew fatigue and stress
 - Aircraft status (e.g., MEL items)
 - Operational environment (e.g., night, terrain, hazards)
- If any significant delay occurs after PFRA completion and/or operational factors such as weather, fuel, or crew status materially change, a new PFRA must be submitted.
- The PFRA application automatically logs the completed assessment and retains PFRA records for a minimum of 90 days.



Med Comm Notification Requirement

Med Comm must inquire with the HAA task requester if the flight request was previously refused or declined by another air medical provider, and must inform the PIC of this information before accepting or launching the mission.

Risk Escalation and Mitigation

- The PFRA software assigns a risk level (e.g., low, medium, high) based on cumulative scoring.
- Medium-risk flights may proceed with PIC-initiated mitigation strategies.
- High-risk flights require documented approval from the Chief Pilot, Director of Operations, or their designated representative prior to departure.

Compliance and Oversight

- PFRA completion is mandatory for every HAA flight and is subject to random audits by the Safety Department and the Director of Operations.
- Training on the PFRA process is included in initial and recurrent HAA pilot training.

HSUSA Pre-Flight Risk Mitigation

HSUSA Pre-Flight Risk Mitigation Strategies

Risk Factor	Example Condition	Mitigation Strategies
Weather	Marginal VFR conditions at departure or enroute	1. Delay departure until improved conditions- Adjust route to avoid deteriorating WX 2. Request updated WX brief & PIREPs
Night Operations	Night flight in unfamiliar terrain	1. Require dual pilot 2. NVG qualified crew 3. Increase minimum altitude 4. Use enhanced preflight hazard briefings
Pilot Experience	Low recent experience in aircraft or area	1. Assign a more experienced PIC or SIC 2. Conduct a preflight review with Chief Pilot 3. Limit operation to daylight
Duty/Rest Time	Long duty day or approaching max limits	1. Reassign crew 2. Delay mission start 3. Adjust crew rest schedule in advance
Previous Operator Refusal	Another provider declined the mission	1. Require direct briefing between PIC and Med Comm 2. Elevate mission to High Risk for DO/CP review
MEL Item Active	Aircraft dispatched with deferred maintenance	1. Verify no impact on mission profile 2. Use alternative aircraft if available
Fuel Concerns	Tight fuel margins due to distance/weather	1. Add fuel or plan fuel stop- Recalculate alternate and contingency fuel 2. Reassign shorter route or closer landing zone



HSUSA Pre-Flight Risk Mitigation Strategies

Risk Factor	Example Condition	Mitigation Strategies
Landing Zone (LZ)	Confined area, sloped terrain, obstacles	1. Require daylight arrival 2. Utilize ground contact with LZ survey 3. Assign pilot experienced with site
Aircraft Limitations	Performance margins reduced (weight/temp)	1. Reduce payload 2. Delay for better performance window 3. Use higher performance aircraft if available



6.6.5 Shift-Change and Post-Flight Debriefing

At the change of each shift, the PIC will conduct a briefing of the duty clinicians and any others that might be appropriate. As a minimum, the topics discussed will be as follows:

- Weather for the duty period
- Mechanical issues with the aircraft, including the medical interior and upcoming aircraft maintenance and inspections
- Flight restrictions required when operating with inoperative equipment
- Crew input (Med crew/co-pilot/nurse/mechanic)
- Public relations events
- "Third" riders (or "ride-along")
- Scheduled training
- Any other events that may impact that duty period's operation

Post-flight debriefings will also be completed. Items for discussion will include but not be limited to the following:

- Safety issues and requirements to report to SMS
- Communications problems with aircraft, portables, or other communications equipment
- Weather concerns
- Aircraft issues
- Any other noteworthy items

Debriefing is critical in the HAA high-stakes environment, where errors can have considerable, often life-threatening consequences and therefore should be a cultural practice involving the whole crew.

After each flight, the PIC will facilitate a post-flight debriefing specifically to reflect on and review the preceding flight to improve cognition and performance in non-technical, human factor areas. The debrief should be designed around the key elements of an HAA flight and the five tenants of the Air Medical Resource Management (AMRM) core competencies. Non-HAA flights should adjust the debrief elements to fit the task.

The debriefing should not be rushed and should be conducted in a quiet appropriate area as soon after the flight as reasonably possible. The PIC should be familiar with the AMRM skills standard and look to develop a standardized, logical approach to debriefing the crew.

6.6.5.1 Base Readiness

After the completion of a shift change briefing, it is the responsibility of the incoming crew to immediately update Med Comm with the current base status, using the Red, Yellow, or Green system to



indicate operational readiness. This initial status should reflect aircraft availability, crew readiness, and any limitations due to weather or maintenance. Throughout the shift, the crew must continue to provide timely updates to Med Comm whenever conditions change, especially when transitioning between local area missions and cross-country operations. Green status indicates full operational capability for both local and cross-country flights. Yellow status denotes restricted capabilities typically limiting flights to local area operations only due to factors like marginal weather or partial crew readiness. Red status means the base is not mission-ready, halting all HAA operations. Minimum weather requirements for cross-country flights are more stringent than local ops and should be assessed in conjunction with the appropriate sections of the OM-A and Part 135 as applicable. This continuous communication loop ensures accurate flight following, reduces launch delays, and enhances mission safety for both the flight crew and patients.

6.6.6 HAA Specific Weight-and-Balance Control

[135.23, 135.185]

In addition to the guidance given in the aircraft maintenance manual, the following equipment (as appropriate) shall be included in the Operational Empty Weight (OEW).

- Stretcher or litter
- Secondary stretcher or litter
- Full and operational ready O2 system
- Duals removed and dual covers installed
- Other medical equipment as appropriate

Note:

The PIC must ensure the OEW does not include items already accounted for in the weight of any removable medical equipment bag. To that extent portable gaseous cylinders are included in the removable medical equipment bags.

Note:

All medical equipment carried aboard HeliService USA aircraft has been individually weighed and cataloged. These weights have been incorporated into the company's weight and balance software to ensure accurate calculations for every flight. This includes both permanently installed and mission-specific equipment. The equipment list is maintained by the Director of Maintenance or designee in the Aircraft's Chart C, and it is updated whenever new equipment is added, removed, or modified. Flight crews are responsible for verifying that the equipment onboard matches the documented configuration prior to each mission.

14 CFR 135.185 requires all HSUSA multi-engine aircraft to be weighed every 36 calendar months. Aviation personnel may determine whether an aircraft complies with this regulation by checking the aircraft maintenance logbook (Digital Airware).



6.6.7 Complete Flight (CF) Manifest

A CF Manifest shall be completed and signed by the PIC for all flights.

The PIC will log total starts on the "close manifest" page. For any additional starts for maintenance or cancelled requests, create a manifest for a maintenance ground run and in the "close manifest" page note number of starts and then save and close the manifest.

For each leg of the flight the PIC will provide the following information:

- The number of passengers
- The total number of landings (multiple landings can be logged on a single leg, such as might occur during training flights)

Complete Flight Manifest - Certifying and Processing Logs

- The Program Manager or their designee (usually the Base lead) audits the manifests, and then electronically signs as completed to lock the manifest from further change. This audit process will be conducted at least every eight days. The Program Manager should be contacted for any irregularities/adjustments in the manifest after this audit process.
- Completed load manifests will be kept electronically and are available on the CF server in accordance with HSUSA's document retention policy.

6.6.8 Medical Oxygen Tanks – Filling and Changing

[43.3, 135.91]

When necessary, HSUSA pilots who have been trained, qualified, and authorized, as specified in the HSUSA Pilots Maintenance and Servicing Procedures, may be authorized to fill and change out medical oxygen tanks in the company aircraft.

6.6.9 Flight Operations

6.6.9.1 HAA Helicopter Night Vision Goggle Operations (HNVGO)

The following procedures are applicable to all HAA flights at night employing night vision goggles conducted under Title 14 CFR Parts 91 and 135.

HNVGO will only be conducted in aircraft with an approved Supplemental Type Certificate (STC)



authorizing such operations. Ops Specs D093 must be current, the Rotorcraft Flight Manual Supplement (RFMS) must be current and retained in the Rotorcraft Flight Manual (RFM).

For the purpose of this manual, a helicopter night vision goggle operation (HNVGO) consists of the following:

- During the time period from 1 hour after sunset to 1 hour before sunrise
- A before-takeoff check, takeoff, climb out, cruise, descent, approach, and landing
- Hovering tasks
- Area departure and arrival tasks
- Transitioning from aided flight to unaided night flight and back to aided flight

HNVGOs must be performed in the same category, class and type, if a type rating is required.

6.6.9.1.1 Crew Resource Management and Crew Briefings

For HAA HNVGO operations below 300 feet AGL, at least one other person, shall be equipped with NVGs during landings and departures at un-improved landing zones to assist in clearing the site. The other required person, when able, is located on the side opposite the pilot, in either the front or back compartment. The other required person referenced in this paragraph must be current and trained in accordance with the approved HSUSA NVG training program.

Due to the limitations of NVGs, the implementation of CRM and TEM during aided operations is paramount to safe and effective operations. Good teamwork requires positive communication between the pilot and medical crew members. During flight planning and crew briefings, the pilot briefs the medical crew on the following:

1. Type of flight – aided, unaided, or both
2. Weather for the route
3. Illumination
4. Lunar position (moon)
5. Obstacles along the route
6. NVG deficiencies
7. Crew experience
8. Abort criteria

The pilot analyzes the route of flight, and identifies aids to navigation, visual navigation cues, potential difficulties, and emergency landing areas, as needed. The crewmembers will aid the pilot during all critical phases of flight. Each crewmember is responsible for their quadrant of the aircraft. Examples include but are not limited to the following:

1. Hovering maneuvers



2. Taxiing
3. Takeoffs and landings
4. Area arrival and departure
5. Flight in congested areas

The crew will clear the immediate area in all directions during hovering and taxi operations, and left, right, and overhead, before and after takeoff. The crew will use clearing turns to clear the area before making any climbs or descents. Crewmembers are responsible for clearing within their field of view.

1. **Directing Assistance** The pilot directs the crewmembers when assistance is needed. Crewmembers announce when they divert their attention from outside the aircraft to inside the aircraft for more than a few seconds.
2. **Announcing Decisions** – Crewmembers announce decisions anytime actions deviate from the previously briefed procedures, or an action of one crewmember affects the performance or responsibilities of another crewmember.
3. **Offering Assistance** – Crewmembers offer assistance when information or assistance is requested, when the pilot deviates from normal or expected actions, and anytime a crewmember sees and/or recognizes anything that could pose a hazard to flight.
4. **Acknowledging Actions** – All announcements or directives should be acknowledged by the intended receiver by a short and positive response indicating the message has been received.
5. **Standard or Common Terminology** – Using common terms and standard phraseology in the aircraft minimizes confusion and reduces the likelihood of misunderstanding. Use explicit terms and phrases. Use terms that give object, direction and distance (for example, “tree on the left side,” or “traffic, 2 o’clock high, 1 mile.”) Use prominent terrain features instead of headings (for example, “Turn left towards the hill at your 2 o’clock position,” or “straight ahead to the pond”).
 - a. Examples of terms that describe motion: fast, slow, stop, turn, hold
 - b. Examples of terms that describe a direction: forward, back, right, left, up/down

6.6.9.1.2 NVIS Aircraft Lighting

1. **Internal lighting** – Only the internal aircraft lighting authorized by the STC may be used during HNVGO.
2. **External lighting** – Position lights will remain on for all night operations. The aircraft external lights will not be modified, for example, taped, painted, or an IR filter installed over the light. The anti-collision light and/or strobe lights may be turned off when the PIC determines that, because of operating conditions, it would be in the interest of safety to turn the lights off. A landing light, searchlight, and/or night sun will be used for all takeoffs and landings unless environmental conditions, such as blowing snow, preclude use of the lights.
3. **Blackout operations**, in which all external lights are off, are not authorized.

6.6.9.1.3 Pre-mission Planning



1. In addition to normal pre-mission planning, terminal and area forecasts shall be obtained and analyzed with particular emphasis on temperature and dewpoint spread, cloud cover and visibility, sunset, sunrise, moon-phase, moonrise, moonset, and illumination data for all phases of flight.
2. During enroute phases of HNVGO, no pilot will operate below 500 feet AGL.
3. Before initiating an approach, an aided or unaided high reconnaissance shall be conducted at or above 300 feet AGL.
4. For HNVGO, only takeoffs and landings are authorized below 300 feet AGL.

NOTE:

Weather minimums listed in Operations Specifications Paragraph A050 and 135.609 apply to all HNVGO operations.

6.6.9.1.4 Abort or Go-Around Criteria

The decision to go-around shall be made before descending below obstacles or decelerating below effective translational lift. A decision to go-around shall also be made if visual contact with the touchdown point is lost.

6.6.9.1.5 HAA Conditional Flight Release

All HAA night operations that cannot be conducted with night vision goggles (NVGs), or under an IFR flight plan, require a Conditional Flight Release. To obtain a Conditional Flight Release, Night High Lighting Conditions, defined as follows, must exist.

1. Cloud cover is less than broken (less than 5/8 cover)
2. The time is between local moonrise and moonset. (Moonrise, moonset, and lunar disk illumination data shall be consistent with the data available from the United States Naval Observatory.)
3. At least 50 percent of the lunar disk is illuminated, **or**
4. The entire operation is conducted over a lighted surface area.

A lighted surface area is an area in which prominent objects are lighted, and surface lighting is adequate to identify terrain features and establish a usable horizontal reference. The lighting required to support this level of surface definition may be manmade, natural, direct or indirect, or any combination thereof, provided these stated requirements and the requirements of 14 CFR 135.207 are met.

Changes to a FRAT will identify which aircraft and pilots are unable to conduct night operations aided by



NVGs. Pilots who request a Conditional Flight Release must obtain authorization from an Operational Control Designee will verify Night High Lighting Conditions exist and are reasonably expected to continue to exist for the requested Conditional Flight Release. For this purpose, a flight is considered to be all legs of one flight request or manifest number.

6.6.9.1.6 NVG Currency Pilots/Medical Crewmembers

OM-A Section 6.6

No pilot may act as PIC in NVG operations, and no medical personnel shall act as a required crewmember during NVG operations unless the following conditions are met:

Pilots:

1. The pilot has completed Initial, Recurrent, Requalification, and/or Transition training in accordance with the approved HSUSA NVG training program.
2. To carry passengers, the pilot has completed 6 HNVGOs in the 2 calendar months preceding the month of flight.
3. Without passengers on board, the pilot has completed 6 HNVGOs in the 4 calendar months preceding the month of flight.
4. Pilots who have exceeded the 4-calendar month lookback period must receive requalification training in accordance with the HSUSA Pilot Training Program, prior to acting as pilot in command while utilizing night vision goggles.

Medical Crewmembers:

1. The medical crewmember has completed Initial or Recurrent training in accordance with the approved HSUSA NVG training program.
2. The medical crewmember has completed three HNVGOs in the previous 180 days.
3. Medical crewmembers who have exceeded the 180-day currency requirement must regain currency prior to acting as a required crewmember.

All Medical Crewmember HNVGOs must be recorded on the Medical Crew HNVGO Currency Form or tracked in applicable company software.

When operating close to the ground, the medical crewmembers must warn the pilot anytime they detect an unexpected deviation from the intended airspeed or altitude. These deviations include aircraft drift, unusual altitude, excessive change in rate of closure, or any unsafe condition.

6.6.9.1.7 NVG Maintenance Requirements



HSUSA will maintain all NVG's IAW manufacturers' specifications.

6.6.9.2 VFR/IFR Operations – Flight Planning

[135.207, 135.609, 135.611, 135.613, 135.615, and A050]

HSUSA pilots are authorized to use the lower night minimums found in 14 CFR 135.609, provided the following:

1. The operation is permitted by Operations Specifications Paragraph A021.
2. The helicopter is operated using night vision goggles (HNVGO) or a Helicopter Terrain Awareness Warning System (HTAWS) that meets the Technical Standards Order (TSO) C194 or (TSO) C151b.
3. If operating HNVGO, Operations Specifications Paragraph A050 applies.
4. If operating with HTAWS, the use of the inhibit function is not authorized.
5. If operating below the NVIS/HTAWS minimums in 14 CFR 135.609 and both the NVIS and HTAWS systems fail or are rendered inoperative, the pilot will follow the procedures in **Section 6.6.9.6 Deteriorating Weather Conditions Enroute**.

6.6.9.3 VFR Operations

HSUSA pilots, before VFR flight, are to:

1. Determine the minimum safe altitude (MSA) along the planned route of flight. The purpose of knowing the MSA is to provide the pilot with awareness of the highest obstacle along the route and the required minimum altitude to observe in the event of IIMC.
2. Identify and document the MSL altitude of the highest terrain/obstacle for each leg of flight in the CF Manifest.
3. Determine the minimum safe cruise altitude for each leg by utilizing current weather observations and forecasts ceiling and visibility information to maintain cloud clearance required by the airspace while clearing obstacles vertically by 300 feet in the daytime and 500 feet at night.
4. Reevaluate and document, in accordance with the above points, any plan to reroute, including a significant deviation around terrain or an obstacle that occurs at any time while on the ground. MSA, terrain, and obstacle clearance determination must be made using current charts, forms, publications, or known obstacle heights. HSUSA pilots shall comply with the weather minimums and weather reporting requirements found in 14 CFR 135.609 for all operations in uncontrolled airspace including Part 91 flights.

During VFR operations, including VFR in-flight deviations, the pilot shall ensure that ceiling and visibility allow them to maintain the required vertical obstacle clearance and cloud clearance, as well as to see and avoid any obstructions, terrain, or other traffic along the route. In addition, pilots will maintain visual surface reference during the day and visual surface light reference at night.



For any in-flight deviation, the pilot shall, when safe operations permit, determine the new terrain/obstruction clearance altitudes from current aeronautical charts or current avionics databases approved for navigation.

6.6.9.3.1 Helicopter Air Ambulance VFR Ceiling and Visibility in Class G Airspace

Location	Day		Night		Night using an Approved NVIS or HTAWS	
	Ceiling	Flight Visibility	Ceiling	Flight Visibility	Ceiling	Flight Visibility
Nonmountainous local flying areas	800-feet	2 statute miles	1,000-feet	3 statute miles	800-feet	3 statute miles
Nonmountainous non-local flying areas	800-feet	3 statute miles	1,000-feet	5 statute miles	1,000-feet	3 statute miles
Mountainous local flying areas	800-feet	3 statute miles	1,500-feet	3 statute miles	1,000-feet	3 statute miles
Mountainous non-local flying areas	1,000-feet	3 statute miles	1,500-feet	5 statute miles	1,000-feet	5 statute miles

6.6.9.4 Minimum Altitude for VFR

[135.203, 135.615]

For Helicopters:

1. Except when necessary for takeoff and landing pilots will operate at an altitude allowing, if a power unit fails, an emergency landing without undue hazard to persons or property on the surface.
2. Pilots will, when able, cruise at a minimum of 1,000 feet AGL, day or night.
3. When airborne, pilots will vertically clear obstructions or terrain features by at least 300 feet during day operations and 500 feet during night operations or, maintaining a safe distance, elect to fly around the obstructions or terrain.
4. Pilots will not operate over congested areas at an altitude less than 300 feet above the surface.

6.6.9.5 VFR Obstacle Clearance Requirements

[14 CFR § 135.615]



1. HeliService USA PICs are required to determine the minimum safe altitude using the following procedure prior to each flight:
 - a. Determine the route of flight from departure to arrival points using the appropriate VFR Sectional(s). Straight line routes are not required.
 - b. Identify the highest obstacle within three (3) NM of the intended route of flight (man-made or terrain feature) for each leg of the flight to include any turns in the route segment.
 - c. For HAA flights only, document the MSL altitude of the highest obstacle on the Obstacle Elevation block on Complete Flight Manifest Leg.
2. PIC will determine the minimum VFR weather required to complete the flight along each segment of the route to clear the highest obstacle by 300' for day and 500' night operations, except for take-off and landing.
3. PICs will adhere to the weather minimums applicable for the type of airspace they are operating.
4. Deviations from the planned route for weather or operational reasons while enroute, are authorized. However, Pilots are not relieved of the requirement to maintain cloud clearance and visibility requirements for the type of airspace and the terrain clearance requirements listed above.
5. Any change in routing or accepting a subsequent flight will require the Pilot to evaluate the route prior to launch using the procedures listed above.

6.6.9.6 Deteriorating Weather Conditions Enroute

If deteriorating weather conditions are encountered while conducting VFR operations, one of the following procedures will be followed:

1. If weather and regulations permit, continue flight under IFR.
2. Return to departure point, if practical.
3. Divert to an alternate suitable landing location.
4. Land (if overland / practical) and notify HSUSA dispatch.
5. Execute the IIMC procedure in **Section 6.6.9.8** Inadvertent Instrument Meteorological Conditions (IIMC) Recovery if the preceding options are not available

HeliService USA pilots will use the "Enroute Decision Point" concept to determine whether or not deteriorating weather conditions exist. The definition is as follows:

1. Slowing the helicopter 30 kts from cruise speed to adjust to declining ceiling and visibility conditions.
2. Descending to the Minimum Altitude for VFR listed in paragraph 6.4.3 specific purpose of avoiding declining weather.
3. Lack of ground reference as required by paragraph 6.4.2 Helicopter surface reference requirements.



6.6.9.7 Special Visual Flight Rules (SVFR)

Pilots operating in controlled airspace designated to the surface may request an SVFR clearance for operations conducted beneath a ceiling reported as being less than 1,000 feet. HSUSA pilots will use the following minimum cloud and visibility requirements for SVFR operations.

1. Day – 600-foot ceiling and 2 SM visibility
2. Night – 600-foot ceiling and 3 SM visibility

6.6.9.8 Inadvertent Instrument Meteorological Conditions (IIMC)

The base lead at each HAA base of operations, with the assistance of the pilots, will develop a local IIMC recovery procedure. This procedure will be posted at the respective base and available to the pilot in the aircraft on the EFB.

The pilot shall become knowledgeable about the procedure. The procedure will include at least the following information.

1. The priority and most important aspect of an IIMC procedure is to maintain aircraft control. Positive control of the aircraft with reference to instruments must take priority over all other duties.
 - a. Transition to Instrument Scan.
 - b. Wings level / Nose attitude for cruise flight - Turn Only to Avoid Known Obstacles.
 - c. Engage autopilot (if equipped) - Initiate GA mode.
 - d. Apply climb power - Top of Maximum Continuous Power.
 - e. Adjust attitude to climb airspeed - Set airspeed between Airspeed - Best Rate of Climb (Vy) (maximum climb rate) and Vy (Instrument Climb Speed).
 - f. Climb to or maintain safe altitude - Minimum Safe Altitude (MSA), Minimum Obstacle
 - g. Clearance Altitude (MOCA), or Minimum Enroute Altitude (MEA) as required.
 - h. Use standard rate turns.
 - i. Communicate with ATC (on last assigned frequency or on guard frequency).
 - j. Request an Instrument Flight Rules (IFR) clearance (as applicable).
 - k. Continue flight as appropriate.

In order of preference below, the pilot shall inform ATC as to how they wish to proceed:

1. Radar vectors to VMC conditions
2. Vectors to the closest approach

Complete the approach procedure to landing or entering VMC conditions. Maintain VMC, and land.

For the local area, determine the most likely airports and approaches for an IMC procedure, and complete the IIMC Procedure Template. Ensure these approaches are available on the aircraft and reviewed with each pilot on an annual basis.



Coordinating with the air traffic control (ATC) facility that is responsible for the area of operation of the base can be productive. If possible, meet with the manager of the ATC facility and have them review the procedure so that they are familiar with it.

6.6.9.8.1 IIMC Quarterly Recovery Drills

All HSUSA helicopter pilots are required to complete practice of an IIMC recovery with an emphasis on AMRM.

The drill will be a team-oriented exercise that will include a preflight briefing as well as a training flight / Dead Head Leg (No passengers) with a full instrument approach recovery. If the drill is done during a Dead Head Leg and in VMC conditions the crew members will act as a "safety pilot" keeping eyes outside looking for potential hazards. This function shall be briefed prior to the drill.

The use of a view limiting device is not authorized for the purposes of this section.

When possible, the drill will take place on the return to base leg after the completion of a patient transport or reposition flight. Some base locations may not present this opportunity due to airport locations and instrument approach availability. For these bases, it will be necessary to initiate a flight for the sole purpose of flying to the nearest location where a practice instrument approach procedure can be performed. In all circumstances, this will be accomplished while remaining in-service and available for any patient transport request. Pilots will contact the regional aviation manager or director prior to departing on a training flight.

It is important that there be an equal amount of emphasis placed on avoiding IIMC as well as the recovery. Each recovery scenario and practice approach shall be coupled with a discussion around the recognition and avoidance of the conditions that may lead to such an encounter.

The following subjects shall be discussed during the preflight briefing:

1. Decision making during preflight and inflight weather evaluations.
2. Limitations of equipment (ex.: radar altimeter, NVGs, external lighting).
3. Utilization of all available equipment and cockpit organization prior to flight.
4. Recognition and avoidance of conditions which may lead to loss of visual reference, visual illusions, or spatial disorientation.
5. Identifying, briefing and utilizing an enroute decision point (EDP) during flight in marginal conditions.
6. Key actions immediately following IIMC encounter: Attitude, Heading, Power, Airspeed and how the medical crew can assist with these steps initially.
7. Expectations for crew assistance - checklists, radio, callouts, etc.
8. How to open iPad to ForeFlight - enter airport and open approach plate.



9. How much communication the crew can expect from the pilot during the event.

Tracking of this requirement will be maintained on company currency tracking software with the acknowledgment by the pilot on the date the training exercise was accomplished.

For IFR current pilots, the semi-annual 135.297 evaluation will count towards the quarterly requirement for the quarter in which it is performed.

6.6.9.9 HAA IFR Operations at Locations without Weather Reporting [135.611]

1. This paragraph applies only for helicopter air ambulance operations. This allows HSUSA HAA pilots to conduct IFR helicopter air ambulance operations at airports with an instrument approach procedure and at which a weather report is not available from the U.S. National Weather Service (NWS), a source approved by the NWS, or a source approved by the FAA, subject to the following limitations:
 - a. Pilots must obtain a weather report from a weather reporting facility operated by the NWS, a source approved by the NWS, or a source approved by the FAA, that is located within 15 nautical miles of the airport. If a weather report is not available, the certificate holder may obtain weather reports, forecasts, or any combination of them from the NWS, a source approved by the NWS, or a source approved by the FAA, for information regarding the weather observed in the vicinity of the airport;
 - b. Flight planning for IFR flights conducted under this paragraph must include selection of an alternate airport that meets the requirements of §§ 135.221 and 135.223;
 - c. In Class G airspace, IFR departures with visual transitions are authorized only after the pilot in command determines that the weather conditions at the departure point are at or above takeoff minimums depicted in a published departure procedure or VFR minimum ceilings and visibilities in accordance with § 135.609.
 - d. All approaches must be conducted at Category A approach speeds as established in part 97 or those required for the type of approach being used.
2. Each helicopter air ambulance operated under this section must be equipped with functioning severe weather detection equipment, unless the pilot in command reasonably determines severe weather will not be encountered at the destination, the alternate destination, or along the route of flight.
3. Pilots conducting operations pursuant to this section may use the weather information obtained in paragraph (a) to satisfy the weather report and forecast requirements of § 135.213 and § 135.225(a).
4. After completing a landing at the airport at which a weather report is not available, the pilot in command is authorized to determine if the weather meets the takeoff requirements of part 97 of this chapter or the certificate holder's operations specification, as applicable.

6.6.9.9.1 IFR Operations



IFR operations to and from destinations without an approved weather source are approved in accordance with the provisions stipulated in 14 CFR 135.611.

VFR transitions are approved in accordance with the provisions stipulated 14 CFR 135.613.

VFR relocation flights performed for refueling, returning to base, filing IFR, or other operational purposes may be conducted in accordance with Section 6.6.9.7 Special Visual Flight Rules (SVFR) for controlled airspace and 14 CFR 135.609 for uncontrolled airspace.

6.6.9.9.2 Point in Space (PinS) Approaches

HeliService USA incorporates the use of FAA-approved Point in Space (PinS) instrument approach procedures to enhance operational flexibility and access to designated heliports and landing zones. All pilots authorized for PinS operations must receive initial and recurrent training specific to PinS approach procedures, including approach briefings, chart interpretation, missed approach execution, and operational considerations unique to helicopter IFR operations. These procedures may include approaches requiring Required Navigation Performance (RNP) 0.3 for Localizer Performance with Vertical guidance (LPV) minimums. In these cases pilots must ensure aircraft and crew qualifications meet these requirements.

As part of annual recurrent training, pilots will be evaluated on their proficiency in conducting a PinS approach, with emphasis on situational awareness, adherence to published procedures, and decision-making during all phases of the approach.

6.6.9.9.2.1 PinS Control and Distribution

1. The **Chief Pilot** is designated as the Point of Contact (POC) for all matters related to H122 Special Procedures. The Chief Pilot is responsible for:

- Receiving, reviewing, and validating new or revised H122 procedures.
- Ensuring procedures are current and meet operational suitability.
- Coordinating with the FAA Flight Standards District Office (FSDO) for approvals or changes.

2. Distribution and Access

All current and active H122 procedures will be:

- Controlled through SharePoint with read-only access for authorized pilots.
- Reviewed and updated regularly by the Chief Pilot.
- Distributed to affected flight crews through official channels (e.g., pilot bulletins or updates in the Flight Folder briefing materials).



No unauthorized reproduction, distribution, or modification of H122 procedures is permitted.

3. Storage Location

- The **master copy** of all H122 procedures will be stored electronically in SharePoint in the Chief Pilot's Folder under the folder: PinS Approach and Departures
- Archived or superseded procedures will be removed and logged as obsolete to avoid inadvertent use.

6.6.9.9.3 HAA Approach/Departure Transitions 14 CFR §135.613

1. When conducting an authorized instrument approach and transitioning from IFR to VFR flight, upon transitioning to VFR flight the following weather minimums apply—
 - a. For Point-in-Space (PinS) Copter Instrument approaches annotated with a "Proceed VFR" segment, if the distance from the missed approach point to the landing area is 1 NM or less, flight visibility must be at least 1 statute mile and the ceiling on the approach chart applies.
 - b. For all instrument approaches, including PinS when paragraph (a)(1) of this section does not apply, if the distance from the missed approach point to the landing area is 3 NM or less, the applicable VFR weather minimums are—
 - i. For Day Operations: No less than a 600-foot ceiling and 2 statute miles flight visibility.
 - ii. For Night Operations: No less than a 600-foot ceiling and 3 statute miles flight visibility; or
 - c. For all instrument approaches, including PinS, if the distance from the missed approach point to the landing area is greater than 3 NM, the VFR weather minimums required by the class of airspace.
2. For transitions from VFR to IFR upon departure—
 - a. The VFR weather minimums of paragraph (a) of this section apply if—
 - i. An FAA-approved obstacle departure procedure is followed; and
 - ii. An IFR clearance is obtained on or before reaching a predetermined location that is not more than 3 NM from the departure location.
 - b. If the departure does not meet the requirements of paragraph (b)(1) of this section, the VFR weather minimums required by the class of airspace apply.
 - c. If the departure involves a VFR to IFR transition and does not meet the requirements of (b) (1), there is no departure procedure, and/or the IDF is more than 3 NM from the point of liftoff, the VFR weather minimums required by the class of airspace apply. If the flight is within Class G, airspace, refer to OM-A paragraph 6.4.1.3, if within Class B, C, D, or E airspace, refer to OM-A paragraph 6.4.1. **During these departures, pilots will remain VFR until they either receive their IFR clearance or be under Radar Control by ATC.**

6.6.9.10 Heliport and Landing-Zone Diagrams



Each HAA base will develop, and keep current, books, folders or electronic documents containing information on each heliport or predesignated landing zone (LZ) from which pilots might reasonably be expected to operate. One copy (electronic or printed) will be maintained as a flight planning reference at the base, and one copy will be kept on the company EFB.

As a minimum, the base copy of these documents will contain a graphic or textual depiction of the heliport/LZ, the municipality and hospital name or predesignated LZ identifier, the heliport/LZ size, lighting, awareness of helicopter ingress/egress, and obstructions. Other recommended information may include distance and direction from the base location, suggested fuel load for one way or round trip, and closest fuel location.

As a minimum, the aircraft copy of these books or folders will contain the same information as listed above; however, the graphic depiction may be replaced by a textual description of the heliport/LZ. Use of these books or folders does not relieve the pilot of the requirement to conduct a reconnaissance to verify the landing area condition and obstructions.

If it is noted by the crew that there are unsatisfactory or dangerous conditions found the crew shall submit a SMS report. Reports can be submitted through the company's Safety Management System (SMS) portal, directly to the Safety Manager. All reports are reviewed by the Safety Department. Upon receipt of a dangerous or unsatisfactory condition the Program Manager or designee shall update the diagram accordingly.

6.6.9.11 Landing-Zone Safety

6.6.9.11.1 Limitations

1. **Improved Landing Area** — an area designed or intended to be used for the landing and takeoff of helicopters and must have the following basic elements: a clear area suitable to safely position the aircraft for flight, a clearly defined boundary, lighting sufficient to illuminate the area and obstructions, and a wind indicator.
2. **Unimproved Landing Area** — an area that does not meet the improved landing area requirements.

6.6.9.11.2 Unimproved Landing Areas

The minimum distance for unimproved landing areas is 100ft x 100ft. Consideration when landing to unimproved areas include evaluation of obstructions (trees or wires), lighting (if required) and evaluation of wind conditions.

Whenever possible, landings should be made to the long axis of a landing zone into the wind .



6.6.9.11.3 Unimproved - Day

1. Appropriate high and low reconnaissance will be performed prior to landing to ensure the area is suitable for the desired operation, including no less than one full turn around the LZ.
2. High reconnaissance will be performed at an altitude no lower than 300 ft for day operations.
3. The LZ must provide sufficient rotor and landing gear clearance.

6.6.9.11.4 Unimproved - Night

Prior to conducting night operations to an unimproved LZ, the pilot shall perform a high and low reconnaissance. High reconnaissance will be performed at an altitude the PIC deems necessary, but no lower than 500ft AGL. After completion of the initial reconnaissance subsequent reconnaissance orbits may be conducted if required.

Additionally, the following are required:

1. The limits of the area must be clearly marked by lights or reflective material in such a way that the pilot can see the landing area from any direction.
 - a. Electrical or battery powered lights.
 - b. Items wrapped with reflective tape.
 - c. Heliport surface painted or taped with reflective material.
 - d. Handheld flashlight wands.
 - e. Vehicle headlights may be used if they are positioned in such a manner as to illuminate the area while not blinding the pilot on final approach.
 - f. Lights/reflectors that are of a portable nature should be placed in a rectangle or triangle pattern with at least the corner points marked.

6.6.9.12 Scene Flight Operations

Pilots will not accept flights unless they are reasonably certain of completing the flight safely under VFR conditions (except bases approved for IFR operations) based on all weather information available to the pilot at the time of departure. If deteriorating weather is encountered enroute, comply with the procedures for **Section 6.6.9.6 Deteriorating Weather Conditions Enroute**.

Before landing, if terrain, airspace, or environmental conditions allow, a 360° high reconnaissance will be flown. If terrain, airspace, or environmental conditions restrict the 360° high reconnaissance the pilot will use the appropriate means to ensure a safe landing area. An overhead approach out of high reconnaissance can be performed.

The pilot will consider safety recommendations from the medical and ground personnel. Any other safety precautions deemed necessary shall be followed.



When environmental conditions permit, controllability and performance will be assured by performing a hover check, a 10 percent power margin below maximum takeoff power shall exist. If this margin does not exist, aircraft load (fuel, equipment, passengers, etc.) shall be reduced to meet this requirement.

Prior to departure from the scene, the pilot shall visually check and confirm the location and height of all obstacles that could have an effect on the planned departure path. After departure and clearance of the obstacles, the pilot will accelerate to and maintain best rate of climb speed.

A turn-on course will not be made until the aircraft has climbed (at a minimum) to 300 feet AGL for day operations and 500 feet AGL for night operations unless rising terrain, obstacles, or local procedures dictate.

It is at the discretion of the pilot with input from the crew, whether to have the helicopter in a cold/warm/hot configuration during scene calls.

6.6.9.13 Landing Zone Catalog

The EFB manager will maintain a common list of utilized landing zones. If a landing zone is determined to be unsatisfactory or dangerous, the EFB Manager will be notified, and a temporary NOTAM will be published into Fleet Plan for the pilots reading file.

NOTE:

When operating in an unimproved landing area, consideration should be given to the potential presence of foreign objects and debris (FOD). Approaches should be made to the ground and prolonged hovering should be avoided whenever possible.

Landing zones will normally be at least twice the overall length and width of the helicopter to be used, and have a reasonable approach and departure path that will not require exceeding the performance capability of the helicopter used. Landing zones may have any shape.

As a minimum, obstructions shall be cleared by 30 feet during approach and departure. During ground operations, including surface movements such as taxiing, a minimum of 15 feet of clearance shall be maintained between the rotor system and any obstacle to the tip path plane. Pilots should exercise caution when shorter obstacles are clear of rotating components but may still present a dynamic rollover hazard to skids and wheels or a damage hazard to the fuselage.

The pilot must also be able to determine wind direction from a wind indicator, two-way voice communications, or other reliable means. Downwind approaches and takeoffs shall not be attempted with a tail-wind component exceeding the aircraft manufacturer's flight limitation. Rates of descent shall,



when able, be kept below 300 feet per minute when less than 300 feet above the rooftop or confined landing area. Steep approach angles with a rate of descent greater than 300 feet per minute shall be avoided.

6.6.9.14 Scene Security and Crowd Control

Landing zones shall be secure before commencing an approach. Confirmation of a secured landing zone should include two-way radio communication with ground personnel, when available. If two-way radio communication is not available, the pilot shall visually check for landing-zone security during the high reconnaissance, approach, and landing.

After landing, scene security shall be ensured by the PIC, trained medical personnel, or a properly briefed first responder such as law enforcement officer or fireman. If a tail rotor guard is to be utilized, this individual will be briefed by the PIC or properly trained medical personnel as well.

The contents of the briefing that the crewmember will give to the appropriate first responder is as follows:

1. Stay at least 50 feet from aircraft.
2. Do not allow anyone to approach the aircraft without permission from the pilot or a crewmember.
3. Anyone that approaches the aircraft must be accompanied by a crewmember.

The PIC retains responsibility for safety around the aircraft. If the security of the scene is ever in question, and/or no positive crowd control is actively in place, the aircraft will be shut down.

6.6.9.15 Loading and Unloading Patients or Passengers

The following terminology shall be used.

- **Hot offload/offloading** - The helicopter will be deplaned with engines running and or rotors turning.
- **Hot onload/loading** - The helicopter will be enplaned with engines running and or rotors turning. It is recommended that the pilot not assist in physically loading the patient.
- **Warm offload/offloading** - The helicopter will be deplaned with APU mode engaged.
- **Warm onload/onloading** - The helicopter will be enplaned with APU mode engaged. It is recommended that the pilot not assist in physically loading the patient.
- **Cold offload/offloading** - The helicopter will be deplaned with engines shut down and rotors completely stopped.
- **Cold onload/loading** - The helicopter will be enplaned with engines shut down and rotor completely stopped.



The loading or unloading of patients or passengers while the rotors are turning is allowed only if the pilot and/or properly trained medical personnel is outside the helicopter to guide and direct anyone who approaches the aircraft. Ground personnel will not come beneath the rotor disc until directed to do so by the PIC. The pilot and/or properly trained medical personnel must be constantly alert to prevent anyone from coming near the tail rotor.

Aircraft power will be reduced to ground idle or a reduced power setting as specified in the Flight Manual. The pilot will not exit the cockpit of a running aircraft if the flight controls or autopilot/autoflight systems do not allow for the positive security of the rotor disk, or if Rotorcraft Flight Manual or supplement limitations prohibit the operation.

Whenever practical, the loading and unloading of patients or passengers will be done with the aircraft shut down. Patient condition and a consensus of the pilot and medical personnel/crewmembers will determine whether the helicopter may be enplaned/deplaned with rotors turning. In all cases, the PIC will have the final authority as to whether enplaning/deplaning with rotors turning will be allowed.

Whenever the helicopter has landed to pick up patients or passengers, and, when practical, the pilot shall position the aircraft so that the tail rotor is away from the area from which people are expected to approach the helicopter. For aircraft equipped with a rotor system that has a forward tilt or a low clearance at the front, such aircraft shall be positioned so that all personnel movement will be to or from the 3 o'clock or 9 o'clock positions.

The helicopter may be enplaned or deplaned with rotors turning provided the following:

1. The rotor tip path plane is leveled.
2. The controls are secure or guarded so as to not allow unintended movement of the rotor disk.
3. IV poles and other equipment shall be kept at head height or lower.
4. The pilot will use appropriate hand signals when directing ground personnel to approach the aircraft.
5. Crew will assign personnel to help carry the stretcher to the aircraft.

First responders assisting in the loading of a patient will be reminded to exit the rotor disk the same way they approached.

6.6.9.16 Deplaning Aircraft After Landing or Enplaning Before Takeoff

Clinicians and passengers shall not depart the aircraft until the pilot verbally notifies them that they have



landed and are cleared to deplane. The clinicians or passengers shall inform the pilot before departing the aircraft.

Pilots shall not take off until they have received verbal confirmation from on-board medical crewmembers or other passengers that they are seated; safety belts/shoulder harnesses (as applicable) are fastened, and doors are closed and secure.

6.6.9.17 Scene and Hospital Cold/Warm/Hot procedure guidance

For operations when the crew may be waiting at a scene or hospital, the following will act as guidance.

Hospital

- Urgent care or deemed necessary by crew – Hot
- Wait times 0-20 minutes – Warm
- Wait times 20 + minutes – Cold

Scene

- Urgent or deemed necessary by crew – Hot
- Wait times 0-30 minutes – Warm
- Wait times 30 + minutes – Cold

Note:

Crew must take into consideration the availability of external power units to assist in starting before shutting aircraft down.

6.6.9.18 Scene and Hospital Communications

This procedure applies to operations to or from hospitals and scenes where no established communications procedure exists. Examples of established communications procedures are CTAF, Class B, C, and D airspace, or hospitals that have established procedures for operations at their facility.

If an area does not have a designated communications frequency or the frequency is unknown, the pilot will announce in the blind their intentions on 123.025. If the frequency is known, the pilot will make announcements on that frequency.

Pilots will announce their intentions for the following operations when no established communications procedure exists.



Approach

1. At 10 miles from landing
2. Upon landing

Departure

1. Upon takeoff
2. At five miles from departure

6.6.9.18.1 Mult-Ship Operations

During multi-helicopter operations at a scene call or hospital pad, clear communication and coordinated arrival/departure sequencing are critical for safety. Pilots should establish and maintain direct radio contact on the designated air-to-air frequency prior to entering the area if able and confirm with any aircraft already on scene. All aircraft should maintain visual separation, adhere to a standardized traffic pattern when feasible, avoid overflight of patients, crews, or active pads.

Departures must be staggered, with only one aircraft maneuvering at low altitude at a time. At hospital pads, adhere strictly to rooftop or ground pad SOPs, wait for clearance from security or ground personnel, and never assume clearance based on another aircraft's actions.

6.6.9.19 Destination Hazards [135.69]

HSUSA pilots will not continue to fly if becoming aware of a condition that involves an airport, destination, and/or runway that may present a hazard to safe operations. Operations shall be restricted or suspended as necessary until those conditions are corrected. Pilots may continue toward an airport or destination and/or use a runway when a hazard exists, provided the hazard will no longer exist at the estimated time of arrival.

6.6.10 HAA Policies, Procedures, and Instructions**6.6.10.1 Carriage of Narcotics and Other Prohibited Drugs and Substances**

HSUSA, by the very nature of its business, will transport narcotic and other controlled drugs and substances. Those drugs and related substances carried aboard HSUSA aircraft will be only those controlled by federal and/or local state statutes and agencies.

6.6.10.2 Oxygen for Medical Use

Oxygen dispensed for medical use will be provided by HSUSA or by an authorized EMS/hospital from an approved system.



Oxygen dispensing systems (liquid and gaseous) will be maintained in accordance with HSUSA FAA-approved maintenance program.

Gaseous oxygen bottles will not be filled above the container's rated pressure.

6.6.10.3 Guidance on Exposure Control and Aircraft Cleaning

6.6.10.3.1 Protection and Control of Infectious Conditions

Crewmembers and mechanical staff members shall take appropriate measures to guard themselves and our patients from the harm of exposure to infectious conditions such as blood-borne pathogens, MRSA, Staph, and Hepatitis-B. Though this is not an inclusive list of all diseases, these are some of the more common types encountered in the scope of helicopter air ambulance operations.

6.6.10.3.2 Appropriate Measures

Crewmembers and mechanical staff will ensure that aircraft and aircraft components are cleaned and decontaminated using an acceptable, noncorrosive, EPA-approved antibacterial/antimicrobial cleaning solution to eliminate bacteria and other microbial growth on the interior surfaces of the aircraft and its fixed equipment.

All applicable manufacturers' recommendations for the proper application of the acceptable, noncorrosive, EPA-approved cleaning solution, and accompanying cleaning items, such as cloths, paper towels, brushes, and other cleaning aids, will be disposed of according to CDC recommendations. Crewmembers and mechanical staff will don and doff appropriate personal protective equipment to prevent accidental exposure to biohazardous substances via transmission through skin, eyes, mouth, inhalation, or persistent residual contact on individual clothing items.

Manufacturer's recommendations will be followed to rinse and remove cleaning solution residue from aircraft floors and surfaces.

When favorable conditions exist, the aircraft interior should be allowed to bathe in sunlight and fresh air should be allowed to circulate. Unfavorable conditions refer to high winds, precipitation, darkness, or hangared aircraft. Sunlight and clean air have desirable disinfecting qualities proven to kill bacterial growth.

6.6.10.3.3 Personal Protective Equipment Required when Cleaning Aircraft

The following are required when a cleaning agent is used for aircraft cleaning.

1. Eye and face protection – Wear goggles or safety glasses with side shields.
2. Skin and hand protection – Chemical resistant gloves are recommended.
3. Other wear – Chemical-resistant footwear and protective clothing appropriate for the risk of exposure. Contact health or safety professionals or manufacturer for specific information.
4. Respiratory protection – If engineering controls do not maintain airborne concentrations below recommended exposure limits (where applicable) or to an acceptable level (in countries where exposure limits have not been established), an approved respirator must be worn. Contact health and safety professionals or manufacturer for specific information.
5. Thermal hazards – Not available.
6. General hygiene considerations – Always observe good personal hygiene measures, such as washing after handling the material and before eating, drinking, and/or smoking. Routinely wash work clothing and protective equipment to remove contaminants.

6.6.10.3.4 Cleaning Interval

Weekly thorough cleaning

Weekly thorough cleaning is defined as the removal by scrubbing and washing, as with hot water and soap, disinfectant, or suitable detergent, or by vacuum cleaning, of infectious agents and of organic matter from surfaces on which and in which infectious agents may find favorable conditions for surviving or multiplying. Aircraft that are removed from service for extended periods of time such as for extended maintenance is exempt from weekly thorough cleaning but shall be cleaned according to this guidance before being placed back in service.

Routine cleaning

Routine cleaning of the aircraft will occur between each patient's transport and may be accomplished upon the completion of the patient transport at the receiving facility or after arrival at home base.

6.6.10.3.5 Adherence to Exposure Control Plan

The exposure control plan is an exhaustive reference for avoidance, mitigation, and personal protection against biohazardous conditions. The practices prescribed in the exposure control plan shall be adhered to by all HSUSA personnel.

6.6.10.4 Equipment Requirements

[135.605, 135.607, 91.225]

No person may operate a helicopter in helicopter air ambulance operations unless it meets the equipment requirements of 135.605 and 135.607. HSUSA aircraft shall meet the ADS-B requirements specified in 91.225 and will adhere to the limitations contained therein.



6.6.10.5 Post-Accident Incident Plan (PAIP)

The Director of Safety shall develop a PAIP. The Director of Safety will coordinate with the respective Med Comm to ensure the PAIP provides timely notification to HSUSA Part 135 certificate management and other key HSUSA personnel. The PAIP will indicate who is to be notified and who is responsible for making the notification.

The following are the minimum required items to be included in the PAIP.

1. **Medical emergencies** – Requiring an unscheduled landing.
2. **Weather or mechanical difficulties** – Those resulting in an unscheduled landing, inflight abort, or change in destination.
3. **Overdue aircraft** – When an aircraft fails to reach its destination within 30 minutes of estimated time of arrival or overdue in-flight reports by 30 minutes.
4. **Actual emergency** – Either reported via radio or notification from ATC.
5. **Post-incident (damaged involved)** – Notification from any party that the aircraft has been involved in an incident resulting in damage to the aircraft, or a more serious accident resulting in damage or injury.
6. Procedures on notifying Operation Control Personnel and Med Comm of an accident, incident or occurrence which affects or could affect safety of flight. The 24-hour contact number for Flight following is (401) 373-2935.
7. Upon notification, Flight Following will contact the appropriate HSUSA Certificate personnel.
8. Immediate notification of Flight Following is mandatory following an accident, incident, or overdue aircraft.
9. The notification to the Operational Control Personnel and Med Comm shall include but not be limited to the following:
 - a. PIC of the aircraft
 - b. Tail number and program call sign
 - c. Souls on board and whether carrying a patient
 - d. Current location
 - e. Nature of the PAIP
 - f. Any injuries or damage
 - g. Procedures to alert program security and public relations personnel, if necessary.
 - h. Procedures to request assistance from law enforcement and other emergency programs.
 - i. Procedures to perform an annual review of the PAIP to ensure changes in personnel and contact information are updated.
 - j. At a minimum the plan shall be tested and evaluated annually.

The Director of Safety will ensure that the PAIP plan is tested and evaluated on at least an annual basis. The Director of Safety or a designee will be responsible for maintaining the documentation.

6.6.11 Medical Crewmember Guidance



6.6.11.1 General Information

This section provides guidance for those medical personnel who have successfully completed the FAA-approved HSUSA Crewmember Training Program.

Crewmember training must be completed annually, as outlined in the training program. Crewmember training is required for all clinicians involved in helicopter NVG operations.

NOTE:

Medical personnel are those who have not completed the HSUSA Crewmember Training program. They shall receive a full passenger brief in accordance with 14 CFR Part 135.117(a), 135.117(b), and 135.621 for each assigned flight sequence before takeoff of the first segment.

6.6.11.2 Duties and Responsibilities

Guidance for the following duties and responsibilities is included in the HSUSA Crewmember Training Program presentation.

1. Supervise patient during fueling procedures (hot-engine operating and cold-engine shutdown).
2. Perform passenger/patient briefing.
3. Call for appropriate checklists when necessary.
4. Assist the PIC during cabin emergencies (fire, medical equipment malfunction, etc.).
5. Assist the PIC during emergency egress.
6. Participates in the Flight Risk Assessment Tool (FRAT) process.
7. Secure medical equipment/baggage in the cabin compartment.
8. Assist with crowd control at landing areas, including acting as the tail rotor guard or briefing a ground emergency worker as to the tail rotor guard.
9. Prior to each departure, ensure all doors, cowls, caps, belts, and fasteners are secured by completing a walk-around of the aircraft.
10. Ensure that the EPU (External Power Unit) and/or APU (Auxiliary Power Unit) disconnect after start.
11. Ensure cabin exits in cabin compartment are secure.
12. Assist the PIC with obstacle clearance during approach and landing.
13. Perform medical associated communications on appropriate medical communications equipment.
14. Assist PIC with charts, approach plates, FMS loading, checklists, coordinates, and other reference material as appropriate.
15. Be able to perform an emergency aircraft engine shutdown in the event the PIC is incapacitated.
16. Perform normal and emergency operation of medical equipment.
17. Be responsible for the cleanliness of the cabin, as described in Section 6.6.10.3 Guidance on Exposure Control and Aircraft Cleaning.



6.6.11.3 Aircraft Emergency Engine Shutdown

If a PIC becomes incapacitated in the event of an accident or incident, the medical crewmembers will be responsible for the emergency engine shutdown of the aircraft. This shall include the correct positioning of engine controls, fuel system controls, and electrical equipment controls as appropriate to the aircraft being operated.

Detailed guidance for specific make and model will be given during the crewmember training presentation.

6.6.11.4 Aircraft Pre-flight/Pre-departure Walk-Around

To assist the pilot in ensuring that all doors, cowls, caps, belts, and fasteners are secured prior to departure, medical crewmembers will perform a complete 360-degree walk-around of the aircraft before entering. Upon exiting the aircraft, when there is no intention to reenter, medical crewmembers will perform a walk-around of the aircraft to ensure no belts are hanging out of the aircraft and that all doors are properly closed. It is vital that caution is taken to avoid the tail rotor of the aircraft when the aircraft is operating. When the aircraft is operating, the crewmember shall perform a detailed look down the left and right sides of the helicopter before entering. It is imperative that care be taken to ensure doors are completely closed and that items such as seat belts or stretcher belts are not hanging out of the aircraft when the doors are secured.

6.6.11.5 Approach and Departure Procedures

Medical crewmembers shall assist the PIC with obstacle clearance during approach and departure to and from all landing zones.

During approach, medical crewmembers shall assist the PIC in determining the suitability of a landing zone (for example, size, shape, surface, slope, surroundings, etc.), and bring any immediate concerns to the attention of the PIC.

During departure, medical crewmembers shall assist the PIC in observing any obstructions that may have been overlooked during the approach phase.

During any critical stage of flight (such as taxi, approach, landing, or takeoff), the crew shall, when able to, divert their attention from patient care to assist the pilot with obstacle clearance.

6.6.11.6 Assisting Pilot during Emergencies

In the event of an in-flight emergency, the pilot will announce the emergency and may request assistance



from the crew. When requested, the crew shall cease patient care and await instructions and/or guidance from the PIC

6.6.11.7 Assisting Pilot with Reference Materials

Upon request, medical crewmembers shall, when able, assist the PIC with handling navigation charts, approach plates, checklists, coordinates, and other reference materials. Medical crewmembers may be requested to find specific information (such as airport communication frequencies or minimum descent altitude), confirm an emergency procedure,

or confirm coordinates for a landing zone, etc.

Detailed information regarding the use of such publications and reference materials is given during the Crewmember Training.

6.6.11.8 External Power Unit (EPU) Procedures

To assist the pilot with an external power unit (EPU) after engine start, the following procedure will be used.

To assist the pilot with an EPU after engine start:

1. Wait for a previously briefed signal from the pilot before removing power from the aircraft.
2. Turn off the EPU as applicable.
3. Remove the plug from the aircraft receptacle.
4. Close and secure the EPU door on the aircraft.
5. Remove the EPU and cords from the takeoff area and secure.

Detailed guidance for specific make and model is given during the Crewmember Training.

6.6.11.9 Communications with First Responders and Medical Facilities

Medical crewmembers shall be responsible for air-to-ground communications with first responders and medical facilities in regard to patient information. In regard to landing-zone information (obstructions, coordinates, etc.), the PIC may delegate these communications to medical crewmembers.

6.6.11.10 Normal and Emergency Operations of Medical Equipment

Medical crewmembers shall be responsible for the normal and emergency operation of all installed medical equipment (suction system, medical oxygen system, etc.). Detailed guidance for specific equipment is given during the Crewmember Training.

6.6.11.11 Securing Doors on the Aircraft



Medical crewmembers will assist the PIC in securing doors after entry into the aircraft, and ensure that they remain closed and secure during flight operations. Special care should be taken to ensure that seatbelt tails and buckles are inside the aircraft before securing cabin doors. Operations with doors open will not be performed unless under the direct supervision of the PIC. Detailed guidance for specific make and model is given during the crewmember training.

6.6.12 Communications Specialist Guidance

6.6.12.1 General Information

This section provides guidance for those who have successfully completed the HSUSA's communications specialist training program and which is part of first tier operational control. This training must be completed annually, as outlined in the communications specialist training program.

Those personnel who do not comply with the communications specialist training requirements will not be authorized to perform the duties and responsibilities listed below.

HeliService USA maintains primary flight following and operational oversight from company headquarters to ensure consistent communication and tracking across all missions. Additionally, HSUSA may deploy local Communication Specialists to assist in specific bases to coordinate and maintain effective communication between requesting facilities or agencies, flight crews, medical personnel, maintenance teams, and receiving facilities. These specialists play a vital role in supporting both emergency and non-emergency missions by ensuring timely information exchange and facilitating a safe, coordinated, and expeditious response.

Local Area Communication Specialist Facilities:

Quonset, RI

Dayton, OH

6.6.12.2 Duties and Responsibilities

Additional guidance for the following duties and responsibilities can be found in the HSUSA communications specialist training program presentation.

1. Answer all incoming requests for service and information in a professional and courteous manner.
2. Coordinates and monitors all rotor-wing transport in response to customer requests.
3. Tracks status of all aircraft to include out of service times, public relations missions, and maintenance-related missions.
4. Operates and monitors all radio equipment maintaining effective communications with all crewmembers as appropriate, including flight following and tracking according to policies, procedures, and regulations.



5. Initiates PAIP as outlined in this manual.
6. Coordinates and maintains effective communications between requesting facilities/agencies, crewmembers, medical personnel, and receiving facilities/agencies, as appropriate, to ensure an expeditious response for emergency and nonemergency assistance and/or transport.
7. Will inquire about whether or not an incoming request has been refused or rejected by another air ambulance operator and include this information in the flight request.
8. Arranges for all necessary and/or requested ground transportation associated with a flight.
9. Ensure effective communications with the customer relaying any information regarding transport delays or changes in itinerary as soon as possible.
10. Performs other duties as assigned.

6.6.12.3 Post-Accident/Incident Plan (PAIP)

The communications specialist shall initiate the PAIP as required by this manual. The PAIP shall be developed and maintained by the HSUSA Program Lead according to the guidance provided in this manual. Overdue aircraft, accidents, incidents, damage to aircraft, unscheduled landings, in-flight weather and maintenance aborts, unplanned deviations from the original flight plan, or fuel-associated issues related to reported fuel loads versus estimated flight times shall be reported to the Program Lead without delay. In addition, the following are examples of possible reasons to elevate concerns.

1. General safety concerns
2. Unplanned fuel stops
3. Weather concerns
4. Maintenance issues
5. Indicators of inadequate crew rest

6.6.12.4 Requests for Service

All requests for service (flight request) will be accepted and relayed on an emergent and prioritized basis. It will be the responsibility of the Communication Center to assign and notify the appropriate aircraft. An appropriate aircraft is defined as the closest available aircraft to the location requesting the service and an aircraft that is properly equipped and qualified for that mission (IFR versus VFR, etc.).

If it is known that another flight service or HSUSA PIC declined the flight for any reason, this information must be communicated to the PIC that is offered the flight request.

Upon initial contact all known information pertinent to the flight request shall be communicated to the PIC, including, but not limited to the following:

1. Type of flight (inter-facility transfer, scene response, specialty transport, etc.)
2. Additional equipment requirements (balloon pump, neonate nitric gas, etc.)
3. LZ information for on-scene responses



4. Frequencies for communicating with ground personnel for on-scene responses
5. Requesting facility or agency
6. Receiving facility or agency
7. Bearing and distance to the requesting facility or agency or other location
8. HazMat considerations as appropriate
9. Patient weight (if known)

It is the sole responsibility of the PIC to accept or decline a flight request that has been offered by a communications specialist. No attempts should be made by the communications specialist to question the pilot's judgment in denying a flight request.

6.6.12.5 Transport Delays

When any aircraft transport is delayed or a change in flight plan is made for any reason (weather, maintenance, patient condition, etc.), the PIC shall notify the communications specialist, and then the communications specialist shall notify all parties involved in the original flight request as soon as possible.

6.7 HNVGO

This section contains specific procedures related to Helicopter Night Vision Goggle Operations in non HAA operations. (For HAA operations see **Section 6.6.9.1**). (HNVGO). HNVGOs shall be conducted in accordance with the procedures contained herein, and other applicable regulations. All crewmembers who conduct NVG (Night vision goggle) operations shall be familiar with this section.

1. The following procedures are applicable to all Helicopter Night Vision Goggle Operations (HNVGO) conducted under Title 14 CFR Parts 91 and 135. HSUSA will only conduct HNVGO in helicopters with an approved Supplemental Type Certificate (STC) or Manufacturers Service Bulletin (SB), authorizing such operations. The Rotorcraft Flight Manual (RFM) Supplement must be current and retained in the RFM.
2. All HNVGO shall be conducted in accordance with applicable STC, SB, or RFM Supplements and in compliance with the HSUSA OpSpecs.
 - a. Night vision imaging system (NVIS) modified aircraft and authorized NVG's will be maintained in accordance with operation specification D093
3. No Pilot or HSUSA Personnel shall conduct HNVGO unless they have completed the Night Vision Goggle Initial Qualification Training, Re- Qualification, Recurrent or Transition training, as appropriate, including required initial and annual flight checks, in accordance with the Training Manual (OMD).

6.7.1 NVG Qualification HSUSA Pilots



1. Initial Training: HSUSA Pilots must complete the approved NVG qualification requirements in accordance with the HSUSA Pilot Training Manual (OMD).
2. Recurrent Training: HSUSA Pilots are required to complete annual recurrent training with a proficiency check to remain qualified for utilizing NVG's.
3. Initial, Recurrent Training, and NVG Proficiency Checks shall be conducted by:
 - a. A HSUSA Qualified Check Airman or Instructor who is authorized to conduct NVG training.
 - b. A Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) Inspector who is qualified and current to perform night vision goggle operations.
 - c. A person approved by the Administrator to perform night vision goggle operations.

6.7.2 NVG Currency

No HSUSA pilot may act as pilot in command in a night vision goggle operation with passengers on board unless, within the 2 preceding calendar months of the flight, that person has performed and logged the following tasks as the sole manipulator of the controls on a flight during a night vision goggle operations—

1. Three takeoffs and three landings, with each takeoff and landing including a climbout, cruise, descent, and approach phase of flight (only required if the pilot wants to use night vision goggles during the takeoff and landing phases of the flight).
2. Three hovering tasks (only required if the pilot wants to use night vision goggles when operating helicopters hovering phase of flight).
3. Three area departure and area arrival tasks.
4. Three tasks of transitioning from aided night flight
5. Three tasks of transitioning from aided night flight to unaided night flight and back to aided night flight.
6. Six Helicopter Night Vision Goggle Operations

No HSUSA pilot may act as pilot in command in a night vision goggle operation unless, within the 4 preceding calendar months of the flight, that person has performed and logged the tasks listed in 14 CFR 61.57(f)(1)(i) through (v) as the sole manipulator of the controls during a night vision goggle operation.

Night Vision Goggle Proficiency Check

A person must either meet the night vision goggle experience requirements of 14 CFR 61.57(f)(1) or (f)(2) or pass a night vision goggle proficiency check to act as pilot in command using night vision goggles. The proficiency check must be performed in the category of aircraft that is appropriate to the night vision goggle operation for which the person is seeking the night vision goggle privilege or in a full flight simulator or flight



training device that is representative of that category of aircraft. The check must consist of the tasks listed in 14 CFR 61.31(k), and the check must be performed by:

1. An Examiner who is qualified by HSUSA to perform night vision goggle operations in that same aircraft category and class;
2. A company check pilot who is authorized to perform night vision goggle proficiency checks under Part 135 provided that both the check pilot and the pilot being tested are employees of HSUSA;
3. An authorized HSUSA flight instructor who is qualified to perform night vision goggle operations in that same aircraft category and class;
4. A HSUSA pilot in command for night vision goggle operations in accordance with 61.57(f) or
5. A person approved by the FAA to perform night vision goggle proficiency checks.

HNVGOS will be tracked and annotated in the Electronic Flight and Duty Log, or as directed by HSUSA Director of Operations.

6.7.3 NVGO Qualification - Medical Personnel

1. Initial Training: HSUSA Medical Personnel (MP) must complete the approved NVG qualification requirements in accordance with the HSUSA Pilot Training Manual.
2. Recurrent Training: MP do not have a requirement to complete annual recurrent flight training or currency requirements.
3. Initial MP NVG training shall be conducted by:
 - a. A HSUSA Qualified Check Airman or Instructor who is authorized to conduct NVG training.
 - b. A FAA Inspector who is qualified and current to perform night vision goggle operations.
 - c. A person approved by the Administrator to perform night vision goggle training.

6.7.4 NVG Check Airman and Instructors

A Check Airman or Flight Instructor may not conduct HSUSA Pilot or MP training for Night Vision Goggle Operations unless that Flight Instructor or Check Airman:

1. Is current and qualified as a Part 135 PIC IAW with the HSUSA Training Program and this chapter.
2. Has completed HSUSA's Initial HNVGO Ground and Flight curriculum.
3. Has a minimum of 50 hours NVG flight time. Or has been approved by the Director of Operations.
4. Has logged at least 100 HNVGO's as the sole manipulator of the controls while operating helicopters. Or has been approved by the Director of Operations.
5. Completes the HSUSA Training Program requirements for Flight Instructors or Check Airman.

6.7.5 Equipment Requirements



1. PIC's will complete a NVG preflight in accordance with the manufacturers operating manual prior to each flight operation utilizing NVGs.
2. Only NVGs approved for use by the OEM, STC, or SB, are authorized for use.
3. Each set of NVG's will be inspected by a qualified facility every 180 days. HSUSA will contract with an FAA-approved vendor to conduct required inspections and complete approved repairs.
 - a. HSUSA will verify that the vender is inspecting the NVG IAW the manufacturers data.
4. Aircraft lighting will be inspected IAW STC or SB instructions for continued airworthiness (ICA).
 - a. NVIS configured aircraft will meet approved design light leakage and incompatible light requirements.
5. NVIS configured aircraft will meet the NVIS approved design night unaided readability requirements.
6. Use of an Electronic Flight Bag, that is not NVIS compatible is prohibited during flight.
7. Any discrepancies or irregularities with the night vision imaging system noted by the HSUSA Pilot, will be written up and recorded in the NVG maintenance log and removed from service, and notify the HSUSA Aviation Maintenance.
8. HSUSA's maintenance program will include night vision imaging system (NVIS) instructions for continued airworthiness to include NVIS configuration documents.

6.7.6 NVG Route Planning

When NVGO is to be conducted, route planning shall include:

1. The potential impact of terrain, background lighting, lunar illumination and obstacles such as wires and towers, and other significant features to the flight.
2. Aircraft performance will be in accordance with the RFM.
3. Escape routes if unanticipated weather is encountered.
4. Alternate routes if NVG failure occurs.
5. Other preflight planning information as required by the General Operations Manual (GOM).

6.7.7 HNVGO Ceiling and Visibility Requirements

The Visual Flight Rules (VFR) listed in A050 OpSpecs shall apply. At no time shall NVG's be utilized to continue flight into weather below those minimums listed in A050 OpSpecs. The aircraft shall not be operated under VFR unless the HSUSA Pilot has visual surface reference or, at night, visual surface light or aided reference sufficient to safely control the helicopter.

6.7.8 Inadvertent IMC (IIMC) Procedures

One limitation of NVGs is the capability to see "through" atmospheric obscurants. Historically, this has increased the likelihood of pilots flying into IIMC conditions. HSUSA mitigates this risk factor by using night weather minimums based on unaided flight.



Additionally, HSUSA Pilots will be trained on IIMC encounters while using NVGs and will comply with the IIMC procedures listed in the HSUSA Training Program. MP will be trained on the limitations of NVGs and their role in assisting the Pilot in avoiding IIMC encounters.

6.7.9 Minimum Flight Crew for HNVGO Operations

This paragraph will list minimum flight crew for HNVGO Scene Landings (Unimproved Landing and Takeoff Areas)

1. The minimum Flight Crew for HSUSA HNVGO is one HSUSA Pilot. However, HSUSA has identified these takeoffs and landings as a potential hazard. To mitigate these hazards HSUSA requires the following for landings and takeoffs to or from unimproved takeoff and landing areas (Scene):
 - a. Landing: An additional HSUSA Pilot or MP or both will be equipped with and use NVG during the landing to assist with obstacle identification and clearing.
 - b. Takeoff: An additional HSUSA Pilot or MP or both will be equipped with and use NVG during the takeoff to assist with obstacle identification and clearing if operational conditions permit (. i.e. patient status, etc.).

Note 1: Helipads and landing areas associated with hospitals are considered Improved Landing and Takeoff Areas.

Note 2: Offshore helipads that are lit IAW with IOPG 690 or CAP 437 are not considered unimproved Landing and Takeoff Areas.

Note 3: The restrictions in this paragraph are not to be construed as to limit HSUSA unaided night operations in any way.

6.7.10 Light Discipline

1. Aircraft supplemental lighting will be NVG compatible. The use may not produce a glare on the windscreen, nor may it produce a "halo" which will obscure the HSUSA Pilot or MP vision inside or outside the cockpit.
2. The use of external lights shall not obscure the Pilot and MP's vision. A Pilot controlled slewable landing light or search light is required for all NVG operations.
3. In the interest of safety and in accordance with FAR 91.209(b), anti-collision, and strobe lights may be extinguished prior to descending below obstacles where light reflection will occur.

6.7.11 NVG Authorized Areas of Operations

HSUSA is authorized to conduct NVG operations within the contiguous United States.



6.7.12 NVG Air Medical Resource Management (AMRM)/Crew Resource Management (CRM)

MP are responsible to act as directed by the PIC in support of NVG operations. MP shall participate in the decision-making process, by offering timely suggestions and opinions. When not engaged in HNVGO duties, MP revert to other assigned duties.

The PIC will announce to the MP and SIC if applicable, the status of NVG use in all phases of a flight. The terminology "My goggles are up" or "My goggles are down" will be clearly articulated to the MP and SIC.

6.7.13 Definitions

1. **Aided flight:** A flight where the HSUSA Pilot uses night vision goggles to maintain visual surface reference.
2. **Night Vision Goggles:** an appliance worn by a HSUSA Pilot that enhances the HSUSA Pilot's ability to maintain visual surface reference at night.
3. **Night Vision Goggle Operation (NVGO):** a flight at night where the HSUSA Pilot maintains visual surface reference utilizing night vision goggles in an aircraft that is approved for night vision goggle operations.
4. **Unaided night flight:** a flight at night where the HSUSA Pilot either does not use night vision goggles or the night vision goggles are in a non-operational position.
5. **NVG Flight:** take-off and landing with each landing involving a flight in the traffic pattern.
6. **Helicopter Night Vision Goggle Operation: (HNVGO)** For the purpose of HSUSA, to log one Helicopter Night Vision Goggle Operation on the flight and duty log, a flight must take place from one hour after sunset to one hour before sunrise while utilizing NVG's and will consist of the following tasks:
 - a. One Take-off and Landing.
 - b. One Climb Out.
 - c. One Cruise.
 - d. One Descent and Approach.
 - e. One Hover.
 - f. One Area Departure and Arrival.
 - g. One Transition from aided flight to unaided flight and back to aided flight.
7. **Unimproved Landing and Takeoff Areas:** Any area used for the landing or takeoff by HSUSA aircraft that is not a designated airport, helipad, or heliport. All hospital helipads are considered Improved Landing and Takeoff Areas.

6.8 Policy and Procedures for In-flight Fuel Management

The PIC shall ensure that a fuel check is made prior to takeoff on a given leg and regularly during the flight, at least every 20 minutes or as relevant. Fuel planning shall be evaluated by:



1. Comparing actual fuel flow versus planned fuel flow.
2. Checking endurance remaining.
3. Confirming that the fuel remaining will be sufficient to arrive at the destination or to complete the operation as planned.

For legs longer than 40 NM, intermediate points (Fuel Check Points) shall be inserted into the FMS / flightplan at least every 40 NM along the track to allow comparison of the above mentioned parameters.

If the fuel check indicates that the expected fuel remaining on arrival at the destination or when the operation will be completed is less than the fuel required plus the alternate / reserve fuel, the PIC shall:

1. In VMC, cancel IFR and continue VFR.
2. Proceed the flight to an alternate destination, which can be safely reached with the remaining fuel.
3. Consider a precautionary landing if fuel becomes critical and the landing can be performed safely.
4. Inform HeliService USA dispatch about the diversion.

If the replanning shows no safe alternatives, the PIC may use alternate fuel to reach the destination if weather conditions at the destination comply with HSUSA operating minima. If the remaining amount of fuel is less than the final reserve fuel the PIC shall declare an emergency.

6.9 Arrival & LZ Procedures

[14 CFR §135.69(a)]

If a certificate holder or pilot in command knows of conditions, including airport and runway conditions, that are a hazard to safe operations, the certificate holder or pilot in command, as the case may be, shall restrict or suspend operations as necessary until those conditions are corrected.

If these conditions exist, the reporting individual will contact HeliService USA Dispatch, who will make the appropriate notifications to the suspended unit. Dispatch will notify notification the Director of Operations and Director of Safety for appropriate dissemination and issue tracking.

Once the issue is resolved by the suspended entity, Dispatch and the Director of Operations will notify Pilots of the corrected issue.

6.9.1 Helideck Operations

When operating to/from a helideck, the following aspects shall be considered in relation to the helicopter used of the operation where applicable:

1. Helideck dimensions (D-Value).
2. Helideck weight limitation (T-Value).
3. Obstacle clearance in the approach, missed approach and departure sectors Lighting system.
4. Visual approach aids.



5. Navigational aids.
6. Special local weather phenomena.
7. Approach and Departure routes.
8. Night flying restrictions.
9. Communication capabilities and procedures.
10. Fire fighting and rescue service.

6.9.1.1 Moving Deck Limitations

For moving decks, the limitations in the table below apply. The AW169 is classified as Aircraft Category 2.

For the helideck category, the following definitions apply:

- Category 1: Mobile Offshore Drilling Units (MODU) and Vessels such as Floating Production Storage and Offloading Unit (FPSO) etc with good visual references;
- Category 2: Vessels with Stern or mid-ship mounted helidecks giving good visual references;
- Category 3: Vessels with Bow mounted helidecks with poor visual references.



Helideck Limitation List (HLL)

Part C Summary of Pitch, Roll & Heave Limitations

Notes:

1. Acceptable parameters are up to and including the limits given below, (pitch and roll figures are half amplitude, heave is given in metres per second)
2. Limitations for helicopters not included in the table below are to be requested from the HCA Helideck Steering Committee (HSC)
3. Category 3 vessels (Bow mounted helideck) operating with the helideck downwind are automatically upgraded to Category 2
4. Category 2 vessels (Stern helideck) operating with the helideck upwind are automatically downgraded to Category 3
- Vessels with Midship helidecks are always Category 2*
5. FPSO night operations – use Category 1 "Night Other Vessels" limitations
6. Stable deck conditions, when applied, assume a maximum of 1 degree pitch & roll and 0.4 m/s SHR

Aircraft Category		Helideck Category								
		1			2			3		
		P/R	INC	SHR	P/R	INC	SHR	P/R	INC	SHR
A	DAY	±3	3.5	1.3	±2	2.5	1.0	±2	2.5	1.0
	Night Semi-Sub	±3	3.5	1.0	Not Applicable			Not Applicable		
	Night Other	±2	2.5	1.0	±2	2.5	0.5	±1*	1.5*	0.5*
	DAY	±4	4.5	1.3	±3	3.5	1.0	±3	3.5	1.0
B	Night Semi-Sub	±4	4.5	1.0	Not Applicable			Not Applicable		
	Night Other	±3	3.5	1.0	±2	2.5	0.5	±1.5*	2.0*	0.5*
	DAY	±3	3.5	1.3	±2	2.5	1.0	±2	2.5	1.0
	Night Semi-Sub	±3	3.5	1.0	Not Applicable			Not Applicable		

* Night operations to Category 3 vessels are not permitted in UK waters.

Key:

P/R = Pitch and Roll (deg); INC = Helideck inclination (deg); SHR = Significant Heave Rate (m/s);

For tanker mooring buoys (whose deck movement is measured by inclination rather than pitch and roll) the inclination limits are ±2° by day and ±1° by night regardless of aircraft category.

Aircraft Category:

A = S92, EC225, AS332 Series, AW189

B = AW139, S76 series, AS365 Series, B212, B412, EC135, EC145, EC155, EC175, AW169.

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6.9.1.2 Wrong Deck Procedures

1. During preflight planning crews will review each location to identify the possibility (High, Medium, or Low) of landing at the incorrect helideck/heliport. Crews shall consider items such as:
 - a. Mobile installations and vessels
 - b. Proximity to other helideck/heliports
 - c. Similar vessels or installations either physical or in naming conventions.
2. If the risk of landing on the wrong helideck/heliport exists the crews will brief that possibility and likelihood during preflight and during the before landing checks briefing.
3. Crews will insure to verify helideck markings prior to landing.



6.9.1.2.1 Wrong Deck Landing

If a wrong deck landing occurs the crew will:

1. Identify the helideck/heliport.
2. Try to contact the wrong helideck/heliport crews to obtain clearance for departure.
3. Relay to HSUSA the mistake.
4. Go through proper checklists prior to departure.

Note: There can be many hazards to helicopter operations on or near helideck/heliports. Crews must take proper precautions after landing on the wrong helideck/heliport before departing.

6.9.2 Unimproved Landing Areas

The minimum distance for unimproved landing areas are 100ft x 100ft. Consideration when landing to unimproved areas include evaluation of obstructions (trees or wires), lighting (if required) and evaluation of wind conditions.

Whenever possible, landings should be made to the long axis of a landing zone into the wind.

6.9.2.1 Unimproved - Day

1. Appropriate high and low reconnaissance will be performed prior to landing to ensure the area is suitable for the desired operation, including no less than one full turn around the LZ.
2. High reconnaissance will be performed at an altitude no lower than 300 ft for day operations.
3. The LZ must provide sufficient rotor and landing gear clearance.

6.9.2.2 Unimproved - Night

Prior to conducting night operations to an unimproved LZ, the pilot shall perform a high and low reconnaissance. High reconnaissance will be performed at an altitude no lower than 500' agl for night operations. After completion of the initial reconnaissance at 500' agl subsequent reconnaissance orbits may be conducted at an altitude no lower than 300' agl if required.

Additionally the following are required:

1. The limits of the area must be clearly marked by lights or reflective material in such a way that the pilot can see the landing area from any direction.
 - a. Electrical or battery powered lights.
 - b. Items wrapped with reflective tape.
 - c. Heliport surface painted or taped with reflective material.
 - d. Hand held flashlight wands.
 - e. Vehicle headlights may be used if they are positioned in such a manner as to illuminate the area while not blinding the pilot on final approach.
 - f. Lights/reflectors that are of a portable nature should be placed in a rectangle or triangle pattern with at least the corner points marked.



6.9.2.3 Landing Zone Catalog

The EFB manager will maintain a common list of utilized landing zones. If a landing zone is determined to be unsatisfactory or dangerous, the EFB Manager will be notified and a temporary NOTAM will be published into Fleet Plan for the pilots reading file.

6.9.3 Airport Operations

Helicopters should avoid the flow of airplanes on approach to the runway by using the taxi-way or heliport areas. This does not preclude the use of the runway by helicopters when conditions warrant. Helicopter pilots should be aware that when a conflict between a helicopter and airplane arises over use of the runway, the helicopter is expected to give way.

1. When operating at an unfamiliar or complex airport, the airport diagram should be reviewed before taxiing and accessible for reference during surface operations.
2. Before crossing any runway or taxiway, scan the full length for traffic.

Two pilot crews: In addition to the above paragraph, both pilots shall maintain a sterile cockpit and constant vigilance as to the aircraft's location and the movement and location of other ground and air traffic.

6.10 Icing and Cold Weather Operations

6.10.1 Outside the Aircraft Check

[14 CFR § 135.227(a) and 135.227(b)(1)]

The following Outside the Aircraft Check (OTAC) procedures are focused toward properly equipped and certified aircraft for flight into known icing conditions; however, ALL aircraft must be checked anytime conditions may exist for accumulation of frost, ice, or snow.

1. The PIC will complete an OTAC anytime conditions may exist for accumulation of frost, ice or snow.
2. The OTAC will be performed on the required 360 degrees walk around.
3. If Ground Icing Conditions exist then the flight may not proceed until Ground Icing Conditions are no longer present.
4. The OTAC will consist of:
 - a. A visual check for the accumulation of frost, ice, or snow.
 - b. The check will ensure that the wings, control surfaces, rotors, engine inlets,
 - c. and other critical surfaces are free of frost, ice, or snow.
 - d. The vertical surfaces must be free of frost, ice, or snow.

6.10.2 Icing Conditions



[14 CFR § 135.227(a)(d)(f)]

1. Helicopter flights into known or forecast inflight icing conditions are prohibited unless helicopter is equipped with "De-Icing" equipment and pilot(s) have been trained and qualified on specific equipment to be operated.
2. Helicopter operations during ground icing conditions are prohibited.
3. Pilots may not takeoff with frost, ice, or snow adhering to any rotor blade, windshield, stabilizer, engine inlet, pitot or static system inlets.
4. Chemicals or fluids other than water shall not be used to assist in the removal of ice unless specifically authorized by HSUSA maintenance for that purpose.
5. Helicopters shall not be run up in order to remove ice or snow from the rotor system as a severe out of balance condition may develop and ice may be shed in a dangerous manner. However, aircraft covered with frost may be run-up to remove frost, but must be shut down and inspected for remaining frost prior to flight.
6. When freezing precipitation is forecast, aircraft should be hangared. If this is not possible, engine inlet and exhaust covers will be installed.
7. When available, ground heater units may be used to remove ice from aircraft. Pay particular attention to throttle cables to ensure all moisture is removed.
8. Ensure that all ice and snow is removed from the engine inlet area. On some aircraft this may require the use of an inspection mirror because of the possibility of snow or freezing moisture collecting behind a lip or ledge and not readily visible without cowling removal.
9. Inspect fuel drains to ensure normal drainage.
10. Ensure the landing gear is not frozen to the ice or snow.
11. Prior to start, ensure that the engine is not frozen by turning the rotor system backwards. Resistance to being turned backwards under these conditions normally indicates a frozen engine.
12. If current weather reports and briefing information relied upon by the Pilot in Command indicate that the forecast icing condition that would otherwise prohibit the flight will not be encountered during the flight because of changed weather conditions since the forecast, the flight may be commenced.

6.10.3 Cold Weather Operations

Any time ambient temperature is 37 degrees F (4°C) or less, operations will be considered "cold weather" and precautions will be taken as follows.

1. Pilots will review the manufacturer's flight manual before flying in cold weather.
2. Aircraft anti-icing shall be used in accordance with the manufacturer's flight manual.
3. Recommended cold weather fuels or fuel additives shall be used in accordance with the manufacturer's flight manual.
4. When operating on ice, the aircraft may turn as power is reduced or increased unless anticipated and controlled. Take extra caution and guard pedals during throttle manipulation.



5. Do not land too close to obstructions as there is a possibility the aircraft may slide on the ice.
6. When operating in powdery snow conditions, plan all takeoffs, landings and flights to avoid "white out."

6.11 Application of Risk Assessment

The foundation for conducting a complex operation like HHO and Crew Change operations is the application of a thorough risk assessment process.

The mitigation measures to reduce the risks to a level as low as reasonably practicable (ALARP), are the limitations and procedures described in these SOP or applicable other manuals.

HeliService USA uses the severity over probability system to assess risks. The risk is expressed as the product of probability multiplied by severity.

The scale used by HSUSA to assess risks is shown below.

		Severity				
		1	2	3	4	5
Probability	1	1	2	3	4	5
	2	2	4	6	8	10
	3	3	6	9	12	15
	4	4	8	12	16	20
	5	5	10	15	20	25

Unacceptable (15 - 25)	Risk mitigation mandatory
Tolerable (5 - 12)	Mitigate risks to a level as low as reasonably practicable (ALARP)
Acceptable (1 - 4)	No further mitigation necessary

5	Catastrophic	• Loss of Helicopter • Equipment destroyed • Multiple fatalities
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4	Hazardous	- Substantial helicopter or equipment damage - Fatal or serious injuries to a number of people
3	Major	- Minor damage to helicopter or equipment - Individual serious injuries, but no fatalities
2	Minor	- Insignificant damage to helicopter or equipment - Individual minor injuries
1	No significant effect	- No damage to helicopter or equipment - No injuries

5	Frequent	Likely to occur many times
4	Occasional	Likely to occur sometimes
3	Remote	Unlikely to occur, but possible
2	Improbable	Very unlikely to occur
1	Extremely improbably	Almost inconceivable that the event will occur

6.11.1 HHO and Crew Change Risk Assessment

Considering the nature, complexity and operational environment, HeliService has identified the following hazards and assesses the risks as follows.

No.	Hazard	Associated risks	Prob	Sev	Init. Risk	Mitigation measures	Prob	Sev	Res. Risk	Remarks
-----	--------	------------------	------	-----	------------	---------------------	------	-----	-----------	---------



1	Low cloud base, fog, poor visibility	Collision with platform / vessel	2	5	10	- Define weather limitations - Contact destination before flight for current weather status - Use radar during approach	1	5	5	
2	Gusty wind conditions causing sudden helicopter movements	Hoist PX hits obstacle or helicopter while being hoisted	2	3	6	- Hoist PX wears cranial protection and sturdy clothes - Use low hover height (15-20 ft) to minimize transfer time	1	2	2	
		Hoist PX falls out of helicopter when disconnected from hoist	2	5	10	- Use low hover height (15-20 ft, if possible) - Hoist PX remains attached to hoist until secured with safety line	1	4	4	
		Helicopter hits obstacle	3	5	15	Select hoist position with sufficient obstacle clearance and good visual references for the pilot	1	5	5	



3	Unfavorable relative wind for HHO to a moving vessel	Helicopter or hoist PX hits an obstacle due to pilot losing sight of visual references	3	5	15	- Helicopter requests vessel to turn to the desired flying course for HHO - Copilot is also trained for HHO and can take over controls if vessel is unable to change course	1	5	5	
4	Ship movement due to high sea state	Hoist PX hits obstacle / Hoist cable gets entangled in superstructure of vessel	3	3	9	- Define pitch, roll and heave limits for HHO - Use approved hoist spots whenever available - Select hoist area with sufficient obstacle clearance to allow for ship movement - Hoist PX wears cranial protection and sturdy clothes - Ground crew to assist in disentangling cable/hook - Discontinue HHO if cable is damaged - Cut cable with cable cutter if disentangling not possible	1	2	2	



5	No radio contact with the platform / vessel / control center	Platform / vessel is unable to communicate if ground crew is ready for transfer	3	1	3	• Use back-up radio • Use hand signals with deck crew	1	1	1	
		Control Center is unable to communicate if WT is ready for HHO	3	3	9	• Use of back-up radio • Observe status light • If in doubt, helicopter does not approach the WT for HHO	2	1	2	
6	Crane operation during HHO	Helicopter or hoist PX hits an obstacle	2	5	10	• Crane operations prohibited during HHO • Crane needs to be properly stowed before commencing HHO	1	5	5	
7	Loose objects / debris on the hoist area	Ground crew being hit by objects or debris blown by helicopter downwash	3	3	9	• Ground crew / first crew on ground checks hoist area before HHO • Ground crew wears protective clothes, goggles, gloves, etc.	1	1	1	



8	Obstacles in close vicinity of hoist area	Helicopter's rotor / tailrotor hits an obstacle	3	5	15	- Select hoist area with sufficient clearance - Select appropriate hover position and height (helicopter clear of obstacles) with good visual references for the pilot	1	5	5	
		Hoist PX hits an obstacle	3	3	9	- Use approved hoist spots whenever available - Select hoist area with sufficient visual references for the pilot - Hoist PX wears cranial protection and sturdy clothes	2	1	2	
9	Static electricity	Hoist PX being injured by static discharge	4	2	8	- Use of static line or grounding bar - Hoist PX to wear shoes with anti-static soles - HOP to confirm static line touches the deck first	1	1	1	



10	Static line entangles during hoist ops	Hoist PX being injured by static discharge	3	2	6	• Use static line of continuous shape • Always carry a spare static line	1	1	1	
11	Hoist motor seizure	Hypothermia due to hoist PX exposure to adverse weather during transit to recovery site	2	3	6	• Hoist PX to wear proper PPE • Recovery site shall be available within 10 minutes of flight time • Use secondary hoist, if equipped, to retrieve hoist PX	2	1	2	
12	Single engine failure during HHO (PC 1 required)	Helicopter loses height and crashes	1	5	5	• Conduct HHO only with 2.5 min OEI performance available • Minimize time overhead hoist area • Only minimum required personnel allowed underneath the rotor arc	1	1	1	



13	Single engine failure during HHO (PC 1 not required)	Helicopter loses height and crashes	1	5	5	- Conduct HHO only with 5/10 sec OEI performance available - Flyaway path / landing area shall be clear - Minimize time overhead hoist area - Only minimum required personnel allowed underneath the rotor arc	1	2	2	
		When heading into wind (nose pointing towards WT rotor), helicopter collides with parts of WT during fly-away after engine failure	1	5	5	Flyaway path shall be clear	1	1	1	



14	Non-standard WTG machine cabin position	When heading into wind, pilot loses visual references and collides with parts of WT	3	5	15	- Helicopter tail shall never point towards the rotor of the WT - Heading shall always be close to parallel to the plane of rotation of the WT rotor - Sufficient visual references on the WT shall be available to the PF (e.g. aiming system, structures, textures, etc.)	1	5	5	
		Helicopter loses height and collides with WT after engine failure due to lack of performance with crosswind / tailwind	1	5	5	- No tailwind allowed for HHO - Crosswind component to be within limits - Power check to be performed before commencing HHO	1	2	2	
		Wind over WT rotor blades produces turbulence over hoist area causing hoist PX to hit an obstacle	3	3	9	- Turbulence level to be checked before lowering PX. If necessary, abort - PX to wear sturdy clothes and cranial protection	1	2	2	



15	Nacelle not locked	Helicopter loses height and collides with WT after engine failure due to lack of performance with changing crosswind / tailwind	1	5	5	- Machine cabin must be steady (no movement) for HHO - Status light installed on WT to warn crew - If movement detected -> abort	1	2	2	
16	Non-standard rotor blade position	Collision with WT blade due to decreased clearance (vertical blade is usually the closest)	2	5	10	At least 5 meters clearance between helicopter's main rotor and plane of rotation of WT rotors shall be provided when hoist cable over center of hoist area	1	5	5	



17	Rotor not blocked	WT rotor blades produce turbulence causing hoist PX to hit an obstacle	3	3	9	• Status light installed on WT to warn crew • Only slow tumbling acceptable • Turbulence level to be checked before lowering PX. If necessary, abort • Hoist PX to wear sturdy clothes and cranial protection • Helicopter does not continue HHO if blades are moving too fast	1	2	2
18	Rotor and machine cabin not controllable (dead-turbine)	Combination of above risks possible	3	5	15	• Crew (including HHO PX) to assess situation and apply above mitigation measures as applicable. If mitigation not possible -> abort	1	5	5

6.11.2 Operational Risk Management

Situations arising during hoist operations that are not covered by risk assessments and / or standard operating procedures still need to be managed properly applying operational risk management (ORM) techniques.

The basis for proper ORM is a good assessment of the situation at hand followed by an analytic decision making process that helps reducing possible risks to a level ALARP.



HeliService uses the FORDEC method to assist the crew in decision making during operations.

F acts	• What is the situation? • What are the facts?
O ptions	• What are the options?
R isks & benefits	• Identify the hazards for each option and assess the associated risks as described above. • Identify mitigation measures to reduce the risks to a level ALARP. • What are the benefits associated with each option? • Is a benefit essential?
D ecision	• Choose the option with the lowest risk and most benefits.
E xecution	• Execute the chosen option applying the mitigation measures.
C heck	• Check if the chosen option leads to solving the situation and if the mitigation measures applied are effective. • Are there new facts? • Are there new options available?

6.11.3 Helicopter Air Ambulance Risk Assessment

I



HELISERVICE USA FLIGHT RISK ASSESSMENT TOOL					
Date:		Departure:			
Callsign:		Destination:			
Aircraft:					
Section 1 Crew Qualifications, Experience, Fatigue					
1	PIC less than 25 hrs in the last 90 days	Day	2	Night	3
2	PIC less than 100 hrs in type		2		3
3	PIC hoist currency >90 days		3		4
4	SIC less than 25 hrs in the last 90 days		1		2
5	SIC less than 100 hrs in type		3		4
6	SIC hoist currency >90 days		4		5
7	HO hoist currency >90 days		3		4
8	RS hoist currency >90 days		3		4
9	Medic hoist currency >90 days		3		4
10	Flight time >6 hrs in the duty day		4		6
11	Duty day >12 hrs		3		5
12	Flight occurs between hours of 0200-0600				7
13	Hours since last flight in same duty period		<1		5
			1-3		4
			3-6		2
14	Any crewmember having unmitigated stressors		YES = NO GO		
			Total		0
Section 2 Environment					
18	Flight Rules	MVFR	4		
		IFR	2		
		LIFR	3		
19	Wind Velocity at departure or destination (Kts)	<10	2		
		>35	4		
20	Wave Height (Feet)	3-6	2		
		6-12	4		
		>12	6		
21	OAT (Degrees Celcius)	<-10	4		
		-9 to 4	2		
		31-40	2		
		>40	4		
22	Icing conditions within 2000' of cruise altitude without Anti-Ice		3		
23	Thunderstorms within 20 miles of intended route		5		
24	Heavy precipitation along route		5		
25	Moderate to Severe turbulence along route		5		
26	Moon illumination (%)	<25	5		
		26-50	4		
		51-75	2		
		>76	1		
27	Night operations without NVGs		7		
28	Mountainous area		5		
29	Twilight operations		2		
			Total		0
Section 3 Operation					
30	Number of additional aircraft in operation	1	1		
		2	2		
		3	4		
		>4	6		
	Type of operation (Select highest expected/planned)	Day	Night		
	Land Hoist	1	2		
	Platform/Rig Hoist	3	4		
	Open Water Hoist	2	3		
31	Vessel Hoist	4	5		
	Confined Area Operations	3	4		
	HAA Over Land	4	6		
	Search Pattern (Over Land)	5	7		
	Search Pattern (Offshore)	1	3		
32	Fuel load is less than 30 minutes above required minimum		3		
			Total		0
Section 4 Equipment					
33	Aircraft has MEL'd items		3		
			Total		0
Highest obstacle along intended flight route					
Obstacle location					
Flight rejected by another operator					
Reason for flight rejection					
Total Risk Score 0					
LOW	Acceptable risk level, continue with positive safety actions to reduce risk.				
≤58	Flight can be authorised by the PIC				
MODERATE	Chief Pilot or Director of Operations approval required				
59-85					
HIGH					
>85					
PIC		Signature			
Date/Time		10/6/2023 14:16			



7 COCKPIT PROCEDURES & CREW CONCEPT

This chapter contains HeliService USA standards for crew interaction and CRM during flying operations. The OM-A lays out descriptions of aircraft agnostic crew coordination, call-outs, SOP's, and general company philosophy on the subject. Aircraft specific SOP's and call-outs are laid out in each aircraft's respective OM-B.

This chapter contains the crew coordination for:

1. Sterile cockpit procedure.
2. Standard call-outs.
3. Standard in-aircraft briefings.
4. Normal procedures.
5. Emergency procedures.

7.1 Flight Personnel Configuration

All HeliService USA pilots are trained and certified to fly single-pilot. While this ensures they have met the highest standards in training and certification, HSUSA strongly believes dual-pilot operations are the safest and most efficient way to support offshore operations. Additionally, HSUSA has contractual requirements with several customers mandating dual-pilot operations.

As such, single-pilot operations under 14 CFR Part 135 or Part 133 will only be conducted with the following stipulations:

1. VFR.
2. No contractual client requirements for dual-pilot operations.
3. The PIC meets HSUSA specific PIC minimums (OM-A 3.2.3).
4. Approval from the DO, CP, or Managing Director.
5. The pilot has received training in single pilot operations.

7.2 Crew Members at their Station

7.2.1 PIC & SIC

The following requirements shall be complied with:

1. No crew member may perform any duties during a critical phase of flight except those duties required for the safe operation of the aircraft. No flight crewmember may engage in, nor may any pilot in command permit, any activity during a critical phase of flight which could distract any flight crewmember from the performance of his or her duties or which could interfere in any way with the proper conduct of those duties. Activities such as eating meals, engaging in nonessential conversations within the cockpit and nonessential communications between the cabin and cockpit crews, and reading publications not related to the proper conduct of the flight are not required for



the safe operation of the aircraft.

2. A qualified pilot shall be at the controls of any company helicopter when the rotors are turning for the purpose of ground taxi or flight.
3. Transfer of control from one pilot to the other shall be distinct and overlapping with emphasis on the word "controls" (PF: "You have controls.", PF: "I have controls.", former PF: "you have controls.").
4. During taxi, take-off and landing each flight crew member required to be on duty in the cockpit shall be at his station and while rotors are running, flight crew members shall be properly secured by the safety belts and harnesses provided.
5. During all other phases of flight each flight crew member required to be on duty shall remain at his station unless his absence is necessary in the performance of his duties in connection with the operation, or for physiological needs provided at least one suitably qualified pilot remains at the controls of the helicopter at all times.
6. PF shall have hands and feet on the controls at all times when personnel are entering or leaving the cockpit area. In addition the person shall not leave or enter the cockpit without receiving acceptance from PF, either by thumbs up or verbal communication.
7. During coupled flight the PF shall remain vigilant with hands and feet off the controls so as not to interfere with the automation, but ready to respond and manually fly the aircraft if required.
8. The commander shall exercise due caution when deciding whether to leave his seat on a moving helideck.

7.2.2 Technical Specialists

[14 CFR § 135.171]

During take-off and landing, and whenever decided by the PIC in the interest of safety, each technical specialist shall:

1. Be seated at the assigned station and shall not perform any activities other than those required for the safe operation of the helicopter.
2. Be properly secured by all safety belts and restraint systems provided.

During other phases of the flight, each technical crew member shall keep the assigned station safety belt fastened while at his station. If a task requires being out of seat, the doors shall be closed unless the task specialist has already secured themselves with a harness prior to opening the door.

Note: If landing in an unsurveyed, confined area, is permitted (at the request of the PIC) to open the door and ensure clearance of the tail.

7.2.3 Use of Vacant Crew Seats

[14 CFR § 135.113]



Only a pilot qualified in that class/make/model may occupy a seat equipped with flight controls on aircraft configured with more than eight passenger seats (excluding any pilot seat) during a revenue flight.

With CP (or higher) approval, a passenger may occupy a seat equipped with flight controls on aircraft configured with eight or less passenger seats that doesn't require dual pilot operations. This is considered an abnormal operation as the majority of flights have internal or client requirements to fly dual pilot.

When a passenger occupies a seat equipped with flight controls, the pilot shall brief that passenger on the following:

1. Not to touch or interfere with the flight controls in any way.
2. To move steadily and slowly when getting in or out of the aircraft.
3. To keep seatbelt fastened until aircraft has landed and instructed to remove the seatbelt and exit the aircraft by the pilot.

7.2.4 Manipulation of Flight Controls

[14 CFR § 135.115(a)(b)]

Only pilots qualified by HeliService USA may manipulate the controls of an aircraft in flight operations under 14 CFR Part 135. When single pilot operations are conducted on any flight with dual control equipped aircraft, the pilot shall fly from the primary pilot station.

An authorized safety representative of the Administrator who has the permission of the PIC, is qualified in the aircraft, and is checking flight operations, may be permitted to manipulate the flight controls.

7.3 Use of PEDs by Crew Members

1. Apart from the EFB (see EFB policy and procedures manual), portable electronic devices (PED's) may only be used by the PNF or a crewmember when in "flight mode" and when sterile cockpit procedures do not apply.
2. The use of PED's shall generally be restricted to an absolute minimum and shall in no way interfere with flight crew duties.
3. These provisions shall not preclude the use of a PED (specifically a mobile phone) by the flight crew to deal with an emergency. However, reliance should not be predicated on a PED for this purpose.
4. When not in use, all PED shall be stored appropriately not to pose a loose item risk.
5. When PED's are not accessible during the flight for deactivation (i.e. in the baggage compartment), they shall be switched off.

7.4 Use of Auto-Pilot



Due to the hands on nature of HSUSA operations, pilots are to maintain a high level of "stick and rudder" proficiency, while also being expected to effectively utilize the automation systems of their respective aircraft. In order to achieve these two conflicting goals, when possible, one leg should be performed with an autopilot system on (flight director modes coupled) and the following with autopilot system off (flight director modes uncoupled).

This applies to all phases of the flight including take off, cruise, approach and landing, irrespective of VMC or IMC (unless single-pilot). Considerations should be given to workload, environmental conditions and passenger comfort.

For abnormal and emergency situations, the autopilot system shall be utilized (or not) in accordance with how the pilot(s) think will result in the most favorable outcome.

With the autopilot system in use, it shall be operated in such a way that its capabilities and benefits are maximized. Examples including:

1. Reduction of workload.
2. Precision of navigation.
3. Availability of protection modes.

When using the autopilot systems, one of the main tasks of the flight crew is to effectively manage and operate the automated systems. The monitoring of the automated systems is equally as important as performing the maneuvers manually.

It is essential that flight crews are fully aware of how the system performs and functions in order to recognize and verify any failure or invalid output of the automated system. When selecting automated systems, appropriate levels of automation shall be used and the automation should be programmed well in advance of maneuvers to be performed. Any changes in entries and / or selections shall be performed according to the closed loop principle and be acknowledged by the both pilots.

7.4.1 Automation Crew Task Sharing

When transitioning from manual to automated flying:

PF:

1. Requests PNF to engage the desired AFS modes.
2. Confirms proper selection and function of AFS modes.

PM:

1. Engages AFS modes as directed by PF.
2. Monitors proper function of AFS modes (vertical and horizontal flight path).

When autopilot is engaged:

PF:

1. Announces and engages modes / sets parameters for the AFS and performs display management



as necessary.

2. Monitors proper function of AFS modes (vertical and horizontal flight path).

PM:

1. Monitors proper function of AFS modes (vertical and horizontal flight path).

7.5 Standard Procedures and Phraseology

7.5.1 CRM & Crew Duties

In all situations it is essential that an appropriate delegation of duties and responsibilities exists. In an multi-pilot crew, the tasks are divided between the pilot flying and the pilot not flying.

In case of emergency:

1. The pilot flying or PF's primary duty is to fly the helicopter safely.
2. The pilot not flying or PM will assist / monitor the PF as necessary and handle situations according to the normal or emergency checklist.

Some typical tasks of the PM including the following:

1. Make required radio calls.
2. Switch on / off automation when asked to do so.
3. Change navigation guidance.
4. Note times and fuel in the flight log.
5. Perform checklist items when asked for by the PF or prompt the PF should he neglect to call for them in a timely manner.
6. Monitor instruments during the flight to ensure that a safe flight path is maintained, specially during approach and departure.
7. Call out any potential hazardous or unsafe situations to the crew.
8. Be ready to take over the controls when asked to do so or when it appears that the PF is incapacitated.

The HSUSA designated PIC may consider re-arranging standard duties of the PF and PM as required to most safely and effectively accomplish the flight.

Workload should be carefully distributed between crew members, considering the duties of the pilot flying, pilot not flying, and technical specialists.

Example:

1. The PF controls and handles the flight path of the helicopter and confirms information received by the PM.
2. The PNF navigates and communicates with air traffic control and confirms information received by the PF.
3. The Pilot in Command directs all crew members.



4. All crew members supervise one another.

All crew members should work together as a team with each individual assigned to their duties in order to fulfill the common targets and reach the operational goal. The crew should support each other at all times in fulfilling these duties and responsibilities. The leadership of the HSUSA designated PIC shall be focused on what is right and not who is right.

Should there be a situation where any member of the crew does not agree with the HSUSA designated PIC's course of action, flying, or management of the flight, it shall be discussed in a professional / calm manner. He / she still remains the final authority for the aircraft and will politely state they are making a "pilot in command" decision.

However, shall any member of the crew feel unsafe continuing in any way, they shall formally state they feel it is unsafe to continue. The HSUSA designated PIC shall then terminate the flight and return to its primary base if safe to do so. If not, then they shall land at the most convenient HSUSA facility or airport that is safe to do so.

Example: Half way to an offshore platform, the weather begins to deteriorate. The PIC is comfortable continuing, but the SIC feels it is beyond their personal limitation or believes it to be unsafe. A healthy discussion may occur (including mitigation or plans the SIC may not be aware of), but should the SIC still feel it is unsafe, they shall state they feel it is unsafe and the crew will return back to base.

If the crew remains of a different opinion about the situation after the debrief or there was a confrontation of any variety between crew-members, this shall be brought to the attention of the DO or CP.

7.5.2 Sterile Cockpit Procedures

All HeliService USA flight crews shall apply sterile cockpit procedures during all critical phases of flight.

Critical phases of flight are:

1. During taxi, takeoff and departure from the surface to 1,000 ft AGL or to en-route cruising altitude if below 1,000 ft AGL.
2. During the approach below 1,000 ft AGL to touchdown (VFR).
3. During the approach from FAF to touchdown (IFR).
4. During all other phases of flight as required by the PIC or when requested by any crew member.

No paperwork or electronic data entry shall be done, and no food or drink consumed during critical phases of flight. Crew conversation shall be restricted to standard phraseology necessary to complete the relevant checklists and observe sound airmanship.

Taxi includes any ground operation with the rotor system at flight settings, and requires extra vigilance from both crew members to minimize the risk of upset.

7.5.3 Hand-over of Controls



The hand-over of who is flying the helicopter is standardized using the 3-way system.

For example:

1. PF: HDG, ALT and NAV coupled (or uncoupled), you have controls.
2. PM: Copied coupled, I have controls.
3. PF: You have controls (only then does he become the PNF).

Emphasis should be on the word controls.

7.5.4 Checklist Management

[14 CFR § 135.83(a)(1)]

Checklists should not be handled below 1,000 ft AGL. Depending on obstacles in the vicinity, a higher altitude for the handling of checklist may be briefed. The PF is the one normally initiating the next check, but the PNF or task specialist is allowed and encouraged to remind him of the next check.

Three methods of checklist handling are used:

1. C/R (challenge and reply)

PM reads the challenge.

PF performs the check and replies.

The C/R method shall be used only when the helicopter is stationary on ground with the rotor at stable RPM (e.g. engine start / shutdown checks).

2. R/D (read and do)

PM reads the challenge, performs the check, and replies.

PF confirms as required and only performs those checks the PNF cannot perform due to i.e. location of switches.

The R/D method shall be used whenever the rotor of the helicopter is being accelerated / decelerated, during taxi or during flight to allow the PF to always monitor the flight controls and movement of the helicopter.

3. MEMORY (These are the immediate actions / memory items indicated by the manufacturer)

PM recites the challenge from memory and performs the check.

PF confirms as required.



Checks that are to be performed in-flight below 1,000 ft AGL should be performed by memory to comply with sterile cockpit procedures. These checks are limited to a maximum of five items.

7.5.4.1 Single Pilot Checklist Management

Effective single pilot checklist management is critical to maintaining safety, situational awareness, Single Pilot Crew Resource Management Skills and compliance with operational requirements. A single pilot must be disciplined in using checklists systematically, ensuring each item is completed without omission, even under high workload. This includes preflight, in-flight, and postflight phases, where reliance on memory alone can lead to critical errors. The checklist should be tailored to the specific rotorcraft and operation type, aligning with manufacturer guidance, and any applicable procedures from the Rotorcraft Flight Manual (RFM) or company operations manual. In single pilot operations, verbalizing checklist steps (even internally) enhances attention and reduces the risk of omission. The use of flow patterns combined with checklist verification, or “do-verify” methods, is recommended in complex environments. Ultimately, strict adherence to checklist discipline supports both regulatory compliance and safe decision-making in dynamic helicopter operational settings.

7.5.5 Start-up and Shut-down

Reserved.

7.5.6 Taxi

Taxi includes any ground operation with the rotor system at flight setting, and requires extra vigilance from the crew to minimize the risk of upset. Taxiing, including ground taxi, is considered a critical phase of the flight and hence sterile cockpit procedures as described in chapter 7.5.2 apply.

1. No paperwork or electronic data entries shall be done, and no food or drink consumed while taxiing.
2. Standard radio-telephony phraseology with the respective controlling unit shall be used.
3. Crew conversation shall be restricted to standard phraseology necessary to complete relevant checklists and to observe sound airmanship.
4. Lower anti-collision lights and strobe lights shall be switched off while taxiing in vicinity of ground personnel and / or other aircraft.
5. When entering the runway, the lower anti-collision lights and strobe lights shall be switched on.
6. For offshore helideck landings and take-offs, the lower anti-collision lights and strobe lights shall be switched off to avoid dazzling of the helideck crew.

To enhance the situational awareness of the flight crew, the following procedures shall be applied:

1. Each flight crew member shall have the necessary aerodrome layout charts available.
2. The pilot taxiing the helicopter shall announce in advance his intentions to the pilot monitoring.
3. All taxi clearances shall be heard and shall be understood by each flight crew member.
4. All taxi clearances shall be cross-checked against the aerodrome chart and aerodrome surface



markings, signs, and light.

5. A helicopter taxiing on the maneuvering area shall stop and hold at all lighted stop bars, and may only proceed further when an explicit clearance to enter or cross the runway has been issued by the aerodrome control tower, and when the stop bar lights are switched off.
6. If the pilot taxiing the helicopter is unsure of his position, he should stop the helicopter and contact air traffic control.
7. The pilot monitoring shall monitor the taxi progress and adherence to the clearances, and shall assist the pilot taxiing (MP ops only).
8. Any action which may disturb the flight crew from the taxi activity shall be avoided or done with the parking brake set.

7.5.7 PFD / MFD Setup

PFD / MFD setup for departure / approach

To provide better situational awareness to the PF and to have TCAS information available during departure and arrival.

For the AW169:

1. The MFD should display the FPLN page.
2. The PVI and SVI windows in both PFDs shall be used to monitor T's and P's (N_G and ITT are the only values not displayed in the SVI window. PI indicates first limit).
3. For IFR departures and approaches the SVS should be selected on both PFD's.

7.5.8 Offshore Departure

1. Before departure, the pilots shall establish radio contact to the HLO and/or control room to determine whether and where other flight operations are being conducted in the vicinity.
2. After the helicopter has been cleared by the responsible HLO, the pilots give the HLO the signal to take-off, either by hand signals or by radio.
3. The take-off is performed according to the procedure described in the OM-B of the relevant helicopter type.
4. After take-off the departure area shall be exited immediately (maintaining visual contact of and a safety distance to the obstacles at all times) and the cruising altitude attained as soon as possible.
5. When the after take-off checks are complete, radio contact shall be established with the appropriate controlling agency or ops stating:
 - a. Call sign.
 - b. Type of helicopter.
 - c. Number of persons on board.
 - d. Place of departure.
 - e. ATD.



- f. Destination.
 - g. The relevant flight rules (VFR / IFR)
 - h. Planned cruising altitude / flight level.
 - i. Name and ETA of next reporting point.
 - j. Request to open the ATC flight plan, if necessary.
6. As soon as contact with the air traffic control unit has been established, the pilots shall "sign off" with the radio operator of the place of departure and inform him of the ETA at the destination airport.

7.5.9 After Take-Off Checks

The after take-off checks shall be performed passing 1,000 ft AGL. If the cruising altitude will be below 1,000 ft AGL, the after take-off checks shall be performed after level-off.

7.5.10 Climb

Initial climb

The initial climb up to 1,000 ft AGL following the take-off procedure shall be flown with V_Y using the take-off power setting described in the OM-B of the respective helicopter type.

Cruise climb

Above 1,000 ft AGL and for altitude changes of more than 1,000 ft during cruise, the recommended AEO climb speed shall be used.

1. Rate of climb should not exceed 1,000 ft/min for passenger comfort.
2. Altitude changes of less than 1,000 ft during cruise may be flown with cruise speed.

For multi pilot operations, the following phraseology shall be used.

Event	PF / PM	<i>"Phraseology"</i> and/or Action	
500 ft before level-off	PM	<i>"500 feet to go."</i>	
	PF	Checks altitude.	<i>"Checked."</i>
100 ft before level-off	PM	<i>"100 feet to go."</i>	
	PF	Checks altitude and performs level-off / confirms autopilot is leveling-off.	<i>"Leveling."</i>



7.5.11 Cruise Checks

The cruise checks shall be performed when the helicopter has reached the briefed cruising altitude, and the desired cruise speed is attained.

7.5.12 Approach Checks

The approach checks shall be performed no later than 10 NM before reaching the IAF (IFR) or destination (VFR) to allow sufficient time for set up and briefing.

7.5.13 Descent Checks

Standard descent speed

For a normal descent, the standard cruise speed shall be used.

The maximum speed in a descent is V_{NE} minus 10 knots.

Rate of descent

The rate of descent should not exceed 1,000 ft/min when above 500 ft AGL and 500 ft/min when below 500 ft AGL.

For multi pilot operations, the following phraseology shall be used:

Event	PF / PM	<i>"Phraseology"</i> and/or Action	
500 ft before level-off	PM	<i>"500 feet to go."</i>	
	PF	Checks altitude.	<i>"Checked."</i>
100 ft before level-off	PM	<i>"100 feet to go."</i>	
	PF	Checks altitude and performs level-off / confirms autopilot is leveling-off.	<i>"Leveling."</i>

7.5.14 Use of ALT/ALTA Mode Offshore

1. For offshore flights, the ALT and ALTA mode shall only be used for altitudes above 1,000 ft AGL.
2. At or below 1,000 ft AGL use RHT mode.

7.5.15 Before Landing Checks

The before landing checks shall be performed no later than 4 NM before reaching the FAF/FAP (IFR) or destination (VFR) to allow sufficient time to configure the helicopter for the intended landing.



7.5.16 Approach and Landing

7.5.16.1 Onshore Approach

7.5.16.1.1 Stabilized Approach - VFR

For multi pilot operations, the following "common" standard phraseology shall be applied. Additional type specific calls and/or actions may be necessary. These are described in the respective OM-B.

Onshore stabilized approach and landing VFR

Event	PF / PM	<i>"Phraseology"</i> and/or Action	
Passing 500 ft ALS	PM	Checks if approach is stable.	
Unstable -> Go-around			
If approach is unstable	PM	<i>"Passing 500 ft, unstable, go-around."</i>	
	PF	<i>"Roger, going-around."</i>	Performs a visual go-around.
Passing 1,000 ft AGL	PM	<i>"1,000 ft."</i>	
	PF	Checks altitude / height.	<i>"Checked, go-around checks."</i>
	PM	Performs go-around Checks.	<i>"Go-around checks completed."</i>
Stabilized -> Continue			
If approach is stabilized	PM	<i>"Passing 500 ft, stabilized, continue."</i>	
	PF	<i>"Roger, continuing, final checks."</i>	Continues shallow descent and starts to decelerate slowly by raising the nose.
	PM	Performs final checks.	<i>"Final checks completed."</i>
At LDP / CAT B Gate	PM	<i>"LDP." / "Gate."</i>	
	PF	<i>"Landing."</i>	



7.5.16.1.2 Stabilized Approach - IFR

For multi-pilot operations, the following "common" standard phraseology shall be applied. Additional type specific calls and/or actions may be necessary. These are described in the respective OM-B.

Onshore stabilized approach and landing IFR

Event	PF / PM	<i>"Phraseology"</i> and/or Action	
Passing the FAF	PM	<i>"Final approach fix."</i>	
	PF	<i>"Roger, sterile cockpit, confirm before landing checks completed."</i>	
	PM	<i>"Affirm, before landing checks completed."</i>	(If previously omitted, the before landing checks shall be performed now)
Passing 1,000 ft above runway threshold	PM	Checks if approach is stable.	
Unstable -> Go-around			
If approach is unstable	PM	<i>"Passing 1,000 ft, unstable, go-around."</i>	
	PF	<i>"Roger, going-around, go-around checks."</i>	Presses the "GA/TU" button on the collective.
	PM	Performs go-around checks.	<i>"Go-around checks completed."</i>
Stabilized -> Continue			
If approach is stabilized	PM	<i>"Passing 1,000 ft, stabilized, continue."</i>	
	PF	<i>"Roger, continuing."</i>	
At 500 ft above MDA / DH	PM	<i>"500 ft to minimums."</i>	
	PF	<i>"Checked."</i>	
At 100 ft above MDA / DH	PM	<i>"100 ft to minimums, looking out."</i>	Checks landing environment in sight.



50 ft above MDA / 20-30 ft above DH	PF	<i>"Approaching minimums."</i>	
No visual -> Go-around			
Landing environment not visual	PM	<i>"Negative visual, go-around!"</i>	
	PF	<i>"Roger, going-around."</i>	Presses the "GA/TU" button on the collective.
Passing 1,000 ft AGL	PM	<i>"1,000 ft."</i>	
	PF	Checks altitude / height.	<i>"Checked, go-around checks."</i>
	PM	Performs go-around checks.	<i>"Go-around checks completed."</i>
Visual -> Continue			
Landing environment in sight	PM	<i>"Visual, look up for sight xx o'clock."</i>	
	PF	Checks landing environment in sight.	<i>"Visual, continuing, final checks."</i>
	PM	Performs final checks.	<i>"Final checks completed."</i>
At LDP / CAT B Gate	PM	<i>"LDP." / "Gate."</i>	
	PF	<i>"Landing."</i>	

7.5.16.2 Offshore Approach

7.5.16.2.1 Offshore Stabilized Approach

For commercial air transport operations to offshore helidecks, whenever the obstacle situation allows, the helicopter shall be stabilized prior to reaching a point 0.5 NM from the deck at 300 ft ALS.



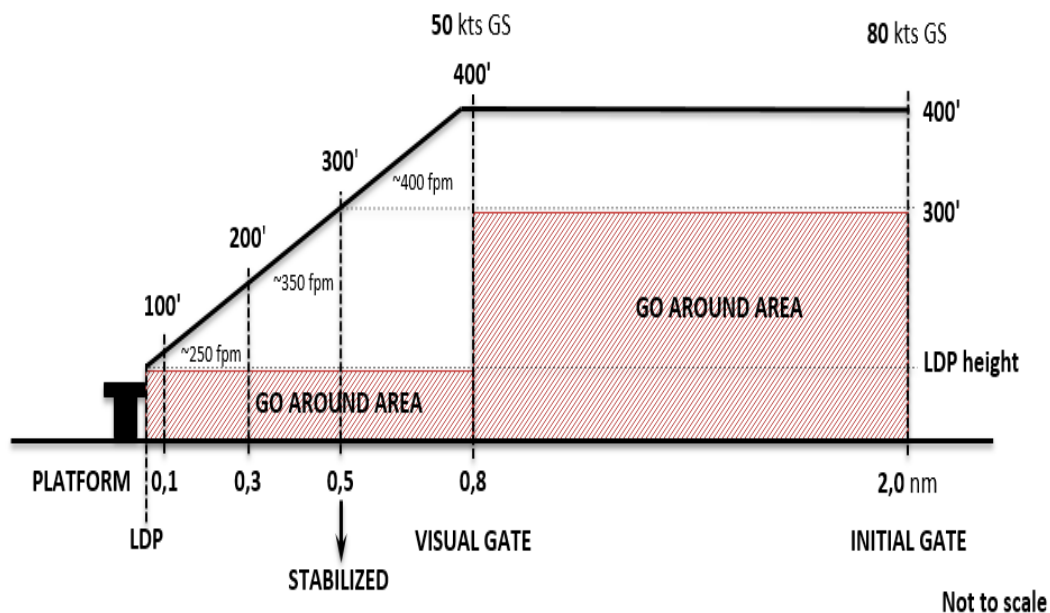
For the approach to the deck, the helicopter shall be maneuvered to arrive at a point 2 NM from the helideck, at a height of 400 ft ALS, with a ground speed of 80 kts (initial gate).

From there, a level deceleration shall be performed to achieve and maintain a ground speed of 50 kts.

At 0.8 NM (visual gate), the upper modes of the FD should be disengaged and the final descend be initiated according to the following profile.

At 0.5 NM, the helicopter shall be stabilized on final track (no tailwind component allowed) and ground speed shall be reduced linearly (0.4 NM: 40 kts, 0.3 NM: 30 kts, 0.2 NM: 20 kts) while continuing the descent.

HEIGHT IN FEET ABOVE DECK ELEVATION



For multi pilot operations, the following "common" standard phraseology shall be applied.

Additional type specific calls and/or actions may be necessary.

These are described in the respective OM-B.

Offshore stabilized approach and landing

The deck height in this example is 200 ft AGL.

Entry conditions:

1. 1,500 ft AMSL, cruise speed
2. ALTA preselected to 1,500 ft.
3. Initial gate set as waypoint in FMS.



4. HDG bug selected to briefed go-around heading.

Event	PF / PM	„Phraseology” and/or Action	
At 4 NM from initial gate	PM	<i>“4 NM to the gate, descent 600 ft.”</i>	
	PF	<i>„Roger, engage RHT 600.”</i>	
	PM	Engages RHT, starts beeping to 600 ft.	<i>“RHT engaged, confirm.”</i>
	PF	Checks RHT on PFD upper modes.	<i>“Confirmed.”</i>
When 600 ft is selected	PM	<i>“600 ft selected, confirm.”</i>	
	PF	Checks 600 ft set on PFD and magenta.	<i>“Confirmed, 600.”</i>
When passing 1,000 ft AGL	PM	<i>“Passing 1,000 ft.”</i>	
	PF	Checks altitude / height.	<i>“Checked.”</i>
At 2 NM from initial gate	PM	<i>“2 NM to the gate, reduce 80.”</i>	
	PF	<i>“Reducing 80, before landing checks.”</i>	Reduces speed to 80 kts GS.
	PM	Completes Before Landing Checks.	<i>“Before Landing Checks completed.”</i>
At the initial gate	PM	<i>“At the gate, reduce 50.”</i>	
	PF	<i>“Reducing 50.”</i>	Reduces speed to 50 kts GS.
At 1.0 NM	PM	<i>“1 NM, standby for descent.”</i>	



	PF	<i>"Roger, standing by."</i>	
At 0.8 NM (visual gate)	PM	<i>"0.8, look up for sight 12 o'clock."</i>	
No visual -> Go-around			
If PF not visual with the helideck	PF	<i>"Negative, going-around."</i>	Presses the "GA/TU" button on the collective and adjusts HDG as required.
Passing 1,000 ft AGL	PM	<i>"1,000 ft."</i>	
	PF	Checks altitude / height.	<i>"Checked, go-around checks."</i>
	PM	Performs go-around checks.	<i>"Go-around checks completed."</i>
Visual -> Continue			
If PF visual with the helideck	PF	<i>"Visual, descending, final checks."</i>	Presses "FD STBY" / "ATT" button on cyclic and reduces collective smoothly to achieve an initial 400 ft/min ROD.
	PM	Performs final checks.	<i>"Final checks completed."</i>
At 0.5 NM	PM	<i>"0.5, check 500."</i>	
	PF	Checks RHT at or slightly above 500 ft.	<i>"Checked."</i>
	PM	Checks if approach is stable.	
Unstable -> Go-around			
If approach is unstable	PM	<i>"Unstable, go-around."</i>	



	PF	<i>"Roger, going-around."</i>	Presses the "GA/TU" button on the collective and adjusts HDG as required.
Passing 1,000 ft AGL	PM	<i>"1,000 ft."</i>	
	PF	Checks altitude / height.	<i>"Checked, go-around checks."</i>
	PM	Performs go-around checks.	<i>"Go-around checks completed."</i>
Stabilized -> Continue			
If approach is stabilized	PM	<i>"Stabilized, continue."</i>	
	PF	<i>"Roger, continuing."</i>	Continues shallow descent and starts to decelerate slowly by raising the nose.
At 0.3 NM	PM	<i>"0.3, check 400."</i>	
	PF	Checks RHT and speed (ca. 30 kts GS)	<i>"Checked."</i>
At 0.1 NM	PM	<i>"0.1, check 300"</i>	
	PF	Checks RHT and speed (15 / 20 kts GS).	<i>"Checked."</i>
	PM	<i>"Continue visual."</i>	
	PF	<i>"Roger, continuing."</i>	
Unsafe to land (before LDP) -> Go-around			



If at any point before LDP the PF feels unsafe to land	PF	<i>"Going-around."</i>	Performs balked landing procedure.
	PM	<i>"Roger, going-around."</i>	
At V_{TOSS} and positive ROC	PM	<i>"V_{TOSS} climbing."</i>	
	PF	Checks IAS and positive ROC.	<i>"Checked, engage ALTA, (IAS) and HDG."</i>
	PM	Presses ALTA, (IAS) and HDG buttons on APCP.	<i>"ALTA, IAS and HDG engaged, confirm."</i>
	PF	Checks upper modes on PFD and beeps IAS to V_Y .	<i>"Confirmed, accelerating V_Y."</i>
Passing 1,000 ft AGL	PM	<i>"1,000 ft."</i>	
	PF	Checks altitude / height.	<i>"Checked, go-around checks."</i>
	PM	Performs go-around checks.	<i>"Go-around checks completed."</i>
Safe to land -> Continue			
At LDP	PM	<i>"LDP."</i>	
	PF	<i>"Landing."</i>	Performs landing.
	PM	<i>"Roger, landing."</i>	

7.5.16.3 Landing Position on a Helideck

The helicopter position on a helideck shall be as far forward as possible with the whole landing gear within the yellow touch down circle, but not so much forward that it is impossible to pass the helicopter around the nose, specifically for the AW169 where the baggage compartment can only be accessed from



the left.

7.6 Standard Briefings

7.6.1 Departure Briefing

When the departure clearance for a VFR or IFR departure is received and the FMS is setup accordingly, a departure briefing shall be performed.

7.6.1.1 VFR Departure Briefing

For a visual departure, the minimum items to be briefed shall cover:

1. Runway to be used.
2. VFR departure route and points (if available).
3. Initial altitude / altitude restrictions along the departure route.

7.6.1.2 IFR Departure Briefing

1. For an IFR departure, the PF shall conduct the departure briefing by reading the briefing section of the SID plate. This briefing section contains all necessary information for the departure.
2. The PM follows the briefing and confirms the navigational set up.
3. The SID plate shall be ready for use on both pilot's sides.

7.6.2 Take-off Briefing

For a visual departure, the minimum items to be briefed shall cover:

1. Runway to be used.
2. VFR departure route and points (if available).
3. Initial altitude / altitude restrictions along the departure route.

7.6.3 Approach Briefing

In preparation for an approach for landing or low approach / go-around, an approach briefing shall be performed as part of the approach checks

7.6.3.1 VFR Approach

For a visual approach, the minimum items to be briefed shall cover:

1. Runway / helideck to be used.
2. Field / helideck elevation (for home field, elevation may be omitted).
3. Pattern entry procedure to be used.
4. Pattern altitude (if used).



7.6.3.2 IFR Approach

For an IFR approach, once the aerodrome weather is checked and the appropriate approach requested, the PM shall set up the approach in the FMS and tune and identify the required nav aids.

Afterwards, the PM shall conduct the approach briefing by reading the briefing section of the approach plate. This briefing section contains all necessary information for the approach.

Once the PM has completed the briefing, the PF shall hand over the controls, confirm the navigational set up, and familiarize himself with the approach. The approach plate shall be ready for use on both pilot's sides.

7.6.4 Landing Briefing

The landing briefing shall be kept as short as possible and refer to described standards.

The minimum items to be briefed shall cover:

1. Landing profile (CAT A clear area, elevated helideck, ...).
2. Runway / helideck to be used.
3. Pilot landing.
4. LDP (height / speed).

Example:

"We will perform a CAT A elevated helideck landing on DolWin Alpha. Right seat pilot will be landing. LDP is at 260 ft AGL with 15 kts / 20 kts. standard calls and actions."

7.6.5 HNVGO Briefing

7.7 Emergency Procedures

In all emergency situations it is essential that a complete distribution of responsibilities exists.

PF will keep the helicopter flying safely.

PM will assist/monitor the PF as necessary and handle the emergency according to the emergency checklist.

The HSUSA designated PIC may consider re-arranging duties of PF and PM as required.

As soon as an emergency has been identified and acknowledged by both PM and PF (but not before), the appropriate WARNING or CAUTION light shall be cancelled, in order to re-arm the system for a new indication.

During the take-off and landing phase or when flying at low altitudes, all emergency procedures, except for immediate actions required to maintain helicopter control, shall be handled either on ground (after landing / rejected take-off) or at a safe height (500 ft AGL for memory items, 1,000 ft AGL for checklists).



The PF calls for the (emergency) checklist to be performed.

Following a malfunction or degradation of a system and where a procedure calls for a reset, "only one" attempt may be tried unless a different number of attempts is specifically stated in the emergency checklist.

7.7.1 Simulation of Emergency Procedures

Simulation of abnormal or emergency procedures as well as simulation of IMC by artificial means are strictly forbidden when passengers or cargo are being carried.

7.7.2 Allocation of Duties

[14 CFR § 135.83(a)(2)]

The **PF** will continue to fly the aircraft.

The **PM** will handle any emergencies and malfunctions, including securing engines and switching off systems if required by the nature of the emergency. He will also brief the passengers and normally make any distress calls when required.

If the commander is the PF, he has to consider whether to hand over control, in order to better manage the situation. In any event, he shall ensure that the passengers and any additional crew in the cabin are briefed as soon as practical.



7.7.3 General Actions

For handling abnormal and/or emergency situations, the following basic methodology shall be applied whenever possible:

Maintain aircraft control

1. The pilot recognizing a failure or malfunction calls *"(type of) malfunction"* or *"WARNING"* and *"CAUTION"* with the appropriate caption (such as "FIRE").
2. PF controls the aircraft to achieve a stable safe flight condition or an immediate landing as appropriate. In or close to a hover over a safe surface, PF lands and deals with the emergency on the ground. In the air, PF attains a safe flight configuration.

Analyze the situation

1. PM identifies and states all the displayed warnings and cautions for the PF to acknowledge, then cancels the Master WARNING or CAUTION, starts diagnosing and states the problem to PF.
2. PF continues to fly the aircraft safely. Both pilots confirm the symptoms and agree on the diagnosis of the problem. When PF has the aircraft under control and is ready to deal with the follow-up, he calls for *"Immediate actions"*.

Take proper action

1. PM then carries out, or coordinates, the memory items, stating clearly what he is doing. PM shall be precise and methodical so that PF can monitor the his actions. When the memory items are completed, PM will call *"Immediate actions completed"*. If there are none, PM states *"No immediate actions"*. At this point PF will call for the *"Emergency checklist"*.
2. PM starts reading the emergency checklist including the boxed immediate actions / memory items, to confirm they were carried out correctly. He then carries out the other items using the emergency checklist as a "read and do" list (that is, read the item then carry out the action).
3. PM then states *"Emergency checklist completed"*.
4. PF then calls for the *"Normal checklist"*, if applicable (for example, after takeoff or before landing).

The PF shall decide and call for each type of action or checklist appropriate for the phase of flight. For example, if a fire happens on final approach it may be wise to conduct the before landing checks between the memory items and the emergency checklist. PF shall continue to fly the aircraft, maintaining a safe profile (speed, altitude, track and N_R), while PM administers the emergency.

7.7.4 Crew Coordination

1. If an emergency occurs, it is usually accompanied by a master caution/warning light. The master caution/warning shall not be acknowledged until both pilots have confirmed the emergency.
2. After confirming the emergency, the PF shall call for the *"immediate actions"*. If applicable, the memory itmes shall be completed by the PM using dual-concurrence with PF on critical systems (e.g. engine mode switches, ECLs, fire arm buttons, etc.).



3. When the memory items are completed, PM shall call out ***"immediate actions completed"***.
If there are no memory items for the respective emergency, PM shall call out ***"no immediate actions"***.
4. After the memory items have been completed, PF shall call for the ***"emergency check list"***. PNF shall confirm the appropriate drill in the QRH with the PF by holding the QRH next to the PF's CAS list (day) or reading the exact drill name to the PF (night) to cross-check with the CAS message.
5. After the emergency check list has been reported complete by PM (***"emergency check list completed"***), PF shall call for the ***"normal check list"*** as required. PM shall then complete the applicable normal check list (e.g. before landing checks).



Example:

Event	PF / PM	<i>"Phraseology"</i> and/or Action	
Master caution light with associated CAS message	PM	Checks and reads out CAS message	<i>"1 DC GEN FAIL, acknowledge."</i>
	PF	Confirms CAS message and acknowledges the master caution	<i>"Acknowledged. Immediate actions."</i>
	PM	<i>"Immediate actions."</i>	
	PF	<i>"Roger. Emergency check list."</i>	
	PM	Holds the appropriate page of the QRH next to the PF's CAS list for comparison	<i>"1 DC GEN FAIL. Confirm."</i>
	PF	Cross-checks CAS list with QRH and confirms correct QRH procedure is selected	<i>"Confirmed."</i>
	PM	Completes the emergency check list reading out all applicable items notes, cautions, and warnings	<i>"Emergency check list completed."</i>
If normal check list required	PF	<i>"Roger. Normal check list."</i>	
	PM	Completes the applicable normal check list	<i>"Normal check list completed."</i>
	PF	<i>"Roger."</i>	

7.7.5 MAYDAY and PAN PAN Calls

The commander is responsible for transmitting the distress call.

The call shall be transmitted on the appropriate frequency, where contact is established, the emergency frequency or any other suitable frequency.

MAYDAY-MAYDAY

The call "MAYDAY" shall be used during emergency situations where trajectory control is severely limited or an immediate landing needs to be performed.

For example:

1. Double engine failure.
2. Tail rotor failure.
3. Flight control failure.



4. Loss of MGB lubrication.
5. Fire.

PAN-PAN

The call "PAN-PAN" shall be used during all other emergencies or abnormal conditions necessitating a distress call.

7.7.6 Activation / Deployment of CPI

In certain emergency situations, especially offshore, it may be considered to select the CPI to TRANSMIT in flight to assure that emergency services are alerted.

However, depending on the mod status of the CPI, once selected to TRANSMIT, the CPI may not automatically deploy either by means of the g-switch or the water-activated switch, unless a system reset has first been performed by pressing the TEST / RESET button on the cockpit control panel.

Crews should be aware that if the CPI has been selected to TRANSMIT on the aircraft, it may not be released in the event of a ditching unless the system is reset by pressing the TEST / RESET button on the control panel.



7.7.7 Cockpit Voice Recorder

[14 CFR § 135.151]

The Cockpit Voice Recorder (CVR) must be operated continuously from the use of the checklist before the flight to completion of the final checklist at the end of the flight.

When a CVR is installed, and in the event of an accident, or occurrence requiring immediate notification of the NTSB which results in termination of the flight, the certificate holder shall keep the recorded information for at least 60 days or if requested by the Administrator, for a longer period.



8 EMERGENCY AND ABNORMAL PROCEDURES

8.1 General

8.2 Definitions

8.3 Ground and In-Flight Emergencies

[14 CFR § 91.123, 135.19, 135.23(d) and 135.123]

Emergency Procedures. In the event of a known in-flight emergency, precautionary landing, or lost communications, the HeliService USA Communications Center (CC) will:

1. Immediately notify the Director of Operations (DO). In the event the Director of Operations is not available, one of the following individuals will be contacted in this order:
 - a. Chief Pilot (CP).
 - b. Director of Safety.
 - c. Director of Maintenance (DOM).
2. Once notified, the responsible manager shall contact the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) and or National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB), as appropriate.
3. Using the last known coordinates and the time elapsed since the last Position Report, the comm center shall contact the emergency response organization responsible for the area (nearest town fire department, state police, etc.) in an attempt to locate the aircraft.
4. The Pilot in Command (PIC) will back up all emergency procedures with the Rotorcraft Flight Manual (RFM) Emergency Procedures (EP) Checklist. The SIC will assist the PIC during the EP.
5. The PIC may deviate from the rules of Federal Aviation Regulations 14 CFR Part 135 relating to aircraft, equipment, and weather minimums if an emergency (during flight or otherwise) arises to the extent required to address that emergency.
6. If the PIC deviates from a rule in 14 CFR Part 135, the pilot shall, within ten (10) business days after such deviation, send to the Certificate Holding Flight Standards District Office, a complete report of the aircraft operation involved, including a description of the deviation and reasons for the deviation.
7. The PIC will notify ATC of a deviation as soon as possible if the PIC has to deviate from an ATC clearance or instruction in an emergency or when responding to a traffic alert and collision avoidance system resolution advisory.
8. If the PIC is given priority handling in an emergency, but does not deviate from a rule of 14 CFR Part 91 or Part 135, the Pilot shall submit a detailed report of that emergency within 48 hours to the manager of that facility, if requested by Air Traffic Control (ATC). (14 CFR § 91.123)

8.4 Emergency Evacuation



[14 CFR § 135.23(m)(q), 135.123(a)]

The PIC is responsible to ensure that all passengers are properly briefed as to location and use of all survival equipment, and emergency exits.

The PIC is responsible for the execution of those procedures which are necessary for control of the aircraft and equipment as is necessary to meet the emergency situation, as listed below:

1. As soon as possible after the landing, the PIC should check on the condition of all passengers, count them, and make them as comfortable as conditions allow. The decision to activate rescue beacons (EPIRB, ADELT, ELT, etc) should be made at this time.
2. Passengers should be given additional instructions or assistance as early as practical in the event it becomes necessary to abandon the aircraft before rescue facilities arrive. When there is an SIC, the PIC should delegate these functions to him. The PIC shall ensure that each person who may need assistance to move to an exit (and that person's attendant, if any) has received a briefing as to the procedures to be followed if an emergency evacuation becomes necessary. The person needing assistance will be placed in the most practical position to facilitate his access to an exit without impeding the exit of other passengers.

8.5 Precautionary Landing

A precautionary landing will be made in the event the pilot feels that his aircraft is not operating properly or he has an indication that there has been a malfunction, and a considerable delay in checking this could affect the safety of the flight.

The pilot will report to the communications center giving his intentions, place of landing, malfunction if known, and assistance required, if known. The aircraft will not be flown until properly released for flight if the precautionary landing was made due to a suspected maintenance issue.

8.6 Emergency Forced Landing

When a pilot is forced to make an emergency forced landing over land areas, he will attempt to make the landing in terrain suitable to the type landing gear and the nature of the emergency. The pilot will attempt to make radio contact and give his position to the nearest radio station during the descent.

All personnel will remain at the landing site unless no radio contact was made, and they are only a short distance from a populated area. In this case, the pilot will attempt to notify the nearest operational base by telephone.

8.7 Inadvertent Instrument Meteorological Conditions (IMC)

The Pilot's primary responsibility is to maintain control of the aircraft. Pilots will perform the following:

1. Transition to Instrument Scan.



2. Wings level / Nose attitude for cruise flight - Turn Only to Avoid Known Obstacles.
3. Engage autopilot (if equipped) - Initiate GA mode.
4. Apply climb power - Top of Maximum Continuous Power.
5. Adjust attitude to climb airspeed - Set airspeed between Airspeed - Best Rate of Climb (Vy) (maximum climb rate) and Vyi (Instrument Climb Speed).
6. Climb to or maintain safe altitude - Minimum Safe Altitude (MSA), Minimum Obstacle
7. Clearance Altitude (MOCA), or Minimum Enroute Altitude (MEA) as required.
8. Use standard rate turns.
9. Communicate with ATC (on last assigned frequency or on guard frequency).
10. Request an Instrument Flight Rules (IFR) clearance (as applicable).
11. Continue flight as appropriate.

8.8 Special Emergency (Air Piracy)

1. If a hijacking is threatened, the pilot will attempt to comply with all requests of the hijacker to prevent any chance of injury or loss of life.
2. The pilot will notify ATC by radio and, if the aircraft is so equipped, squawk code 7500 on the transponder. If unable to reach ATC and/or time permitting they will also notify the HSUSA comm center.
3. The DO or CP will also notify ATC will then coordinate follow-up action with local, state and federal law enforcement agencies.

8.9 Aircraft Accident / Incident Notification

The use of HeliService USA email and cell phones are the preferred methods for all notifications. Email alerts will go to all pertinent managers as soon as the report is submitted. The PIC of an aircraft must ensure the HSUSA Dispatch Center is notified as soon as possible after the occurrence of any of the following events:

1. Serious injury to HSUSA personnel or personnel other than HSUSA.
2. Substantial damage to HSUSA equipment or equipment other than HSUSA.
3. Environmental damage.
4. Fuel spill.
5. Engine failure or shutdown in flight.
6. Smoke in the cockpit or cabin.
7. Hydraulic failure.
8. Precautionary landing due to a mechanical malfunction.
9. Hot Starts.

Immediate Notification – Emergency

The Aviation Department is responsible for submitting the required NTSB form 6120.1 "Pilot/Operator



Aircraft Accident/Incident Report" that serves as official notification to the NTSB. To facilitate the timely submission of the form when required, it is imperative that any occurrence that involves any of the conditions above be documented via email to the Director of Safety as an Aircraft Occurrence as soon as possible. It is paramount to include as much information as possible, and describe exactly what transpired. The Aviation Safety Manager will transfer the email information to the NTSB form and submit it to the correct parties. 49 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) 830.5 requires an operator of an aircraft to immediately, and by the most expeditious means available, notify the nearest NTSB field office when an aircraft accident occurs or any of the following incidents occur:

1. Flight control system malfunction or failure.
2. Inability of any required flight crewmember to perform normal flight duties as a result of injury or illness.
3. Failure of any internal turbine engine component that results in the escape of debris other than out the exhaust path.
4. In-flight fire.
5. Aircraft collision in flight.
6. Damage to property, other than the aircraft, estimated to exceed \$25,000 for repair (including materials and labor) or fair market value in the event of total loss, whichever is less.
7. A complete loss of information, excluding flickering, from more than 50 percent of an aircraft's cockpit displays including: Electronic Flight Instrument System (EFIS), Engine Indication and Crew Alerting System (EICAS), Electronic Centralized Aircraft Monitor (ECAM) displays, or other displays of this type, which generally include a primary flight display (PFD), primary navigation display (PND), and other integrated displays.
8. Airborne Collision and Avoidance System (ACAS) resolution advisories issued when an aircraft is being operated on an instrument flight rules flight plan and compliance with the advisory is necessary to avert a substantial risk of collision between two or more aircraft.
9. Damage to helicopter tail or main rotor blades, including ground damage that requires major repair or replacement of the blade(s).

8.10 Events Requiring FAA/NTSB Notification

[14 CFR § 135.415 and NTSB 830]

14 CFR § 135.415(A)(16) requires a report anytime a component or system malfunction requires the crew to take "emergency action." Since the term "emergency action" is ambiguous, HSUSA employees shall submit a report anytime the PIC declares an emergency and receives priority handling from ATC.

8.11 Damage to Aircraft or Property

1. The PIC will inform the Director of Operations of any incident/accident prior to further flight. The Director of Maintenance will dispatch an Aviation Maintenance Technician (AMT) to make an on-site determination of airworthiness of the aircraft.



2. If damage is sufficient to make the aircraft non-airworthy or other property is damaged, the pilot will contact the Director of Operations, the Chief Pilot, or the Chief Operating Officer-Transport, as soon as possible. Management will notify the FAA/NTSB and other appropriate authorities as required. (See PAIP for detailed reporting procedures and contact information.)
3. If damage is slight, prior to further flight, the Director of Maintenance or the Director of Maintenance's representative will determine the airworthiness of the aircraft. Director of Operations or Chief Pilot will notify the FAA/NTSB and other appropriate authorities as required. Any discrepancy to the aircraft will be corrected before further flight or the Director of Maintenance will contact the Flight Standard District Office (FSDO) in regards to a obtaining a Special Flight Permit (Ferry Permit).
4. In all cases, accident reporting procedures will be in full compliance with the provisions of 49 CFR Part 830 (the NTSB regulations).

8.12 Hazardous Meteorological Condition or Irregularity

[14 CFR § 135.67 and 91.187]

Whenever an HSUSA pilot encounters a potentially hazardous meteorological condition or an irregularity in a ground facility or navigation aid in flight, which he or she considers to be essential knowledge to the safety of other flights, the pilot will notify an appropriate ground radio station as soon as practical. HSUSA PIC's operating in controlled airspace under IFR must report as soon as practical to ATC any aircraft navigational, approach, or communication equipment that fails in flight.

8.13 Lost Communications

[14 CFR § 91.186]

Unless otherwise authorized by ATC, HSUSA Pilots that have a two-way radio communications failure when operating under IFR shall comply with the following:

1. VFR conditions: If the failure occurs in VFR conditions, or if VFR conditions are encountered after the failure, each pilot shall continue the flight under VFR and land as soon as practicable.
2. IFR conditions: If the failure occurs in IFR conditions, or if paragraph "A." of this section cannot be complied with, each pilot shall continue the flight according to the following:
 - a. Route. By the route assigned in the last ATC clearance received.
 - b. If being radar vectored, by the direct route from the point of radio failure to the fix, route, or airway specified in the vector clearance.
 - c. In the absence of an assigned route, by the route that ATC has advised may be expected in a further clearance.
 - d. In the absence of an assigned route or a route that ATC has advised may be expected in a further clearance, by the route filed in the flight plan.



3. Altitude: At the highest of the following altitudes or flight levels for the route segment being flown:
 - a. The altitude or flight level assigned in the last ATC clearance received.
 - b. The minimum altitude (converted, if appropriate, to minimum flight level as prescribed in 14 CFR § 91.121(c)) for IFR operations.
 - c. The altitude or flight level ATC has advised may be expected in a further clearance.
4. Leave clearance limit:
 - a. When the clearance limit is a fix from which an approach begins, commence descent or descent and approach as close as possible to the expect-further- clearance time if one has been received, or if one has not been received, as close as possible to the estimated time of arrival as calculated from the filed or amended (with ATC) estimated time enroute.
 - b. If the clearance limit is not a fix from which an approach begins, leave the clearance limit at the expect-further-clearance time if one has been received, or if none has been received, upon arrival over the clearance limit, and proceed to a fix from which an approach begins and commence descent or descent and approach as close as possible to the estimated time of arrival as calculated from the filed or amended (with ATC) estimated time enroute.

8.14 Restriction or Suspension of Operations: Continuation of Flight in an Emergency

[14 CFR § 135.69]

If a certificate holder or PIC knows of conditions, including airport and runway conditions, that are a hazard to safe operations, the certificate holder or PIC, as the case may be, shall restrict or suspend operations as necessary until those conditions are corrected.

No PIC may allow a flight to continue toward any airport with suspended or restricted operations, unless, in the opinion of the PIC the conditions that are a hazard to safe operations may reasonably be expected to be corrected by the estimated time of arrival or, unless there is no safer procedure. In the latter event, the continuation toward that airport is an emergency situation under § 135.19.



9 PASSENGER AND CARGO HANDLING

9.1 Authorized Passengers

Only the following persons may be carried on board:

1. Flight crewmembers and flight crewmember trainees.
2. Passengers assigned to the specific operation to which the aircraft is assigned.

No person may operate a company aircraft, nor may any guests accompany crew members, for any purpose other than that required for company or customer business without prior approval from a Company Officer, the DO, or Chief Pilot.

9.1.1 Customs Requirements & Process

Responsibility:

1. While HeliService USA Dispatch should inform the PIC of any customs requirements for any offshore flights, the PIC is the ultimately authority responsible for ensuring customs clearance of the aircraft and aircrew. They shall also notify Customs that their services are required if dispatch has not done so already.
2. The customer is responsible for Customs clearance of the passengers and cargo.

When US Customs is required, the PIC should determine from the customer or HeliService USA which Customs Agent is being used to clear Customs. The PIC should then contact that agent at least two hours prior to arrival in the U.S. with the following information:

1. Crewmember's names
2. Dates of birth
3. Social Security Numbers
4. Aircraft N-number
5. Type aircraft
6. Name of vessel or location from which flight is to depart
7. Estimated time of arrival and location of flight returning to the U.S.

The Customs Agent will prepare the Crew Declaration using the above information. When the aircraft lands, the agent will present the Declaration to the PIC for signature; then clear the crewmembers and aircraft. At that time the aircraft is free to continue operations within the U.S.

Note: The PIC is not responsible for the clearance of passengers or cargo, but should provide any assistance possible in clearing U. S. Customs.

9.2 Passenger Briefing Procedures

[14 CFR § 135.117(a)(b)]



Before each takeoff the PIC shall ensure that all passengers have been briefed. When the aircraft to be flown has minor configuration differences to that shown in the video safety briefing, a verbal briefing to a documented script either on the aircraft or with reference to illustrations of the differences should be provided before flight.

Whether the briefing is given orally or by play-back device, the following information will be covered:

1. Smoking: Smoking is not allowed in HeliService USA aircraft.
2. Alcohol: No person may drink any alcoholic beverage aboard an aircraft.
3. Instruction on use of Seatbelts and Shoulder Harnesses: How to fasten/unfasten Seatbelts and Shoulder Harnesses. Direction that seatbelts and shoulder harnesses (if installed) must be fastened during all flights. Compliance with crew instruction is required.
4. Do not unfasten the belts until the aircraft is completely on the ground.
5. Seat Backs: Seat backs are to be placed in an upright position before takeoff and landing.
6. Doors and Emergency Exits: Location of passenger entry doors, emergency exits, and the means for opening passenger entry doors and emergency exits.
7. Lighted Passenger Signs: Compliance with the lighted passenger information signs.
8. Survival Equipment: Location of survival equipment (life rafts, EPIRB's, emergency kits, etc.).
9. Ditching Procedures: In the event of a forced landing at sea, the float landing gear is capable of supporting the helicopter; however, life vests are to be worn on all over water flights. In the event it becomes necessary to use the vest, they are inflated by a quick pull on the two lanyards, if two lanyards are installed, at the bottom of the vest. Do not inflate a vest in the aircraft; be sure you are well clear of the aircraft before inflation. If a life vest should lose some of its buoyancy after inflation, the lost air can be replaced by blowing into one of the oral tubes located on each side of the vest. One tube inflates the front section and the other tube inflates the rear section.
10. Location and Use of the Fire Extinguishers: To use the fire extinguisher, remove it from the mounting bracket, pull the safety pin, point the nozzle at the base of the flame, and depress the extinguisher handle. Spray the agent until the bottle is empty or the fire is extinguished. Use other extinguisher as required or available. Do not use the fire extinguisher in an enclosed area unless directed by the pilot, unless open flames are visible, or time is a major constraint.
11. Ground Operations: During ground operations, never walk in back of the helicopter or under the tailboom. Avoid the tail rotor area completely. Keep head and objects low when near or under main rotor blades. Do not approach or depart the helicopter without the pilot's approval. Do not approach or depart the helicopter from straight out in front. Use 45 degrees angle in sight from either side.
12. PED: Cellular telephones and other non-approved devices shall be powered off or in airplane mode at all times. The use of approved devices is permitted in cruise flight only.
13. Before takeoff the PIC shall ensure that each person who may need the assistance of another person to move expeditiously to an exit if an emergency occurs and that person's attendant, if any, has received a briefing as to the procedures to be followed if an evacuation occurs. This paragraph does not apply to a person who has been given a briefing on a previous leg or flight in the same aircraft.



14. In addition to the briefing, the following procedures will be adhered to: No passenger who appears intoxicated will be carried aboard the aircraft.
15. Altitudes: If the flight involves operations above 12,000 feet MSL, the normal and emergency use of oxygen will be covered.
16. Supplemental Briefing Cards: The location of Supplemental Briefing Cards.

When a passenger briefing system is installed, it shall be used in addition to any oral or video briefings conducted outside the aircraft by non crewmembers, or other authorized persons. Additionally:

1. A crewmember must monitor the briefing to ensure sound quality and volume are understandable, and the briefing is played in its entirety before takeoff.
2. All passengers must be seated with seatbelt fastened.
3. Main cabin doors closed when possible to reduce ambient noise.
4. If the briefing system malfunctions a complete oral briefing will be given by a crewmember.

No person may assault, threaten, intimidate, or interfere with a crewmember in the performance of the crewmember's duties aboard an aircraft being operated under this part. Should this situation occur, the following procedures will be followed:

1. Non-compliant passengers will be removed prior to departure or at the soonest possible opportunity.
2. Should a passenger become violent, dangerous, or physically abusive, the crew will restrain the passenger if needed/possible, and land the aircraft at the nearest suitable location. They will contact law enforcement and have them meet the aircraft to have the passenger removed.
3. In both cases the CHDO will be notified via phone or email and the occurrence will be detailed with the following:
 - a. Date and time of the occurrence.
 - b. Any injuries or aircraft damage.
 - c. Whether law enforcement was notified or needed.
 - d. Did the aircraft have to divert from it's intended point of landing.

9.3 Carriage of Cargo Including Carry-on Baggage

[14 CFR § 135.87(a)(b)(c)(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6)(7)(d)(e)]

1. The PIC is responsible for the supervision and proper loading of all cargo (including checked baggage) and carry-on baggage. The pilot will ensure:
 - a. It is loaded within weight and balance limits.
 - b. It does not impose any load on seats or on the floor structure that exceeds the load limitation for those components.
 - c. It is carried in an approved bin or compartment.
 - d. That cargo is secured by an approved means.
 - e. That carry-on baggage is restrained so as to prevent its movement during air turbulence.



2. Note: If hot-loading passengers and/or cargo, the aircrew member supervising the on load or off load will relay to the PF (Pilot on the controls during load/unload) upon completion:
 - a. Number of Passengers on board.
 - b. Passengers are secured.
 - c. Total weight of cargo on board.
 - d. Cargo secured.
 - e. Fuel cap and cowlings secured.
3. Cargo and carry-on baggage shall not be located in a position that obstructs the access to, or use of, any emergency or regular exit which would normally be accessible from the compartment in which the passenger is seated, unless it is located in or upon an FAA approved cargo device. It shall not be located in a position that obstructs the use of the aisle between the crew and the passenger compartment, or located in a position that obscures any passenger's view of the "seatbelt" sign, "no smoking" sign or any required exit sign.
4. Cargo or carry-on baggage shall not be stowed under a passenger seat.
5. For cargo only operations (flight crew only) the above paragraph does not apply if the cargo is loaded so that at least one emergency or regular exit is available to provide all occupants of the aircraft a means of unobstructed exit from the aircraft if an emergency occurs.
6. At least one entry door shall remain open until the required crew member or ground ops personnel incase of hot loading, ensures all items are properly stowed.
7. Prior to loading any object four feet or over in length, the aircraft shall be shut down and the rotor stopped. This is to prevent a possible blade strike. If qualified persons are handling each end of objects longer than four feet, they may be loaded with the rotor turning.
8. If any cargo is Hazardous Material, refer to the Hazardous Program and Acceptance guide.
9. All personal items (flight crew) must be secured prior to flight. No loose articles are allowed on the flight deck. Pilots will be responsible to ensure all items are removed/secured from the cockpit at the end of the day. Flight bags (flight crew only) may be left in the aircraft provided all equipment is secured within it in the event it must be moved to facilitate daily maintenance.

9.4 Use of Safety Belts and Child Restraint Devices

[14 CFR § 135.128(a)(1)(2)(i)(ii)(A)(B)(1)(2)]

Seatbelts and shoulder harnesses (if installed) of all occupants (to include crewmembers) must be fastened during all flights. They shall be fastened prior to the first movement of the aircraft for takeoff and remained fastened until the aircraft is completely stopped on the ground.

A child which has not reached the age of two years old shall be either held by an adult, or placed in a child restraint system, which must be properly secured to a forward facing seat, and the child must not exceed the specified weight limit for the restraint system. Any "in-lap" child shall also be provided with and wear flotation device if operating outside of auto-rotational distance of land. The restraint system must bear one or more of the following labels:



Seats manufactured from Jan 1, 1981-Feb 25, 1985 must bear the following label: "This child restraint system conforms to all applicable Federal motor vehicle safety standards."

Seats manufactured on or after Feb 26, 1995 must bear two labels:

1. This child restraint system conforms to all applicable Federal motor vehicle safety standards.
2. "THIS RESTRAINT IS CERTIFIED FOR USE IN MOTOR VEHICLES AND AIRCRAFT".

HeliService USA will not permit a child to occupy a booster-type, vest-type, harness-type, or lap-held CRS during takeoff, landing, and movement on the surface, except when the CRS has been approved by the FAA through a TC, STC, TSO, under § 21.305(d) (2010 ed.), or under § 21.8(d). Booster-type, vest-type, and harness-type CRSs approved by the FAA through a TC, STC, TSO, under § 21.305(d) (2010 ed.), or under § 21.8(d), may be used during all phases of flight.

HSUSA will not permit a child, in an aircraft, to occupy a booster-type child restraint system, a vest-type child restraint system, a harness-type child restraint system, or a lap held child restraint system during take off, landing, and movement on the surface.

9.5 Passenger Embarkation and Disembarkation

All persons responsible for handling the HeliService USA aircraft on the ground (including the loading and unloading of cargo and embarkation/disembarkation of passengers) shall be given detailed instructions for the performance of their duties in respect of all aircraft types for which they will be employed. Such personnel include the HSUSA technical crew, task specialists and ground crew. In cases where outside ground personnel are deployed, the PIC is responsible for ensuring that said personnel are given adequate instructions.

It is the PIC's duty and responsibility to escort the passengers from/ to the aircraft to/ from the arranged meeting or farewell point; this could be a business lounge, handling reception, at passport control etc. depending on the aerodromes or operating sites facilities. If this is not possible, the PIC has to ensure that appropriate ground handling staff escorts the passengers.

The PIC must assist all passengers in embarking and disembarking, ensuring that the passengers do not experience any discomfort or difficulties and are advised of any possible danger areas in order to ensure they are not put at risk. The PIC must always be aware of the position of servicing and loading vehicles at or near the exits.

1. Passengers should be assisted in the carrying of personal belongings, without invading the passengers privacy concerning sensitive belongings.
2. Passengers must always be accompanied.
3. Passengers shall always be kept together in a group.
4. Passengers must be kept away from the danger areas such as engines and rotors.
5. Area used for embarkation and disembarkation should be kept as free as possible from any anti/de-ice fluid, oil or contamination.



It is the PIC's duty and responsibility to escort the passengers from/ to the aircraft to/ from the arranged meeting or farewell point; this could be a business lounge, handling reception, at passport control etc. depending on the aerodromes or operating sites facilities. If this is not possible the PIC has to ensure that appropriate ground handling staff escorts the passengers. Any special circumstances concerning additional passenger transport will be noted by administration staff in the crew briefing documentation.

For pre-boarding and passenger briefing procedures reference 9.2.

9.5.1 Passenger Control

1. The PIC shall ensure all occupants are at their seats with safety belts and shoulder harness fastened during surface movement, takeoff, and landing.
2. After landing, if the aircraft is to be shut down, passengers are to remain on board until the rotors have come to a complete stop. This procedure does not preclude offloading passengers then repositioning the aircraft for shutdown.
3. In two pilot crews, where no HLO or crew chief is present, the pilot monitoring (PM) shall supervise the loading and unloading of passengers and cargo. PM will ensure number of passengers and cargo weight is reflected on the applicable manifest. Upon completion of loading, the PM will ensure proper security of passengers, cargo, and doors.
4. After landing, if the aircraft is to be shut down, passengers are to remain seated until the rotors have come to a complete stop.
5. No one shall approach or depart the aircraft (under the rotor system) during initial start or rotor coast down.

9.5.2 (De) Boarding Onshore

Boarding is performed by own staff of HeliService USA at the stations or by trained airport staff at other airports. In exceptional cases the flight crew can take over boarding on site.

During boarding it must be observed:

1. That the "OUT manifest" corresponds to the weight and number of passengers stated in the briefing.
2. That the passengers arrive at least one hour before departure.
3. That upon request of customers a drug / alcohol test is performed.
4. That the passenger identification numbers correspond to the manifest.
5. That the passenger weight corresponds to the manifest and that any possible changes are entered in the manifest.
6. That the passenger luggage corresponds to the manifest regarding size and weight and that any possible changes are entered in the manifest.
7. That the relevant survival suits are provided and put on properly.
8. That the PLB is activated, if applicable.
9. That the safety video is shown in English.



10. That a security check (depending on the airport) is performed.
11. That the PPE is checked, if applicable.
12. That safe access to the helicopter in the parking position is ensured.
13. That safe boarding into the helicopter (also with rotating rotors) is ensured.
14. That proper buckling-up of the passengers is ensured.
15. That proper closing of the doors of the helicopter is ensured.
16. That subsequent clearance for the helicopter to take off has been given by the boarding crew.

De-boarding is performed by own staff of HSUSA at the HSUSA stations or by trained airport staff at other airports. In exceptional cases the flight crew can take over de-boarding on site. During de-boarding it must be observed:

1. That the "Manifest IN" is handed over for subsequent verification of the passengers / passenger identification numbers with the manifest in the check-in area.
2. That proper opening of the doors of the helicopter is guaranteed.
3. That proper unbuckling of the passengers is guaranteed.
4. That safe de-boarding from the helicopter (also with rotating rotors) is guaranteed that safe access to the check-in area from the parking position is guaranteed.
5. That a security check (depending on the airport) is performed.
6. That the PLB is activated, if applicable.
7. That the relevant survival suits are returned properly.

9.5.3 (De) Boarding Offshore

Boarding is only performed by the trained board staff on the relevant flight decks. In exceptional cases the flight crew can take over boarding on site. Before de-boarding the helicopter must be secured with blocks against unintentional rolling, after consultation with the pilot. If necessary, the helicopter must be secured additionally on the flight deck according to the RFM.

During de-boarding the following must be observed:

1. That the "Manifest OUT" is handed over for subsequent verification of the passengers / passenger identification numbers with the manifest in the check-in area proper opening of the doors of the helicopter.
2. That proper unbuckling of the passengers is guaranteed that safe de-boarding from the helicopter (also with rotating rotors) is guaranteed that a security check (depending on the ship) is performed.
3. That the PLB is activated, if applicable.
4. That the relevant survival suits are returned properly.

During boarding it must be observed:

1. That the passengers arrive at least one hour before departure.
2. That upon request of customers a drug / alcohol test is performed.



3. That the passenger identification numbers correspond to the manifest.
4. That the passenger weight corresponds to the manifest and that any possible changes are entered in the manifest.
5. That the passenger luggage corresponds to the manifest regarding size and weight and that any possible changes are entered in the manifest.
6. That the relevant survival suits are provided and put on properly.
7. That the PLB is activated, if applicable.
8. That the safety video is shown.
9. That a security check (depending on the ship) is performed.
10. That the PPE is checked, if applicable.
11. That safe access to the flight deck is guaranteed.
12. That safe boarding into the helicopter (also with rotating rotors) is guaranteed.
13. That proper buckling-up of the passengers is guaranteed.
14. That proper closing of the doors of the helicopter is guaranteed.
15. That subsequent clearance of the helicopter for take-off is given by the responsible HLO on the flight deck by hand signals or by radio.

9.6 Oxygen for Medical Use

[14 CFR § 135.91]

1. When any type of oxygen dispensing and/or storage equipment is carried onboard, smoking is prohibited.
2. Medical oxygen dispensing equipment may be carried onboard, and used in flight, only when operated by an individual trained in the use of medical oxygen. In this case, the oxygen is not treated as Hazardous Material. Take care to secure the oxygen bottle to protect all valves, fittings, and gauges from damage.
3. Oxygen of any type which is onboard solely for transportation from one location to another shall be treated as Hazardous Material. Refer to the HAZMAT Program and Acceptance Guide.

9.7 Carriage of Drugs

[14 CFR § 135.41]

The PIC may allow narcotic drugs, marijuana, and depressant or stimulant drugs onboard the aircraft when they are under the control of either certified medical or law enforcement personnel.

9.8 Carriage of Firearms

[14 CFR § 135.119(a)(b)]



1. Firearms may be carried on or about a person onboard HeliService USA aircraft by officials or employees of a municipality or a state, or of the U.S., who are authorized to carry arms.
2. Additionally, non-government firearms may be transported onboard HeliService USA aircraft under the following procedures:
 - a. The firearm is declared and unloaded.
 - b. The firearm and ammunition are enclosed in a suitable container.
 - c. The firearm and ammunition are not removed from the container while inside the aircraft.

9.9 Passenger use of PED's

[14 CFR § 135.144(a)(b)(1)(2)(3)(4)(6)(c)]

In general, larger electronic devices (computers, etc.) shall be turned off and packed in baggage. Cameras must be secured in baggage unless prior approval for use in the cabin is obtained from both the HeliService USA and Customer. The use of certain smaller portable electronic devices may be allowed when flying helicopters with HSUSA in the U.S. as shown below.

1. Certain PED's or smaller portable electronic devices such as smart phones (Android, iPhone, Blackberry, etc.), iPods, MP3 players, smaller tablets and e- Readers can be carried in the aircraft cabin and may be used during cruise flight conditions.
2. The device must be small enough as to allow storage in a passenger pant or jacket pocket.
3. The device must be off and secured in a clothing pocket during helicopter safety video briefings, both on and offshore, and transiting to and from the aircraft at the heliport and offshore helideck.
4. The device must be capable of airplane mode and it shall be off and secured in a clothing pocket or stowed in a seat pocket during ground taxi, takeoffs and landings and in turbulent flight conditions where flight crew will direct passengers to turn off and secure the PED.
5. Use of these devices will only be permitted during cruise flight and must be in the off positions secured at all other times.
6. If a device is inadvertently dropped, do not remove your seatbelt to retrieve it or ask anyone else to do so. Wait until after landing and instructed to remove your seatbelt before attempting to recover your device.
7. Lost or damaged devices are not the responsibility of HSUSA.
8. Use of wired in-ear headphones is authorized in line with the use of PEDs (only worn when PED use is authorized). Use of Bluetooth/wireless headphones is prohibited. The complete set of headphone cables shall be secured in a pant or jacket pocket at all times the PED also needs to be secured. Assure that cabin emergency PA announcement can still be heard when using headphones.
9. Passengers are responsible for maintaining the security of all items carried onto the aircraft.
10. No video or other recordings are allowed unless specifically approved by Customer and HSUSA.
11. Failure to comply with these instructions could result in denial of access to HSUSA and/or Customer contracted flights.



12. Computers either laptop or notebook shall not be utilized in the helicopter cabin. All computers must be turned off and stored in the baggage compartment for flight. Video, Cassette and disc players, computers, or other electronic equipment such as battery operated soldering irons must be declared at check-in. The listed electronic equipment may be allowed in passenger baggage but only if the power switch is placed in the off position or the batteries removed.
13. In-flight cell phone may result in false cockpit indications if a call is transmitted to the phone. It is imperative that cell phones be in airplane mode or off during flight.

9.10 Carriage of Persons Without Briefing Compliance

Employees of HeliService USA are not required to receive a Part 135 briefing when carried onboard HSUSA aircraft. However, all passengers, to include HSUSA employees shall be briefed on the use of the seatbelts and shoulder harness (when installed). This does not relieve the PIC from his responsibility of ensuring passenger safety. Therefore, an HSUSA employee shall be given a Part 135 briefing, when in the PIC's judgment the employee demonstrates unfamiliarity with the aircraft.



10 FUEL PROCEDURES AND POLICIES

10.1 General

This section contains procedures for fueling HeliService USA helicopters, avoiding fuel contamination, protecting against fire, including electrostatic protection, supervising and protecting passengers during fueling. All personnel shall be familiar with their responsibilities as related to these fuel procedures and policies. The policies and procedures will be made available to fuel vendors and fuel service personnel. Competent personnel, adequate facilities and equipment must be present before any fueling operations may take place.

HSUSA does not own it's own or operate it's fuel dispensing vehicles (i.e. trucks, tanks, or vessels) and will utilize FBO fuel services for it's fueling operations. HSUSA will take every measure as outlined in chapter 10 and 11.28 to ensure that the fueling process and procedures are trained and implemented to it's staff.

10.2 Aviation Fuel Handling and Fire Safety

1. Clothing:

- a. NOMEX and other types of clothing are well known for their ability to build and retain static electricity, particularly if wool or silk undergarments are worn. To prevent arcing and possible fire, personnel involved in refueling operations shall periodically dissipate static electricity by touching bare skin to bonding points not in the vicinity of any fumes during refueling. Also, care must be taken to not spill fuel on clothing. A crew member must not perform flight duties in fuel- contaminated clothing. Prior to removing, immediately saturate fuel contaminated NOMEX and clothing with water to suppress static electricity and lower the flash point and flammability of the fuel.
 - i. Remain clear of ignition sources and quickly remove clothing.
 - ii. Wash exposed skin with soap and water to reduce the possibility of chemical burns from liquid fuel.

2. Equipment:

- a. Fueling equipment or fuel trucks must have a positive low point sump and adequate fire extinguishers present.

3. Electrostatic Protection:

- a. Static electricity can be a source of ignition. Bonding the fuel source to the helicopter and bonding the fuel nozzle to the helicopter prior to opening a fuel cap will help dissipate an unequal charge. The fuel source and nozzle must remain bonded to the helicopter throughout the refueling process, as fuel passing through the refuel hose will build a static charge. It can take up to two minutes to completely dissipate a static charge. A bonding wire or cable is the preferred bonding instrument and if available, will be used.
- b. A fixed station pump or fuel truck bonding wire will be connected to the helicopter first,



after which the fuel nozzle bonding wire will be attached to the helicopter.

4. Thunderstorms:
 - a. Refueling operations are not permitted when active thunderstorms with lightning are detected within five (5) miles of the refueling site. Sound travels at approximately 1100 ft/sec or about one (1) mile in five (5) seconds. Using a flash to bang time of 25 seconds will approximate five (5) miles. With very widespread or intense thunderstorms, good judgment may dictate a farther distance.

10.3 General Refueling Process

1. Refueling shall be accomplished by qualified individuals only. FBO, HSUSA pilots and maintenance technicians are qualified to refuel HSUSA helicopters.
2. Ensure that proper eye protection is worn by anyone performing refueling operations.
3. Ensure the fuel nozzle is never blocked in the open position.
4. Prior to beginning refueling or defueling, note the location and serviceability of the fire extinguisher.
5. Bond (ground) fuel nozzle to aircraft.
6. If an object is accidentally dropped into a fuel tank, alert maintenance, the object must be removed before further flight is attempted.
7. If a hose nozzle has been dropped or placed on the ground, it shall be cleaned before further use.
8. Remove bond ground from aircraft only after fueling is completed.
9. Ensure fuel cap is secured before leaving or re-boarding aircraft.
10. Do not drag fuel nozzles along the ground or heliport surface.
11. Properly return and stow the refueling equipment prior to take off.
12. Smoking is prohibited within 100 feet of the helicopter.
13. To preclude the possibility of electrical discharge or other fire hazard, do not transmit on radio(s).
14. If there is an operational requirement for passengers to remain on the aircraft or maintenance technicians to work on the helicopter during refueling operations:
 - a. The door closest to the fueling port will remain closed.
 - b. The PIC or a crewmember shall remain with passengers and alert them if there is a need to evacuate the aircraft.
 - c. The cargo door or cockpit door opposite will remain open to allow for a clear egress in the event of an emergency.
 - d. Egress and rendezvous procedures will be briefed with passengers prior to refueling occurring.

10.4 Refueling Emergencies

1. Fuel Spill:
 - a. Take immediate action as necessary to minimize the fuel spill. (Activate Emergency Fuel Pump shut off valve, place catch bins under fuel leak, etc.).
 - b. Ensure all potential ignition sources are removed or shutdown.



- c. Immediately notify HeliService USA management and the responsible Fixed Base Operator (FBO).
 - d. The PIC will assist HSUSA and FBO management with determining the amount of fuel spilled, the party responsible for the fuel spill, appropriate clean-up procedures and associated costs, as well as notification of airport authorities and the fire department if required.
2. Fire:
- a. Immediately stop fueling. Activate emergency shut-off if available.
 - b. Request emergency help by any means possible.
 - c. Take the appropriate fire extinguisher to the location of the emergency.
 - d. Position yourself upwind of the spill or fire.
 - e. Remove the safety pin.
 - f. For fires, activate agent.
 - g. Point nozzle at base of flame.
 - h. Move nozzle back and forth in rapid motion.
 - i. After fire is extinguished, back away and watch for flare-up.
 - j. Notify as appropriate – 911, HSUSA and / or FBO management.

10.5 Hot Refueling Procedures

Helicopter Rapid Refueling (HRR), engine(s)/rotors operating, can be conducted safely when utilizing trained personnel and observing safe practices. Therefore the following HRR procedures and conditions shall be followed:

1. Firefighting capability is available and manned.
2. A qualified pilot shall be at the controls.
3. Reduce power to idle RPM unless conditions dictate otherwise.
4. Use of radio voice transmissions shall be avoided during refueling unless in emergency circumstances.
5. The radar shall be switched to standby.
6. The refueler shall be a HeliService USA employee or an individual verified as having completed HRR training.
7. All doors, windows, and access points allowing entry to the interior of the helicopter that are adjacent to or in the immediate vicinity of the fuel inlet ports should be kept closed during HRR operations.
8. The aircraft, fuel supply and fuel hose are grounded before removing the fuel cap and inserting the fuel nozzle into the aircraft fuel tank.
9. Passengers may remain onboard during HRR (unless the PIC or client requirements dictate otherwise).
 - a. If necessary for safety or required by the customer, discharge passengers to a safe waiting area prior to commencing HRR operations.
 - b. Passengers will be briefed on an evacuation route to follow to clear the area.



- c. All seat belts are unfastened.
 - d. The door(s) opposite the fueling point shall be open to facilitate emergency egress.
 - e. A person is stationed at the helicopter door to communicate with the passengers if they remain on board, and assist evacuation in the event of a fire. This person has visual contact with the refueling operator.
- 10. Do not board or disembark passengers during HRR operations nor will cargo be loaded or unloaded.
 - 11. Confirm with ground personnel that refueling equipment has been removed from the landing area, is properly stowed, and locked prior to takeoff.
 - 12. After refueling, a member of the crew verifies to the flight crew that all equipment has been removed, the fuel cap has been replaced securely and the aircraft is properly configured for flight.

10.5.1 Hot Refueling From Truck

Rapid refueling from trucks must be approved by the DO or Chief Pilot, and is not considered a routine operation. If rapid refueling has been approved, the pilot shall ensure the following.

- 1. Follow the fueling procedures under HRR.
- 2. Ensure that the main rotor blades are no closer than 20 feet from the truck and ensure the truck is at least 50 feet from the aircraft fuselage.

Cold refueling from trucks may be accomplished in accordance with cold refueling procedures. The pilot or other crewmember shall remain in the vicinity of the aircraft when a fuel truck is maneuvering to or from the aircraft to ensure proper clearances.

10.6 Remote/Offshore Refueling Facilities

Reserved for future use.

10.7 Aircraft Fuel Contamination Procedures

10.7.1 Aircraft Fuel Sumping

Aircraft Fuel Sumping

- 1. The primary concern is to ensure fuel quality by checking for visual signs of water, contamination, and correct fuel type, etc.
- 2. Aviation Maintenance Technicians (AMT's) and HeliService USA pilots will comply with the manufacturer's recommended procedures described in each Approved Rotorcraft Flight Manual (RFM). Each HeliService USA helicopter has an Approved Rotorcraft Flight Manual (RFM) available via the EFB or there is a hard copy available via the DO/CP.
- 3. AMT's or Pilots will sump the helicopter fuel system daily.
 - a. The fuel will be sumped and stored in a glass jar (at least ten (10) ounces in size) and labeled with the helicopter registration number, date, time, tank (L or R) and location for



- each tank.
 - b. Use fuel water detectors to test the fuel.
 - c. Whoever takes the sample shall verify the fuel is free of water and contaminants by initialing the sample jar.
 - d. If the sample is not free of contaminants and water, additional samples shall be taken until an acceptable sample is received or the fuel is suspected to be contaminated. If contaminated fuel is suspected, refer to paragraph 10.7.2 below.
 - e. The jar shall be stored in a specified location designated by the Director of Maintenance or their designated representative. The fuel sample will be retained until the next day when the process is repeated. The sample fuel will be disposed of in the 55 gallon waste fuel drum provided for the purpose at each base.
 - f. In the event that no AMT is available, trained HSUSA pilots will sump fuel from the helicopter.
4. The sumped fuel shall be inspected daily by the PIC or HSUSA designated SIC at the start of the shift. Pilots will verify the fuel to be free of water and contaminants. The pilot will indicate the sample is satisfactory by initialing the sample jar.

10.7.2 Procedures for Contaminated Fuel

1. If fuel contamination is suspected, contact the Director of Operations or the Director of Maintenance for guidance and further testing, or if needed, helicopter defueling.
2. In the event of fuel contamination or improper fuel grade, the tanks shall be drained by appropriate service personnel and refueled to the PIC's satisfaction. This procedure applies to operations both at and away from the base of operations. Any fuel drained or spilled by a helicopter fuel sump will be considered contaminated and not suitable for use.



11 MAINTENANCE AND INSPECTIONS

11.1 General

1. HeliService USA is responsible for the airworthiness of the company helicopters and shall have its aircraft maintained under 14 CFR Part 135. If an aircraft is operated under 14 CFR Part 91 HeliService USA will ensure that one of the following is accomplished:
 - a. The aircraft maintenance continues to adhere to the maintenance program at all times.
 - b. The aircraft undergoes an appropriate airworthiness conformity check prior to being operated under 14 CFR Part 135 again.
2. Defects that occur between required maintenance shall be repaired under 14 CFR Part 43
3. All maintenance discrepancies discovered before takeoff are considered grounding items and shall be addressed in accordance with the methods outlined in this chapter prior to takeoff.

11.2 Maintenance General Requirements

1. HeliService USA will maintain its aircraft under Federal Aviation Regulations (FAR) 14 CFR § 135.411 (a)(1) using adequate facilities and equipment.
2. Inspections of aircraft, engines, rotors, accessories and appliances will be performed by Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) approved repair stations under 14 CFR Part 145, or appropriately certificated technicians in accordance with the manufacturers recommended intervals and practices.
 - a. HeliService USA will employ appropriately certificated Aircraft Maintenance Technicians (AMTs) to perform or supervise maintenance, preventive maintenance, and alterations in accordance with appropriate sections of 14 CFR Part 43, 91, 119, and 135. Each person who is directly in charge of maintenance, preventive maintenance, or alterations will hold an appropriate airman certificate for the specific operation concerned.
 - b. A certificated repairman may not perform or supervise duties under the repairman certificate unless the repairman understands the current instructions of the certificate holder and the manufacturer's instructions for continued airworthiness relating to the specific operations concerned
 - c. HeliService USA will have a maintenance facility capable of performing maintenance, alteration, or preventive maintenance on an aircraft, engine, propeller, or appliances with the proper tools, equipment, and test apparatus necessary to ensure completion of the work per accepted industry practices in accordance with the manufacturers service manuals, parts manuals, and Airworthiness Directives.
3. All maintenance, preventive maintenance and alterations will be performed in accordance with the most current manufacturers instructions, Instructions for Continued Airworthiness, component maintenance manuals, FAA regulations, and Airworthiness Directives. When using electronic publications, or when using printed material, the user must verify that it is the most current version prior to use. If there is any doubt about the revision status contact the Director of



Maintenance.

4. Additionally, any personnel working on HeliService USA aircraft will participate in an approved drug and alcohol program.
5. HeliService USA prohibits the operation of an aircraft unless it:
 - a. Is registered as a civil aircraft of the United States.
 - b. Carries an appropriate current airworthiness certificate.
 - c. Is in airworthy condition.
 - d. Meets the applicable airworthiness requirements of 14 CFR Part 135, including those relating to identification and equipment.

11.2.1 Inspections and Scheduled Maintenance

1. All company aircraft will be inspected and maintained in accordance with 14 CFR Part 91 and 14 CFR § 135.421. The inspection forms found in the current revision of the manufacturers maintenance manual will be used when performing inspections and maintenance in accordance with the manufacturers recommended inspection program.
2. Current inspection checklists for installed Optional Equipment, (those items not manufactured by the Airframe or Engine manufacturer) Instructions for Continued Airworthiness, are found on the aircraft home page under the "Documents" tab in Digital AirWare and in the applicable aircraft folder on the HeliService USA SharePoint drive. The Director of maintenance, or designee, will ensure that only the current checklists are available on these sites.
3. All technicians performing inspections will use the applicable inspection form and follow the instructions for that particular form.

Note: If an item on an inspection form is Not Applicable to the aircraft, the technician shall annotate that section with "N/A" and enter the reason for the non-applicability with their initials. Example: "N/A Not Installed".

4. Each person performing an inspection required by Part 91 on a rotorcraft shall inspect the following systems in accordance with the maintenance manual or Instructions for Continued Airworthiness of the manufacturer concerned:
 - a. The drive shafts or similar systems.
 - b. The main rotor transmission gear box for obvious defects.
 - c. The main rotor and center section (or the equivalent area).
 - d. The auxiliary rotor on helicopters.
5. All completed forms are required to be filled out, scanned into Digital AirWare to the associated work order, and kept on file until the inspection has been superseded.
6. A maintenance record entry shall be made for all maintenance performed. The entry shall contain the following information:
 - a. A description (or reference to data) that fully describes the work performed. For inspections; the type of inspection and a brief description of the extent of the inspection.



- b. The date of completion of the work or inspection performed.
- c. The aircraft's total time when the work or inspection was completed.
- d. The signature, certificate number, and kind of certificate held by the person approving the work. An Aviation Maintenance Technician's signature constitutes the approval for return to service for his work. When a pilot performs the work, he must add "returned to service" to the entry.
- e. For inspections, the following or a similarly worded statement – "I certify that this aircraft has been inspected IAW (insert type) inspection and was determined to be in airworthy condition."
- f. When the aircraft is found to have un-airworthy items, the following or a similarly worded statement - "I certify that this aircraft has been inspected in accordance with (insert type) inspection and a list of discrepancies and unairworthy items dated (date) has been provided for the aircraft owner or certificate holder"
- g. Any person performing any inspection required by 14 CFR Part 91 or 135.411(a)(1) that finds the aircraft is unairworthy will give the owner or lessee a signed and dated list of discrepancies found including those permitted to be inoperative under 135.179.

11.2.2 Maintenance General Requirements for Night Vision Imaging System (NVIS) Equipped Aircraft

The following requirements apply to NVIS equipped aircraft listed in HeliService USA OpSpec D093.

1. The aircraft NVIS system will be maintained in accordance with the Supplemental Type Certificate (STC), or Manufacturers Service Bulletin (SB) Instructions for Continued Airworthiness.
 - a. Any aircraft modifications to the cockpit, cabin, or exterior, involving light emitting or reflecting systems shall be evaluated IAW the limitations and conditions of the NVIS STC or SB.
 - b. HeliService USA will ensure that all NVIS inspection personnel are trained IAW manufacturers recommended procedures.
 - c. The DOM will ensure that all maintenance personnel are trained in any new equipment, procedures, or techniques that pertain to maintaining the NVIS IAW the STC or SB.
 - d. Maintenance personnel will complete initial and recurrent ground training for NVGs using the same ground training program that is utilized by the aircrew.
2. Night Vision Goggles (NVGs) will be maintained in accordance with the following documents.
 - a. General Operations Manual (GOM).
 - b. The latest revision of the Night Vision Goggle technical manual.
3. All HeliService USA Night Vision Goggle inspection due times will be tracked in Digital AirWare.
4. HeliService USA will use an FAA approved vendor for all NVG goggle maintenance requirements and scheduled inspections.

11.3 Maintenance Tracking Program



HeliService USA utilizes Digital AirWare, which is a web-based computer maintenance tracking program with related purchase order and inventory management modules. In the following paragraphs the terms "Digital AirWare" and "Computerized Maintenance Tracking Program" or simply "the program" may be used interchangeably.

1. Digital AirWare will be used to track and forecast; all inspections, retirement items, overhaul items, recurring bulletins, recurring Airworthiness Directives (AD's), applicable Code of Regulations (CFR's), any major alteration or repairs, Instruction for Continued Airworthiness (ICA), and any other required items. The tracked items are measured in days, cycles, hours, and time remaining as applicable to each aircraft.
2. This System will be used by HeliService USA pilots to record current aircraft flight times, landings, and engine times and cycles on a daily basis through the Flight Log "Forms" section. The recording of these items will track the following:
 - a. The total time in service of the airframe, engines, rotors, and appliance.
 - b. The current status of life-limited parts of each airframe, engine, rotor, and appliance to include Time Since New (TSN), Time Since Install (TSI), and Time remaining.
 - c. The Time Since Overhaul (TSO) of each item installed on the aircraft and time remaining for required overhaul items.
 - d. Current inspection status of the aircraft, including the time since the last inspections required by the inspection program under which the aircraft and its appliances are maintained, and time remaining until next due.
 - e. Current inspection / maintenance status of any emergency equipment assigned to or installed in the aircraft.
 - f. Airworthiness Directives compliance status for all applicable AD's and time remaining until next due if it is a repetitive AD.
3. Digital AirWare will also be used by HeliService USA AMT's to record all scheduled and unscheduled maintenance performed on the aircraft, utilizing a discrepancy/work order system and added to electronic log books to organize and track all maintenance performed.
 - a. Digital AirWare Discrepancies section are ID numbered under the aircrafts home page and discrepancies tab. Each discrepancy entered will entail the Tail number and Serial number, along with the aircraft and engines total time and cycles at the time of the discrepancy entry and attached to a ID numbered Work Order.
4. HeliService USA will also use Digital AirWare to utilize electronic Flight and Maintenance log entries.
5. Digital AirWare will also be used by HeliService USA pilots and AMT's to record and track MEL / NEF program items that have been performed. These maintenance records will be organized and tracked through the use of log book entries and filed according to airframe, engine, etc. and shall be kept in the program as permanent records.
6. The program will be administered by the Director of Maintenance, or designee, who will ensure the completeness and accuracy of the program at all times.
7. All procedure and instructions for pilots and AMT's in the use of Digital AirWare are located on HeliService USA SharePoint drive.



8. Digital AirWare will be accessible via the aircraft EFB by flight crew, AMT's and other appropriate personnel for Airworthiness review, recording or deferring mechanical irregularities, and their correction. In the event that Digital AirWare is inaccessible due to remote location, Form M-09 will be used.

11.3.1 Modifying Items or Intervals Tracked in Digital AirWare

Any change to intervals or the addition of items to the Digital AirWare Maintenance Tracking Software will be approved by the Director of Maintenance (or designee).

11.3.2 Electronic Signatures and Electronic Record Keeping

HeliService USA will employ the use of Digital Signatures and Electronic Record Keeping within the Digital AirWare system and the HeliService USA SharePoint drive, as referenced in appendix C of this manual and OpSpec A025.

1. These signatures and records are in a controlled format and will be utilized by the maintenance technicians for all scheduled and un-scheduled maintenance and discrepancy sign offs and return to service statements.
2. The pilots will also utilize the same system for Pre Flight inspection sign offs and proper deferral of approved MEL and NEF items, and certain inspection sign offs, i.e. power checks, pre-flight checks, as well as security and attachment check.
 - a. Pilots may utilize Complete Flight Software to digitally sign Flight Risk Assessment Tools (FRATs) IAW Appendix C of this manual.
3. All HeliService USA authorized personnel will be kept on file for management of the program. The program is controlled by the Director of Maintenance for certain access rights.

11.4 Aircraft Status Reporting

The Director of Maintenance will ensure that all individuals with Tier 1 Operational Control authority will be updated on a daily basis with regards to the airworthiness status of each aircraft in the fleet. This will be accomplished in the following manner:

1. All management personnel will be given read-only access to Digital AirWare to view the real time status of all upcoming inspection requirements, ADs, SBs, and MEL open items.
2. All management personnel will be given read-only access to Digital AirWare to view the real time Base Operational Status and receive an automated email for any changes.
3. The Director of Maintenance, or designee, will ensure that after a discrepancy has been created for an aircraft in Digital AirWare, that an automated email will be sent out to notify the pilot group, maintenance group, HeliService USA Communications Center and Tier 1 Operational Control personnel, noting the aircraft registration number, discrepancy time, and date of discrepancy.
4. The Director of Maintenance, or designee, will ensure that after a deferred maintenance item has been created for an aircraft in Digital AirWare, that an automated email will be sent out to notify



the pilot group, maintenance group, HeliService USA Communications Center, and Tier 1 Operational Control personnel, noting the aircraft registration number, discrepancy time, and date of the MEL.

5. The Director of Maintenance, or designee, will ensure that when all scheduled and un-scheduled maintenance has been completed for an aircraft, that the system is updated, and an automated email will be sent out to notify the pilot group, maintenance group, HeliService USA Communications Center and Tier 1 Operational Control personnel, noting the aircraft registration number, time, and date aircraft is back in service.

The Director of Maintenance may add additional items.

11.5 Determining Aircraft Airworthiness/Availability for Flight or Release

This section provides pilots and qualified mechanics with procedures for determining aircraft airworthiness. If there is any question concerning the airworthiness of an aircraft - STOP - contact both Maintenance and/or Operations. Do not fly (to include hover) the aircraft until it is determined to be airworthy, or a ferry permit is issued stating that it has been determined that the aircraft is safe to fly.

At the beginning of each day's work shift, the pilot shall ensure the aircraft is airworthy and safe for the intended operation by adhering to the procedures in the following paragraphs.

The pilot in command will be responsible for determining the aircraft current inspection status, MEL/NEF items, and that the aircraft has been "returned to service" after any maintenance, inspection, alteration, or report of flight discrepancy.

1. HeliService USA will use Digital AirWare Maintenance Tracking Program for tracking airworthiness information. The Director of Maintenance is responsible for the currency and accuracy of the information for all aircraft.
2. The Pilot in Command will review the aircraft status in Digital AirWare at the start of their shift and check the maintenance history and previous flights. The PIC will check the next inspections coming due under the Aircraft's Home Page "Quick View" tab. Once in the Quick View the pilot can ascertain the inspection status of the aircraft. Digital AirWare is the primary means for a pilot to determine if the helicopter is available for flight.

Note: The Digital AirWare program is the primary method for confirming airworthiness. Once logged into the program, HeliService USA's homepage will appear. Next to each individual helicopter there is a traffic light status notification with a color coded status indicator to show the operational availability of the aircraft. (Examples: Red = Not in airworthy condition, Yellow = inspection due in less than 10 hours, an MEL item or non-grounding discrepancy, Green = next inspection due in ten (10) hours or more.) In the case of a RED light, the pilot will contact the maintenance department for further details.

3. The PIC will cross check the current aircraft and engine total times and cycles from the latest



Digital AirWare Flight and Maintenance Log page against the Flight Log Forms page for accuracy.

4. The Pilot in Command is responsible for determining helicopter airworthiness, and will verify airworthiness by reviewing the following on the Digital AirWare Aircraft Status page:

- a. Check for all upcoming inspections by selecting and opening the "Quick View" tab and ensuring that no Inspections, Overhaul/Retirement Components, ADs, ASBs, ICAs, or Deferred Maintenance items are projected to come due for estimated flight.
- b. Check for any MEL/NEF items for adequate time remaining for the intended flight. All MEL/NEF items are found on the Aircraft Status page in the "MEL" tab with the time remaining until expiration. The pilot will select the "MEL" tab to view any items. Additionally, the pilot will check the MEL discrepancy in the OPEN MEL's section in Digital AirWare to see if any "O" or "M" procedures need to be applied before the next flight.

Note 1: The MEL tab has parentheses () with the number of MEL'd items, if any, and is also color coded RED to alert the pilot in command if an MEL item is overdue.

Note 2: All MEL items will also be displayed under the "Quick View" tab.

- c. Check for discrepancy items under the "Discrepancies" tab. This can be viewed to see the last 30 days of discrepancies for the aircraft. If there are any current open discrepant items, the tab will be RED and there will be a number in parentheses to indicate how many discrepant items are listed.

Note 1: The Discrepancies tab has parentheses () to indicate how many discrepant items, if any, and is also color coded RED to alert the pilot in command that a discrepancy has not been addressed.

Note 2: All discrepancy items will also be displayed under the "Quick View" tab.

- d. Check that the aircraft has been approved by maintenance for "return to service" after any maintenance, inspection, alteration, or report of flight discrepancy. This can be determined in the following manner:
 - i. By checking the "Discrepancies" tab to ensure there are no open discrepancies.
 - ii. By consulting the Log Book section of Digital AirWare and checking the Airframe and Engine log books for the latest maintenance sign offs. Both inspection items and discrepancies will have scanned copies of the completed Aircraft/Engine Manufacturer Inspection Guides attached to them that can be viewed for further information in the Digital AirWare system.

11.6 PIC Preflight Responsibility

The Pilot in Command of any of HeliService USA aircraft is directly responsible for, and is the final authority as to the operation of that aircraft.

1. It will be the responsibility of the Pilot in Command to ensure that the inspection status of the



aircraft is current, and that inspections will not come due before the planned completion of the flight.

2. The Pilot in Command will also be responsible to have mechanical irregularities corrected or deferred prior to flight and for ensuring that any MEL deferred maintenance items do not affect the operational capability of the aircraft.
3. The Pilot in Command will also be responsible for the decision of flight, ensuring that MEL deferred maintenance items do not affect the operational capability of the aircraft, the pilots decision may take precedence over the provisions contained in the MEL Remarks section. If the pilot interprets the irregularities or feels that in view of climatic conditions enroute, the aircraft should not depart with these irregularities, the pilot will contact and coordinate with the Director of Maintenance and with the Director of Operations regarding their decision.
4. The pilot in Command shall not depart on a flight with an unreported or non-logged aircraft discrepancy, nor continue a flight if the aircraft is believed to be in an unairworthy condition.

11.6.1 Pilots Pre-Flight/Post-Flight Duties

1. At the start of their shift, PICs are required to ensure their assigned aircraft is airworthy. A preflight must be completed by an AMT or the PIC to determine that. The shift AMT will create an electronic Flight and Maintenance log entry in Digital AirWare and electronically sign the Pre-Flight Inspection Block. In the case there is not an AMT available the shift PIC will create an electronic Flight and Maintenance log entry in Digital AirWare and electronically sign the Pre-Flight Inspection Block.
2. By digitally signing the Pre-Flight Inspection in Digital AirWare the pilot is attesting to having reviewed the aircraft airworthiness and completed a preflight inspection to include any Instruction for Continued Airworthiness (ICA) preflight inspections (RFMS) as per this manual.
3. PICs will enter the total flight time and cycles for the shift flown into the "Forms" section of Digital AirWare as taken from the flight manifests as entered in Complete Flight.
4. PICs then return to the electronic Flight and Maintenance log created at the beginning of their shift and verify the log book is signed. If No AMT is available the PIC shall electronically sign the Complete Log Book entry block at the end of their shift.
5. The total flight time and cycles will be verified through a cross check of Digital AirWare and Complete Flight.
6. PICs will cross check the updated totals against the upcoming inspections in the Aircrafts Quick View.

11.7 Required Equipment

In addition to all manufactures required equipment all HeliService USA aircraft will have:

1. Sensitive altimeter with adjustable barometric pressure.
2. Two-Way radio equipment.
3. Fire Extinguisher located on the flight deck.



4. Required oxygen for the route to be flown for pilots and passengers.
5. Required ADSB equipment.
6. FAA approved radio altimeter.
7. At least one hand fire extinguisher located on the flight deck for use by the crew with a quantity and type of extinguishing agent to handle the types of fire that would typically occur.

For night flights:

1. Anti-collision light system.
2. Instrument lights to make all switches and gauges easily readable.
3. A flashlight that has two size D cell batteries or equivalent.

For passenger carrying operations VFR at night or VFR over the top conditions:

1. Gyroscopic rate of turn indicator unless not required by 14 CFR 135.159(a).
2. Slip skid indicator.
3. Gyroscopic bank and pitch indicator.
4. Gyroscopic direction indicator.
5. Generator.

For passenger carrying IFR operations or extended overwater operations, the aircraft will be equipped in accordance to 135.163 and 135.165.

11.8 Recording and Documentation of Maintenance General

This section contains the documentation formats that HeliService USA will use for tracking, reporting, and recording all scheduled and un-scheduled maintenance and discrepancies that come to the attention of the PIC or AMT.

1. All aircraft maintenance entries for HeliService USA are recorded in two places:
 - a. In electronic format contained in Digital AirWare in the following manner:
 - i. Discrepancy section as entered by the Pilot or AMT.
 - ii. The work order section.
 - iii. The Flight and Maintenance log section as automatically sent from the discrepancy and work order sections.
 - iv. Additionally, if circumstances dictate for remote operations and connection to Digital AirWare is not possible, a maintenance discrepancy or inspection may be recorded on a paper log entry with the use of a HeliService USA Paper Log Form M-09. The form will be filled out in accordance with instructions in appendix B. Blank forms will be located and will be accessible from the aircrafts EFB for pilot use.
 - b. All electronically saved completed maintenance entries of discrepancies, work orders, and flight and maintenance logs from the Digital AirWare system will be downloaded into a PDF document and saved to the HeliService USA SharePoint under the applicable aircraft folder.
2. A maintenance discrepancy or inspection may be recorded on vendor forms during approved contracted maintenance.
3. Digital AirWare will be used primarily for the pilots to report discrepancies and for AMTs to record



electronic log book entries.

4. Any item that is recorded in Digital AirWare aircraft discrepancy section will then be automatically duplicated on the electronic Aircraft Flight and Maintenance Log.
 - a. The following items recorded results are not duplicated in Digital AirWare electronic Aircraft Flight and Maintenance Log, but are tracked for inspection time intervals in Digital AirWare.
 - b. VOR Check.
5. When a calibrated tool is utilized during maintenance, it shall be recorded in the sign off to include:
 - a. Nomenclature of tool (example) 0-50 inlb Tq wrench
 - b. S/N of calibrated tool used
 - c. Date of next calibration due listed on the sticker
6. When an aircraft is returned to service following maintenance, the Return to Service entry must include the following:
 - Aircraft registration number
 - Date of release to service
 - Printed name of the individual signing the release
 - A&P certificate number
 - Signature
 - Confirmation that all FOD (Foreign Object Debris) and tools have been removed
 - Statement confirming all work was performed in accordance with (I/A/W) OEM and Company maintenance manuals

Example Statement:

Aircraft N123HS has been inspected and returned to service. All maintenance was performed in accordance with applicable OEM and Company maintenance manuals. All FOD and tooling have been accounted for and removed. Work was completed by authorized and qualified personnel.

Signed: John Doe

A&P Certificate No.: AP112344

Date: 01/01/2001

11.8.1 Electronic Flight and Maintenance Log

1. HeliService USA will use the electronic Flight and Maintenance Log for each aircraft as the method for the pilots to sign off the preflight inspection. It will also be used to verify that documented discrepancies and scheduled aircraft maintenance have been completed before flight.
2. Electronic Flight and Maintenance Log pages are documented by aircraft serial number and date.
3. Mechanical irregularities or discrepancies discovered during the preflight or during a flight will be entered by the Pilot in the aircraft discrepancy section as per section 11.8 of this section. The discrepancy will automatically be updated on the electronic log.



11.8.2 Disposition of Electronic Flight and Maintenance Log

Completed electronic Flight and Maintenance Logs will be stored in the Digital AirWare system permanently. The log page will also be downloaded to a PDF file and stored in the aircrafts electronic Flight and Maintenance Logs folder on the HeliService USA SharePoint drive as a backup for the aircrafts permanent records.

1. After completion of the Electronic Flight and Maintenance Log by the Pilot in Command at the end of their shift, as per section 11.5.1. As a check and balance to the entries, the base AMT will review the log and ensure all aircraft and engine times and cycles are correct and all times are current. They will then co-sign the log. This will be performed on a daily basis Monday through Friday. Weekends and Holidays electronic co-signs will be performed on the next business day.
2. Some completed electronic Flight and Maintenance Logs will have no maintenance entries other than the pilots pre-flight sign off. These will be filed in the aircrafts electronic Flight and Maintenance Logs folder on the HeliService USA SharePoint drive as a backup for the aircrafts permanent records.
3. Pages that have maintenance activities will be downloaded to a PDF file and stored in the aircrafts Maintenance log books file on the HeliService USA SharePoint drive.
4. The Director of Maintenance, or designee, will review all entries and downloaded PDF files weekly.

11.8.3 Aircraft Maintenance Digital AirWare Format

HeliService USA will use Digital AirWare as the primary method for the use of documenting discrepancies and scheduled and un-scheduled aircraft maintenance.

1. Digital AirWare discrepancies are ID numbered under the aircrafts home page and discrepancies tab. Each discrepancy entered will entail the Tail number and serial number, along with the aircraft and engines total time and cycles at the time of the discrepancy entry.
2. All discrepancies, scheduled and un-scheduled maintenance, entered will be in the system as a discrepancy and then assigned to a work order that also utilizes an ID numbering system.
3. Mechanical irregularities or discrepancies discovered during the preflight or during a flight will be entered either by the Pilot or by an AMT.
4. It is both the Pilot's and AMT's responsibility to ensure all entries are accurate.
5. All scheduled maintenance coming due will be listed in Digital AirWare as a discrepancy.

11.8.4 Digital AirWare Work Order System

For discrepancy recording and corrections during large inspections expected to generate multiple discrepancies, or during routine scheduled maintenance, it is not practical to record all discrepancies singularly in Digital AirWare discrepancies section. In this instance, the Work Order created by the original discrepancy will be utilized to allow for numerous discrepancies or items to be recorded.

1. The AMT will be responsible for documenting the discrepancy, scheduled, or unscheduled information in the Digital AirWare discrepancy section. Followed by attaching the discrepancy to a



work order in the system.

2. All tracked components (rotable), non-tracked (consumable) components and items, associated paperwork i.e repair designs, FAA Form 337, FAA Form 8130, EASA Form-1, Certificates of Conformity and other documentation deemed necessary for an aircraft return to service will be scanned and uploaded to the work order.
3. All completed inspection guides will be scanned and uploaded to the work order.
4. As in the case of any discrepancy, scheduled, or un-scheduled maintenance, the item is noted, the corrective action taken explained (a description of the work accomplished), and then a signature and certificate number by an authorized individual. Each individual discrepancy on the work order has an individual sign off block that will be digitally signed by the completing AMT.
5. Upon completion of the discrepancy, scheduled, or un-scheduled maintenance events, the work order will be closed. In the original discrepancy section corrective action block the AMT will enter "see W.O XXX for details."
 - a. All work orders will be added to the Electronic Flight and Maintenance logs for duplication of all completed maintenance entries.
 - b. A PDF file of the work order and the work order generated log entry will be downloaded and stored in the aircrafts Maintenance log books file on the HeliService USA SharePoint drive.
 - c. These records are considered aircraft permanent records as described in this manual.
6. The Director of Maintenance is responsible to have qualified company personnel available or a properly rated maintenance provider to accomplish the work. All maintenance forms and record entries generated during the non-routine maintenance will be completed in accordance with 14 CFR § 43.9(a).

11.8.5 Disposition of Digital AirWare Format

All discrepancies, work orders, maintenance log entries, and electronic Flight and Maintenance Logs entered into Digital AirWare shall remain in the Maintenance Tracking System permanently. These are easily accessible through the systems redundant search functions for each aircraft and are viewable by all pilots and maintenance technicians. All entries will be downloaded into a PDF file and saved on the HeliService USA SharePoint drive under the appropriate maintenance folder.

11.8.6 Disposition of HeliService USA Paper Log Form M-09

In the event that a paper log entry has been made due to circumstances of remote operations and connection to Digital AirWare is not possible. After the HeliService USA paper Log Form M-09 has been filled out in accordance with the instructions in appendix B. The completed log entry will be printed, signed, and dated by the completing AMT. At the first opportunity the AMT must duplicate the entry in the Discrepancy section of the aircraft in Digital AirWare. The written log entry and any associated maintenance documentation will then be scanned and uploaded to Digital AirWare. The entry will be saved in the system as per this section of the HeliService USA OMA.



11.8.7 Vendor Forms

Another method for discrepancy recording and correction is HeliService USA acceptance of forms developed and used by Certificated Repair Stations or other approved vendors which have been contracted to perform maintenance, preventive maintenance, or alterations to HeliService USA aircraft or equipment. These vendor forms or electronically generated discrepancy lists will be accepted provided they are within FAA regulations and contain all the information necessary to meet the needs of the company.

1. If aircraft maintenance is contracted to an outside maintenance provider such as a repair station, the repair station performing the work will record all the maintenance in the repair station records system and forward the completed records to the HeliService USA Director of Maintenance.
2. It is the responsibility of the Director of Maintenance to schedule routine/non-routine maintenance or inspections at other facilities or outside vendors as well as making all the arrangements for the work to be accomplished.
3. Prior to the start of any work, the Director of Maintenance or designee must review and confirm the vendor's documentation and current FAA authorization, including applicable certifications and capability listings, to ensure compliance with regulatory and company requirements.
4. All vendor forms, maintenance documentation and records will be scanned into the aircraft system in Digital AirWare and the HeliService USA SharePoint drive by the Director of Maintenance, or designee.

11.8.8 Maintenance Task/Job Cards

This section provides a description and instructions for using Maintenance Task/job Cards. Maintenance task/job cards are a guide to assist AMT's in the accomplishment of certain maintenance tasks.

11.8.8.1 Applicability

Maintenance Task/Job Cards shall be used when major components are replaced on the following aircraft.

- (1) Leonardo AW169

Major components are defined as:

- (1) Main Rotor Hub
- (2) Transmission
- (3) Tail Rotor Gearbox
- (4) Intermediate Gearbox
- (5) Engine
- (6) Swashplate



(7) Tail Rotor Assembly

(8) Combining Gearbox

(9) Flight Controls

11.8.8.2 Task Card Description

Maintenance Task Cards are located on the OEM website for all installations. These job cards as seen below capture all important information including critical/vital tasks that are annotated in bold **VP**.




 AW169 IETP - 22nd Issue: 2024-08-01 [WBA - AW169
 Wheel Landing Gear - Basic]

Job Card n°:	69-A-64-31-04-00A-720A-A	issue:		rev.:	
				date:	
Title:	69-A-64-31-04-00A-720A-A Sliding control assy - Install procedure				
Prepared by Technical Support:			Approved M.M.:		
Note: The technical content of this Job Cards is in accordance with the approved maintenance data					
s/n.:		marks.:		t.s.n.:	

Sliding control assy - Install procedure

WARNING

This installation includes Vital Points (VP). During the procedure, you must obey the Local Regulations applicable to the Vital Points.

Procedure

	Operations description	Recorded Values Tool S/N & Utilization Date	Operator Stamp & Signature	Add. Insp. Stamp & Signature
1	Make sure that the Tail rotor maintenance ladder (GG-01-03) is adjacent to the right side of the fuselage, near the vertical fin.			
2	If you replace the spacer (4, Fig 1) install a new thermal strip on the new spacer (4). Refer to the applicable steps of the data module 69-A-64-31-00-00A-31AD-A.			
3	Clean the control rod nut (2) with the Soft lint-free cloth (C011) and the Cleaning solvent (C010). (VP)			
4	Inspect the visible parts of the inboard side of the duplex bearing (including the seals) for absence of wear, damages and particles. Look inside the slider cylinder to do the inspection.			
5	Apply the Oil (C139) on the surfaces that follow: -The seat of the duplex bearing (11) on the control rod (7) -The surface of the shaft of the control rod (7) that is in contact with the internal diameter of the duplex bearing (11). Refer to Section A-A of Fig 1.			
6	Note Verify that the fork of the spider (upper part of the sliding control assy (5)) painted in yellow, is on the same side of the hub scissor attachment painted in yellow. Carefully install the sliding control assy (5) into the hub (10).			
7	Apply the Oil (C139) on the top surface of the inner race of the duplex bearing (11) that is in contact with the spacer (4). Refer to Section A-A of Fig 1.			
8	CAUTION When you install the spacer (4) make sure that the Celsius scale			

11.8.8.3 Task Card Procedures

Procedure for when a major component needs to be replaced for scheduled or unscheduled maintenance.

(1) Ensure Latest Manual AMPI Revision posted on the OEM portal and compare against the downloaded



manual.

(2) Print the corresponding task/job card from the OEM maintenance manual website.

(3) Fill in all blocks at top ensuring accuracy and latest revision is recorded.

(4) As steps are completed:

- enter your signature in blocks next to the task
- enter tool S/N and utilization date
- Ensure Inspector signs and verifies all vital points

(5) Scan in the completed task cards and place in digital airware under the appropriate work order.

11.8.9 Quality Control Checklist

The purpose of this Aircraft Work Order QC/QA Checklist is to ensure that all maintenance tasks are performed, documented, and verified in strict compliance with the company's Operations Manual (OM-A), the applicable OEM maintenance data, and regulatory requirements.

This checklist shall be utilized for the following:

- All heavy maintenance
- All scheduled and unscheduled maintenance requiring utilization of maintenance job cards outlined in OM-A Chapter 11.9.8

Using this checklist helps:

- Ensure that all required tasks are completed correctly and fully documented.
- Confirm that signatures, dual inspections, and approvals are in place to demonstrate airworthiness.
- Verify that Required Inspection Items and other critical tasks receive the necessary independent inspections where applicable.
- Maintain consistent standards of quality control and assurance, minimizing the risk of omissions, errors, or regulatory findings.
- Provide a clear record trail for internal audits and aviation authority oversight.

Consistent use of this checklist supports the safe return of the aircraft to service, helps uphold the organization's commitment to safety and compliance, and protects the validity of maintenance releases and certifications.

The quality control checklist form M-11 is located in the OM-A Appendix B - forms and records.



Aircraft Work Order QC/QA Checklist

Aircraft Reg: _____ Work Order No.: _____ Date: _____

Inspected By: _____

1. Work Order Documentation

- ☐ Work order identifies aircraft, task cards, and maintenance references.
- ☐ Applicable task cards attached and legible.
- ☐ Task cards reference current OM-A and OEM instructions.
- ☐ Latest OM-A/OEM revisions used.
- ☐ Parts/materials traceability documented.

2. Execution of Tasks

- ☐ Tasks carried out I/A/W OM-A procedures.
- ☐ Tasks comply with OEM instructions.
- ☐ Deviations documented with approved Engineering Orders/concessions.
- ☐ Tools/equipment calibrated and in date.

3. Signatures & Approvals

- ☐ Each task card signed by certifying technician.
- ☐ Dual inspections where required signed off.
- ☐ Final release signed by authorized certifying staff.

4. Records & Release

- ☐ Work order closed with no undocumented open/deferred items.
- ☐ Discrepancies corrected and signed off.
- ☐ All required documents attached (e.g., test reports, certs).
- ☐ Aircraft release completed I/A/W OM-A.

5. Final QA Verification

- ☐ QA audit completed and checklist signed.
- ☐ Findings/non-conformances rectified.
- ☐ Final QA sign-off by authorized personnel.

QA Auditor Name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____

11.9 Recording of Discrepancies General

Pilots and AMT's will report irregularities by:

1. Notifying HeliService USA Communications Center to remove the aircraft from service.
2. Call the Director of Maintenance, or designee, for notification of the discrepancy.
3. Place the aircraft and if appropriate the base "Out of Service" in Digital AirWare on the Base Status Board. This will generate an automated email alerting all pilots, AMT's and Tier 1 Operational Control personnel that the aircraft is out of service.
4. Enter the discrepancy for the aircraft in the aircraft discrepancies section of Digital AirWare. This is



the primary task for tracking maintenance. Once a discrepancy has been entered into Digital AirWare a computer generated email will be sent to the Director of Maintenance and the Director of Operations notifying them of the discrepant item.

5. Reference the MEL or NEF Program documents to determine if the item can be deferred.
6. If deferral is permitted, proceed with applicable instructions in this section to initiate an MEL deferral or NEF deferral or other deferred maintenance. Once the deferral is completed properly the aircraft is now back in service.
7. If deferral is not permitted, the aircraft is grounded until the discrepancy is corrected by maintenance.
8. Other deferred maintenance, defined as a discrepancy that has been written and the inspection determined it is within serviceable limits. These items are still airworthy yet warrant repair at a later time or when items no longer meet serviceable limits. This method of deferral may require repetitive inspections to ensure continuing airworthiness of the item. Examples of items that are commonly deferred in this manner are fuel leak classifications, dent limitations, and items worn in limits but approaching out of limits. Record the initial discrepancy in accordance with this section. Tracking will be adhered to by reporting items in Digital AirWare.

Before further flight, all discrepancies will be corrected or deferred in accordance with the procedures in this manual.

11.10 Dual Inspection Program

HeliService USA has established a Dual Inspection Program (DIP) as a safety function for a security and attachment check of maintenance items after minor maintenance functions have been performed. This program is NOT to be confused with a Required Inspection Item program. The following procedures shall be used for performing these checks and for documentation of the Dual Inspection Program after these maintenance functions have been completed. AMTs and Pilots are authorized to sign off the Dual Inspection Program.

1. After aircraft maintenance has been performed that consists of the removal of engine/transmission cowls or access panels for a component replacement the technician will:
 - a. Describe in detail to a second AMT, or Pilot if second AMT is not available, the maintenance that was performed and what items need to be checked.
 - b. Have a second AMT or Pilot if second AMT is not available, visually inspect the aircraft for the maintenance items performed for security and attachment of items removed and replaced or reconnected.
 - c. The second AMT or Pilot will also inspect for the following; rags, tools/tool control, disconnected lines, safeties (including safety wire, cotter pins, lock tabs, etc.) oil or fuel etc.
2. The AMT that has performed the maintenance will make a maintenance entry for the maintenance completed in the corrective action section of the discrepancy in Digital AirWare and annotate that a Dual Inspection is required for the maintenance performed, and select the "QC Required" option on the job details page.



3. The second AMT or Pilot who has completed the check will then log into the system and access the discrepancy in the Job Details and select the "Perform QC Signature" block on the discrepancy, and add their Digital Signature. The QC Signature will constitute that the DIP has been completed satisfactorily.
4. For paper documentation utilizing Paper Log Form M-09, the AMT that has performed the maintenance will make a written maintenance log entry for the maintenance completed. An additional signoff line is provided for the "DIP Completed by:" as needed. A second AMT or Pilot who has completed the check will then sign their name with their Certificate or ATP number and date. This log entry will be entered into the Digital AirWare system at the next opportunity.

11.11 Operational Check Flights

1. An operational check flight is required after an aircraft has undergone maintenance or alterations that may affect the flight or performance characteristics of the aircraft.
2. In order to perform an operation check flight, a pilot must be comfortable with operating the aircraft, have been previously qualified under 14 CFR Part 135 at HeliService USA (or completed a HeliService USA ground course and flight instruction) and have flown the aircraft within the previous 24 months. The Chief Pilot or Director of Operations will approve exceptions.
3. A review of the Maintenance Check Flight Risk Assessment must be carried out for any additional Risk.
4. Pilots shall perform operational check flights by performing any specific maneuvers or checks required.
5. No person, other than necessary crewmembers and required maintenance personnel may be flown in the aircraft until the operational check flight is complete and the pilot returns the aircraft to service in the Engineering Report. Operational flight checks conducted from sunset to sunrise shall require approval from an Area Manager, Chief Pilot, or Director of Operations.
6. Operational check flights are not required if ground tests or inspections, or both, show conclusively that repair or alteration has not appreciably changed the flight characteristics or substantially affected the flight operation of the aircraft.
7. The manufacturer's maintenance manual and flight manual must always be followed and takes precedence over any company guidance that may be given.
8. A "Hover" is considered flight and the pilot may sign off an Operational Check Flight with a "Hover" if the pilot deems this is sufficient.

11.12 Operational Check Flight Release

1. It is the responsibility of the AMT or Repair Station approved by HeliService USA to authorize the aircraft's airworthiness release to determine when an operational check flight is required.
2. Before the first flight after an aircraft has been maintained, rebuilt, or altered in a manner that may have appreciably changed its flight characteristics or substantially affected its operation in flight the technician will:



- a. Ensure that all discrepancies are corrected, or deferred if allowed by the MEL or NEF program.
 - b. In Digital AirWare add a discrepancy for the Operational Check Flight to the work order created for the initial discrepancy. Example: "Operational Check Flight Required for replacement of the tail rotor assembly."
3. Once the Operational Check Flight has been completed and found to be satisfactory, the operating pilot will:
 - a. Make an Operational Check Flight completed entry in the Digital AirWare work order discrepancy previously created, with the following or similarly worded statement: "Operational check flight performed for (reason for check flight) IAW (include any applicable reference material used) aircraft found satisfactory."
 - b. Then select the "Perform QC Signature" block on the discrepancy and add their digital signature. The QC signature will constitute that the Operational Check Flight has been completed satisfactorily.

11.13 Avionics Checks

1. All aircraft altimeter and transponder systems will be tested and inspected within each 24 calendar months by an appropriately rated and properly equipped FAA approved repair station as per 14 CFR § 91.411, 91.413, and Part 43 Appendix "E" and "F". Additional checks may be required between these intervals following any opening and closing of the static pressure system. Or following any installation or maintenance on an ATC transponder, where data correspondence error could be introduced.
2. Emergency Locator Transmitters (ELT's) shall be inspected annually in accordance with 14 CFR § 91.207.
3. VOR equipment will be operationally checked every 30 days for IFR flight and every six (6) months for VFR flight in accordance with 14 CFR § 91.171. The pilot performing the check will record the results in the inspection line item of Digital AirWare with the following information.
 - a. Date.
 - b. Next Due date (within 30 days).
 - c. Location of the check.
 - d. Bearing Error (if on the ground +/- 4 degrees, if in the air +/- 6 degrees).
4. Functional checks, Periodic inspections and maintenance of ADS-B equipment will be performed IAW the manufacturer's recommended procedures, intervals, associated ICA's and AC 20-165. Further inspection or functionality check may also be required when performing maintenance or design changes on equipment that interfaces with ADS-B. Maintenance or design changes to these interfacing components shall be accomplished in such a way that continued satisfactory performance of the overall ADS-B system is maintained. Before performing ground tests HeliService USA will Coordinate with local ATC before broadcasting over the air to prevent being a source of interference to ATC or ADS-B IN equipped aircraft in the area. All applicable testing will be completed to ensure the installation meets the requirements of 14 CFR 91.227



5. Cockpit Voice Recorders (CVR), Acoustic Beacons, and associated equipment, if required, will be inspected and maintained IAW the manufacturers guidance and associated ICA's, and IAW 14 CFR 135.151 & 135.152.
6. For CVR's on aircraft with Datalink communication equipment installed the following will be verified:
 - a. Audio is properly recorded
 - b. Audio is intelligible
 - c. Audio is free from electrical noise or other interference
 - d. CVR retains at least the last 2 hours of recorded information using a recorder that meets the standards of TSO-C123a, or later revision
 - e. All datalink messages are recorded; and
 - f. Recorded information is retained for 60 days, or longer if requested by the Administrator or Board, in the event of an accident or NTSB reportable occurrence.
7. Flight Data Recorders (FDR), Acoustic Beacons, and associated equipment, if required, will be inspected, maintained, operational and functional checked, to include functional checks of dedicated sensors, as required IAW the manufacturers recommended procedure, intervals, and associated ICA's and 14 CFR 135.152.
8. The required FDR parameters as stated in 14 CFR 135 Appendix E will be identified, recorded, and stored for rapid retrieval to ensure they are intelligible, accurate, include sampling rates, and include resolutions.
9. A document will be created and maintained that is used to convert FDR recorded values to corresponding engineering units or discrete states. An FDR correlation document will be used to show recorded data meets the sampling rate, range, resolution, and accuracy for each parameter listed in the applicable 14 CFR Part 135 Appendix E.
10. FDR Data will be retained for:
 - a. A minimum of 25 hours for airplanes or 10 hours for rotorcraft of FDR recorded data; and
 - b. FDR data and recording media for 60 days in the event of an accident or NTSB reportable occurrence
11. Any maintenance or changes that could effect the continued airworthiness of the FDR system will be done, and will be functionally and operationally checked IAW the applicable manufacturers procedures to include:
 - a. Data stream
 - b. Dedicated sources
 - c. Removal and replacement; and
 - d. Software
12. HeliService USA will follow the Design Approval Holder (DAH) procedures or instructions for continued airworthiness (ICA) developed to meet special conditions (SCs) addressing electronic system security.

11.14 Records Responsibility



The permanent aircraft records comprise the history of an aircraft. Because of this, it is extremely important that these records are kept current and that entries be accurate. It is the responsibility of the Director of Maintenance, or designee, to perform this service at HeliService USA. The Director of Maintenance will be the primary administrator for the Maintenance Record Keeping and Computer Tracking Software. Any changes to the aircraft permanent records and the maintenance tracking software will be by approval of the Director of Maintenance. The Director of Maintenance may delegate these tasks but retains the overall responsibility.

1. All maintenance records will be maintained and kept in accordance with 14 CFR § 91.417 and 14 CFR Part 135 Subpart J. Records kept will include the following:
 - a. The total time in service for airframes, engines, propellers, and rotors. This will include the time in service accrued since new or since rebuilt expressed in hours or landing cycles as applicable.
 - b. The current status of the LLPs of each airframe, engine, appliance, propellers and rotors. The following will be included, expressed in the appropriate parameter:
 - i. The time in service since new.
 - ii. The time remaining in service until the end of the specified life limit.
 - iii. The specified life limit.
 - iv. A record of any action that alters the life limit or changes the parameter of the life limit.
 - c. The time since the last overhaul of all items installed on the aircraft which have a specified overhaul interval. These records will include:
 - i. The items requiring overhaul and the associated, scheduled interval for the overhaul.
 - ii. The time in service since the last overhaul.
 - iii. The time in service remaining until the next scheduled overhaul.
 - iv. The time in service until the next scheduled overhaul is due.
 - d. The current inspection status of the aircraft, including the times since the last inspections required by the inspection program under which the aircraft and its appliances are maintained.
 - e. The current status of the applicable ADs, including the date and methods of compliance and, if the AD involves recurring action, the time and date when the next action is required.
 - f. A list of major alterations and major repairs to each airframe, engine, propeller, and appliance. To include:
 - i. A record identifying each major alteration and/or major repair including the item associated with the major alteration and/or major repair.
 - ii. A description of or reference to the FAA-approved technical data used to make the major alteration or major repair.
 - g. Records must show that all requirements for the issuance of an approval for return to service have been met.
2. The DOM, or designee, will update the aircraft records in the following manner:
 - a. Review the Aircraft Flight and Maintenance logs and the Aircraft Discrepancy Work Order to ensure the maintenance and inspection entries meet the guidelines of this manual.



- b. Discrepancy entries showing installation of parts will be compared to parts certification paperwork to ensure that each part installed on the aircraft (other than standard parts) has traceability.
- c. The Aircraft Flight and Maintenance logs are permanent aircraft records. They will be stored with that aircrafts permanent records and will be transferred with the other aircraft permanent records if the aircraft leaves the HeliService USA fleet.
- d. Inspection forms, including Optional Equipment Checklist forms, will be reviewed to ensure that the form has been completed in accordance with this manual.
- e. The paper inspection forms, including Optional Equipment Checklist forms, will be uploaded into the Digital AirWare system. Original paper copies may be discarded when the inspection is superseded. Until that time the completed forms will be stored with the aircrafts permanent records.
 - i. Note: Digital copies of paper forms loaded into Digital Airware shall remain in the Maintenance Tracking system permanently.
- f. Records of the last complete overhaul of each airframe, engine, propeller, appliance, and rotor will be retained until the work is superseded by work of equivalent scope and detail.
 - i. Note: A digital history of all records for overhauled items shall remain in the Maintenance Tracking system permanently.
- g. Paper records showing all requirements for the issuance of an approval for return to service must be retained until the work is superseded or must be retained for 1 year after the work is performed.
 - i. Note: Digital copies of paper forms loaded into Digital AirWare shall remain in the Maintenance Tracking system permanently.
- h. All maintenance records required by 91.417 will be made available for inspection by the Administrator or an authorized representative of the NTSB

11.15 Major Repairs and Alterations

1. All Major and Minor Repairs or Alterations to HeliService USA aircraft will be approved by the Director of Maintenance or designee prior to completion. The determination of a major repair or alteration will be made by using the guidance set forth in 14 CFR Part 43.
2. All Major Repairs or Alterations will be performed by appropriately rated US certificated mechanics and approval for return to service will be performed only by qualified individuals as listed in 14 CFR § 43.7. Canadian Aircraft Maintenance Engineers are prohibited from approving major repairs or alterations for return to service on HeliService USA aircraft. Technical data used for the completion of a Major Repair or Alteration will be that provided by the manufacturer, or other technical data approved by the FAA. If no previously approved data exists, HeliService USA will first obtain approval through a DER or FAA Field Approval. An aircraft, engine, appliance, or propeller shall not be returned to service after a major repair or alteration until the following have been completed:
 - a. The appropriate maintenance record entry has been made.



- b. The required repair or alteration form (Form 337) has been properly executed and completed.
 - c. If a repair or alteration results in any change in the aircraft operating limitations or flight data contained in the approved aircraft flight manual, those operating limitations or flight data are appropriately revised marked/placarded as required.
 - d. If a major repair or alteration could appreciably affect the flight characteristics of the aircraft, the required ground testing or operational check flight has been performed.
3. Software modifications that affect the safe operation of the aircraft will be treated as major alterations.
4. A copy of the FAA Form 337 will be scanned and uploaded into Digital AirWare to be kept with the aircraft historical records, a copy will be sent to the FAA AFS-750 as required, and a copy will be provided to the owner.

11.16 **Airworthiness Directive and Service Bulletin Compliance**

1. The Director of Maintenance is responsible for ensuring compliance with all ADs and SB's.
2. A current status of all AD's, Mandatory/Alert/Recommended and Optional Service Bulletins applicable to an aircraft will be kept by HeliService USA. This status will be maintained in Digital AirWare and will be available to all pilots and technicians.
3. All applicable Airworthiness Directives (AD's) will be complied with. Guidance from 14 CFR part 39 and AC 39-9 will be used as applicable.
4. A maintenance entry following compliance will be made in the Digital AirWare system. The Maintenance entry must include the following:
 - a. AD/SB number and revision date. The revision date will be found in the last sentence of the body of the AD.
 - b. Method of compliance. The method of compliance is a description of work performed, if an AD is found to be Not Applicable; the reason for the non-applicability should be listed.
 - c. References to paragraph numbers in the AD or other FAA approved alternate methods of compliance are to be listed. Sufficient information and references as to paragraph numbers etc. are to be listed to fully describe the maintenance performed.
 - d. If the AD requires recurring action, the time, date, cycles, or landings when the next recurring action is required must also be entered.
 - e. The date of completion of the work performed.
 - f. Aircraft total time at the time the work was performed.
 - g. The signature, certificate number, and type of certificate held by the person approving the work.
5. If an emergency AD is issued for company aircraft on a flight, the DOM or a designee will contact the flight crew on the affected aircraft with instructions to ensure compliance with the emergency AD.
6. Alert or Mandatory manufacturer's service bulletins will be complied with in the same manner as AD's. All other Recommended and Optional service bulletins will be at the discretion of the DOM.



7. Any aircraft or article that does not meet the requirements of an applicable AD will be placed out of service and the DOM will be notified.
8. If a change affects the ability of HeliService USA to accomplish the actions required by an AD, an alternate method of compliance (AMOC) may be requested. The proposal must provide an acceptable level of safety and must include the specific actions being proposed to address the unsafe condition. The DOM will send the proposal to the principal inspector and may also send a copy to the manager of the office identified in the AD. The principal inspector may add comments and will send the request to the manager of the office identified in the AD. The proposed AMOC will not be used unless it is approved by the appropriate FAA manager.

The office identified in the Airworthiness Directive (AD) may be contacted to obtain information about alternative methods of compliance (AMOC) that have already been approved.

9. In some cases an airworthiness directive incorporates by reference a manufacturer's service document in the body of the AD. In these cases, the service document becomes part of the airworthiness directive and is considered mandatory. In some cases the directions in the service document may be modified by the airworthiness directive. If there is a conflict between the service document and the airworthiness directive, you must follow the requirements of the airworthiness directive.

11.16.1 AD / ASB / SB Tracking

HeliService USA maintenance operations will use Digital AirWare (DA) to track and forecast; all inspections, retirement items, overhaul items, recurring bulletins, recurring Airworthiness Directives, applicable Code of Federal Regulations (CFRs), and any other required items. The tracked items are measured in days, hours, cycles and time remaining, as applicable to each aircraft.

The current status of all Airworthiness Directive's (ADs) and Service Bulletins (SBs) applicable to an aircraft are tracked by the computerized maintenance tracking system in Digital AirWare for each helicopter. The Director of Maintenance (DOM) is responsible for compliance with ADs and SBs. This status will be maintained in Digital AirWare and be available to all Pilots and AMTs. ADs / SBs due within 30 days will be listed on the next due Block of the current AML page to notify the PIC of the pending airworthiness directive. The required inspection will be listed by flight hours, calendar date, or cycles as applicable.

11.16.2 AD / SB Management

11.16.2.1 AD / SB Planning

When an AD or SB is issued against an aircraft, engine or appliance owned or operated by HeliService USA the Director of Maintenance will perform a review of the following as part of the planning stage:



- The AD / SB;
- Referenced documents;
- Engineering;
- Materials;
- Scheduling;
- Recordkeeping;
- Maintenance execution;
- Quality control (QC); and
- Quality assurance (QA).

After review, and depending on the complexity of the AD or SB, the Director of Maintenance will consult with the Managing Director, Director of Ops, Quality Control, or any other department necessary for the planning and implementation of the AD / SB requirements. An AD & SB Configuration Control Board (CCB) will be assembled from the necessary departments that will have regular meetings (or equivalent) where action plans are reviewed, coordinated, and assigned. The CCB's action plan will encompass a complete overview of the AD & SB management process. The plan should identify the details (i.e., who, what, when, where, and how) regarding effective AD / SB compliance. These meetings will help ensure all affected departments are aware of their responsibilities and where acknowledgement of those responsibilities is recorded.

All Optional and Recommended Service bulletins are reviewed by the CCB as mentioned above. The Optional and Recommended SBs will follow this same planning, support, and when applicable or if applied, the implementation, recording, and auditing processes. Careful consideration shall be given regardless of the optional / recommended status to ensure continuous program and safety improvement.

During the AD / SB planning stage the CCB will Identify Risks. The planning element is an appropriate venue to determine what verification process may be needed to identify risk, which would ensure continued compliance with ADs and SBs. This planning element should determine if an AD or SB is applicable to HeliService USA. The planning element may also include a risk analysis that considers the conditions that could arise through implementation or configuration changes. These conditions, which could affect the probability of errors, may include:

- Operator's dynamics;
- ADs / SBs with a high risk of change;
- AD / SB complexity (complex or workload-intensive ADs / ASB may create greater error rates and higher risks);
- Accessibility/location; and
- ADs / SBs with repetitive inspections.

Once these risks are analyzed, a possible AD / SB verification process may be developed to include:



- Physical verification;
- Verification of records;
- Meeting criteria for inclusion into a sampling program; and
- A required one-time verification (i.e., no future verifications are required).

This part of the planning element should identify ADs SB/s that have the highest risk for potential alteration during normal maintenance.

Once a risk assessment is accomplished, prioritized ADs / SBs should continually be verified through a verification program developed by the CCB.

The planning element should include consultation with the ACO/ECO responsible for managing the AD if clarification is needed. This is also an opportune time to determine if the contemplated actions will comply with the AD.

Alternative Method of Compliance (AMOC) Policy. The extent and nature of appropriate AD / SB compliance documentation, and determining if an AMOC is required, should be considered during the planning element. The AMOC policy should:

- Identify the specific requirements needed to obtain approval;
- When proposing an AMOC, consider making the proposal for global distribution;
- When requesting design approval holder (DAH) assistance in obtaining an AMOC, provide permission to allow the DAH to pursue a global AMOC if appropriate;
- Identify personnel and their role in the process;
- Have a concise process to ensure deviations from AD requirements do not occur, unless the deviations have been approved (i.e., an approved AMOC); and
- Ensure AD compliance is recorded only after an approved AMOC has been accomplished.

NOTE: AMOC proposals, which can be submitted at any time during the AD / SB management process, must be processed through the cognizant ACO/ECO/designee and/or local FSDO/PI. The AD identifies the responsible ACO/ECO that approves/disapproves AMOC proposals (refer to 14 CFR part 39, § 39.19 and the current edition of FAA Order 8110.103, Alternative Methods of Compliance (AMOC), for more information).

As part of the AD / SB management process, HeliService USA AD / SB CCB will coordinate AD / SB compliance matters with their local FAA office. This process may reference a conflict resolution process for circumstances that need an immediate resolution.

Additional areas for the CCB to consider during the planning element are as follows:

1. Careful review of the AD / SB with particular focus on any unique aspects of the AD / SB. Does it



require specific parts or articles that require long lead times? Does it impact future inspection schedules?

2. Determining any unique product or appliance aspects. Does the AD / SB apply to the entire fleet or only particular products or appliances? Are there repairs or alterations on the product or appliance that might require an AMOC?
3. Evaluating the method of compliance as annotated in the maintenance records (e.g., task cards, Engineering Orders (EO), engineering authorizations, etc.) to ensure AD / SB requirements will be met.
4. Determining whether to use physical markings to identify areas where an AD / SB is in effect.
5. Determining whether AD / SB -referenced service instructions have already been accomplished. Also, determine if any deviations occurred from the service instructions, which would require an AMOC.
6. Determining whether there should be changes to the Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM), an Illustrated Parts Catalog (IPC), or a Wiring Diagram Manual (WDM) to ensure continued compliance.
7. Ensuring ratable spares and work performed in the shop are AD and SB compliant and that noncompliant spares are not installed on compliant aircraft.
8. Determining the need for training and specific labor skills (e.g., avionics, Nondestructive Testing (NDT), structures, etc.).
9. Determining the restriction of AD / SB accomplishment to site-specific locations.
10. Determining the need for an enhanced perspective (i.e., a second set of eyes) at the point of implementation.
11. Determining when and how audit plans will be impacted for ADs and SBs that call for segmented actions.
12. Determining whether prototyping is needed and, if so, the persons or departments that will accomplish that process.

11.16.2.2 AD / SB Support

The support element may consist of engineering, provisioning material, configuration control, etc. Staff responsible for technical documentation may also be responsible for reviewing and evaluating information associated with an AD or SB. The operators may also employ or use outside engineering staff. NOTE: The term "engineering" is used as a generic reference to a department or individual that performs this function.

1. Establish the Method of Compliance. The Director of Maintenance will ensure that the AD / SB method of compliance is concisely tracked and is included in maintenance records. Thus, the HeliService USA CCB should use the support element to establish the method of compliance with



each AD requirement.

2. **Schedule Coordination.** The support element regarding configuration control may involve confirmation of forecasts and schedules to accomplish the work of AD / SB implementation. The schedule coordination should preclude changes to the direction that was determined (e.g., omissions or changes to task cards).
3. **Organizational Structure.** The Director of Maintenance will coordinate with materials and scheduling/planning departments to ensure the materials specified in the AD / SB and engineering document are provided. Those departments should plan for adequate capacity and time to accomplish the AD / SB requirement in appropriate work environments with the required maintenance personnel.
4. **Deviations.** During accomplishment of AD / SB-mandated actions, it is sometimes necessary to use an AMOC to deviate from the provided work instructions. Deviations may be due to issues such as configuration differences, damage findings, oversized fastener requirements, material substitutions, or service instruction discrepancies. The operator should have a process in place, preferably during the planning phase of AD / SB implementation, to support these alternative processes/procedures. This process often involves an engineering department capable of collecting and addressing the necessary changes and then coordinating those changes with the DAH, FSDO/certificate management office (CMO), and ACO/ECO, as required. In addition, having an engineering department as part of this process may identify potential fleet-wide compliance or safety concerns and allow industry-wide resolution.
5. **Engineering Review.** The HeliService USA engineering review should include a side-by-side, paragraph-by-paragraph comparison of all AD / SB requirements against any compliance actions developed by the operator. The engineering review should:
 - a. Ensure that the method of compliance conforms to each element of an AD / SB; or
 - b. Identify if an AMOC is needed (refer to FAA Order 8110.1 03). NOTE: Obtaining direct input from the maintenance organization during the support element review of engineering-authorized documents can help eliminate a single-point failure risk.
6. **Prototyping.** If prototyping is needed, the AD / SB management process should provide instructions to perform prototyping assistance and monitoring. Silent prototyping (i.e., witnessing a technician accomplish the instructions) is recommended.

11.16.2.3 AD / SB Provisioning

1. **Capabilities, Time, and Materials.** HeliService USA's materials and scheduling/planning departments should ensure that the materials specified in the AD / SB and/or AMOC are procurable and available at the scheduled time for AD / SB accomplishment. The CCB should also ensure adequate time and capabilities are sufficient to accomplish the AD / SB in an appropriate work environment with the required maintenance personnel, tooling, and equipment.
2. **Kitting.** HeliService USA may develop, or purchase from the Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM)/DAH, a kit that consists of all the AD / SB-required parts and materials. This process is referred to as kitting. The accuracy of the kit contents should be verified. Special attention should be made to ensure that part or material substitutions are only made with written approval from



the appropriate ACO/ECO/designee (refer to the AMOC process in FAA Order 8110.103).

3. AMOC Proposal. If AMOCs are required for parts or material substitutions, the AMOC proposal should be coordinated in a timely manner so that all provisions of the AD /SB are in compliance by the due dates.

11.16.2.4 AD / SB Implementing

The implementation element is the result of finalized actions involved in the planning, support, and provisioning elements. The Director of Maintenance is responsible for ensuring the accomplishment of AD / SB work instructions in accordance with HeliService USA procedures. This responsibility remains even if the work is performed by an outside source/vendor.

11.16.2.5 AD / SB Recording

The recording element should include the option of archiving all planning, supporting, provisioning, and implementing element documentation, as well as validation audits.

Maintenance Records. Maintenance records establishing AD / SB compliance will be maintained in accordance with regulatory requirements and this manual. Once a maintenance record is made showing AD / SB compliance, the product must meet and continue to show compliance with required AD / SB actions. The documents should include the compliance requirements listed below:

1. Identification of the particular aircraft, aircraft engine, propeller, and appliance to which the AD / SB is applicable.
2. The AD / SB number and effective date.
3. The date and time (which may be expressed in hours, cycles, calendar time, etc.) when the required action was accomplished.
4. If the requirement is recurring, record the specific action to be accomplished and when that specific action is due. This time may be expressed in hours, cycles, calendar date, etc.
5. Regarding records for an AD / SB, the "method of compliance" means a concise description of the action taken to comply with the requirements of the AD / SB. If the AD / SB, or its service instructions, permits the use of more than one method of compliance, the record must include a reference to the specific method of compliance used. When following service instructions, place emphasis on the embedded notes. If an AMOC is used to comply with an AD / SB, the method of compliance means a description of the AMOC and a copy of the FAA approval of the AMOC.

AD / SB Record of Accomplishment. Listing the current status of an AD / SB or method of compliance should not be confused with an AD /SB record of accomplishment. The AD /SB record of accomplishment is a description of the work and the person who performed it on the product.

11.16.2.6 AD / SB Auditing

The main objective of HeliService USA auditing element is to provide a comprehensive method for continued verification and validation of AD and SB compliance.

1. Compliance Validation. The Director of Maintenance or designee will review the aircraft AD and SB



records for completeness and correctness at least annually.

2. Validation Checks. Validation checks are considered when there is a risk of altering mandated AD / SB actions or when there are highly complicated requirements that cross many maintenance areas. Validation checks will include random sampling or physical validation (refer to AC39-9 Appendix 5, Sampling Program and Physical Verification).

These checks will be coordinated by the Director of Maintenance and the CCB and will be performed during aircraft heavy maintenance. The CCB will be responsible for the following auditing sub elements:

Auditing Sub-elements. A comprehensive auditing element will be maintained by the CCB and should include the following sub-elements:

1. Audit Processing. A documented activity that assesses the effectiveness and efficiency of a series of related or sequential work activities.
2. Audit Scheduling. A program that establishes a schedule of events to be performed during a set calendar period.
3. Audit Preparation. A plan that considers the resources needed to perform an audit (e.g., source documents, personnel, facilities, and access of equipment).
4. Audit Performance. A documented activity that determines whether the objective evidence of applicable AD / SB management process elements are implemented and documented.
5. Audit Results Process. A process that includes:
 - a. A method to identify noncompliance and/or unsafe conditions that should result in immediate reporting and corrective measures to resolve noncompliance.
 - b. Describing audit findings and how they were discovered. Results may be presented in terms of findings, concerns, observations, and recommendations.
 - c. Analyzing evidence to determine the root cause(s) of the finding.
 - d. Identifying planned corrective actions to take in response to the finding.
 - e. Establishing a timeframe for putting corrective actions in place.

Documentation. Documenting all decisions made during the AD / SB management process is encouraged so that appropriate measures can be taken, and processes can be improved in case any issues arise.

11.17 Service Difficulty Reports

1. The PIC shall report to the Director of Operations, Director of Maintenance, Chief Pilot, and Maintenance Manager the occurrence or detection of each failure, malfunction, or defect concerning the following:
 - a. Fires during flight and whether the related fire-warning systems functioned properly.
 - b. Fires during flight not protected by related fire-warning systems.
 - c. False fire-warning during flight.
 - d. An exhaust system that causes damage during flight to the engine, adjacent structure, equipment, or components.
 - e. An aircraft component that causes accumulation or circulation of smoke, vapor, or toxic or noxious fumes in the crew compartment or passenger cabin during flight.



- f. Engine shutdown during flight because of flameout.
 - g. Engine shutdown during flight when external damage to the engine or aircraft structure occurs.
 - h. Engine shutdown during flight due to foreign object ingestion or icing.
 - i. Shutdown of more than one engine during flight.
 - j. A fuel or fuel-dumping system that affects fuel flow or causes hazardous leakage during flight.
 - k. An unwanted landing gear extension or retraction or opening or closing of landing gear doors during flight.
 - l. Brake system components that result in loss of braking actuating force when the aircraft is in motion on the ground.
 - m. Aircraft structure that requires major repair.
 - n. Cracks, permanent deformation, or corrosion of aircraft structures, if more than the maximum acceptable to the manufacturer or the FAA.
 - o. Aircraft components or systems that result in taking emergency actions during flight (except action to shut-down an engine).
2. The PIC will complete Part 1 of the HeliService USA Form M-05 (Operation Service Difficulty Report, Structural Service Difficulty Report, mechanical Interruption Report Form) (14 CFR § 135.415/417)) and send it to the Director of Operations, Director of Maintenance, Chief Pilot, and Maintenance Manager as soon as practical within 24 hours of an occurrence.
 3. The purpose of this section, "during flight" means the period from the moment the aircraft leaves the surface of the earth on takeoff until it touches down on landing.
 4. Upon determining the apparent cause and corrective action, the AMT assigned to the defect will complete Part 2 of the HSUSA Maintenance Form M-05 and send it to the Director of Operations, Director of Maintenance, Chief Pilot, and Maintenance Manager within 24 hours.
 5. It shall be the responsibility of the Director of Maintenance, or designee, to transmit the report to the FAA.
 6. The report required by this section will not be withheld even if all information required in this section is not available. After initial submission any missing information shall be expeditiously updated to supplement the initial report.
 7. Failures, malfunctions, or defects reported under the accident reporting provisions of Part 830 of the regulations of the National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB) need not be reported under this section.
 8. Furthermore, IAW 14 CFR 135.415(c) HeliService USA shall report any other failure, malfunction, or defect in an aircraft that occurs or is detected at any time if, in HSUSA's opinion, the failure, malfunction or defect has endangered or may endanger the safe operation of the aircraft.
 9. When HSUSA gets subsequent information from the manufacturer or other agency concerning a previously submitted report, HSUSA shall expeditiously submit it as a supplement to the first report and reference the date and place of submission of the first report.
 10. Each SDR will cover a 24-hour period beginning at 0900 local time of each day. HeliService USA shall transmit the report within 96 hours online via the internet Service Difficulty Report system



(iSDRS) at FAA web site: <http://sdrs.faa.gov/>. The HSUSA Service Difficulty Report will be submitted to the CHDO. Both forms contain the required information that must be sent, therefore when using either method the form must be filled out completely and include:

- a. Type and identification number of the aircraft and the name of the Operator.
- b. The Date.
- c. The nature of the failure, malfunction, or defect.
- d. Identification of the part and system involved, including available information pertaining to type designation of the major component and time since overhaul, if known.
- e. Apparent cause of the failure, malfunction, or defect (i.e., wear, crack, deficiency, or personnel error).
- f. Other pertinent information necessary for more complete identification, determination of seriousness, or corrective action.

Note: Form M-05 and procedures for filling the Form M-05 can be found in Appendix B Forms and Records.

11.18 Mechanical Interruption Summary Report

1. HeliService USA shall submit to the Administrator, before the end of the 10th day of the following month, a summary report for the previous month of each interruption to a flight, unscheduled change of aircraft en-route, or unscheduled stop or diversion from a route, caused by known or suspected technical difficulties or malfunctions that are not required to be reported under 14 CFR § 135.415.
2. The pilot will complete Part 1 of HSUSA Form M-05 (Operation Service Difficulty Report, Structural Service Difficulty Report, mechanical Interruption Report Form) and send it to the Director of Operations, Director of Maintenance, Chief Pilot, and the assigned AMT as soon as practical within 24 hours of an occurrence for multi-engine aircraft.
3. Upon determining the apparent cause and corrective action the assigned AMT will complete Part 2 of HSUSA Form M-05 (Operation Service Difficulty Report, Structural Service Difficulty Report, mechanical Interruption Report Form) and send it to the Director of Operations, Director of Maintenance, and Chief Pilot within 24 hours.

11.19 Obtaining Maintenance Away from Base of Operations

This section covers the use of an outside maintenance facility or Maintenance technician, other than HeliService USA AMT's, if an aircraft requires maintenance away from a HeliService USA base of operations. Every effort will be made to use HeliService USA Maintenance Technicians to complete the required maintenance. In the event that it is deemed impractical to get a HeliService USA Maintenance Technician to the aircraft and Non-HeliService USA Maintenance Services have to be used, then the following procedures must be followed to ensure the work is done by qualified personnel and the work is completed IAW policies and procedures in this manual.



11.19.1 Pilot Procedures

This section covers the procedures to be followed by the Pilot in Command to obtain maintenance, preventive maintenance, and servicing of the aircraft at a place where previous arrangements have not been made by the operator.

1. The PIC shall enter the discrepancy in Digital AirWare from the aircrafts iPad.
2. When maintenance services are required away from base, the Pilot in Command will contact the Director of Maintenance or Maintenance Manager in the absence of the Director of Maintenance and inform them of any discrepancies affecting the airworthiness of the aircraft, and get instructions on how to proceed.
3. Upon receiving instructions on how to proceed, the PIC will act as a liaison between the service facility and the Director of Maintenance as needed in arranging the required maintenance.
4. The Pilot in Command will be present at the maintenance facility whenever repairs are being made and monitor all work being done to the aircraft.
5. The pilot in command will ensure the maintenance personnel or repair station provide logbook documentation of the repairs and/or inspections performed as coordinated with Director of Maintenance.

11.19.2 Director of Maintenance Responsibilities

The Director of Maintenance is responsible for determining an appropriate maintenance facility away from HeliService USA bases of operation and to ensure qualified maintenance AMT's perform the maintenance required. The Director of Maintenance or the Maintenance Manager in the Director of Maintenance's absence will:

1. Ensure the technician performing the repair is employed by a certified repair station, in accordance with 14 CFR Part 145, or a certified airframe and powerplant mechanic.
2. Ensure the repair station and/or the technician is qualified to perform the repair.
3. Prior to the start of any work, the Director of Maintenance or designee must review and confirm the vendor's documentation and current FAA authorization, including applicable certifications and capability listings, to ensure compliance with regulatory and company requirements.
4. Request a copy of the repair station's and/or the AMT's certificate and a copy of their FAA Approved Drug and Alcohol Program
5. Ensure the technician is on an approved drug program.

Note: This will comply with Ops Spec A449.

6. The Director of Maintenance or designee will provide the proper technical publications, maintenance manuals, or documentation necessary to perform the repair if needed.
7. The Director of Maintenance or designee will also set up shipment of any proper/special tooling needed for the work to be accomplished, if necessary.
8. Ensure maintenance providers complete and document only that maintenance authorized by



HSUSA.

9. The Director of Maintenance will ensure that the work order or logbook entry insert for the work completed is entered into Digital AirWare.

Note: HeliService USA will accept the forms developed and used by Certificated Repair Stations or other approved vendors which have been contracted to perform maintenance, preventive maintenance or alterations to HSUSA aircraft or equipment. These vendor forms or electronically generated discrepancy lists will be accepted, provided they are within FAA regulations and contain all the information necessary to meet the needs of the Company.

10. Once the aircraft returns to an HSUSA Base the work will be reinspected by an HSUSA Maintenance Technician before further flight.

11.20 Minimum Equipment List (MEL) and Deferral Program

This section contains procedures for the release or continuation of flight, if any item of equipment required for the particular type of operation becomes inoperative or unserviceable enroute.

No aircraft may takeoff with inoperable instruments or equipment installed unless an MEL exists for that aircraft, and the OpSpecs authorize its use. MELs can only be used for aircraft listed in OpSpec D095

1. Modern aircraft provide extensive duplication in systems, components, instrumentation, communications, and structural elements. These are provided to ensure aircraft safety and reliability, even after failure of certain individual units or certain combinations of units. These features have come because of great effort spent in research development, detail, design, and testing. Failure to safely utilize these characteristics in daily operation of these aircraft would constitute a waste of this vast effort. The Company's maintenance and flight policies depend upon realistic application of all that is built into these aircraft.
2. This section addresses HeliService USA Minimum Equipment List (MEL) Management program and Non-Essential Equipment and Furnishings (NEF) Program controls set in place to ensure the deferral is properly documented and tracked for timely resolution.
3. HeliService USA MEL's are derived from the FAA Master MEL (MMEL) for each type aircraft. The MEL does not include every piece of equipment or system in the aircraft. When no specific mention is made in the MEL list, it is necessary that the equipment be in place and operative.
4. Instruments required for specific operations under 14 CFR Part 135 will not be included in the MEL.
5. Instruments and equipment required by the airworthiness requirements under which the airplane is type certificated and essential for safe operations will not be included in the MEL.
6. Occasionally, an AD may apply to an item that may be authorized to be inoperative under the MEL. In those cases, the operator must fully comply with the terms of the AD or an FAA-approved alternative method of compliance (AMOC) with the AD. When provisions of an AD allow operation



of the aircraft on the condition that certain installed items be used or be operable, those affected items must be operable, even if the MEL provides for deferral of repair.

7. STC installed items may only be deferred if they have been incorporated into the MMEL prior to inclusion into the MEL.
8. The Director of Maintenance is responsible for the management of the MEL/NEF program. Should any doubt exist as to the interpretation of the MEL or the proper class of the item, assistance may be obtained from the Director of Maintenance or his/her designee.
9. In addition to the PIC, the Director of Maintenance or his designee will review the status of multiple deferred items to ensure that there is no interrelationship of items, which will cause an unsafe condition to exist.
10. Revisions to the MEL may be initiated by either the Operator or the FAA. Operator-initiated revisions may be equal to or more restrictive than the Master MEL. If the revision will result in individual pages being added or deleted, the table of contents page will be revised and included.

11.20.1 MEL / (NEF) Purpose

1. Federal Aviation Regulations require instruments or equipment to be operative at all times. These Federal Aviation Regulations also provide for the deviations from these requirements via the Minimum Equipment list (MEL). These are components and systems which the operator or manufacturer has found (and proven to FAA) can be operated safely under specific conditions. The MEL does not include every piece of equipment or system in the aircraft. When no specific mention is made in the MEL list, it is necessary that the equipment be in place and operative.
2. Items having no airworthiness connections such as reading lights, etc. are not listed and need not to be operative for flight. These items should be deferred IAW the NEF Program.
3. Should any doubt exist as to interrelation of the MEL or the category of an item, assistance should be obtained from the Director of Maintenance or designee so delegated to approve MEL actions.

Note: The Director of Maintenance is responsible to exert all efforts to have corrected any MEL items at first available opportunity after arrival at the principal maintenance facility, a manufacturer's support facility, or qualified contract maintenance facility.

11.20.2 Releasing Aircraft with Inoperative or Missing Components

1. Prior to accepting any aircraft for flight, the pilot in command must review the MEL Section of the Aircrafts home page in Digital AirWare and the electronic Aircraft Flight and Maintenance Logs to become familiar with operational requirements or limitations. When operating the aircraft all applicable conditions and limitations contained in the MEL must be adhered to.
2. Aircraft may be released in the various non-standard configurations allowed by the MEL if the PIC agrees that operation in this configuration under the conditions prevailing at the time does not compromise safe operation of the aircraft.
3. Further, the maintenance staff, if an (M) procedure is specified, must confirm that required



maintenance action is taken to ensure compliance with MEL procedures and prevention of secondary hazards.

4. If an item is marked with an (O) or (M), the procedure to follow is listed in the MEL Procedures pages associated with the ATA numbering sequence.
5. The PIC is authorized to perform the (O) procedures and qualified AMTs are authorized to perform the (M) procedures.
6. If an (M) procedure requires the pulling of a system/unit circuit breaker only, and maintenance is not readily available the pilot may perform the (M) procedure of pulling the circuit breaker.
7. If the (M) procedure references a maintenance manual, then that manual reference must be available to the AMT before he can perform the action.
8. The MEL is designed to provide coverage for individual failure in non-related systems. In the event of multiple discrepancies, even though each in itself may be permitted, coordination, communication and agreement shall be accomplished by the PIC and the aircraft maintenance staff at HeliService USA. Consideration of the interrelation of the discrepancies and good judgment must be exercised by personnel authorized to release the aircraft.
9. Appropriate action must be taken to ensure that no secondary hazard can be introduced by an inoperative or missing component. This action may include disconnecting the technical drive of a unit, disconnecting and securing lines or electrical connections, securing circuit breakers, valves or switches in specific positions, or inspecting the system or units for cause or modes of failure. A careful review shall also be made to ensure that such attention does not conflict with Flight Emergency procedures or Airworthiness Directives.
10. In order to properly apply the requirements of this section, when the indicating portion of an aircraft system or component is malfunctioning, it may be necessary to perform the appropriate troubleshooting procedures to determine that the fault exists in the indicating system and not in the aircraft system or component.
11. Ongoing inspections required by an MEL will noted in the discrepancy when entered into Digital Airware. These will be viewable from the MEL tab and will be performed in accordance with the applicable section of the Minimum Equipment List.

11.20.3 Reporting Deferral Procedures

When an item is found to be inoperative the aircraft may be released under the provision of the approved aircraft MEL. The following procedures will be followed:

1. The Pilot or AMT will determine if the discrepancy is permitted to be deferred by referencing the type aircraft FAA approved MEL.
2. Determine the category of the applicable MEL item. All MEL items are categorized and the maximum time between deferral and repair for each category is as follows:
 - a. Category A: These items must be repaired within the time limit stated in the remark's column.
 - b. Category B: Items in this category must be cleared within three (3) consecutive days (72 hours) not counting the day the item was discovered. For example, if an item is deferred on



Monday, the item must be cleared by midnight on Thursday.

- c. Category C: Items in this category include all items which are not in categories A and B and those items which are not required by 14 CFR to be operative at all times. Category C items must be cleared within ten (10) consecutive days (240 hours) not counting the day the items were discovered.
 - d. Category D: Items in this category shall be repaired within one hundred and twenty (120) consecutive calendar days (2880 hours) not counting the day the item was discovered.
- 3. Determine whether or not a maintenance action is required in addition to that mandated in the MEL, and ensure prevention of secondary hazards.
 - 4. If a maintenance procedure is required, an AMT will comply with the (M) procedures in the remarks column of the MEL, if applicable.
 - 5. If an operational procedure is required, a pilot will comply with the (O) procedures in the remarks column of the MEL, if applicable.
 - 6. The Pilot or AMT will record the discrepancy in the Aircrafts "Discrepancy" Section of Digital AirWare.
 - 7. The procedures for Pilots and AMT's for recording and deferring a discrepancy in Digital Airware are the same with the exception of the compliance of the (O) and (M) procedures.
 - 8. Pilot deferrals that require and (M) procedure will contact the Director of Maintenance or his designee for maintenance support.
 - 9. AMT deferrals that require an (O) procedure, the AMT will notify the PIC of the procedure. If there is an (M) Procedure the AMT will comply with the procedure before further flight.
 - 10. In both instances, and if no (M) or (O) procedure is required, the pilot or AMT will notify the Director of Maintenance of the deferred item

11.20.3.1 Recording Deferral Procedures in Digital AirWare

- 1. The Pilot or AMT discovering the discrepancy will be responsible for documenting the discrepancy in Digital AirWare. When the discrepancy and MEL action is complete, a computer generated email will be automatically sent to the Tier One Operational Control Authorities.
 - a. The Pilot or AMT will enter the discrepancy in the Aircraft Home page "Discrepancies" section. The current date and time, aircraft, engines total times and cycles will auto populate at the time of entry.
 - b. In the Discovered Section: Select the name of the person who discovered the discrepancy from the drop down menu and enter the date and time the discrepancy was discovered.
 - c. In the Discrepancy Section: Write a description of the discrepancy along with the following information:
 - i. The name of the item that is being deferred.
 - ii. The model of aircraft MEL being used.
 - iii. The MEL ATA Section number and Item Number.
 - iv. Reference to any (M) or (O) procedures that will be required to be performed if applicable.
 - d. In the Status Section of the Discrepancy section: Select the "In Service [GREEN]"



- e. In the Schedule Maintenance Section: Select No.
 - f. In the MEL Section select "Yes-Create MEL" Note: In the Notifications section, ensure that in the "selected items" box that Aviation Management, Maintenance Department and Rotor Wing Pilots are in the selected items box.
 - g. When all information is complete select Create Discrepancy block at the top or bottom of screen.
 - h. After the discrepancy has been created the Discrepancy page will refresh. Select the View MEL Icon on the discrepancy page.
 - i. The MEL page will populate. Select Edit MEL.
 - j. The Aircraft registration number, date, time, and discrepancy with MEL deferral will be listed.
 - k. On the MEL page enter in the MEL number as taken from the approved HeliService USA aircraft MEL, and enter in the HeliService USA MEL revision number in the appropriate blocks.
 - l. Enter in the date the item is being deferred.
 - m. Enter in the aircraft electronic flight and maintenance log page number generated for the item that is being deferred on in the appropriate block.
 - n. Select the type category the MEL is as listed in the approved HeliService USA MEL. A, B, C, D. The MEL Expiration date will self-populate.
2. If a maintenance procedure is required the AMT will log into the original discrepancy and add the (M) procedures performed for the MEL item in the description section of the discrepancy. Note: The "Corrective Action" section of the Digital AirWare MEL page will remain blank until the deferred discrepancy has been corrected. This will be completed by the AMT correcting the discrepancy and returning the aircraft to service.
 3. If an operational procedure is required of the MEL, the Pilot will comply with or refer that an Operational procedure as required for flight on the Discrepancy Section of the MEL Page.
 4. When all is correctly filled out on the MEL page select save changes.
 5. After the MEL page has been saved in Digital AirWare, a MEL control number will be automatically assigned to the MEL'd item for system tracking.
 6. When the discrepancy and MEL action is complete it can be viewed from the aircraft home screen under the MEL tab.
 7. All component controls, indicators, or systems that are rendered inoperative due to deferring maintenance action will be placarded (14 CFR § 91.405(d)). Follow MEL tagging procedure found in section 11.20.4.
 8. When the discrepancy and MEL action is complete it can be viewed from the aircraft home screen under the MEL tab. The MEL tab on the Aircraft Home page will be color coded yellow and have the number of MEL'd items in parenthesis to quickly alert Pilots and AMT's.
 9. The aircraft is now available for dispatch.

11.20.4 MEL Placarding Procedure



1. Fluorescent colored stickers shall be kept in the aircraft EFB case for placarding MEL Items. Two placards must be made, one for installing on the aircraft and one for placing on the cover of the EFB case. Wording on the MEL Placard shall read "INOP" followed by the date the item was MEL'd, the MEL ATA Chapter, item number and the item due date. The Control Number will be the Letters MEL followed by the system number (MEL XX) (see sample below).
2. These self-sticking placards shall be placed on or as close as possible to the affected item. Enter the following information on stickers: The placards will be filled out as follows:
 - a. Enter in the word "INOP."
 - b. Enter the date the item was MEL'd.
 - c. Enter in the MEL ATA and Item Number.
 - d. Enter in the Due date of the MEL'd item.
 - i. Note: Time intervals as specified in the approved MEL can be determined by the category item Letter: A= Repair within the time specified in the MEL "Remarks or Exceptions" Column, B=3 days, C= 10 days, D=120 Days.
3. The placard will be affixed in the cockpit as close as possible to the inoperative unit or switch. If the placard is not in plain view of the Pilot, an additional placard will be affixed in plain view to bring his/her attention to the fact that a deferred unit exists .
4. A second corresponding placard will be placed on the case of the "EFB case" to serve as a reminder to flight and maintenance personnel when performing initial notification and clearing of items.
5. The placards will not be removed until all maintenance has been performed and documented to clear the MEL.

Note: Wording may be handwritten on placard.

11.20.5 Clearing of MEL Items in Digital AirWare

Once the corrective action has been performed to clear the deferred item from the aircraft the AMT will log into Digital AirWare and perform the following:

1. Open the discrepancies page: Select the MEL item being signed off.
2. In the Status section: Select Complete [GREEN].
3. In the AMT Assigned to section: Select the AMT's name from the drop down menu.
4. In the Aircraft total time when complete section: Enter in the aircraft total time at completion of correcting discrepancy.
5. In the Corrective Action section: Sign off the corrective action performed in accordance with procedures outlined in this chapter, that include:
 - a. A description and accepted method for repair reference to the work performed.
 - b. A description, part number, and serial number (if applicable) of any parts/components replaced.
 - c. The aircraft total time in service and date of completion.
 - d. The signature, certificate number, and kind of certificate held or an appropriate entry by a Repair Station. An appropriate entry by a Repair Station must include at least the items



listed above plus the Repair Station number and must be signed by a certificated technician or inspector.

6. The AMT will then select Save Discrepancy and then select the EDIT MEL tab on the discrepancy page.
7. The original MEL page will now be shown, the Corrective action section will be auto filled from the discrepancy page. The following information must be edited by performing the following:
 - a. Enter the electronic flight and maintenance log page number generated for the entry that the MEL Discrepancy was cleared on.
 - b. Enter the date the item was cleared on.
 - c. Select the Placards removed box.
 - d. Select Save Changes.
8. The AMT will then view the Digital AirWare system discrepancy and MEL tabs to ensure that they have been cleared in the system. A computer generated email will be sent to the DOM and the DO notifying them of the cleared MEL item.

11.20.6 MEL Extensions

1. HeliService USA is authorized to approve extensions to the maximum repair interval for Category "B" or "C" items accordance with OpSpec D095. Category "A" and "D" items require approval by the FAA Flight Standards District Office (FSDO) prior to releasing an aircraft for service. Approval for the Category "A" and "D" extensions will come via email from the FSDO.
2. For Category B and C Items only, when an MEL is approaching the due date limit an AMT will fill out the HeliService USA M-03 MEL Extension Notification Form (Refer to section 10.11). The Form will contain the supporting data (i.e., estimated time of arrival of parts on order, estimated time for completion of trouble-shooting, etc.) and will be email to the Director of Maintenance for approval within 24 hours of notification for all MEL/NEF extension requests.
 - a. Upon completion of the M-03 MEL Extension Notification Form the AMT will send a request for extension via email to the Director of Maintenance or designee for approval.
 - b. Once the extension request has been confirmed that it is within the scope of an allowed extension the Director of Maintenance or Designee will approve the request by signing and dating the form.
 - c. The completed form will be returned to the requesting AMT after approval.
 - d. The Director of Maintenance or Designee will notify the FSDO on the day of the extension by email with an attached copy of the completed HeliService USA M-03 MEL Extension Notification Form.
 - e. The extension authorized by this provision cannot exceed the original time for the category.
3. For B and C deferred items, if an MEL is expiring on a weekend or holiday and it is anticipated that an extension will be needed, due to the lack of parts or tooling needed, the request must be submitted prior to the close of business on the last day of the week. However if the part or tooling arrives before the expiration of the extension, the discrepancy will be corrected.
4. If an extension is required on Category A or D items, the Director of Maintenance will request the



extension by notifying the FAA Principal Maintenance Inspector by email 24 hours prior to the expiration.

- a. The Director of Maintenance will attach a copy of the completed HeliService USA M-03 MEL Extension Notification Form.
 - b. The Director of Maintenance will add any extra pertinent supporting data or circumstances not included on the M-03 MEL Extension Form (i.e., estimated time of arrival of parts on order, estimated time for completion of troubleshooting, etc.)
 - c. The Director of Maintenance is responsible for keeping the M-03 form as part of the aircraft permanent records.
5. Once the extension is granted, the AMT or Pilot, will be responsible for accomplishing the extension by updating the expiration date of the deferred item in Digital AirWare.
- a. When updating the extension in Digital AirWare, the AMT or Pilot will perform the following:
 - i. Navigate to the original MEL page for the discrepancy and select the "Extended" block in the Discrepancy section. The new due date will auto populate. Then select "Save Changes"
 - ii. The new due date will be listed and accessible to view through the aircraft home screen MEL tab, and/or the Maintenance Tab under MEL.
6. In addition, the AMT or Pilot, will be responsible for updating the Inoperative Placards with the new "Due Dates."

11.21 Non-Essential Furnishings Program

1. HeliService USA NEF Program and procedures are very similar to the MEL process described in this chapter. The NEF Items List found in the approved MEL uses the same basic format as that of the MEL. The deferral of NEF Items are tracked in the computerized maintenance tracking system, Digital AirWare. The NEF Items deferral categories utilize the same MEL Item deferral categories (Category A, B, C, and D). Also, as with the MEL, the NEF List of items may include (M) Maintenance and (O) Operation procedures that must be complied with in order to defer an item.
2. As with MEL Items, not all NEF items require the use of the maintenance deferral placarding to communicate the item is inoperative or missing, but if the NEF Item requires placarding, it is noted in the NEF Item List.
3. Detailed procedures to document the deferral of an item on aircraft's NEF list are the same as with MEL items and can be found in this section.
4. The Non-Essential Furnishings List (NEFL) is located in the back section of the MEL.
5. These non-essential items may be installed in areas including, but not limited to, the passenger compartment and the cockpit.
6. Due to the nature of NEF items, all deferrals will be assigned an initial 120 day repair interval.
7. Extensions may be granted by the Director of Maintenance in 30 day increments.
8. NEF items are not items already identified in the MEL.
9. NEF items are not items listed in the manufacturer's maintenance manuals such as wear limits,



fuel/hydraulic leak rates, oil consumption, etc.

10. NEF items are tracked in Digital AirWare for historical and tracking purposes.

11.21.1 Procedures and Processes for Identifying NEF Items (that may be deferred)

1. HeliService USA has developed a basic NEF List. This list is located in Section 5.3 of each aircraft approved MEL. This list is in no way all-inclusive and may have items added and possibly removed over time. If a discrepancy is encountered that is covered by the aircraft's approved MEL or NEF list, the discrepancy will be deferred and documented in accordance with the deferral procedures located in this manual.
2. NEF Items are tracked through the use of the Digital AirWare Maintenance Tracking System.
3. If a discrepancy is discovered that is not covered by the aircraft's approved MEL or NEF List, the individual who discovers the item will document the discrepancy in the Digital AirWare Maintenance Tracking System and notify the Director of Maintenance.
4. The Pilot, with the assistance of the maintenance personnel or designee, will evaluate the discrepancy and perform the NEF Item Process to determine if the discrepancy can be added to the NEF List. The discrepancy must meet the intent of the NEF Item Process or it will require the issue to be resolved before further flight.
5. The NEF Item evaluation process will include the following items:
 - a. Is the item required for the flight rules in which the aircraft is operated?
 - b. Does it create the potential for fire/smoke or other hazardous conditions?
 - c. Could it have an adverse effect on other required systems or components?
 - d. Does its condition potentially affect the safety of Pilots, BMP, passengers, or service personnel?
 - e. Could it have a negative impact on emergency or abnormal procedures?
 - f. Does it create additional workload for the Pilot or BMP at critical times of flight or flight preparation?
 - g. Pilots may need to evaluate the deferred NEF on a flight-by-flight basis. Note: The above evaluation process must be accomplished for the damaged, inoperative, or missing items for the underlying cause of the discrepancy.
6. A Flow Chart provided in Section 5.3 of approved MEL will be used to determine if a discrepancy can be added to the aircraft's NEF List. After successfully completing the decision process, the item may be added to the aircraft's NEF List and deferred in accordance with the NEF program.
7. The Director of Maintenance is responsible to notify the FSDO within 72 hours of adding new items to the NEF List. This review by the FSDO is not to be conceived as a requirement to approve the NEF items. It is merely a means to provide oversight to ensure the program is effective. The FAA approval of items will be included with the next MEL revision.
8. Although NEF items are not safety of flight items, they are not deferred under the authority of an Airframe and Powerplant certificate. HeliService USA is deferring the item under their approved NEF program. For this reason, the final decision to add an item to the NEF List will be made by the Director of Maintenance. Extensions to items deferred in accordance with the NEF program must



be approved by the Director of Maintenance.

9. The flowchart in section 5.3 of the MEL provides a chain of steps to decide if a discrepancy can be deferred in accordance with aircrafts MEL or NEF. If neither of these options are applicable, the flow chart provides a line of questions to be used by the Director of Maintenance to determine if a discrepancy can be added to the aircraft's NEF List.
10. Upon Director of Maintenance approval, the item will be added to the NEF List.

11.22 Deferred Maintenance Management

1. The Director of Maintenance will have overall responsibility of the Deferred Maintenance Management program. The Director of Maintenance or designee will review all open deferrals to ensure that necessary actions are being taken to clear deferrals in a timely manner. These items will be viewed for the following:
 - a. Number of deferred items per aircraft.
 - b. Reason for delay in repair, length of delay, and estimated date for which the item is set to be repaired.
2. Identification of Items due within the next 24 hour period.
3. Extension requests as needed.
4. Any delays in parts or man-power needed to clear open deferrals will be communicated to the Director of Maintenance.
5. The Parts/Logistic Coordinator is responsible for notifying maintenance on any delay in parts requested for a MEL item.
6. Deferred items will be tracked through the use of the Digital AirWare MEL section.

11.23 Weight and Balance

Aircraft Weighing Requirements

1. After major modification, alteration, or repair in which the actual weight and moment data are not available.
2. After configuration changes involving numerous parts removed or replaced that make the determination of the weight and balance changes by calculation impractical.
3. When the basic weight data is suspected to be in error.
4. When required by FAA requirements (As Required by 14 CFR § 135.185; 36 months) or other intervals established by the owner/operator.

The aircraft weighing will be performed IAW the Maintenance Manual, Flight Manual, and/or any other pertinent instruction from the manufacturer. The following will be considered:

1. Prior to weighing, an equipment inventory will be performed and documented on Chart A if applicable.
2. The aircraft will be clean and dry.
3. Aircraft fluids will be properly accounted for.



4. The weighing of the aircraft will be indoors to prevent wind from blowing over the aircraft surfaces and possibly causing erroneous scale readings.
5. Scales used to weigh the aircraft will be calibrated IAW Calibration procedure set forth in this manual.
6. Scales will be used utilizing the manufacturer's specific instructions.
7. Aircraft will be weighed as many times as necessary to achieve consistent numbers unless applicable maintenance instructions differ.
8. Type and serial number of any scale used, aircraft weight, residual fluids, and scale tare weight will be recorded in the final weighing record.
9. Upon completion of weighing, the applicable weighing record will be signed.

11.23.1 Weight and Balance Records

The Director of Maintenance will be responsible for ensuring that the current empty weight and balance data is recorded in the Rotorcraft Flight Manual, permanent aircraft logs, and Digital AirWare.

Chart A (rotor wing only) is the aircraft equipment checklist. Its purpose is to provide an inventory of items physically installed in the aircraft at the time of weighing. The list contains items from original type certification, kits, and equipment added by an approved alteration. Component hardware, wiring and installation provisions are not to be included on the Chart A equipment list. Chart A is arranged by category of items originally created by the manufacturer. Each action (equipment inventory or record of installation/removal) will have a date entered at the top of the column along with the signature of the individual performing the inventory. A check mark in the "Basic Configuration" column indicates an item installed during weighing. An "O" in the column indicates an item is removed during weighing.

Chart B is used to record the data obtained from the actual aircraft weighing. The form also includes the necessary instructions for computing the current weight, moment and CG.

Chart C is the continuous history of the basic weight, CG, and moment resulting from mission equipment which alter the current weight and balance status of the aircraft.

Alterations, repairs, and removal and/or installation of equipment requiring a weight and balance entry are the responsibility of the AMT To ensure the applicable weight and balance records are updated. The maintenance log entry will include a statement similar to "aircraft weight and balance records updated as required."

Weight changes that result from alterations, repairs, removal and/or installation of equipment do not require the weight and balance records to be updated if determined that the weight change is negligible. Negligible is defined as less than or equal to 2 lbs. An entry in the aircraft logbook will still be required and will include a statement similar to "aircraft weight and balance change negligible." If more than two entries for weights that are negligible are made it is recommended that the aircraft be weighted.

If a correction to any weight and balance record is required, a single line will be drawn through the error (the entry must remain legible) with the mechanic/inspector's initials placed adjacent to the correction.



11.24 Special Airworthiness - Ferry Permit

Flights will not be authorized or attempted unless open discrepancies are repaired or the equipment is replaced, removed or installed in accordance with applicable FAR's. A ferry permit may be issued by the Director of Maintenance or Maintenance Manager under the Continuing Authorization Flight Permit (CAFP) to relocate an aircraft with open discrepancies to a base where repairs or replacements can be made. The PIC will confer with the Director of Maintenance or Maintenance Manager regarding any open discrepancies. The Director of Maintenance or Maintenance Manager will review/evaluate the aircraft discrepancy to determine if a CAFP is required. The Director of Maintenance or MM will provide notification to the FAA PMI that a ferry permit has been authorized under the CAFP and upon completion of a one-time ferry flight under the CAFP program the Director of Maintenance or MM will notify the FAA PMI.

Reference Appendix D for details on the Continuing Authorization Ferry Flight Program.

11.24.1 Continuing Authorization Flight Permit

The intent of the continuing authorization ferry permit is to allow flight of an aircraft that may not meet applicable airworthiness requirements, but is capable of safe flight for the purpose of flying the aircraft to a base where repair station personnel may perform maintenance or alterations. It is not intended for any other reason or purpose.

Note: Refer to the Approved HeliService USA Continuing Authorization Ferry Flight Program Manual for detailed procedures, training and guidance.

11.24.2 Continuing Authorization Flight Permit Procedure

1. The PIC will determine if the component or system failure can be deferred under aircraft the Minimum Equipment List or if aircraft has damage that would require maintenance actions to allow safe flight. If unable to defer under the MEL, the PIC will notify the Director of Maintenance or Maintenance Manager of the component, system failure or damage sustained to the aircraft.
2. The Director of Maintenance or MM will dispatch a qualified AMT to the aircraft location to evaluate the aircraft condition and provide required information to the Director of Maintenance or MM to determine if any maintenance actions need to be accomplished on the affected component, system or airframe damage prior to approving a one-time direct ferry flight for the aircraft to return to a base where repairs or replacements can be accomplished.
3. If the aircraft condition evaluation by the Director of Maintenance or MM has determined that the affected component, system or airframe damage will allow the safe accomplishment of a one-time direct ferry flight, the PIC, under guidance from the qualified AMT will enter the discrepancy in Digital Airware. Example: "No#1 Hydraulic system low pressure caution light illuminated" "Upon completion of operational check the No#1 & No#2 Hydraulic systems are indicating safe operational pressures. A single pilot one-time direct ferry flight to a base where repairs or replacements can be made is authorized by the Director of Maintenance or MM under the CAFP."



4. Only qualified Aviation Maintenance Technicians (AMT) are permitted and authorized to evaluate aircraft condition or accomplish any on sight repairs that may be required on any component, system failure or airframe damage to ensure a safe one-time direct ferry flight.
5. Prior to releasing an aircraft to accomplish a one-time ferry flight, the pilot will:
 - a. Ensure all conditions, limitations and provisions listed in OpSpec D084 have been met.
 - b. Sufficient fuel quantity is onboard to allow for a safe one-time ferry flight.
 - c. Aircraft weight & balance, (CG) Center of Gravity checks have been completed.
 - d. Ferry flight will be accomplished under VFR conditions only. Pilot is not allowed to fly one-time ferry flight under IFR conditions.
 - e. Minimum aircraft systems or equipment required to accomplish onetime flight are operative prior to flight.
 - f. Ferry flight will be accomplished single pilot. A maintenance technician may be allowed to accompany pilot during one-time ferry flight if Director of Maintenance, MM or operational needs deem its necessity. Medical personnel or passengers are NOT allowed to be onboard the aircraft during one-time ferry flights.
 - g. All required entries & forms have been completed and reviewed prior to accomplishing one-time ferry flight.

11.25 Parts

11.25.1 Parts Identification

1. All parts shall be identified appropriately.
2. New and serviceable parts shall be identified with all information to accurately provide traceability for the part (i.e. 8130-3, Form 1, Certificate of Conformance).
3. Parts removed will be tagged with either a serviceable yellow tag (yellow), repairable tag (green), or rejected tag (red). If a part tagged as repairable has been repaired or inspected and determined to be serviceable, the repairable tag will be removed and a serviceable tag will be installed. If a part tagged as repairable is determined to be unrepairable, the repairable tag will be removed and a rejected tag will be attached.

11.25.2 Parts Receiving

1. All parts will be inspected upon receipt before being placed in storage, and/or before use on an aircraft. Inspection criteria shall include:
 - a. General overall condition of the part or signs of obvious damage.
 - b. Cleanliness of the article, including any foreign objects.
 - c. Preservation of the article according to its instructions for continued airworthiness
 - d. Verify appropriate quantity received.
2. Ensure all documentation and the associated article match according to part number, Total Time/Time Since Overhaul and serial or lot number. For Life Limited articles, verify proper values



are being tracked according to applicable model parameters called out in the appropriate manufacturers approved airworthiness limitations.

3. All necessary documentation must be present to show that the article meets the applicable production and maintenance requirements of 14 CFR Parts 21, and 43 and to determine eligibility for installation. (i.e., Form 8130-3, Form One, Certificate of Conformance, TSO or PMA markings etc.)
4. Suspected unapproved parts will be quarantined and reported to the Director of Maintenance.
5. In general, HeliService USA will attempt to correct discrepancies noted or to resolve any issues with the manufacturer, distributor or service provider. However, if the discrepancy involves activity believed to be in violation of the CFRs or if criminal activity is suspected, HeliService USA may voluntarily report the suspected unapproved parts in accordance with the guidance set forth in AC 21-29.

11.25.3 Parts Storage

1. Serviceable and unserviceable parts will be stored in separate locations.
2. Stored parts will be preserved in accordance with manufacturers recommendations or methods acceptable to the administrator. To afford protection against humidity, extreme temperatures, dust, rough handling or other damage, the component shall be preserved in suitable containers, plastic bags and/or rigid boxes containing shock absorption material. Caps and plugs or other protective/safety devices shall remain installed until the component is to be used/installed. Parts placed in storage shall be tagged and all appropriate paperwork will be placed with the part.

11.25.4 Life Limited Parts / Shelf-Life Items

1. Life Limited parts removed from an aircraft will be appropriately tagged (yellow, green, red). The tag must include the part number, serial number, and current life status of the part.
2. Aircraft articles, products, and consumables which have a shelf-life consideration assigned to them by the manufacturer or Military Specification must be identified as such and controlled. Shelf-life items include but are not limited to the following: rubber products (O-rings, seals etc.) sealants, glues, adhesives, grease, etc. In addition, any part or component with a shelf life requires marking of the expiration date.
3. Before use on any aircraft, all parts and supplies will be checked for expiration date. Expired parts or materials shall never be installed or used on an aircraft. Expired materials will be quarantined and/or properly disposed of per the applicable regulations.

11.26 Calibrated Tools

1. Precision tools and test equipment used for precision measurement in the air carrier operations are subject to periodic checks and calibration to an FAA recognized national standard. A list of precision tools and test equipment will be maintained in Digital AirWare by the Director of Maintenance or designee.



2. All persons, before using precision tools, are responsible for verifying that the precision tool has a current legible calibration label attached. Any precision tool found without a current calibration label attached will not be used. At no time will any person be permitted to perform work on aircraft or components using precision equipment which is out of calibration.
3. Test equipment will be calibrated at periodic intervals established by the manufacturer. In the absence of such information HeliService USA will determine the interval on the basis of stability, purpose, and degree of usage. Calibrated tools will be good until the end of the month in which the calibration expires. Calibration periods are shown on the Calibrated Tools Master List.
4. Each piece of calibrated test equipment will be identified with a serial number. An attached label must indicate the last calibration date, the next calibration due date, and the supplier that performed the last calibration. In the event the equipment size prevents a label, the label may be affixed to the container. New tools that are purchased or received with a certificate of calibration will have a serial number assigned; a sticker will be placed on the tool or container with the next calibration due date and will be entered into the Calibrated Tools Master List. Certificates of calibration will be retained for the period of calibration plus one year for the purpose of verifying previous maintenance if required.
5. Equipment marked "For Reference Only" will not be utilized to return an aircraft or article to service.
6. Any calibrated tool that is damaged or suspected of not being in calibration will not be used on any aircraft to perform maintenance or return any aircraft to service. Such tool will be quarantined, tagged or labeled in a manner to ensure that it will not be used. The person identifying the discrepancy with the tool will be responsible for notifying management as to the disposition of that tool. Arrangements will be made for repair, calibration, or replacement ASAP.
7. If special equipment or a test apparatus is recommended by the manufacturer, personnel will use the recommended equipment, apparatus, or an equivalent acceptable to the administrator.
8. If a calibrated tool is found to be defective during the vendor's calibration process, the following actions shall be taken:
 - a. Tool Usage Review:
Review all special tooling sign-in/out rosters and audit the Digital Aircraft (DA) system to identify any usage of the defective tool within the past six (6) months.
 - b. Torque Verification:
Perform torque verification on all components where the defective tool was used during that six-month period. Document and record the results of each verification in accordance with applicable requirements.

11.27 Aircraft Acceptance Process

1. No aircraft will be operated by HeliService USA on a 14 CFR Part 135 revenue flight unless the following aircraft evaluation has been accomplished/verified:
 - a. The aircraft is registered as a civil aircraft of the United States



- b. The aircraft carries an appropriate current airworthiness certificate.
 - c. The aircraft conforms to its type design or properly altered condition (TC, STC and field approved alterations). Records show that alterations were accomplished per 14 CFR Part 21, 43, and 91.
 - d. The condition of the aircraft relative to wear and deterioration is acceptable and the aircraft is in safe condition for operation.
 - e. Records show that all maintenance and preventive maintenance is up to date.
 - f. The aircraft conforms to the "Limitations" and "Supplements sections within the approved AFM.
 - g. The aircraft meets the applicable airworthiness requirements of 14 CFR Part 135.
 - h. All required equipment is installed per section 7 of this manual.
2. The following aircraft identification information will be validated and recorded as applicable.
 - a. Serial number.
 - b. Line or fuselage number.
 - c. Date of manufacture.
 - d. Registration number.
 - e. Total time.
 - f. Total cycles.
3. The following parameters will be verified and tracked for each airframe, engine, propeller, landing gear, or life limited component as applicable.
 - a. Total time.
 - b. Total cycles.
 - c. Time since O/H.
4. Review and retain records that show compliance with the following:
 - a. Scheduled tasks that include maintenance, inspections, overhaul, time controlled, and life limited items.
 - b. ATC transponder test and inspection.
 - c. Altimeter system test and inspection.
5. Verify, Track, and Monitor the following weights as applicable:
 - a. Aircraft empty weight.
 - b. Max zero fuel weight.
 - c. Max structural weight.
 - d. Max taxi or ramp weight.
 - e. Max takeoff weight.
 - f. Max landing weight.
 - g. Date of last weighing.

11.28 Fuel Storage and Quality

HeliService USA uses airport provided fuel. The Chief Pilot will be responsible for ensuring that vendor's that are used on a regular basis (e.g.; Flight Level), are audited on an annual basis using the Fleetplan



audit module.

11.28.1 Reserved.

11.28.2 Reserved.

11.28.3 Reserved.

11.28.4 Reserved.

11.28.5 Fire Extinguishers

Verify that fire extinguishers:

- Are in their designated place.
- Have unobstructed access and visibility.
- Are tagged to indicate monthly inspections are current.
- Have unbroken safety seals or tamper indicators.
- Have no obvious physical damage, corrosion, or leakage.
- When equipped, the pressure gauge is in the operable range.
- If any fire extinguisher is missing or does not meet the criteria listed above, it shall be repaired, or removed from service and replaced with a serviceable extinguisher of the same or greater capacity.
- Hydrant vehicles, hydrant carts, and fueling cabinets must be equipped with a minimum of one 20-B:C rated fire extinguisher, securely mounted and readily accessible.
- Refueling trucks must be equipped with a minimum of two 40-B:C rated fire extinguishers, securely mounted on opposite ends of the tank and readily accessible.
- Seals must be intact.
- Current inspection, testing, and recharging records must be attached.
- Daily and monthly inspections of the fire extinguishers will be performed.

11.28.6 Reserved.

11.28.7 Grounding and Bonding

When fueling equipment is correctly grounded and bonded, static electrical charges do not accumulate.

“Bonding” vs “Grounding”: These two terms are often confused and refer to different things. Bonding consists of connecting different items (such as a fuel truck and an aircraft) in such a way that they are at the same electrical potential. When they are bonded a spark cannot jump from one to the other. The usual bonding means is to attach the items to one another with a conductive wire. Grounding consists of



connecting a conductive object to the earth, usually via a wire attached to a metal stake driven into the ground. Any accumulated charge on the grounded object is neutralized.

11.28.8 Fuel Contamination

1. **Clear and Bright.** As a rule, jet fuel that is acceptable for the aircraft should be clear, bright, and contain no free water. The terms "clear" and "bright" are independent of the natural color of the fuel. Jet fuels are not dyed. In accordance with ATA-103, acceptable colors are clear, light straw, dark straw, and amber. "Clear" means the absence of any cloud, emulsion, readily visible particulate matter, or entrained water. "Bright" refers to the shiny appearance of clean, dry fuels. A cloud, haze. Specks of particulate matter, or entrained water indicates that the fuel is contaminated. A sample which may appear as a color or shade not defined above will be left in direct sunlight for at least 30 minutes. (Some samples may require exposure for longer periods of time.) If the sample is an acceptable color after exposure, the fuel will be deemed acceptable.
2. **Particulate Matter.** Particulate matter appears as dust, powder, grains, flakes, fibers, or stain. Particulate matter, or solid contamination, can be separated into two categories – coarse matter and fine matter.
3. **Coarse Matter.** Coarse matter can be seen and easily settles out of fuel or can be removed by adequate filtration. Ordinarily, particles 10 microns or larger in size are regarded as coarse matter.
4. **Fine Matter.** Fine matter particles are smaller than 10 microns. Fine matter scatters light and can appear as flashes of light or a slight haze in the fuel. Occasionally fuel contaminated with gross amounts of fine particulate matter, which does not respond to normal filtration and cleanup procedures, can be encountered.
5. **Most Prevalent Particulate Contamination.** The most prevalent types of particulate matter contamination in aircraft fuels are iron rust and scale, sand, and airborne dirt. The principal source of iron rust and scale is from corrosion in pipelines, storage tanks, and other fuel containers. Sand and dirt are particularly serious problems in extremely sandy or dusty environments.

11.28.8.1 Reserved.

11.28.9 Reserved.

11.28.9.1 Reserved.

11.28.10 Fuel Testing Procedures

11.28.10.1 Reserved

11.28.10.2 Reserved

11.28.10.3 Aircraft Fuel Sampling During Daily Preflight



Fuel samples must be taken during preflight from the sumps of each aircraft fuel tank into a clean glass jar. Perform a clear and bright test on each sample. If visible contamination of fuel is observed or found, aircraft fueling must be discontinued from that source. Contact the Director of Maintenance for further guidance. Fueling shall not be resumed from the system until the source of fuel contamination is found and removed.



12 ELECTRONIC FLIGHT BOOK

12.1 Introduction

HeliService USA will utilize an Electronic Flight Bag (EFB) program to enhance pilot situational awareness and reduce paper in the cockpits. The program is authorized under OpSpecs A061. HSUSA will use Apple iPads as the hardware to operate Type A and B software applications. Each aircraft will be equipped with a primary and a backup to mitigate the risk of a device failure.

12.2 General

Each HeliService USA aircraft will be equipped with the following items which are the hardware components of the EFB system:

1. APPLE iPad MINI 4.
2. Otter Box Hardened Protective Covers (1 each).
3. Thule Protective Carrying Case - Storage for chargers and iPads when not in use.
4. USB Charger Cord - In flight charging when required.
5. MYCLIP iPad Kneeboard.

Note: One iPad will serve as the primary and the second will serve as the backup to mitigate the risk of a primary failure.

12.3 EFB Administrator

HeliService USA will appoint an EFB Administrator (EFBA) to be responsible, under the supervision of the Director of Operations, for administering the HSI EFB Program. The EFBA will be responsible for the following:

1. Creating standardized policies and procedures for the operation of the EFB Program.
2. Coordination with the HSUSA IT Department to ensure the Apple Operating System "iOS" and the software applications perform as intended.
3. Monitoring and controlling any unauthorized modification of HSUSA approved software applications or the loading of any new or additional software without prior approval.
4. Coordinate with HSUSA IT department to ensure the third party application accounts are current and paid.
5. Submitting drafts of new EFB policies and procedures to the Director of Operations, or designee, for review and approval.
6. Maintaining passwords to all required accounts and to monitor Apple's website for firmware updates.
7. Revising EFB databases and confirming system verification with each update.
8. Notifying HSUSA pilots of software revisions and updates.



9. Responsible for remotely wiping and clearing data from a HSUSA EFB if notified that a company EFB is lost or stolen.
10. Provide input and assistance in maintaining the currency of the EFB training curriculum.
11. Ensuring that new operational EFB applications will not adversely affect existing software, applications and documents.

12.4 Revision Control

Revision Control

The EFBA, in coordination with HSUSA IT, will have overall control of the revision process for HSUSA EFBs. The following is the operating system and major software applications in the EFB system:

1. Operating System:
Apple iOS
2. Part 135 Operations Software:
Complete Flight
3. EFB Maps, Charts, Documents Management, AFD Info, Weather Planning Augmentation:
ForeFlight Mobile EFB
4. Document Syncing with ForeFlight:
Dropbox Mobile Application
5. Syncing Microsoft Excel:
Microsoft OneDrive

Note: Refer to the EFB Program Catalog for a detailed list of the current hardware and software applications installed on the EFBs.

Revision Control Policies

Operating System Control

Apple iOS updates will not be downloaded to the HSUSA EFBs until the EFBA receives confirmation from ForeFlight Product Support that the testing of the iOS update with the current ForeFlight revision is compatible and that no functionality is lost. The EFBA will perform additional beta testing on the iOS update using the training EFB to ensure HSUSA functions work properly. The EFBA will coordinate the iOS update on the operational EFBs if the validation testing is successful.

Class A and B Software Application Control

All approved software products will initially be uploaded to the EFBs by the EFBA or HSUSA IT. The version of each software application will be controlled by HSUSA IT and the EFBA. EFB software applications will not be updated to a new version on the EFB without the approval of the EFBA or HSUSA IT. The following process will be used for compliance:

1. HSUSA IT will notify the EFBA of the availability of an upgrade.
2. The EFBA will beta test the application on the new version using the spare training EFB.



3. The EFBA will conduct a validation test to confirm accuracy and compliance with the RFM in the case of the WB application or functionality in case of the other applications.
4. Upon a successful beta test, the EFBA will update all EFBs or trained Pilots, depending on the type of revision, to update all EFBs.
5. EFBA or trained Pilots will update all EFBs.

Revision Notification and Tracking

The EFB Administrator will notify the Pilots via the RW Pilot group email address when an iOS or software application revision is required. Pilot actions will vary based on the type of revision.

Some updates will not require direct Pilot action as HeliService USA IT or the EFBA will make the updates remotely. Other revisions will require Pilots to update the EFBs. The revision email will include a summary of the change, if applicable.

1. Pilot Updating EFBs - Email Revisions that require the Pilot to update the EFB will include a set of instructions for completing the update. Pilots will then email the RW Pilot Email group that the revision is complete. The EFBA will track the update for each EFB and notify the Director of Operations when all EFBs are updated.
2. Remote Updates - The EFBA will notify the Pilots via group email of updates accomplished remotely. All Pilots will acknowledge the update by emailing the EFBA. The EFBA will include a summary of change, if applicable.
3. Priority - The EFBA will establish the priority of revisions. The notification email will include directions on whether the revision is to be made prior to next use of the EFB.

ForeFlight Application Database and Document Updates

1. HSUSA documents are automatically synced to ForeFlight through Dropbox. When a manual is updated, the EFBA will place the update in the ForeFlight synced folder of the Dropbox account. The next time ForeFlight is opened on each iPad, a prompt will appear stating new documents are available. Trained Pilots are authorized to select "yes" to download them. Pilots will notify the EFBA by email when a document download is completed. The Revision Compliance Form will be submitted to the Director of Operations, if applicable.
2. HSUSA documents are viewed on the "Documents" tab at the bottom of the ForeFlight home screen. All HSI EFB documents, including the OM-A, OpSpecs, and Ship/Platform Resume, are located under this tab.
3. Aeronautical database and document updates may be done by trained pilots. Updates shall be done on a Wi-Fi connection whenever possible and preferably at HSUSA bases. Aeronautical chart updates occur every 28 days. A few days prior to expiration, a red badge will appear on the ForeFlight application icon indicating an update is available. Navigate to the "More" tab within ForeFlight and select downloads to view a list of available downloads. Press the download button to complete the update.
4. The Pilot will download any database update that affects the HSUSA operations area, prior to using the EFB. Others, such as the business related downloads, can be delayed until later in the



shift.

Note: Pilots will not perform database and/or application software changes during operations (i.e., taxi, takeoff, in-flight, and landing).

12.5 Paper Removal/EFB Risk Mitigation

Base Backup EFB--Each Base will store one extra EFB which will provide a backup in the event of the failure of one or both aircraft EFBs.

12.6 Operating Procedures

12.6.1 General

12.6.1.1 Graphical Weather

Graphical weather, such as NEXRAD, is provided to HSUSA pilots through the flight deck MFD's and the EFB ForeFlight application. Pilots will only use this information for strategic / flight planning purposes. Pilots will not use graphical weather information for tactical decisions during flight to navigate through active weather systems or as a substitute for airborne weather radar or thunderstorm detection equipment.

12.6.1.2 Authorized Flight Conditions

The HSUSA EFB is authorized for use in all standard flight conditions during day, unaided night, and VFR / IFR operations. EFBs were successfully tested using the iPad "Display & Brightness" dimming function during night unaided operations. The ambient light from the EFB did not interfere with night unaided flight. Pilots will adjust the EFB display as needed for the ambient light conditions.

12.6.2 Prior to Flight

12.6.2.1 EFB Inspection

HSUSA pilots will inspect the primary and backup device as part of their shift preparation. The two EFB's will be checked for dents, cracks or erratic functions before each flight. If any of these conditions exist, use of the device must be discontinued and replaced with an adequately charged iPad. The pilot will notify the EFBA by email for EFB issue tracking.

12.6.2.2 EFB Charging Requirements

Pilots will check the charge state of both iPads. Verify that the backup iPad has a minimum 75% charge, and the primary iPad has sufficient charge for the planned flight. If either charge is insufficient, the iPad



will be charged in the pilot's office while not flying, or connected to a charging USB port in flight until the iPad is fully charged.

12.6.2.3 ForeFlight Database and Revision Status

Check email for notification from the EFBA or IT for EFB revisions. Comply with any instructions included with the emails based on the priority listed in the email. Familiarize with the summary of change if applicable. Check ForeFlight for database updates and update as required.

12.6.2.4 MEL

The Master Minimum Equipment List (MMEL) and MEL are not applicable to portable HSUSA EFB hardware, or EFB applications. All flights will be dispatched with a minimum of two fully functioning EFBs with satisfactory battery charge or aircraft charging available. In the event these dispatch requirements are not met, the flight may be dispatched with the backup paper charts stored at each base.

12.6.2.5 Weight and Balance

HSUSA utilizes Complete Flight, a Class B application to establish weight and balance (WB) for each helicopter and each flight. The HSUSA WB program was validated and approved under A061. Pilots will use Complete Flight to determine the Weight and CG for each flight leg.

12.6.2.6 EFB Aircraft Stowage

1. Primary EFB: Pilots will store the Primary EFB in the pilot side door pocket until needed for flight operations. The EFB will be mounted on the iPad kneeboard when the pilot uses it for hover, taxi, takeoff, and approach / landing.
2. Backup EFB: Pilots will store the backup EFB in the Thule Protective Carrying Case behind the pilot seat. This will provide access for the pilot in the event of a Primary EFB failure. The Otter Box display cover will be installed to protect the display screen.
3. USB Charging Cord: The charging cord will be stored in the Thule Protective Carrying Case behind the pilot seat to be available for in flight charging. This will mitigate the risk of the battery charge running down on the primary and backup EFB.

12.6.2.7 Chart Loading

1. VFR: Pilots will check for ForeFlight VFR database updates for the HSUSA operations area. Downloads will be completed as applicable.
2. IFR: Pilots will download IFR Approach and Departure charts to cover their destination and alternate airports prior to departure. Pilots will additionally download charts for airports along the route of flight as a contingency for aircraft or patient emergencies.

12.6.3 Flight Procedures



The use of the EFB during flight operations will be restricted to one EFB. The primary and backup will not be both used simultaneously. The single EFB in use will normally be the primary. The primary will be stored if it is necessary to put the backup in operation.

12.6.3.1 Ground Taxi Operations

1. If ATC assigns taxi procedures, utilize the zoom feature to expand the taxi route, zoom into runway incursion hot spots, and other features on the taxi chart.
2. While moving on the ground at airports, the pilot will have the Airport Diagram displayed on the EFB, if available. Taxi Progress will be monitored. Prior to takeoff, the pilot will select and display the appropriate chart for the departure.

12.6.3.2 Flight Operations

1. Climb - During climb, the pilot will monitor the applicable charts and route segments on the EFB.
2. Cruise - During the cruise or enroute phase of flight, the EFB will be periodically monitored for route progress. The pilot will select and review the anticipated arrival and approach procedures for the destination airport.
3. Arrival/Approach - If a published Arrival Procedure is being flown, the pilot will monitor the applicable chart. During the approach phase of flight, the EFB will be monitored and appropriate chart will be displayed.

12.6.3.3 After Landing/Shutdown

After flight, the EFB should be shut down to avoid battery loss and stored in the designated storage areas or removed from the aircraft. The EFB should be connected to a charging source to ensure full battery charge.

Caution: Avoid storing the EFB in direct sunlight or in an excessively hot or cold cabin.

12.6.3.4 Using EFB with Other Flight Deck Systems

HSUSA aircraft are equipped with multi-function displays (MFD's) that provide the pilot with moving maps, current position depiction, NEXRAD weather radar, METARS, etc. These installed flight displays will be the primary reference for the pilot during flight operations and maneuvering. The EFB's role will be secondary to these displays and will serve as a redundant situational awareness tool. The primary role for the EFB will be to provide the pilot with the appropriate IFR / VFR charts and information required to safely accomplish the flight.

Note: The flight deck system is the primary source of situational awareness data for the pilot. If there is any conflict between the installed flight deck systems and the EFB, then the flight deck system information will be used.

12.6.3.4.1 EFB Conflict with MFD Data



12.6.3.4.2 Own Ship Function

Pilots are authorized to use the "own-ship" function of ForeFlight, but will cross check the location and accuracy against the flight deck MFD moving map position depiction. The MFD's will take precedence if there is a conflict with the EFB.

Note: HSUSA complies with AC-76D paragraph 11.17 guidance that the EFB own-ship position function on an EFB is only authorized when the installed primary flight displays, weather display, or map displays also depict own-ship position.

12.7 Modifying the Authorized EFB Program

12.7.1 Minor Program Modifications

OpSpec A061 authorizes HeliService USA to evaluate and incorporate minor modifications to their authorized EFB program without FAA review or assessment. Minor program modifications include:

1. Adding/updating Type A EFB applications.
2. Updating Type B EFB applications.
3. Incorporating OS updates.

Note 1: Type B EFB application upgrades and EFB OS upgrades may incorporate significant changes to pilot training, procedures, and use. If any doubt exists about whether or not a program modification is considered minor or significant, HSUSA will consider it significant, unless they determine, through contact with the FAA POI, that it is minor.

Note 2: EMC testing may need to be performed, depending on the portable EFB EMC demonstration method utilized.

Minor changes will be evaluated by the EFBA and submitted to the DO for final approval. Upon approval, the EFBA will make the modification.

12.7.2 Significant Program Modifications

Modifications determined to be greater than minor program modifications require formal FAA review and evaluation before they can be authorized for incorporation into the HeliService USA EFB program. Unlike an evaluation of an initial EFB program application, applications for modifications to an authorized EFB program can be tailored at the discretion of the FAA inspector.

12.7.3 Unauthorized Modification

1. Pilots are not authorized to modify or to load any new or additional software for operational use that has not been tested and authorized by the EFBA or DO and under the revision control process



described in this Appendix.

Note: The EFBA is responsible to ensure the OS and EFB applications perform as intended.

2. Pilots will not download non-EFB software, applications or documents that are not listed in Appendix C and approved by the Director of Operations/ EFBA under the OM-A Appendix B revision process.

Note: Non-EFB applications will not be hosted on HSUSA EFB's. All software, applications and documents will be listed in the Program Catalog and Master Manual located in Appendix C.

12.8 Environmental Considerations

1. The EFB iPad is designed to be used in ambient temperatures between 32°F and 95°F, and stored from -4°F to 113°F. Using the device in extremely high or low temperature conditions may temporarily shorten battery life, cause the device to display a warning message, or shut off until temperatures return to appropriate levels.
2. iPads should not be left in the aircraft if it is to spend an extended period of time parked outside in the hot sun or cold winter conditions.

12.9 EFB Batteries

12.9.1 EFB Battery Design and Certification

The EFB iPad battery has been designed to meet international safety certification standards. All iPad batteries are tested, certified, and in compliance with the standards listed below. These standards meet the safety and testing criteria set forth in the FAA Advisory Circular AC 120-76D regarding the airworthiness and use of portable electronic flight bags.

United Nations (UN) Transport Regulations UN38.3: Covers battery safety during air transport.

Underwriters Laboratory (UL) 2054: Covers safety of lithium-ion batteries in general use; UL 60950-1 covers the use of batteries in information technology equipment.

Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) 1725: Covers safety of lithium-ion battery packs in general use.

12.9.2 EFB Battery Life

Each EFB iPad contains an internal Lithium Polymer (LiPo) battery as the primary source of power for the device. Below is the demonstrated useful life of a representative iPad Air WiFi model under the following conditions: ForeFlight app open and running, 75% screen brightness, WiFi ON and connected to a wireless GPS receiver, Bluetooth OFF, Cellular Data OFF and 72° F ambient air temperature.



Status Run Time:

100% battery life - 5.5 hours

50% battery life - 2.75 hours

12.9.3 EFB Battery Function Test

The EFB Administrator will functionally test EFB batteries every 24 calendar months. The functional test consists of the following steps:

1. Begin the functional test on a full battery charge with ONLY the ForeFlight application running and a 75% screen brightness setting.
2. In settings, ensure that the iPad won't auto lock (go to sleep) and start a timer.
3. Check each hour and confirm the battery can achieve at least 5 hours of use.
4. If successful, the EFBA will record the EFB unit, date of test, and a pass/fail result.

Results will be maintained by the EFBA. A failed test will require EFB battery replacement.

12.10 Emergency Procedures

12.10.1 EFB Failure

1. If an EFB or required application fails in cruise flight, an attempt may be made to reset the EFB. If unsuccessful, switch to the backup EFB. After any EFB failure, notify the EFBA of the failure. Provide details of the failure to include mode of flight, applications in use, ability to reset EFB, etc.
2. If an EFB or required application fails during taxi, departure or approach, the pilot will shift to the flight deck MFD's for required flight information. An attempt may be made to reset the EFB in cruise flight.

12.10.2 EFB Overheat

1. In the event of EFB overheat, move the EFB out of direct sunlight into a cooler location, preferably near a cool air source. Utilize the backup EFB until normal operations are restored on the primary EFB.
2. In the event of primary EFB failure, the backup EFB device will be connected to the USB charger if the battery life drops below 50%.

12.10.3 EFB Low Battery

The EFB will alert the pilot to a low battery condition at or below 10%. The pilot will connect the EFB to the USB charger and change to the backup EFB.

12.10.4 Lost or Stolen EFB



If a HeliService USA EFB is lost or stolen, notify the Director of Operations and EFB Administrator in the most expeditious manner possible. The EFB Administrator will attempt to track the device and possibly wipe the data remotely.

12.11 Reporting Irregularities of EFB Hardware or Software

The following will, as a minimum, be reported to the EFBA and DO via Email system:

1. Irregularities or problems with an EFB.
2. EFB systems that are OOS and backup is in use.
3. Provide feedback and suggestions for improvements to the EFB system.

12.12 EFB Training

All pilots will receive initial training IAW with the EFB curriculum during their BI training.



13 EFB ELECTRONIC MASTER MANUAL

The following are the general procedures to access and use the electronic manuals:

1. Select ForeFlight from the EFB home screen.
2. Select the "Documents" tab from the menu at the bottom of the ForeFlight homescreen.
3. Select the manual.
4. Scroll left or right to read the desired page.

13.1 General

This section is designated as the HSUSA Master Manual for the purpose of complying with A025-Electronic Manual System. The overall goal for the electronic manual system is to reduce paper in the cockpit and improve overall situational awareness for HSUSA pilots.

13.2 Authority and Responsibility

Director of Operations

1. The Director of Operations (DO) has overall responsibility for the Electronic Manual and EFB Program. This includes the HeliService USA, MELs and OpSpecs, including making revisions to the OM-A, MELs and ensuring the Operations Specifications are current and posted.
2. The electronic revision process will be the direct responsibility and under the authority of the Director of Operations. The process is described in 0.3 Revision Control and 0.4 OM-A Distribution.

EFB Administrator (EFBA)

The EFBA will be responsible, under the authority of the Director of Operations, to distribute the electronic copies and revisions of the documents listed in the Master Manual List and EFB Program Catalog to all HSI EFB's. Refer to the process described in paragraphs 12.4 and 12.5.

13.3 Delivery Media

The HSUSA Electronic Manual System will be an two fold. The Operations Manuals will be based on FleetPlan and supporting documents will be Adobe PDF based system for distribution of the electronic documents in the Master Manual List. Adobe PDF provides the level of security required to control and restrict editing of electronic documents.

13.4 Description of the Electronic Manual System

1. This phase of the HeliService USA Electronic Manual System will be implemented by installing the HSUSA OM-A, OpSpecs, MEL's and the EFB documents listed in this appendix into HSUSA EFB's. The EFB electronic versions of all documents will replace the paper copies currently in the aircraft.

Note 1: The distribution of electronic copies of the OM-A and OpSpecs is listed in OM-A



paragraph "Admin and Control 0.3".

2. The FSDO copy of the HSUSA OM-A and MEL's are maintained as an electronic PDF copy, with the current accepted revision inserted. The FSDO copy of the OM-A, MEL's and the OpSpecs are stored on the HSUSA SharePoint Drive and will serve as the basis for the electronic version of the HSUSA OM-A. The additional EFB documents listed in the Electronic Manual List and EFB Catalog will also be stored on the SharePoint Drive.
3. For initial installation, the Director of Operations will authorize the EFBA to download electronic copies of the Master OM-A, MEL's, OpSpecs and EFB documents to the EFB's. The EFBA will complete the download to the ForeFlight "Documents" tab using Dropbox.
4. The EFBA will email the Director of Operations when each download is complete. The Director of Operations will track the initial installation using the HSUSA Master Revision Tracking Compliance form.
5. The Director of Operations will notify the pilot group by email that the electronic documents are now loaded and available on the aircraft EFB's.
6. Paper copies of the OM-A, MEL's and OpSpecs will still be maintained at each base and by the managers designated in paragraph "Admin and Control 0.3 OM-A Revision and Distribution".

13.5 Electronic Manual System Changes

All changes or revisions will be submitted to the FSDO for review and acceptance. The Director of Operations will submit Revisions with LOEP in PDF format with a summary of the change.

Note: Changes to the Electronic Manual System require FAA Acceptance prior to implementation.

The general revision process is described in GOM "Administration and Control 0.3 OM-A Revision and Distribution". Differences for the EFB Electronic Manuals follow:

1. The Director of Operations will insert newly accepted revisions of the GOM, MEL's, EFB documents and amendments to the OpSpecs into the current PDF Master Manuals on the FleetPlan. Changes will be highlighted in yellow or light gray.
2. The Director of Operations will email the entire revised manual to the EFBA for download into the EFBs.
3. The EFBA will initiate and complete the document download process.
4. The shift Pilot that completes the revised document download.
5. The Director of Operations or Director of Maintenance (MELs) will track compliance on the HSI Master Revision Tracking Compliance form.

13.6 Training

Pilots will receive EFB training during Basic Indoctrination. Initial and recurrent training on the use, control and revision of electronic manuals.



13.7 Electronic Manuals Access

The primary location for all manual reference is FleetPlan. If there are secondary manuals or reference material not stored in FleetPlan, the documents will be stored in DropBox with access through ForeFlight. Secondary manual content must be clearly identifiable and viewable and must correlate and be comparable to what would be provided by a printed manual.

The following are the general procedures to access and use the electronic manuals:

1. Select ForeFlight from the EFB home screen.
2. Select the "Documents" tab from the menu at the bottom of the ForeFlight home screen.
3. Select the manual.
4. Scroll left or right to read the desired page.

13.8 Data Archiving

HeliService USA will archive Operations Manuals and OpSpecs in company software. All employees will have access to company software with individual credentials for login.

13.9 Prevention of Unauthorized Access and Data Corruption

FleetPlan creates restricted access for editing, review and publishing of manuals.

A history of all manual revisions are kept for historical recordkeeping.

13.10 Reporting Irregularities of EFB Hardware or Software

Irregularities will be reported to the EFBA via e-mail.

13.11 Listing of Manuals

Manual	Date
OM-A	18 Dec 2026
OM-B	21 July 2025
OM-C	01 Jan 2026
OM-D	01 Jan 2026
AW-169 MEL	01/13/2025
Hazardous Materials Operations Manual	26 April 2023



13.12 EFB Program Catalog

General

The EFB Program Catalog is a reference of the HSUSA EFB hardware (make and model) and EFB applications used by HSUSA Pilots on each aircraft and maintains configuration management of EFB program elements.

HSUSA Pilots

HSUSA Pilots will review the EFB Catalog at the start of each shift rotation to check for the latest revision date. The pilot will then check for Revision emails from the EFBA and confirm their EFB system is up to date.

The EFB Catalog will be readily available to the POI for inspection and review. The current version will be available for review during base inspections or visits.

Responsibilities

EFB Administrator (EFBA) (Refer to Chapter 12)

The EFB Administrator (EFBA), under the supervision of the Director of Operations, will be responsible for keeping the EFB Program Catalog current and accurate. The catalog will include:

1. Current EFB iOS, to include current version.
2. EFB applications, to include current version.

Director of Operations

1. The Director of Operations will forward revision compliance form to the POI.
2. The Director of Operations will file the HSUSA Compliance Form as a record of the program change. The document will be retained for one year.

Application	Version
iPad operating iOS	Current IOS
ForeFlight	Current Version
Complete Flight	Current Version
Microsoft 365	Current Version
Microsoft Office	Current Version
Microsoft Authenticator	Current Version



Google Chrome for iPad	Current Version
Fleet Plan	Current Version



14 DRUG AND ALCOHOL PROGRAM

[14 CFR Parts 120, 135, 121]

14.1 HeliService FAA/DOT Approved Drug and Alcohol Prevention Program

Elements of this program include:

1. The program is administered by Western Aeromedical Consortium and is responsible to randomly select from a list of aviation employees to be tested each quarter as required by 14 CFR § 120.217.
2. HSUSA or its contracted program administrator will designate a Medical Review Officer (MRO) who shall be a licensed physician with knowledge of drug and alcohol abuse disorders. The MRO will not be an employee of HSUSA and/or be an employee, agent or derive any financial interest or benefit from any laboratory that HSUSA uses to perform its drug and alcohol testing.
3. HSUSA contracts with DOT approved Drug and Alcohol Collection Facilities convenient to its bases of operation and provides those collection facilities with proper Chain of Custody Forms.
4. Appropriate HSUSA Managers inform employees selected for testing to report for testing prior to conducting any further safety sensitive duties.
5. HSUSA requires pre-employment drug screening for all prospective safety sensitive employees.
6. HSUSA provides Supervisor Drug and Alcohol Abuse awareness courses each year. This training meets the requirements for and enables HSUSA Supervisors to cause "Reasonable Suspicion" testing to be conducted.
7. All records for the Drug and Alcohol Prevention Program are kept at HSUSA's Principal Base of Operations (PBO) and will be made available for inspection by the FAA and other authorized government agencies.

14.2 Use of Alcohol – All Aviation Employees

1. The use of alcohol by company personnel while on duty is prohibited.
2. It is prohibited for HSUSA pilots, hoist operators, and AMT's to consume alcohol for a period of ten (10) hours prior to arriving for duty.
3. No pilot, hoist operator, or AMT shall refuse to submit to a post-accident, random, reasonable suspicion, or follow-up alcohol test. Failure to submit to any of these tests at the direction of management could result in immediate discharge.

14.3 Use of Drugs – All Employees

1. The "Substance Abuse Policy" statement contained in the HSUSA Drug and Alcohol Manual describes the specific regulations and policies that apply to the use of prohibited drugs under the FAA Anti-Drug Program.
2. Certain drugs in common use have a marked effect on the nervous system, which is temporarily detrimental to a pilot's flying ability and AMT's maintenance ability.



3. Safety sensitive employees should ask their physician concerning the effects of any prescribed drugs or nonprescription medicines the employee is taking or will take, will have on the nervous system.
4. HSUSA pilots are authorized and expected to ground themselves when the possibility of drug side effects exist or when they sense that their physical or mental condition might affect their ability to effectively perform their assigned duties. In such instances, a physician will be consulted and an estimated availability date for resumption of flying duties will be provided.
5. HSUSA AMT's are expected to take themselves off duty when the possibility of drug side effects exist or when they sense that their physical or mental condition might affect their ability to effectively perform their assigned duties. In such instances, a physician will be consulted and an estimated availability date for resumption of maintenance duties will be provided.

14.4 Contract Service/Outside Services

HSUSA will not use any contractor for safety-sensitive services unless that entity has an FAA-approved Drug and Alcohol program in place as required by 14 CFR Part 145.



15 **APPENDIX A - OPERATIONS SPECIFICATIONS**

Current Operations Specifications will be posted in Fleet Plan in the folder labeled "OpSpecs". Additional copies of the OpSpecs will be accessible via EFB document folders in ForeFlight.

15.1 **A001 Issuance and Applicability**



U.S. Department
of Transportation
Federal Aviation
Administration

Operations Specifications

A001 . Issuance and Applicability

HQ Control: 09/26/2023
HQ Revision: 030

a. These operations specifications are issued to HeliService USA LLC, whose principal base of operation is located at:

Primary Business Address:
150 Airport Rd.
North Kingston, Rhode Island 02582

Mailing Address:
150 Airport Rd
North Kingston, Rhode Island 02582

The holder of these operations specifications is the holder of Air Carrier Certificate Number ZS0A760J and shall hereafter be referred to as the certificate holder. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct:

On Demand	operations in	Common	carriage pursuant to Title 14 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) Section	119.25(b) - Rotorcraft On-Demand	and provided, at all times, the certificate holder has appropriate written economic authority issued by the Department of Transportation.
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The certificate holder will conduct these kinds of operations in accordance with the specific authorizations, limitations, and procedures in these operations specifications and all appropriate Parts of the CFR.

- b. These operations specifications are effective as of the "Date Approval is effective" listed in each paragraph and will remain in effect as long as the certificate holder continues to meet the requirements of Part 119 as specified for certification.
- c. The certificate holder is authorized to use only the business name which appears on the certificate to conduct the operations described in subparagraph a.
- d. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct flights under 14 CFR Part 91 for crewmember training, maintenance tests, ferrying, repositioning, and the carriage of company officials using the applicable authorizations in these operations specifications, without obtaining a Letter of Authorization (LOA), provided the flight does not involve the carriage of persons or property for compensation or hire.

HeliService USA LLC

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Amdt. No: 14

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J

U.S. Department
of Transportation
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Operations Specifications

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.

2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Matthew L Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 9/28/2023, [2] AMENDMENT #: 14
DATE: 2023.09.28 12:22:14 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.09.28 15:15:28 -05:00

HeliService USA LLC

A001-2
Amdt. No: 14

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J

15.2 A002 Definitions and Abbreviations

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U.S. Department
of Transportation
Federal Aviation
Administration

Operations Specifications

A002. Definitions and Abbreviations

HQ Control: 09/03/2025

HQ Revision: 11f

Unless otherwise defined in these operations specifications, all words, phrases, definitions, and abbreviations have identical meanings to those used in Title 14 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and Title 49 United States Code as cited in Public Law 103-272, as amended. Additionally, the definitions listed below are applicable to operations conducted in accordance with these operations specifications.

Term or Terms	Definition
<u>Agent(s)</u>	The significance of the words “agent” and “agents” as used in these operations specifications is that the certificate holder is the principal and that the certificate holder is accountable and liable for the acts or omissions of each of its agent or agents.
<u>Air Ambulance Aircraft</u>	An aircraft used in air ambulance operations. The aircraft must be equipped with at least medical oxygen, suction, and a stretcher, isolette, or other approved patient restraint/containment device. The aircraft need not be used exclusively as an air ambulance aircraft and the equipment need not be permanently installed.
<u>Air Ambulance Operations</u>	Holding out to the public as willing to provide air transportation to a person with a health condition that requires medical personnel including, but not limited to, advertisement, solicitation, association with a hospital or medical care provider in the following aircraft: (1) Airplanes, Air Ambulance operation of an airplane includes: (a) Unscheduled air transportation in an airplane of a person(s) with a health condition that requires: - Medical personnel to provide special care, including, but not limited to, basic life support (BLS) or advanced life support (ALS); and - Medical equipment necessary to support the level of care required for the patient(s), such as medical oxygen, suction, and/or a stretcher, isolette, or other approved patient restraint/containment device as determined by a health care provider. (2) Helicopters and Powered-lift. A flight or sequence of flights with a patient or medical personnel on board for the purpose of medical transportation conducted by a part 135 certificate holder authorized by the Administrator to conduct air ambulance operations. A helicopter or powered-lift air ambulance operation includes, but is not limited to: (a) Flights conducted to position the air ambulance at a site where medical personnel, a patient, donor organ, or human tissue will be picked up. (b) Flights conducted to reposition an air ambulance after completing transportation of the medical personnel, patient, donor organ, or human tissue transport.

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Amdt. No: 9

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



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Term or Terms	Definition
<u>Air Ambulance Operations (continued)</u>	(c) Flights initiated for the transport of a patient, donor organ, or human tissue that are terminated due to weather or other reasons. (Refer to Part 135, § 135.601 and Part 194, § 194.306 (mmm).)
<u>Airways Navigation Facilities</u>	Airways navigation facilities are those ICAO Standard Navigation Aids (VOR, VOR/DME, and/or NDB) which are used to establish the en route airway structure within the sovereign airspace of ICAO member states. These facilities are also used to establish the degree of navigation accuracy required for air traffic control and Class I navigation within that airspace.
<u>Approved Unit Load Device (ULD) Cargo</u>	Cargo loaded into a ULD, as defined by National Aerospace Standard (NAS) 3610, SAE Aerospace Standard (AS) 36100, Technical Standard Order (TSO) - C90, or other approval standards, that is approved for carriage within the airplane as specified in the Airplane Flight Manual / Weight and Balance Manual approved by the type certificate or supplemental type certificate
<u>Authority</u>	A power that a person is vested with.
<u>Auto Flight Guidance System (AFGS)</u>	Aircraft systems, such as an autopilot, auto throttles, displays, and controls, that are interconnected in such a manner so as to allow the crew to automatically control the aircraft's lateral and vertical flightpath and speed. A flight management system is sometimes associated with an AFGS.
<u>Automatic Dependent Surveillance (ADS)</u>	A function for use by air traffic services in which the ADS equipment in the aircraft automatically transmits data derived from on-board navigation systems via a datalink. As a minimum, the data include aircraft identification and three-dimensional position. ADS is sometimes referred to as ADS-A or ADS-Contract (e.g., a communications contract between the aircraft communications/surveillance system and an air traffic facility or service provider only).
<u>Automatic Dependent Surveillance-Broadcast (ADS-B)</u>	ADS-B is a function on an aircraft or surface vehicle operating within the surface movement area that periodically broadcasts via datalink its state vector (horizontal and vertical position, horizontal and vertical velocity) and other information. ADS-B is Automatic in that it requires no external stimulus to elicit a transmission. ADS-B is Dependent because it relies on on-board navigation sources. ADS-B Surveillance information is provided, via data link, to any users (either aircraft or ground-based) within range of the Broadcast signal.
<u>Available Landing Distance (ALD)</u>	ALD is that portion of a runway available for landing and roll-out for aircraft cleared for land and hold short operations (LAHSO). This distance is measured from the landing threshold to the hold-short point.

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15.3 A003 Aircraft Authorization

U.S. Department
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Operations Specifications

A003 . Aircraft Authorization

HQ Control: 03/10/2011

HQ Revision: 02h

The certificate holder is authorized to conduct operations under the provisions of Title 14 CFR Part 135 using aircraft with the approved configuration and operations described in the following table:

M/M/S	Type Section 119	Operation Configuration	Class/Category Operation	En Route	Condition of Flight
LEONARDO-AW169	119.25(b) - Rotorcraft On-Demand	PAX and Cargo	HEL	IFR/VFR	Day/Night

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15.4

A004 Summary of Special Authorizations and Limitations



U.S. Department
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Operations Specifications

A004. Summary of Special Authorizations and Limitations HQ Control: 08/03/2001
 HQ Revision: 000

a. The certificate holder, in accordance with the reference paragraphs, is authorized to:

	Reference Paragraphs
Conduct special en route IFR operations in Class G airspace.	A014
Use an autopilot in lieu of a second-in-command.	A015
Conduct helicopter and/or powered-lift air ambulance operations in accordance with 14 CFR Part 135 and/or Part 194, § 194.306, and this operations specification.	A021
Use the electronic signatures, electronic recordkeeping systems, or electronic manual system listed in A025.	A025
Conduct helicopter and/or powered-lift night vision goggle operations.	A050
Accept, handle, and carry materials regulated as Hazardous Materials (HazMat).	A055
Use an Electronic Flight Bag (EFB) in the aircraft as part of an authorized EFB Program.	A061
Use only actual passenger and baggage weights (no combinations of average and actual weights) for all its aircraft	A096
Conduct IFR en route operations with limitations and provisions.	B033
Conduct ferry flights under special flight permits with continuing authorization.	D084
Use an approved maintenance program for helicopter and/or powered-lift night vision goggle operations.	D093
Use an FAA-approved Minimum Equipment List (MEL).	D095
Use aircraft with nine or less passenger seats with the additional maintenance requirements of 14 CFR § 135.421 and § 194.402, applicable for rotorcraft and/or proprotor or other control system(s) operations.	D102
Use aircraft with nine or less passenger seats with the additional maintenance requirements of 14 CFR Section 135.421 applicable for emergency equipment.	D104
Use weight and balance control procedures.	E096
Conduct terminal flight operations under instrument flight rules - helicopter.	H101
Conduct operations using basic instrument approach procedures for helicopters.	H102
Conduct category I IFR landings other than airborne radar approaches - helicopter.	H103
Conduct helicopter offshore instrument operations using Offshore Standard Approach Procedure (OSAP), Airborne Radar Approach (ARA), and Helicopter En Route Descent Area (HEDA) Operations and/or in accordance with operations specification H104.	H104
Use alternate airport IFR weather minimums - helicopter.	H105
Conduct helicopter operations using standard takeoff minimums under Part 135.	H106
Conduct helicopter approach operations using an area navigation system.	H112
Conduct nonscheduled passenger and all-cargo (scheduled and nonscheduled) special terminal area IFR rotorcraft operations in Class G airspace.	H113
Conduct helicopter Category I, ILS, MLS, or GLS approach procedures with specific IFR landing minimums.	H117
Conduct helicopter circle-to-land maneuvers using IFR Category I landing minimums.	H118
Conduct helicopter contact approaches using IFR Category I landing minimums.	H119
Conduct special instrument approach procedure, departure procedure and standard terminal arrival (STAR) rotorcraft operations specified in operations specification H122.	H122

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Conduct Class I Navigation using area or long-range navigation systems with WAAS for rotorcraft RNP 0.3 en route and terminal operations. H123

b. The certificate holder is *not* authorized and shall not :

	Reference Paragraphs
Conduct operations under certain exemptions and/or deviations.	A005
Use an approved carry-on baggage program.	A011
Conduct extended overwater turbojet operations without required emergency equipment.	A013
Use an approved security program in helicopter operations.	A017
Conduct scheduled passenger helicopter and/or powered-lift operations.	A018
Use automotive gasoline as aircraft fuel.	A019
Conduct Part 135 airplane operations without instrument-rated pilots.	A020
Use an approved exit row seat program.	A022
Determine ground icing conditions for the purpose of flight [using an approved deicing/anti-icing procedure IAW CFR Section 135.227(b)(3)].	A023
Conduct airplane air ambulance operations under 14 CFR Part 135.	A024
Conduct Land and Hold Short Operations (LAHSO) at designated airports and specified runway configurations as identified by Air Traffic Services in Notice 7110.118, Appendix 1.	A027
Conduct aircraft wet lease arrangements.	A028
Use an aircraft interchange agreement under 14 CFR Section 119.49.	A029
Make arrangements with training centers and other organizations, and/or powered-lift manufacturers for certificate holder training in accordance with 14 CFR Part 135, § 135.324, and/or Part 194, as applicable.	A031
Adopt flight crewmember flight time limitations rules to establish flight attendant duty & flight time limitations & rest restrictions.	A032
Conduct certain CFR Part 135 operations in accordance with flight and rest time limitations under 14 CFR Sections 135.261 through 135.273.	A033
Conduct operations using an approved Advanced Qualification Program in accordance with 14 CFR Part 121, Subpart Y, subsection 121.901 - 121.925.	A034
Conduct commuter and on-demand operations as a basic Part 135 operator IAW the deviation provisions of Section 135.21(a), and 135.341(a).	A037
Conduct on-demand operations as a basic 14 CFR Part 135 operator IAW the deviation provisions of Sections 135.21(a), 119.69(b), and 135.341(a).	A038
Conduct single pilot-in-command operations as a Part 135 operator IAW the deviation provisions of Section 135.21(a), 119.69(b), and 135.341(a).	A039
Conduct operations as a single pilot operator.	A040
Conduct a pretakeoff contamination check during ground icing conditions for Part 135 airplane and/or powered-lift operators.	A041
Conduct Single Engine IFR (SEIFR) Passenger-Carrying Operations Under CFR Part 135.	A046
Conduct enroute ANVG operations and any additional authorized ANVG operations in accordance with 14 CFR Part 135 and the limitations and provisions of Operations Specification A051.	A051
Conduct data link communications.	A056

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Conduct "eligible on-demand operations" as defined in and in accordance with 14 CFR § 135.4 or in accordance with 14 CFR Part 194, §§ 194.306 (iii), (jii), and 194.307 for powered-lift.	A057
Use multiengine airplanes or single-engine turbine-powered airplanes under an SIC Professional Development Program (PDP).	A062
Use an approved flightcrew member certificate verification plan in accordance with 14 CFR Part 135, § 135.95(b).	A063
Use any combination of actual, standard average, or survey-derived average weights in its small cabin aircraft.	A097
Use any combination of actual, standard average, or survey-derived average weights for its medium cabin aircraft.	A098
Use any combination of actual, standard average, or survey-derived average weights for its large cabin aircraft.	A099
Use standardized and supporting instructor/check pilot curricula under contract or agreement with 14 CFR Part 142 training centers authorized to offer these curricula in accordance with 14 CFR Part 135, § 135.324.	A131
Conduct Part 135 rotorcraft and/or powered-lift operations without the radio altimeter equipment required by 14 CFR Part 135, §135.160(a) and/or Part 194, §194.306(v), under a deviation as provided in §135.160(b) and/or §194.306(v), and in accordance with the conditions and limitations of LODA A160.	A160
Conduct the Airline Transport Pilot (ATP) Certification Training Program (CTP), required by 14 CFR Part 61, §61.156 for all ATP applicants, subject to the conditions and limitations in OpSpec A304.	A304
Conduct training for powered-lift without fully functional dual controls in a training curriculum leading to the addition of a powered-lift category rating, instrument rating, and type rating to an existing commercial pilot certificate or higher in accordance with 14 CFR Part 194, § 194.253.	A307
Conduct flight operations within the territory and airspace of Iraq in accordance with a grant of exemption from SFAR 77.	A320
Conduct airplane operations using a Liquid Water Equivalent System (LWES).	A323
Allow persons eligible under 14 CFR Section 121.547(a)(3) access to the flightdeck using the CASS program and/or the FDAR program IAW the limitations and provisions of A348.	A348
Conduct In-Trail Procedures (ITP) using Automatic Dependent Surveillance-Broadcast IN (ADS-B IN).	A354
Use ADS-B In equipment and procedure(s) as specified in operations specification A355.	A355
Suspend its liability insurance due to seasonal operations.	A501
Use the air carrier merger and/or acquisition plan.	A502
Conduct the Airline Transport Pilot (ATP) Certification Training Program (CTP), required by 14 CFR Part 61, §61.156 for all ATP applicants, subject to the conditions and limitations in OpSpec A504.	A504
Establish an initial approval training curriculum under Part 135 leading to the addition of a category rating, instrument rating, and type rating for powered-lift to a commercial or higher pilot certificate in accordance with 14 CFR Part 194, § 194.243.	A505
Conduct final approval for a powered-lift training program under Part 135 leading to the addition of a powered-lift category rating, instrument rating, and type rating to a commercial or higher pilot certificate, in accordance with 14 CFR Part 194, § 194.243.	A506
Conduct operations into the Democratic Peoples Republic of Korea (DPRK).	A519

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Conduct civil flight operations in the Baghdad Flight Information Region (FIR) (ORBB) at altitudes below Flight Level (FL) 320 under a contract or subcontract, grant, or cooperative agreement with the sponsoring U.S. Government Department, Agency, or Instrumentality.	A530
Conduct flight operations in accordance with SFAR No. 112, 14 CFR Part 91, § 91.1603, in the Tripoli (HLLL) FIR under a contract or subcontract, grant, or cooperative agreement with the sponsoring U.S. Government Entity.	A532
Conduct flight operations in accordance with SFAR No. 107, 14 CFR Part 91, § 91.1613 in the territory and airspace of Somalia at altitudes below FL260 under a contract or subcontract, grant, or cooperative agreement with the sponsoring U.S. Government Entity.	A533
Conduct flight operations in accordance with SFAR No. 114, 14 CFR Part 91, § 91.1609, in the Damascus (OSTT) FIR under a contract or subcontract, grant, or cooperative agreement with the sponsoring U.S. Government Entity.	A535
Conduct flight operations in accordance with SFAR 115, 14 CFR Part 91, § 91.1611, in the specified areas of the Sanaa (OYSC) FIR, under a contract or subcontract, grant, or cooperative agreement with the sponsoring U.S. Government Entity.	A536
Issue an International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO) air operator certificate (AOC) through the Operations Safety System (OPSS).	A999
Conduct operations using approved driftdown or fuel dumping procedures.	B029
Conduct IFR Low Remote Continental Operations below FL 180 and/or IFR Alaska Special Minimum En Route Altitude (MEA) operations in accordance with B030.	B030
Conduct IFR en route operations.	B032
Conduct Class I navigation using an area navigation system.	B034
Conduct Class I navigation in the U.S. Class A airspace using an area or long-range navigation system.	B035
Conduct Oceanic Operations, and Remote Continental Operations at or above FL 180, regardless of ability to conduct One-hour Reliable Fix (1HRF) Operations	B036
Conduct operations in Central East Pacific (CEP) airspace.	B037
Conduct operations in North Pacific (NOPAC) airspace.	B038
Conduct operations in North Atlantic High Level Airspace (NAT HLA).	B039
Conduct operations in areas of magnetic unreliability.	B040
Conduct extended overwater operations using a single long-range communication system (S-LRCS).	B045
Conduct operations in reduced vertical separation minimum (RVSM) airspace.	B046
Conduct commercial air tour operations in accordance with 14 CFR Part 136, in the State of Hawaii, below an altitude of 1,500 feet above the surface.	B048
Conduct operations in the Grand Canyon National Park Special Flight Rules Area (GCNP-SFRA).	B049
Conduct VFR Minimum Altitudes lower than those specified in 14 CFR Part 135, §135.203(a) when operating in wing-borne flight mode.	B053
Conduct Oceanic and Remote Airspace Navigation Using a Single Long-Range Navigation System	B054
Conduct north polar operations.	B055
Conduct commercial air tour operations over certain national park(s) and tribal lands within or abutting those national park(s).	B057
Conduct extended operations (ETOPS) with two-engine airplanes.	B342
Conduct extended operations (ETOPS) in passenger-carrying airplanes with more than two-engines.	B344

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Conduct performance-based VFR fuel/energy requirements carrying fuel less than what is required by 14 CFR Part 135 §135.209(a) or (b) for powered-lift, under a deviation as provided in 14 CFR Part 194, §194.306(rr) and (ss) over specific routes with predetermined suitable landing areas identified.	B345
Operate into/out of or overfly sensitive international area(s) as identified in B450 in accordance with the authorizations, conditions, and limitations of B050.	B450
Conduct the specified EFVS operations under 14 CFR Part 91, § 91.176, in accordance with the limitations and provisions in C048.	C048
Use a destination airport analysis program.	C049
Conduct terminal instrument operations using specific procedures and landing minima for airplanes.	C051
Conduct operations using basic instrument approach procedures for airplanes.	C052
Conduct IFR approach procedures using special IFR landing minimums for airplanes.	C054
Derive alternate airport weather minimums from the standard table for airplanes.	C055
Use IFR takeoff minimums, 14 CFR Part 135 airplane operations - all airports.	C057
Conduct airplane SA CAT I instrument approach and landing operations.	C059
Conduct CAT II, or CAT II and CAT III instrument approach and landing operations in accordance with operations specification C060.	C060
Use flight control guidance systems for airplane automatic landing operations other than Categories II and III.	C061
Use manually flown flight control guidance systems certified for airplane landing operations.	C062
Conduct IFR area navigation (RNAV 1) and/or RNP 1 instrument departure procedures (DPs): RNAV 1 and/or RNP 1 Standard Terminal Arrivals Routes (STARs) published in accordance with 14 CFR Part 97; and/or tailored arrivals (TA).	C063
Conduct nonscheduled passenger and/or all-cargo, special terminal area IFR airplane operations in Class G airspace and at airports without an operating control tower.	C064
Use powerplant reversing systems for rearward taxi in specific airplane operations.	C065
Operate airplanes with special airport authorizations, provisions, and limitations.	C067
Conduct noise abatement departure profile operations with its subsonic turbojet-powered airplanes over 75,000 pounds gross takeoff weight.	C068
Conduct scheduled passenger and cargo operations at authorized airports.	C070
Use autopilot minimum use altitudes/heights in accordance with 14 CFR Part 135, § 135.93 and the limitations and provisions of operations specification C071.	C071
Conduct engine-out departure procedures with approved 10-minute takeoff thrust time limits.	C072
Use minimum descent altitude (MDA) as a decision altitude (DA) with vertical navigation (VNAV) on a nonprecision approach (NPA).	C073
Conduct airplane IFR circle-to-land approach maneuvers.	C075
Conduct airplane contact approaches using IFR Category I landing minimums.	C076
Conduct certain Part 135 turbojet operations in the terminal area using visual flight rules.	C077
Conduct 14 CFR Part 135 IFR airplane operations using lower than standard takeoff minima.	C079
Conduct scheduled passenger, special terminal area IFR airplane operations in Class G airspace and/or at airports without an operating control tower.	C080
Conduct the special Instrument Approach Procedure (IAP), departure procedure, Standard Terminal Arrival (STAR) and RNAV Visual Flight Procedure (RVFP) operations specified in OpSpec C081.	C081
Conduct RNAV operations substituting for 14 CFR Part 97 instrument approaches.	C085
Conduct RNP AR approaches in accordance with 14 CFR Part 97 and operations specification C384.	C384

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 Amdt. No: 29

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



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Conduct continuous airworthiness maintenance programs.	D072
Use an approved aircraft inspection program (AAIP).	D073
Use a reliability program for the entire aircraft.	D074
Use a reliability program for airframe, powerplant, systems, or selected items.	D075
Use short-term escalation.	D076
Use leased maintenance program authorization: U.S.-registered aircraft.	D080
Use short-term escalation authorization for borrowed parts that are subject to overhaul requirements.	D083
Use an Extended Operations (ETOPS) aircraft maintenance program for two-engine airplanes and/or large powered-lift aircraft in accordance with D086.	D086
Use a maintenance program for leased foreign-registered aircraft.	D087
Use maintenance time limitations for operators with a partial reliability program.	D088
Use maintenance time limitations for certificate holders subject to a Continuous Airworthiness Maintenance Program D072 authorization, without a reliability program.	D089
Use coordinating agencies for suppliers evaluation (CASE).	D090
Use listed airplanes for operations in designated RVSM airspace in accordance with B046 and D092.	D092
Use NVIS and NVGs on aircraft to conduct ANVGO per maintenance documents, under Part 135.	D094
Use aircraft with nine or less passenger seats with the additional maintenance requirements of 14 CFR Section 135.421 applicable for aircraft engine, propeller, and propeller control (governor).	D101
Use a single-engine aircraft maintained in accordance with §135.411 and §135.421 in passenger-carrying IFR operations.	D103
Suspend its liability insurance for specific aircraft in long-term storage or maintenance.	D106
Use an integrated aircraft health management (IAHM) program for maintenance credit for the aircraft with an approved IAHM system.	D302
Conduct Helicopter Category II operations.	H108
Conduct Helicopter Category III operations.	H109
Use flight control guidance systems for rotorcraft automatic landing operations.	H110
Use manually flown flight control guidance systems certified for rotorcraft landing operations.	H111
Use special airport authorizations, limitations, and provisions - Helicopter.	H114
Conduct helicopter operations using lower than standard takeoff minimums under Part 135.	H116
Conduct operations in authorized airports for scheduled operations - helicopter.	H120
Conduct scheduled passenger terminal area IFR rotorcraft operations in Class G airspace.	H121
Conduct the specified EFVS operations under 14 CFR Part 91, § 91.176, in accordance with the limitations and provisions in P048.	P048
Use a destination airport analysis program in Part 135 operations in accordance with 14 CFR Part 135, §135.385(f) and Part 194, §194.306 (hhh) and (iii) .	P049
Conduct aircraft SA CAT I instrument approach and landing operations.	P059
Use autopilot minimum use altitudes/heights in accordance with 14 CFR Part 135, § 135.93 and Part 194, §194.306 (c) and the limitations and provisions of operations specification P071.	P071
Use minimum descent altitude (MDA) as a decision altitude (DA) with vertical navigation (VNAV) on a nonprecision approach (NPA).	P073
Conduct RNAV operations substituting for 14 CFR Part 97 instrument approaches.	P085
Conduct terminal flight operations under instrument flight rules - Powered-lift.	P101

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Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



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Operations Specifications

Conduct operations using straight-in instrument approach procedures for powered-lift aircraft.	P102
Conduct category I IFR landings other than airborne radar approaches - Aircraft	P103
Conduct powered-lift offshore instrument operations using Offshore Standard Approach Procedure (OSAP), Airborne Radar Approach (ARA), and Helicopter En Route Descent Area (HEDA) Operations and/or in accordance with operations specification P104.	P104
Use alternate airport IFR weather minimums - powered-lift	P105
Use IFR takeoff minimums under Part 135 and, if authorized, use lower than standard takeoff minimums.	P106
Conduct CAT II, or CAT II and CAT III instrument approach and landing operations in accordance with operations specification P108.	P108
Use flight control guidance systems for powered-lift automatic landing operations.	P110
Conduct IFR area navigation (RNAV 1) and/or RNP 1 instrument departure procedures (DPs): RNAV 1 and/or RNP 1 Standard Terminal Arrivals Routes (STARs) published in accordance with 14 CFR Part 97; and/or tailored arrivals (TA).	P112
Conduct nonscheduled passenger and/or all-cargo, terminal area IFR powered-lift operations in Class G airspace and/or at airports without an operating control tower.	P113
Use special airport authorizations, limitations, and provisions - Powered-lift.	P114
Conduct circle-to-land maneuvers using IFR Category I landing minimums	P118
Conduct contact approaches using IFR Category I landing minimums.	P119
Conduct operations in authorized airports for scheduled operations.	P120
Conduct scheduled passenger terminal area IFR powered-lift operations in Class G airspace.	P121
Conduct the special Instrument Approach Procedure (IAP), departure procedure, Standard Terminal Arrival Route (STAR) and RNAV Visual Flight Procedure (RVFP) operations specified in OpSpec P122.	P122
Conduct IFR operations for powered-lift utilizing RNP 0.3 for en route and terminal operations.	P123
Conduct RNP AR approaches in accordance with 14 CFR Part 97 and operations specification P384.	P384

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Amdt. No: 29

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



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Operations Specifications

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.

2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Hall, Matthew, Principal Operations
Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 3/18/2026,
[2] AMENDMENT #: 29
DATE: 2026.03.18 10:30:08 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by LEGGETT, ZACHARY, Chief Pilot,
Part 135
DATE: 2026.03.19 12:56:09 -05:00

HELISERVICE USA LLC

A004-8
Amdt. No: 29

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



15.5 A006 Management Personnel



U.S. Department
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Operations Specifications

A006. Management Personnel

HQ Control: 09/08/2021
HQ Revision: 04a

a. The certificate holder is authorized to use the named personnel in the 14 CFR Part 135 management positions listed in Table 1 below. The Director of Operations and Chief Pilot listed in this operations specification must be direct employees of the certificate holder. The Director of Maintenance may or may not be a direct employee as indicated with their 14 CFR Part 119 position title.

Table 1 - Authorized Management Positions and Personnel

Part 119 Position Title	Name	Company Equivalent Position Title	Email Address
Chief Pilot, Part 135	Leggett, Zachary	Chief Pilot, Part 135	z.leggett@heliservice-usa.com
Dir. of Operations, Part 135	Russo, Paul	Dir. of Operations, Part 135	p.russo@heliservice-usa.com
Agent for Service	Russo, Paul	Agent for Service	p.russo@heliservice-usa.com
Director of Maintenance	Williams, Sean	Director of Maintenance	s.williams@heliservice-usa.com

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1. The Certificate Holder applies for the Operations in this paragraph.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Keefe, John, Principal Maintenance
Inspector (EA65)
[1] SUPPORT INFO: DOM Replacement - Added Sean
Williams
[2] EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/12/2026,
[3] AMENDMENT #: 17
DATE: 2026.01.13 06:39:34 -06:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.
Digitally signed by RUSSO, PAUL CHRISTOPHER on behalf of
Paul Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2026.01.12 11:55:53 -06:00

HeliService USA LLC

A006-2
Amdt. No: 17

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



15.6 A007 Other Designated Persons



DocuSign Envelope ID: 1E8D1344-6304-410D-A95B-77ACC3E1E9A1

 U.S. Department
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A007. Other Designated Persons**HQ Control: 12/19/2006****HQ Revision: 020**

- a. The following person is designated as the certificate holder's Agent for Service:

Russo, Paul
 150 Airport Rd.
 North Kingston, Rhode Island 02582
 United States

- b. The following personnel are designated to officially apply for and receive operations specifications for the certificate holder as indicated below.

Table 1 – Personnel Designated to Apply for and Receive Operations Specifications

Title	Name	Parts Authorized
Chief Pilot, Part 135	Leggett, Zachary	A,B,C,D,E,H
Dir. of Operations, Part 135	Russo, Paul	A,B,C,D,E,H
Agent for Service	Russo, Paul	A,B,C,D,E,H
Managing Director	Tosi, Michael	A,B,C,D,E,H
Director of Maintenance	DeCristofaro, Nicholas	A,D,E

- c. The following personnel or company email boxes are designated to receive Safety Alert for Operators (SAFO) and/or Information for Operators (INFO) messages for the certificate holder as indicated below. A receipt of the information by an air carrier or person is not required.

Table 2 – Personnel Designated to Receive SAFOs and/or INFOs

Name	Email Address	Telephone No.	Type of Information to Receive
Zachary Leggett	z.leggett@heliservice-usa.com	425-359-0719	Both OPS/AW
Paul Russo	p.russo@heliservice-usa.com	850-736-1756	Both OPS/AW
Nicholas Decristofaro	n.decrisofaro@heliservice-usa.com	401-741-3645	AW
Michael Tosi	m.tosi@heliservice-usa.com	508-330-6378	Both OPS/AW

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 Amdt. No: 16

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Operations Specifications

- 1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.
- 2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Keefe, John, Principal Maintenance Inspector (EA65)
[1] SUPPORT INFO: DOM change - Removed Jacob Lewis.
Added Nicholas DeChristofaro.
[2] EFFECTIVE DATE: 11/17/2025,
[3] AMENDMENT #: 16
DATE: 2025.11.17 08:45:11 -06:00

- 3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.
Digitally signed by RUSSO, PAUL CHRISTOPHER on behalf of Paul Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2025.11.17 11:05:54 -06:00



15.7 A008 Operational Control



U.S. Department
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Operations Specifications

A008 . Operational Control

HQ Control: 01/28/2019

HQ Revision: 040

a. The system described or referenced below in this subparagraph must be used by the certificate holder that conducts operations under 14 CFR Part 135 to provide operational control for its flight operations. The essential elements of operational control described in subparagraph d below must be included or described in that system.

OM-A Section 6.1

b. Certificate Holder Responsibilities.

(1) The certificate holder retains all responsibility for the operational control of aircraft operations, and thus the safety of each flight conducted under this certificate and operations specification, including the actions or inactions of all direct employees and agents of the certificate holder.

(2) This responsibility is not transferable to any other person or entity.

(3) The certificate holder's responsibility for operational control supersedes any agreement, contract, understanding, or arrangement, either oral or written, expressed or implied, between any persons or entities.

c. The certificate holder may not engage in any of the following practices:

(1) Franchise or share the certificate holder's authority for the conduct of operations under its certificate and operations specifications to or with another person or entity.

(2) Use a "Doing Business As" (DBA) name in any way that represents an entity that does not hold an Air Carrier or Operating Certificate and operations specifications as having such a certificate and operations specifications.

(3) Engage in a Wet Lease Contrary to 14 CFR Part 119, § 119.53. In accordance with § 119.53(b), the certificate holder may not wet lease from or enter into any wet leasing arrangement with any person not authorized by the FAA to engage in common carriage operations under 14 CFR Part 121 or Part 135 (as applicable), whereby that other person provides an aircraft and at least one crewmember to the certificate holder. A lease, or other business arrangement with a lease, is considered a wet lease if any of the following conditions exists:

(a) The certificate holder and the aircraft owner or lessor agree that the certificate holder is required to use the aircraft owner's or lessor's pilot in Part 135 operations;

(b) The aircraft owner or lessor is obligated to furnish pilots to the certificate holder to operate the aircraft; or

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(c) The aircraft owner or lessor has the power to veto who the certificate holder will use to pilot the aircraft in Part 135 operations, so as to limit the certificate holder to using only the owner's or lessor's pilots.

(4) Transfer, surrender, abrogate, or share operational control responsibility with any party.

(5) Engage in any arrangement with an aircraft owner, lessor or any other person or entity, such as an aircraft management entity, which allows the use of an aircraft for operations under these operations specifications without a complete, effective, and sustainable transfer of operational control to the certificate holder for all Part 135 operations conducted under these operations specifications.

d. Elements of Operational Control. The following items are essential elements of operational control and are required to be components of the operational control system, used by the certificate holder, and as described or referenced in subparagraph a above:

(1) Crewmember Requirements. The certificate holder may not conduct any operation under Part 135, unless each of the certificate holder's crewmembers is:

(a) The certificate holder's direct employee or agent during every aspect of the Part 135 operations, including those aspects related to any preflight and postflight duties. The certificate holder is accountable for the actions and inactions of these persons during all of its aircraft operations.

(b) Currently trained and/or tested, qualified, and holds the appropriate airman and medical certificates to conduct flights for the certificate holder under Part 135, and is otherwise qualified to accept the specific flight assignment, considering flight and rest requirements, airspace qualification and the type of operation intended in the assignment. Each pilot must be specifically listed by name and airman certificate number on a list of pilots maintained by the certificate holder at its main base of operations or listed in operations specification A039 or A040, if applicable. This information must be available for inspection by the Administrator as specified in Part 135, § 135.63.

(2) Aircraft Requirements.

(a) The certificate holder may not conduct any operation under Part 135 unless each aircraft used in its Part 135 operations is:

(i) Owned by the certificate holder and remains, without interruption in the certificate holder's legal and actual possession (directly or through the certificate holder's employees and agents) during all of its Part 135 flights; or

(ii) Leased by the certificate holder or otherwise in the legal custody of the certificate holder and remains in the certificate holder's exclusive possession or custody during all of its Part 135 flights.

(b) For each aircraft the certificate holder uses under these operations specifications, the aircraft owner or other lessee of the aircraft may operate the aircraft under 14 CFR Part 91, under the control and responsibility (including potential liability for an unsafe operation) of the owner or other lessee, as long as the following condition is met:

(i) The certificate holder ensures that the maintenance of the aircraft continues to adhere to the certificate holder's maintenance program at all times; or

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(ii) When the aircraft is returned to the certificate holder but before the aircraft is operated under Part 135 again by the certificate holder, that aircraft undergoes an appropriate airworthiness conformity validation check.

(3) Exclusive Aircraft Use Requirements for Part 135 Operations. At least one aircraft that meets the requirements for at least one kind of operation authorized in the certificate holder's operations specifications must remain in the certificate holder's exclusive legal and actual possession (directly or through the certificate holder's employees and agents) as specified in § 135.25. This aircraft cannot be listed on any other Part 119 certificate holder's operations specification during the term of the exclusive use lease.

(4) Use of Other Business Name(s) (DBA).

(a) The certificate holder may not allow or create the circumstances that would enable any other entity to conduct a flight for compensation or hire under Part 119, 121 or 135 as if that entity were the certificate holder.

(b) The certificate holder must not operate an aircraft under Part 135 under the legal name or fictitious name of any other person or entity, unless authorized in operations specification A001 of these operations specifications. Such authorization does not authorize any person or entity, other than the certificate holder, to conduct operations under the certificate holder's certificate and operations specifications.

(c) The certificate holder may not allow the use of a fictitious name to obscure the certificate holder's responsibility and accountability to exercise operational control over its flight operations.

(5) Aircraft Operation Agreements and Other Arrangements.

(a) In accordance with § 119.53(b), the certificate holder may not wet lease from or enter into any wet leasing arrangement with any person not authorized by the FAA to engage in common carriage operation under Part 121 or 135, whereby that other person provides an aircraft and at least one crewmember to the certificate holder. This requirement does not prohibit the separate use of a crewmember by the certificate holder when that crewmember is also employed by the aircraft's owner or lessor.

(b) Any agreement or arrangement between the certificate holder and an aircraft owner must fully explain how the certificate holder oversees and ensures that only airworthy aircraft are used in its Part 135 operations.

(c) The certificate holder's operational control system must include a system of ensuring that it has complete, effective, and sustainable operational control over each aircraft operated under these operations specifications, and that no surrender or loss of operational control exists.

(d) The certificate holder may not operate any aircraft in Part 135 operations, which is subject to an agreement between the certificate holder and the aircraft owner or any lessee of the aircraft, if that agreement shifts liability and accountability for the safety of the certificate holder's Part 135 flight operations from the certificate holder to the aircraft owner or other parties.

(6) Management Personnel and Persons Authorized to Exercise Operational Control.

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(a) Prior to conducting a Part 135 flight or series of flights, at least one management person who is a direct employee listed in operations specification A006, Management Personnel, or a management person designee who is a direct employee of the certificate holder, other than a pilot assigned to the specific flight or series of flights, must determine and have sufficient knowledge of the following:

(i) Whether each assigned crewmember is qualified and eligible to serve as a required crewmember in the aircraft and type of operation to which the crewmember is assigned (see subparagraph d(1)(b) above); and

(ii) Whether the aircraft assigned for use is listed in operations specification D085 and is airworthy under the certificate holder's FAA-approved maintenance, inspection, or airworthiness program, as appropriate.

(b) Prior to conducting a Part 135 flight or series of flights, at least the pilot assigned in accordance with subparagraph d(6)(a)(i) above must determine and have sufficient knowledge of the following:

(i) Whether a Part 135 flight or series of flights can be initiated, conducted, or terminated safely and in accordance with the authorizations, limitations, and procedures approved in the certificate holder's operations specifications, general operations manual (GOM), or subparagraph a above and the appropriate regulations.

(ii) Notwithstanding the requirements of subparagraph d(6)(a) above, this determination and knowledge described in subparagraph d(6)(b)(i) above may be made for the certificate holder by pilots and/or flightcrew members assigned to a flight or series of flights, in accordance with the policies, procedures, and standards prescribed by the certificate holder.

(A) Such non-management persons must meet the requirements of § 119.69(d), and their names, titles, and duties, responsibilities, and authorities must be specified in the GOM, or described in subparagraph a above; or

(B) For those certificate holders issued operations specification A039 or A040, the persons listed in those operations specifications must determine and have sufficient knowledge of whether a Part 135 flight or series of flights can be initiated, conducted, or terminated safely in accordance with the authorizations, limitations, and procedures approved in subparagraph a above and in accordance with the appropriate regulations.

(7) Operational Control Information Requirements.

(a) Prior to the certificate holder conducting any flight operation under Part 135, the certificate holder must provide information to the designated PIC that indicates which flight or series of flights will be conducted under Part 135, that indicates which Part 91 flights will be conducted by the certificate holder, and that the certificate holder is accountable and responsible for the safe operations of these flights or series of flights. For those issued operations specification A039 or A040 the pilots listed in those operations specifications are accountable and responsible for the safe operations of these flights or series of flights.

(b) The system of operational control for Part 135 operations must ensure that each pilot is knowledgeable that the failure of a pilot to adhere to the certificate holder's directions and

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instructions, or compliance with directions or instructions from an aircraft owner (other than the certificate holder), or any other outside private person or private entity, that are contrary to the certificate holder's directions or instructions, while operating aircraft under these operations specifications, may be contrary to Parts 119 and/or 135, and therefore may be subject to legal enforcement action by the FAA.

(c) These requirements do not apply to the following:

(i) ATC instructions, clearances and NOTAMs received from FAA or cognizant foreign ATC authorities,

(ii) Aeronautical safety of flight information received by the pilot, and

(iii) Operation under the emergency authority of the PIC in accordance with Part 91, § 91.3(b), and /or Part 135, § 135.19(b).

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.

2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by David Roakes, Principal Avionics Inspector (EA65)

[1] SUPPORT INFO: Updated for manual reference

[2] EFFECTIVE DATE: 8/8/2023, [3] AMENDMENT #: 10

DATE: 2023.08.08 17:28:57 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135

DATE: 2023.08.08 17:01:07 -05:00

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A008-5
Amdt. No: 10

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



15.8 A009 Airport Aeronautical Data



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A009 . Airport Aeronautical Data

HQ Control: 12/05/1997

HQ Revision: 01b

a. The system described or referenced in this paragraph is used by the certificate holder to obtain, maintain, and distribute current aeronautical data for the airports it uses.

(1) ForeFlight, OM-A 12.6.2.7

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.

2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Matthew L Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/30/2023, [2] AMENDMENT #: 5
DATE: 2023.05.30 07:10:21 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.06.01 07:32:58 -05:00



15.9 A010 Aviation Weather Information

U.S. Department
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Administration

Operations Specifications

A010 . Aviation Weather Information

HQ Control: 10/06/2020

HQ Revision: 04b

a. The certificate holder conducting 14 CFR Part 135 operations is authorized to use weather reporting facilities operated by the National Weather Service (NWS), a source approved by the NWS, or a source approved by the Administrator.

b. The Administrator approves the certificate holder to use the following sources of aviation weather information:

The NWS or a source approved by the NWS (within the 48 contiguous United States and the District of Columbia).

For reports of adverse weather phenomena: Pilot Weather Reports (PIREP) provided by aircraft of the same or similar type and size.

For reports of adverse weather phenomena: Aircraft Reports (AIREP) provided by aircraft of the same or similar type and size.

c. The certificate holder is approved to use an Enhanced Weather Information System (EWINS) to obtain and disseminate aviation weather information for the control of flight operations.

Table 1 - EWINS

Name of Weather Source	Name of Manual Containing EWINS	Date of Initial Approval of EWINS	Date of Latest Revision of EWINS
N/A			

d. In accordance with Part 135, § 135.213(b), the certificate holder is authorized to deviate from § 135.213(a) in accordance with A005 of these operations specifications and Table 2 of this operations specification.

Table 2 – Deviation in Accordance with § 135.213(b)

Location of Operation	Location of Weather Observation	Date of National Weather Service Concurrence	Conditions and Limitations	Revision Date of Conditions and Limitations
N/A				

e. If authorized in subparagraph b, the certificate holder may operate to destinations listed in Table 3 below with a published approach in a noncontiguous State under IFR and conduct an instrument approach without a destination METAR in accordance with the approved departure and en route weather evaluation procedures contained in the certificate holder's manual, reference: .

Table 3 - Airports Served by FAA-Approved Noncertified Supplemental Weather Information

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U.S. Department of Transportation Federal Aviation Administration				Operations Specifications			
Airport ID		FAA-Approved Weather Info Techniques		Certificate Holder's Manual Reference for Training/Evaluation Procedures		REV.	
N/A							

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.

2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.
- 

Digitally signed by Matthew L Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/30/2023, [2] AMENDMENT #: 9
DATE: 2023.05.30 07:10:27 -05:00
3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.06.01 07:32:58 -05:00

15.10

A014 Special En Route IFR Operations in Class G Airspace

U.S. Department of Transportation Federal Aviation Administration	Operations Specifications
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A014 . Special En Route IFR Operations in Class G Airspace

HQ Control: 08/09/2002

HQ Revision: 04a

The certificate holder is authorized to conduct en route IFR operations in Class G airspace provided the following provisions are met:

- a. All such IFR operations are conducted within the areas of Class G airspace specifically authorized for IFR flight in operations specification paragraph B050 of these operations specifications.
- b. All such operations are conducted in accordance with the limitations and provisions of operations specification paragraph B032 of these operations specifications.
- c. The facilities and services necessary to safely conduct IFR operations in Class G airspace are available and operational during the period of operation in Class G airspace.
- d. All Title 14 CFR Part 135 turbojet operations in Class G airspace are conducted under instrument flight rules.

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Matthew L Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1]EFFECTIVE DATE: 10/31/2024, [2] AMENDMENT #: 0
DATE: 2024.10.31 11:38:18 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.
- Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2024.11.01 09:16:24 -05:00

HeliService USA LLC

A014-1
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J

15.11

A015 Autopilot in Lieu of Required Second-in-Command

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Operations Specifications

A015 . Autopilot in Lieu of Required Second-in-Command

HQ Control: 04/30/1998
HQ Revision: 01b

The certificate holder is authorized to use the aircraft and its autopilot system listed below, in IFR operations, in lieu of a required second-in-command provided the following provisions are met.

- a. The pilot-in-command has satisfactorily completed the proficiency check requirements of 14 CFR Section 135.297(g).
- b. The installed autopilot system is operational in accordance with Section 135.105(c)(1).

AIRCRAFT M/M/S	AUTOPILOT SYSTEM MANUFACTURER/MODEL	ADDITIONAL CONDITIONS/LIMITATIONS
LEONARDO-AW169	6F2210V00351 Leonardo Electric / DC-PAP	N/A
LEONARDO-AW169	6F2210V00251 Selex ES / DC-PAP	N/A

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.
-  Digitally signed by Matthew L Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 3/17/2025, [2] AMENDMENT #: 0
DATE: 2025.03.17 07:16:33 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.
- Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2025.03.17 08:00:24 -05:00

15.12 A021 Helicopter Air Ambulance (HAA) Operations

Docusign Envelope ID: 1EB7D03D-3512-4A13-8466-372CCDB4CC77

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A021. Helicopter and/or Powered-Lift Air Ambulance Operations

HQ Control: 09/03/2025

HQ Revision: 07a

a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct helicopter and/or powered-lift air ambulance operations in accordance with 14 CFR Part 135 and/or Part 194, § 194.306, and this operations specification.

b. **Off Airport/Off Heliport/Off Vertiport Takeoff and Landing Operations.** The certificate holder is authorized to conduct off airport/off heliport/off vertiport takeoff and landing operations provided the site to be used is adequate for the proposed operation. The certificate holder will consider the size, type of surface, surrounding obstructions, and if applicable, lighting. During night operations, lighting sources must provide adequate illumination of the takeoff/landing area and of any obstructions that may create potential hazards during approach, hovering, taxiing, and departure operations.

c. **Helicopter and Powered-Lift Air Ambulance Specific Flightcrew Member Training.** The flightcrew must satisfactorily complete the certificate holder's approved training program prior to commencing air ambulance flights.

d. **Local Flying Areas.** The certificate holder is authorized to designate, and following FAA approval, to use the local flying areas listed in Table 1 below. Local flying areas allow qualified pilots to use lower visual flight rules (VFR) operating minima depicted in Part 135, § 135.609 for helicopters or Part 194, § 194.306 (qqq) for powered-lift. Local flying areas must meet the criteria contained in § 135.609 for helicopters or § 194.306 (qqq) for powered-lift.

(1) Local flying areas may be any shape but must not exceed 50 nautical miles from any single point designated by the certificate holder.

(2) Local flying areas need not be contiguous, however, any flight outside a local flying area must be operated in accordance with the non-local area minima depicted in § 135.609 for helicopters or § 194.306 (qqq) for powered-lift.

(3) Pilots may be qualified for more than one local flying area. Pilots who have not passed a knowledge test on a particular local flying area within the previous 12 calendar-months, regardless of operational experience in that area or Helicopter Terrain Awareness and Warning System (HTAWS) or Night Vision Imaging System (NVIS) qualification, must use the non-local area minima depicted in § 135.609 for helicopters or § 194.306 (qqq) for powered-lift when operating in that area.

Table 1 – Authorized Air Ambulance Operations

Local Flying Area Base	Description	Coordinating Geographic FSDO (if outside the responsible FSO)
KOQU	50 nm, circle	EA61
KMVY	50 nm, circle	EA61
I74	50 nm, circle	GL07
KVES	50 nm, circle	GL07
I68	50 nm, circle	GL07

e. **Medical Personnel Training.** The certificate holder is authorized to conduct FAA-approved medical personnel safety training and checking in accordance with § 135.621(b) and § 194.306 (xxx). Medical

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Personnel who have successfully completed this training and checking within the past 24 calendar-months are exempt from preflight safety briefings to the extent defined by the certificate holder.

f. **Operations Control Center.** In accordance with § 135.619 and § 194.306 (www), an Operations Control Center is not required. The certificate holder is prohibited from operating more than 9 HAA helicopters, powered-lift air ambulances, or any combination thereof.

g. **Class G VFR ceiling and visibility minima relief.** The certificate holder may, at their discretion, apply § 135.609 NVIS Class G VFR ceiling and visibility minima when the helicopter is properly certificated for NVIS and the flightcrew is compliant in all respects with operations specification A050, Helicopter and/or Powered-lift Night Vision Goggle Operations.

h. The certificate holder, if authorized to conduct either helicopter or powered-lift air ambulance operations under instrument flight rules (IFR), is authorized to conduct those operations under the provisions of § 135.611 or § 194.306 (mr) and § 135.613 or §§ 194.306 (sss) and (ttt), as appropriate to the category of the aircraft.

i. In compliance with Title 49 of the United States Code (49 U.S.C.) § 44731, Collection of Data on Helicopter Air Ambulance Operations, all Part 135 certificate holders utilizing this operations specification must, as mandated by the U.S. Congress, report the following flight operations data to the FAA in their **Helicopter Air Ambulance Mandatory Flight Information Report**.

- The number of helicopters that the certificate holder uses to provide helicopter air ambulance services and the base locations of the helicopters.
- The number of flights and hours flown during which helicopters operated by the certificate holder were providing helicopter air ambulance services.
- The number of patients transported and the number of patient transport requests for a helicopter providing air ambulance services that were accepted or declined by the certificate holder and the type of each such flight request (such as scene response, inter-facility transport, and organ transport).
- The number of accidents, if any, involving helicopters operated by the certificate holder while providing air ambulance services and a description of the accidents.
- The number of hours flown under IFR by helicopters operated by the certificate holder.
- The number of hours flown at night by helicopters operated by the certificate holder.
- The number of incidents, if any, in which a helicopter was not directly dispatched and arrived to transport patients but was not utilized for patient transport.

Reports must be submitted for each calendar year on a template provided by the FAA. Reports must be submitted not later than 30 calendar-days following the close of the calendar year.

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1. The Certificate Holder applies for the Operations in this paragraph.

2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Hall, Matthew, Principal Operations
Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 12/18/2025,
[2] AMENDMENT #: 1
DATE: 2025.12.18 15:10:09 -06:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by RUSSO, PAUL CHRISTOPHER on behalf of
Paul Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2025.12.18 15:14:54 -06:00



15.13 A025 Electronic Signatures, Electronic Recordkeeping Systems and Electronic Manual Systems



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**A025. Electronic Signatures, Electronic Recordkeeping Systems and
Electronic Manual Systems****HQ Control: 12/11/2024****HQ Revision: 040**

a. The certificate holder is authorized to use the electronic signatures, electronic recordkeeping systems, or electronic manual system listed in this operations specification.

b. The certificate holder is authorized to use an electronic signature to attest to, certify, endorse, or otherwise authenticate the items listed in Table 1. The following conditions apply:

(1) The certificate holder must notify the responsible Flight Standards office of changes to the electronic signature process.

(2) The certificate holder must revise the manual or document listed in Table 1 to reflect any changes to the electronic signature process.

Table 1 - Electronic Signatures

Kind of Electronic Signature	Manual or Document Containing the Electronic Signature Process
Signature of Authorized Certificated Mechanic or Repairman on an Airworthiness Release or Aircraft Maintenance Log (§135.443)	OM-A Chapter 17.2
Signature on Training or Qualification Record	OM-A Chapter 17.4

c. The certificate holder is authorized to use the electronic recordkeeping system(s) listed in Table 2 to maintain records and make them available in accordance with the 14 CFR Part 135 recording and recordkeeping requirements. The following conditions apply:

(1) The certificate holder must have a process for software revision control.

(a) The software revision control process must be contained in the manual or document listed in Table 2.

(b) The software revision control process must include certificate holder notification to the responsible Flight Standards office whenever software revisions affect the following items:

- (i) Record entry.
- (ii) Record display.
- (iii) Record access.
- (iv) Data quality.

Table 2 – Electronic Recordkeeping System(s)

Kind of Record	Name of Electronic System	Manual or Document Containing the Electronic Recordkeeping System Description
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Pilot Records	Fleet Plan, SharePoint	OM-A Chapter 17
Duty Logs	Complete Flight	OM-A Chapter 17
Maintenance	Digital AirWare	OM-A Chapter 17

d. The certificate holder is authorized to use the electronic manual system described in the master manual listed in Table 3 to maintain, distribute, and otherwise make available the certificate holder's manuals in accordance with the requirements of Part 135.

(1) The certificate holder must notify the responsible Flight Standards office of changes to the electronic manual system.

(2) The certificate holder must revise the master manual listed in Table 3 to reflect any changes to the electronic manual system.

Table 3 - Electronic Manual System

Master Manual Containing the Electronic Manual System Description and List of Electronic Manuals
OM-A Chapter 13

e. The certificate holder is approved to provide electronic access to the minimum equipment list(s) (MEL) for the aircraft listed in Table 4.

Table 4 – Electronic Access to Minimum Equipment List(s)

MEL by Aircraft M/M or M/M/S as Specified by MEL
LEONARDO-AW169

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1. The Certificate Holder applies for the Operations in this paragraph.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Hall, Matthew, Principal Operations
Inspector (EA65)

[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 10/1/2025,

[2] AMENDMENT #: 2

DATE: 2025.10.01 10:14:58 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

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A025-3
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15.14 A050 Helicopter Night Vision Goggle Operations (HNVGO)

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A050 . Helicopter Night Vision Goggle Operations (HNVGO) HQ Control: 04/20/2022
 HQ Revision: 060

a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct HNVGO in accordance with 14 CFR Part 135 and the limitations and provisions of this operations specification.

Note: Night vision goggle (NVG) operation means the portion of a flight that occurs during the time period from 1 hour after sunset to 1 hour before sunrise where the pilot maintains visual surface reference using NVGs in a helicopter that is approved for such an operation.

b. The certificate holder may not use any person, nor may any person serve as a crewmember in passenger-carrying HNVGO under the provision of Part 135, unless that person has satisfactorily completed the appropriate initial or recurrent phase, as applicable, of the certificate holder's approved training program for HNVGO since the beginning of the 12th calendar-month before that service. The grace provisions of Part 135, § 135.301 apply to these required checks.

c. The certificate holder may not use any person, nor may any person serve as a pilot-in-command (PIC) of a helicopter during passenger-carrying HNVGO, unless that person has met the operating experience and proficiency requirements outlined below:

(1) A person may act as PIC in an NVG operation with passengers on board only if, within 2 calendar-months preceding the month of the flight, that person performs and logs the following tasks as the sole manipulator of the controls on a flight during an NVG operation:

(a) Three takeoffs and three landings, with each takeoff and landing including a climbout, cruise, descent, and approach phase of flight (only required if the pilot will be authorized to use NVGs during the takeoff and landing phases of the flight).

(b) Three hovering tasks (only required if the pilot will be authorized to use NVGs during the hovering phase of flight).

(c) Three area departure and area arrival tasks.

(d) Three tasks of transitioning from aided night flight (aided night flight means that the pilot uses NVGs to maintain visual surface reference) to unaided night flight (unaided night flight means that the pilot does not use NVGs) and back to aided night flight.

(e) Six NVG operations.

(2) A person may act as PIC using NVGs in an NVG operation without passengers only if, within the 4 calendar-months preceding the month of the flight, that person performs and logs the tasks listed in subparagraphs c(1)(a)-(e) of this operations specification as the sole manipulator of the controls during an NVG operation.

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(3) In addition, the pilot must have accomplished one helicopter NVG Visual Inspection and Operational Check within the preceding 60 calendar-days.

(4) All HNVGO maneuvers must be conducted in accordance with procedures stated in the certificate holder's FAA-approved HNVGO training program.

d. Helicopter Air Ambulance (HAA) Operations. If the certificate holder is authorized to conduct HAA operations through issuance of operations specification A021, Helicopter Air Ambulance (HAA) Operations, the certificate holder may use no lower than the visual flight rules (VFR) weather minimums specified in § 135.609 when conducting HAA operations using HNVGO in Class G Airspace.

e. Additional Checking Requirements. The authorized Night Vision Imaging System (NVIS) must not be used to conduct HNVGO under the provisions of part 135 unless all the necessary equipment that is installed or modified as part of the entire NVIS is maintained in accordance with the provisions of operations specification D093, Helicopter Night Vision Goggle Operations (HNVGO) Maintenance Program, and the following:

(1) Prior to conducting HNVGO, each crewmember will complete any required checks on the NVIS to be used in accordance with Table 1:

Table 1 - Required Checks for Night Vision Imaging System (NVIS) Users

Required Check	Document	Reference within Document
NVG Preflight	GOM (OM-A)	Section 6.6.5
NVIS Aircraft Preflight	GOM (OM-A)	Section 6.6.5

(2) Any NVIS equipment that does not pass a required check is prohibited from use in HNVGO.



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1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.

2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Matthew L Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 3/5/2025, [2] AMENDMENT #: 0
DATE: 2025.03.05 08:33:30 -06:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2025.03.05 21:57:45 -06:00

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A050-3
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15.15 A055 Carriage of Hazardous Materials (HazMat)



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A055 . Carriage of Hazardous Materials (HazMat)

HQ Control: 05/27/2009

HQ Revision: 01a

- a. The certificate holder is authorized by the Federal Aviation Administration to accept, handle, and carry materials regulated as Hazardous Materials (HazMat) including hazardous COMAT (company hazmat material), in accordance with 49 CFR parts 171 through 180 and 14 CFR part 121, subpart Z and Appendix O or part 135 subpart K, as applicable.
- b. The certificate holder that conducts operations outside of the United States certifies that it complies with the HazMat training standards established by the International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO) and International Air Transport Association (IATA) for the safe transport of dangerous goods by air.
- c. The certificate holder must notify its repair stations regulated by 49 CFR parts 171 through 180 of its Will Carry status.
- d. The certificate holder that is issued HazMat exemptions or permits should list those in Table 1 below (*if there are no additional exemptions or permits, enter N/A in the cells*):

Table 1 – HazMat Exemptions or Permits Issued by Other Agencies

Exemption/Permit Number	Date of Expiration	Agency Issuing, Remarks and/or References
N/A		

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A055-1
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Digitally signed by Matthew L. Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/30/2023, [2] AMENDMENT #: 0
DATE: 2023.05.30 07:12:46 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.06.01 07:35:16 -05:00

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A055-2
Amdt. No: 0

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15.16 A061 Electronic Flight Bag (EFB) Program



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Operations Specifications

A061 . Electronic Flight Bag (EFB) Program

HQ Control: 11/07/2017

HQ Revision: 020

a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct aircraft operations using an Electronic Flight Bag (EFB) in the aircraft listed in Table 1, below, as part of an authorized EFB Program, and in accordance with the limitations and provisions of this operations specification.

Table 1 - Aircraft Authorized Under An EFB Program

Aircraft M/M/S	Remarks/Limitations
LEONARDO-AW169	None

b. Training Program. The certificate holder's approved training program must include appropriate crewmember training on the use of authorized EFBs.

c. Database Management. The certificate holder must specify in its manual the procedures for updating and maintaining any databases necessary to perform the intended functions of each EFB.

d. Functionality. The certificate holder is responsible to ensure that each EFB and associated software will provide the necessary data, information, functionality, and solutions to perform the intended flight functions and, if not, provide substitute information in non-electronic form.

e. EFB Maintenance. The certificate holder's maintenance program must include and document the required maintenance for each authorized EFB.

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[1]EFFECTIVE DATE: 11/13/2023, [2] AMENDMENT #: 1
DATE: 2023.11.13 06:23:53 -06:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.11.14 06:51:19 -06:00



15.17 A096 Actual Weight Program For All Aircraft



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Operations Specifications

A096 . Actual Weight Program For All Aircraft

HQ Control: 06/11/2020

HQ Revision: 020

a. The certificate holder is authorized to use only actual weights when determining the aircraft weight and balance for all aircraft. This includes:

(1) Actual weights of all passengers and bags (including carry-on, checked, plane-side loaded, and heavy bag weights) and cargo, or

(2) Solicited ("asked") passenger weight plus 10 pounds and the actual weight of bags and cargo.

b. In accordance with the certificate holder's issued operations specification A011, the certificate holder is authorized to use an approved Carry-On Baggage Program.

c. The following aircraft must use actual weights:

(1) All single-engine aircraft, with the exception of single engine turbine-powered HAA operations

(2) All reciprocating engine-powered aircraft, and

(3) All aircraft certificated with less than five (5) passenger seats, with the exception of single engine turbine-powered HAA operations.

d. The certificate holder is authorized to use the following weights for flightcrew members, crewmembers, authorized persons and their baggage, listed in Table 1 below.

Table 1 – Authorized Weights for Flightcrew Members, Crewmembers, Authorized Persons, and their Baggage

Authorized Weights	Expiration Date
Actual weights	N/a

e. For cargo-only operated aircraft, flightcrew member weights and flightcrew member bag weights, may be included in the basic operating weight of the aircraft.

f. The following loading schedules and instructions listed in Table 2 below must be used for routine operations.

Table 2 – Loading Schedules and Instructions for Routine Operations

Aircraft M/M/S	Type Loading Schedule	Loading Schedules Instructions	Weight and Balance Control Procedures
LEONARDO-AW169	Complete Flight	Complete Flight	OM-A 5.1

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2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



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[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/30/2023, [2] AMENDMENT #: 8
DATE: 2023.05.30 07:17:12 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.06.01 07:35:17 -05:00

HeliService USA LLC

A096-2
Amdt. No: 8

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15.18 **A449 Antidrug and Alcohol Misuse Prevention Program**



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Operations Specifications

A449 . Antidrug and Alcohol Misuse Prevention Program

HQ Control: 07/17/2009

HQ Revision: 00a

- a. The certificate holder who operates under Title 14 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) Part 135 certifies that it will comply with the requirements of 14 CFR Part 120 and 49 CFR Part 40 for its Antidrug and Alcohol Misuse Prevention Program.
- b. Antidrug and Alcohol Misuse Prevention Program records are maintained and available for inspection by the FAA's Drug Abatement Compliance and Enforcement Inspectors at the location listed in Table 1 below:

Table 1

	Location of Antidrug and Alcohol Misuse Prevention Program Records:	Telephone Number:
Address:	150 Airport St. North Kingstown, RI 02852	508-330-6378
Address:		
City:	North Kingston	
State:	RI	
Zip Code:	02852	

- c. Limitations and Provisions.
 - (1) Antidrug and Alcohol Misuse Prevention Program inspections and enforcement activity will be conducted exclusively by the Drug Abatement Division. All questions regarding this program should be directed to the Drug Abatement Division.
 - (2) The certificate holder must implement its Antidrug and Alcohol Misuse Prevention Programs fully in accordance with 14 CFR Part 120 and 49 CFR Part 40.
 - (3) The certificate holder is responsible for ensuring that its contractors who perform safety-sensitive work for the certificate holder are subject to Antidrug and Alcohol Misuse Prevention Programs.
 - (4) The certificate holder is responsible for updating this operations specification when any changes occur in the following:
 - (a) Location or phone number where the Antidrug and Alcohol Misuse Prevention Records are kept (as listed in Table 1 above).
 - (b) If the certificate holder's number of safety-sensitive employees goes to 50 and above, or falls below 50 safety-sensitive employees.
 - (5) The certificate holder with 50 or more employees performing a safety-sensitive function on January 1 of the calendar year must submit an annual report to the Drug Abatement Division of the FAA. The certificate holder with fewer than 50 employees performing a safety-sensitive function on January 1 of any calendar year must submit an annual report upon request of the Administrator, as specified in the regulations.

The certificate holder has fewer than 50 safety-sensitive employees.

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1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.

2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Matthew L Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/30/2023, [2] AMENDMENT #: 9
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3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.06.01 07:35:17 -05:00

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A449-2
Amdt. No: 9

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15.19 B031 Areas of En Route Operation



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Operations Specifications

B031 . Areas of En Route Operation

HQ Control: 02/09/2001

HQ Revision: 01e

The certificate holder is authorized to conduct the en route operations specified in this paragraph only within the areas of en route operation listed in paragraph B050 of these operations specifications. The certificate holder shall comply with any limitations and/or procedures specified for each area listed and the provisions of the paragraphs referenced for each area. The certificate holder shall not conduct any other en route operation within any other area under these operations specifications.

- a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct en route operations in accordance with the provisions of these operations specifications.
- b. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct Class I navigation. When conducting IFR Class I navigation, the certificate holder is authorized to conduct these operations in accordance with the following additional provisions:
 - (1) Operate IFR flights over routing predicated on ATC radar vectoring services, within controlled airspace.
 - (2) Operate IFR flights (including flights to alternate or diversionary airports) within controlled airspace over off-airway routings which are predicated on airways navigation facilities, provided the following conditions are met:
 - (a) These off-airway routings lie within the operational service volume of the facilities used and such off-airway operation is authorized by the appropriate ATC facility.
 - (b) The operation is conducted in accordance with the route width and MEA criteria prescribed for or applied to the certificate holder by the appropriate ICAO contracting state.
 - (c) The required airborne and ground-based navigation facilities are available and operational and enable navigation performance to meet the degree of accuracy required for air traffic control over the route of flight specified in the ATC clearance.
 - (3) Operate IFR flights including flights to alternate or diversionary airports in Class G Airspace in accordance with the provisions of paragraphs A014, C064, C080, H113, and/or H121, as applicable, of these operations specifications, if issued.
- c. Deviations from routings specified in this paragraph are authorized when necessary due to inflight emergencies or to avoid potentially hazardous meteorological conditions.
- d. For operations within Class A Airspace, the certificate holder is authorized to conduct Class I navigation under positive radar control with the area navigation or long-range navigation systems specified in paragraph B035 of these operations specifications, if that paragraph is issued.
- e. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct Class I navigation, including en route IFR operations outside positive radar control, with the area navigation systems specified in paragraph B034 of these operations specifications, if that paragraph is issued.
- f. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct Class II navigation in accordance with paragraphs

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Operations Specifications

B032 and B036 of these operations specifications, if those paragraphs are issued.

g. The certificate holder is authorized to use approved GPS navigation equipment as a supplement to ICAO standard navigation equipment while conducting Class I navigation.

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Matthew L Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/30/2023, [2] AMENDMENT #: 4
DATE: 2023.05.30 07:17:24 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.06.01 07:37:10 -05:00

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B031-2
Amdt. No: 4

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



15.20 B032 En Route Limitations and Provisions



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Operations Specifications

B032 . En Route Limitations and Provisions

HQ Control: 03/24/2009

HQ Revision: 020

a. The certificate holder shall comply with the following IFR en route limitations and provisions when conducting any en route operation under these operations specifications. Unless otherwise authorized by these operations specifications, the certificate holder shall not conduct IFR operations outside controlled airspace.

b. When conducting Class I navigation:

(1) An aircraft's position shall be "reliably fixed" as necessary to navigate to the degree of accuracy required for ATC.

(2) With the exception of b(3) and b(5) below, the airways used and the off-airway routing predicated on airways navigation facilities shall lie within the operational service volume of the facilities defining the airways or off-airway routing.

(3) Operations over routes with a minimum en route altitude (MEA) gap (or International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO) equivalent) are an exception to the operational service volume requirement.

(4) With the exception of b(5) below, the facilities which define an airway, or an off-airway routing predicated on airways navigation facilities, shall be used as the primary navigation reference.

(5) An area navigation system may be used if the aircraft's position can be "reliably fixed" at least once each hour using airway navigation facilities to the degree of accuracy required for ATC. This system must be certificated for use in IFR flight for the conduct of Class I navigation over the routes being flown and authorized in accordance with paragraph B034.

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[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/30/2023, [2] AMENDMENT #: 0
DATE: 2023.05.30 07:17:30 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.06.01 07:37:10 -05:00

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15.21 B033 IFR En Route Operations



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B033. IFR En Route Operations

HQ Control: 12/29/2025

HQ Revision: 030

a. General. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct en route operations under instrument flight rules (IFR) in accordance with the limitations and provisions of these operations specifications, listed below.

(1) This authorization is valid only within the areas of en route operation listed in paragraph B050 of these operations specifications.

(2) Except as provided in operations specification(s) B030 and/or B036, flights must be One-Hour Reliable Fix (1HRF) Operations, where a reliable ground-based Navigational Aid (NAVAID) fix is available at least once each hour.

(3) Except as provided in operations specification B036, the certificate holder must not indicate oceanic capability of Area Navigation (RNAV) 10, Required Navigation Performance (RNP) 10, RNP 4, or oceanic/remote continental RNP 2 on the air traffic control (ATC) flight plan.

(4) Except as provided in operations specification A014, en route operations must remain within controlled airspace.

(5) Except when navigation is performed under the supervision of a properly qualified check pilot, the flightcrew must be qualified in accordance with the certificate holder's approved training program for IFR en route operations. The flightcrew must have satisfactorily completed the ground school portion of that training program before performing under the supervision of a check pilot.

b. Using Ground-Based NAVAIDs. The certificate holder is authorized to navigate on published airways and over off-airway routings defined by ground-based NAVAIDs, in accordance with the following additional provisions:

(1) These airways and routings lie within the Operational Service Volume of the NAVAIDs used, except along airways where minimum en route altitude (MEA) gaps in NAVAID reception are published.

(2) The required aircraft NAVAID receivers and ground-based NAVAIDs are available and operational.

c. Using an RNAV System. In accordance with part 135, §135.165 (a)(4), the certificate holder is authorized to navigate using the/an RNAV system(s) compliant with navigation specification(s) RNAV 2 and/or RNP 2 domestic/offshore, as indicated in the applicable flight manual or flight manual supplement. The following additional provisions apply:

(1) If navigating using only a single RNAV system, or multiple RNAV systems that rely solely on Global Positioning System (GPS) navigation sensors, any non-extended overwater operations over off-airway routing must remain within airspace which is under Air Traffic Service (ATS) surveillance and is covered by very high frequency (VHF) voice communications.

(2) Except as provided in operations specification B036 or authorized in subparagraph d, operations must remain outside oceanic control areas (OCA) where ATC requires use of a long-range communication system (LRCS).

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B033-1
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



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1. The Certificate Holder applies for the Operations in this paragraph.

2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Hall, Matthew, Principal Operations
Inspector (EA65)

[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 3/3/2026,

[2] AMENDMENT #: 6

DATE: 2026.03.03 09:06:08 -06:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by RUSSO, PAUL CHRISTOPHER on behalf of
Paul Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135

DATE: 2026.03.03 09:35:17 -06:00

HELISERVICE USA LLC

B033-2
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J

15.22 B034 IFR Class I Terminal and En Route Navigation Using Area Navigation Systems



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Operations Specifications

B034 . IFR Class I Terminal and En Route Navigation Using Area Navigation Systems HQ Control: 12/04/2010
HQ Revision: 040

a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct IFR Class I terminal and en route navigation (including operations outside positive radar control) using aircraft and RNAV systems approved by this paragraph in those areas of operations where this paragraph is referenced in B050 of these operations specifications.

b. Approved Operations. If specified in Table 1 below, the certificate holder is authorized to conduct Precision RNAV (P-RNAV) and/or Basic RNAV (B-RNAV)/RNAV 5 operations in terminal and/or en route areas where this paragraph is referenced in paragraph B050 of these operations specifications.

(1) The route design determines whether the operation is terminal or en route navigation.

(2) For B-RNAV/RNAV 5 terminal and en route operations, the navigation performance is ± 5 nautical miles (NM) for 95 percent of the flight time.

(3) For P-RNAV terminal and en route operations, the navigation performance is ± 1 NM for 95 percent of the flight time.

(4) If the RNAV equipment is certified for P-RNAV, it may be authorized for both P-RNAV and B-RNAV/RNAV 5 terminal and en route operations.

c. Authorized En Route Navigation. Except as provided in these operations specifications, the certificate holder shall not conduct any other IFR Class I en route navigation using RNAV systems.

d. Authorized Aircraft Navigation Systems. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct IFR Class I terminal and en route navigation using the following aircraft and RNAV systems for the operations indicated in Table 1 below. If no specific navigation performance (for B-RNAV/RNAV 5 and/or P-RNAV) is authorized, enter N/A in column 4.

Table 1 – Aircraft, Navigation Systems, and Navigation Performance

Aircraft M/M/S	Area Navigation Systems		Navigation Performance	Limitations and Conditions
	Manufacturer	Model		
LEONARDO- AW169	Leonardo	6F4620AS0400	B-RNAV/RNAV 5 (+/-5NM), and P- RNAV (+/-1NM)	None

e. Special En Route Limitations and Provisions. The certificate holder shall conduct all operations authorized by this paragraph in accordance with the following en route limitations and provisions:

(1) Except when navigation is performed under the supervision of a properly qualified check airman, the flightcrew must be qualified in accordance with the certificate holder's approved training program for the system being used or have satisfactorily completed a flight check using the system. The flightcrew shall have satisfactorily completed the ground school portion of that training program before performing under the supervision of a check airman.

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Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



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(2) The navigation system shall be fully operational or operating in accordance with the certificate holder's approved MEL, when the system is used for any navigation.

(3) Prior to conducting operations in airspace that require a specific navigation performance, if authorized and listed in Table 1 above, the certificate-holder must ensure that the aircraft navigation system will provide the navigation performance for the planned flight time in that airspace.

(4) The RNAV systems used must permit the flight to navigate to the degree of accuracy or operational performance level required for ATC; be approved for the particular area of operation as specified in paragraph B050 of these operations specifications; and be certificated for IFR flight.

(5) IFR Class I navigation using a single RNAV system shall not be conducted unless Class I navigation with a single system is authorized by this paragraph and all of the following conditions are met:

(a) The redundant airborne equipment required to conduct IFR Class I navigation using airways navigation facilities is installed and operational.

(b) The capability exists at any point along the planned route of flight to safely return to and use airways navigation facilities for navigation if the single RNAV system fails.

(c) Any flight operated over off-airway routing is operated under ATC radar control.

(6) IFR Class I navigation, using a single RNAV system, shall not be conducted without at least one pilot using the facilities which define the airway or off-airway routing as the primary navigation reference unless the following conditions are met:

(a) The aircraft's present position and its relationship to NAVAID, airways, and any other Instrument Flight Procedure (IFP) specified in the currently effective ATC clearance are continuously displayed on each pilot's flight instruments.

(b) An indication is immediately provided on the forward instrument panel, within the normal field of view of each pilot, when the navigation performance of the RNAV system is insufficient to navigate to the degree of accuracy required for ATC.

(7) An approved RNAV system fix may be substituted for a required en route ground facility when that facility is temporarily out of service, provided the approved navigation system has sufficient accuracy to navigate the aircraft to the degree of accuracy or navigation performance required for ATC over that portion of the flight.

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B034-2
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Operations Specifications

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.

2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Matthew L. Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/30/2023, [2] AMENDMENT #: 0
DATE: 2023.05.30 07:19:08 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.06.01 07:37:11 -05:00

HeliService USA LLC

B034-3
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



15.23 **B050 Authorized Areas of En Route Operations, Limitations, and**
Provisions



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Operations Specifications

B050 . Authorized Areas of En Route Operations, Limitations, and Provisions **HQ Control:** 09/12/1997
HQ Revision: 020

a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct en route operations in the areas of en route operation specified in this paragraph. The certificate holder shall conduct all en route operations in accordance with the provisions of the paragraphs referenced for each area of en route operation. The certificate holder shall not conduct any en route operation under these operations specifications unless those operations are conducted within the areas of en route operation authorized by this paragraph.

Authorized Areas of En Route Operation	Reference Paragraphs	Note Reference #
Gulf of Mexico	B031	
USA - The 48 contiguous United States and the District of Columbia	B031	

b. The certificate holder shall conduct all en route operations in accordance with the following limitations, provisions, and special requirements referenced numerically for each area of en route operation listed in subparagraph a. above.

Note Reference #	Limitations Provisions and Special Requirements
N/A	N/A

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B050-1
Amdt. No: 5

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



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Operations Specifications

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.

2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.

 Digitally signed by Matthew L Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1]EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/7/2025, [2] AMENDMENT #: 5
DATE: 2025.05.07 08:03:52 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2025.05.10 08:15:36 -05:00

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B050-2
Amdt. No: 5

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



15.24 D084 Special Flight Permit with Continuous Authorization to Conduct Ferry Flights



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Operations Specifications

D084 . Special Flight Permit with Continuous Authorization to Conduct Ferry Flights **HQ Control: 02/03/2011**
HQ Revision: 050

- a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct ferry flights using a special flight permit with continuous authorization in accordance with the limitations and provisions of this operations specification.
- b. This special flight permit with continuous authorization is the certificate holder's authorization to fly an aircraft that may not meet applicable airworthiness requirements but is capable of safe flight to a base where necessary maintenance or alterations are to be performed.
- c. This authorization applies only to those aircraft listed on operations specification paragraph D085.
- d. This authorization permits an aircraft to be moved to a repair facility to perform work required by an airworthiness directive unless the airworthiness directive states otherwise or it is determined that the aircraft cannot be moved safely.
- e. A copy of this operations specification, or appropriate sections of the certificate holder's manual which restate this permit, shall be carried on board the aircraft when operating under a special flight permit.
- f. Before operating an aircraft that does not meet applicable airworthiness requirements, the certificate holder shall determine that the aircraft can safely be flown to a station where maintenance or alterations are to be performed.
 - (1) The certificate holder shall have the aircraft inspected or evaluated according to procedures in its manual and have a certificated mechanic or repairman certify in the aircraft record that the aircraft is in a safe condition for the flight as specified in the operator's manual.
 - (2) The certificated mechanic or repairman may certify only for the work for which he or she is employed.
- g. This operations specification is not required for conducting a ferry flight with one engine inoperative in accordance with Section 91.611 as long as all the applicable requirements of that section are met.
- h. Only flight crewmembers and persons essential to operations of the aircraft shall be carried aboard during ferry flights where the aircraft flight characteristics may have been appreciably changed or its operation in flight substantially affected.
- i. Flights shall be conducted according to the approved program for continuing flight authorization listed in Table 1 below.

Table 1 - Aircraft Maintenance Documents
OM-A Ch 18

- j. Aircraft involved in an accident or incident may not be ferried before it is released by the NTSB and the local FAA District Office is notified.
- k. The certificate holder shall impose any further conditions or limitations necessary for safe flight.

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D084-1
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



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1. Aircraft operated under this authorization may not meet the airworthiness requirements of foreign countries



Digitally signed by John F Keefe, Principal Maintenance Inspector (EA65)
[1] SUPPORT INFO: Add aircraft N652LA
[2] EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/31/2023, [3] AMENDMENT #: 0
DATE: 2023.05.31 08:14:42 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.
Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.06.01 07:37:11 -05:00

15.25 D085 Aircraft Listing

DocuSign Envelope ID: B3F0EC4A-2459-4F6D-B9A6-1C7449E0A6D2

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D085. Aircraft Listing

HQ Control: 02/06/1998
HQ Revision: 02a

a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct operations under 14 CFR Part 135 using the aircraft identified on this operations specification.

Registration No.	Serial No.	Aircraft M/M/S
N691HS	69052	LEONARDO-AW169
N692HS	69166	LEONARDO-AW169
N693HS	69116	LEONARDO-AW169
N694HS	69033	LEONARDO-AW169

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Keefe, John, Principal Maintenance
Inspector (EA65)
[1] SUPPORT INFO: Added N694HS
[2] EFFECTIVE DATE: 10/6/2025,
[3] AMENDMENT #: 12
DATE: 2025.10.06 06:16:09 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.
- Digitally signed by RUSSO, PAUL CHRISTOPHER on behalf
of Russo, Paul
DATE: 2025.10.06 15:59:23 -05:00

Date

HeliService USA LLC

D085-1
Amdt. No: 12

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J

15.26 D093 Helicopter and/or Powered-Lift Night Vision Goggle



Operations Maintenance Program



DocuSign Envelope ID: A133323D-D56B-4E95-9330-4B27B4C141C1

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Operations Specifications

**D093. Helicopter and/or Powered-Lift Night Vision Goggle Operations
Maintenance Program**HQ Control: 09/03/2025
HQ Revision: 02a

- a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct Night Vision Goggle Operations in Helicopters (HNVGO) and/or Powered-Lift (PLNVGO) under the limitations and provisions of 14 CFR Part 135 and paragraph A050 of these operations specifications using the aircraft listed in Table 1.
- b. The Night Vision Imaging System (NVIS) includes the approved installed equipment and the Night Vision Goggles (NVGs). The NVIS and NVGs used to conduct HNVGO or PLNVGO must be maintained in accordance with the maintenance documents with the current revision number/letter listed in Table 1 below. The NVGs are not aircraft specific.

Table 1-Authorized NVIS and NVG Maintenance Documents

Aircraft Registration Number	Aircraft Serial Number	Aircraft M/M/S	STC Number	Maintenance Document for Aircraft NVIS w/ Revision Number	Maintenance Document for Night Vision Goggles w/ Revision Number
N691HS	69052	LEONARDO- AW169	Leonardo Service Bulletin SB 169-288	Leonardo 69-A-33-12- 00-00A-320A-A Rev 2 Issue Date 2022-07-11	ITT-TM-F4949-2, Rev N
N692HS	69166	LEONARDO- AW169	Leonardo Service Bulletin SB 169-288	Leonardo 69-A-33-12- 00-00A-320A-A Rev 2 Issue Date 2022-07-11	ITT-TM-F4949-2, Rev N
N693HS	69116	LEONARDO- AW169	Leonardo Service Bulletin SB 169-288	Leonardo 69-A-33-12- 00-00A-320A-A Rev 2 Issue Date 2022-07-11	ITT-TM-F4949-2, Rev N
N694HS	69033	LEONARDO- AW169	Leonardo Service Bulletin SB 169-288	Leonardo 69-A-33-12- 00-00A-320A-A Rev 2 Issue Date 2022-07-11	ITT-TM-F4949-2, Rev N

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D093-1
Amdt. No: 1

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



Docusign Envelope ID: A133323D-D56B-4E95-9330-4B27B4C141C1

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Operations Specifications

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.

2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Keefe, John, Principal Maintenance
Inspector (EA65)
[1] SUPPORT INFO: Added N694HS
[2] EFFECTIVE DATE: 6/16/2025,
[3] AMENDMENT #: 1
DATE: 2025.10.06 06:57:21 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by RUSSO, PAUL CHRISTOPHER on behalf
of Russo, Paul
DATE: 2025.10.06 16:01:48 -05:00

Date

HeliService USA LLC

D093-2
Amdt. No: 1

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



15.27 D095 Minimum Equipment List (MEL) Authorization

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Operations Specifications

D095 . Minimum Equipment List (MEL) Authorization

HQ Control: 06/14/2013

HQ Revision: 02c

a. The certificate holder is authorized to use an FAA-approved MEL provided the conditions and limitations of this paragraph are met. The certificate holder shall not use an MEL for any aircraft that is not specifically authorized by this paragraph.

b. Authorized Aircraft. The certificate holder is authorized to use an FAA-approved MEL for the aircraft listed below:

Aircraft M/M/S	Limitations and Conditions
LEONARDO-AW169	N/A

c. Maximum Times Between Deferral and Repair. Except as provided in subparagraph e of this operations specification, the certificate holder shall have instrument and equipment items repaired within the time intervals specified for the repair categories listed below:

(1) Repair Category A. Items in this category shall be repaired within the time interval specified in the "Remarks or Exceptions" column of the certificate holder's FAA-approved MEL. For time intervals specified in "calendar days" or "flight days", the day the malfunction was recorded in the aircraft maintenance record/logbook is excluded. For all other time intervals (e.g., flights, flight legs, cycles, hours, etc.), repair tracking begins at the point when the malfunction is deferred in accordance with the certificate holder's FAA-approved MEL.

(2) Repair Category B. Items in this category shall be repaired within three (3) consecutive calendar days (72 hours) excluding the calendar day the malfunction was recorded in the aircraft maintenance log and/or record.

(3) Repair Category C. Items in this category shall be repaired within ten (10) consecutive calendar days (240 hours) excluding the calendar day the malfunction was recorded in the aircraft maintenance log and/or record.

(4) Repair Category D. Items in this category shall be repaired within one hundred twenty (120) consecutive calendar days (2,880 hours) excluding the day the malfunction was recorded in the aircraft maintenance log and/or record.

d. MEL Management Program. The certificate holder shall develop and maintain a comprehensive program for managing the repair of instrument and equipment items listed in the FAA-approved MEL. The certificate holder shall include in a document or manual a description of the MEL management program. The MEL management program must include at least the following provisions:

(1) A method which provides for tracking the date and, when appropriate, the time an item was deferred and subsequently repaired. The method must include a supervisory review of:

- (a) The number of deferred items per aircraft; and
- (b) Each deferred item to determine the reason for any delay in repair, length of delay,

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D095-1
Amdt. No: 0

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and the estimated date the item will be repaired.

(2) A plan for bringing together parts, maintenance personnel, and aircraft at a specific time and place for repair.

(3) A review of items deferred because of the unavailability of parts to ensure that a valid back order exists with a firm delivery date.

(4) A description of specific duties and responsibilities, by job title, of the personnel who manage the MEL management program.

(5) Procedures for controlling an extension to specified repair intervals as permitted by subparagraph e of this operations specification, to include the limit of the extension and the procedures to be used for authorizing an extension.

e. Continuing Authorization-Single Extension. The certificate holder is authorized to use a continuing authorization-single extension to approve a single, one-time extension to the repair interval for repair category B and C items, as specified in the FAA-approved MEL, provided the responsible Flight Standards District Office (FSDO) is notified within 24 hours of the extension approval.

(1) If an additional extension is required after the continuing authorization-single extension privilege has been exercised, it must be approved by the principal inspectors (PIs) prior to the expiration of the current extension time period.

(2) The certificate holder is not authorized to approve a single, one-time extension to the repair interval for repair category A and D items, as specified in the FAA-approved MEL.

(3) The FSDO may deny the use of the continuing authorization-single extension privilege if abuse is evident.

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D095-2
Amdt. No: 0

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Operations Specifications

1. The Certificate Holder applies for the Operations in this paragraph.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by David Roakes, Principal Avionics Inspector (EA65)

[1] SUPPORT INFO: Initial Fleet MEL

[2] EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/16/2025, [3] AMENDMENT #: 0

DATE: 2025.01.16 05:52:21 -06:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135

DATE: 2025.01.16 08:23:50 -06:00

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D095-3
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



15.28 D102 Additional Maintenance Requirements - Rotorcraft

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Operations Specifications

D102 . Additional Maintenance Requirements - Rotorcraft

HQ Control: 04/19/2001
HQ Revision: 00a

The certificate holder is authorized to use the following rotorcraft type identified below in its 14 CFR Part 135 nine seats or less operations provided these rotorcraft have met the additional maintenance requirements of Section 135.421:

a. Aircraft Engine. Each installed engine, to include turbosuperchargers, appurtenances and accessories necessary for its functioning shall be maintained in accordance with the maintenance documents listed in the following table. The engine shall be overhauled on or before the time-in-service interval shown in the table.

b. Rotor. Each installed main and auxiliary rotor shall be maintained in accordance with the manufacturer's maintenance documents listed in the following table.

Table 1. Aircraft Engine and Rotor

Rotorcraft Type	Engine			Rotor Main and Auxiliary
	Make & Model	Maintenance Document	Time-in-Service Interval	Maintenance Document
LEONARDO-AW169	P&WC 210A	Pratt & Whitney 210A Manual # 30L2392 as revised	4000 hours	Leonardo Maintenance Planning Information 69-B-AMPI-00-P

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Operations Specifications

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by John F Keefe, Principal Maintenance Inspector (EA65)

[1] SUPPORT INFO: Add aircraft N652LA

[2] EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/31/2023, [3] AMENDMENT #: 6

DATE: 2023.05.31 08:14:52 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135

DATE: 2023.06.01 07:37:11 -05:00

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D102-2
Amdt. No: 6

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J

15.29 Equipment

D104 Additional Maintenance Requirements - Emergency



Docusign Envelope ID: AFC5262B-EBEF-443E-A1EA-E100CEF483E4

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Operations Specifications

D104. Additional Maintenance Requirements - Emergency Equipment

HQ Control: 05/10/2004
HQ Revision: 00a

The certificate holder is authorized to use the following emergency equipment in its 14 CFR Part 135 nine seats or less operations, provided the applicable aircraft have met the additional maintenance requirements of Section 135.421:

- a. Emergency equipment. Each item of installed emergency equipment shall be maintained in accordance with the manufacturer's maintenance documents and/or the limitations and provisions listed in the following table.
- (1) In addition to the maintenance document listed in this table, the following specifications must be followed for the applicable listed emergency equipment items:
- (a) Oxygen (O2) bottles and liquid fire extinguishers. Inspections, hydrostatic tests, and life limits of pressure vessels manufactured under a DOT specification are accomplished as set forth in 49 CFR Part 180.209, as amended.
- (b) Fire extinguishers. Inspections, hydrostatic tests, and life limits of portable fire extinguishers are accomplished as set forth in 46 CFR Sections 71.25 and 162.028, as amended.
- (c) Military-manufactured. Pressure vessels manufactured under a MIL-SPEC are maintained in accordance with the applicable military specifications.
- (d) Foreign-manufactured. Foreign-manufactured pressure cylinders are maintained in accordance with the applicable foreign manufacturer's specifications.
- (e) Other. Pressure cylinders not manufactured under DOT, foreign, or U.S. MIL-SPECS are maintained in accordance with the applicable aircraft manufacturer's specifications.

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D104-1
Amdt. No: 2

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J

Docusign Envelope ID: AFC5262B-EBEF-443E-A1EA-E100CEF483E4

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Operations Specifications

Emergency Equipment

Emergency Equipment Items	Maintenance Document	Limitations and Provisions
Fire Extinguisher: FFE Limited BCF Halon 1211	Leonardo 69-BAMPI-00-P	Annual Inspection
ELT: CPI Beacon Techtest Limited 503-GPC	Leonardo 69-B-AMPI-00-P	12 Month Inspection
Engine Fire Extinguisher Bottle: 3G2620V00131	Leonardo 69-B-AMPI-00-P	12 & 24 Month Inspection
Engine Fire Extinguisher Squibs: 30903915-1 & 30909914-1	Leonardo 69-B-AMPI-00-P	10 years date of expiry from date placed in service (DOI) or 15 years from date of manufacture, whichever comes first
Lifejackets: Viking Crew PV9365 & Passenger PV9375	Service Manual for Viking aviation life jacket Edition 26 Dated 05/27/2024	12 Month Inspection
Life Raft: Survitec 7 person (2)	Leonardo 69-B-AMPI-00-P	12 Month Inspection
Emergency Power Supply Battery EISI: MD835-1	Leonardo 69-B-AMPI-00-P	10 Years from date of manufacture

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D104-2
Amdt. No: 2

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



Docusign Envelope ID: AFC5262B-EBEF-443E-A1EA-E100CEF483E4

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Operations Specifications

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Keefe, John, Principal Maintenance
Inspector (EA65)
[1] SUPPORT INFO: Added N694HS
[2] EFFECTIVE DATE: 6/16/2025,
[3] AMENDMENT #: 2
DATE: 2025.10.06 06:18:11 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.
- Digitally signed by RUSSO, PAUL CHRISTOPHER on behalf
of Russo, Paul
DATE: 2025.10.06 16:03:31 -05:00

Date

HeliService USA LLC

D104-3
Amdt. No: 2

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J

15.30

E096 Aircraft Weighing

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Operations Specifications

E096 . Aircraft Weighing

HQ Control: 11/21/2016

HQ Revision: 02a

- a. The following procedures have been established to maintain control of weight and balance of the certificate holder's 14 CFR Part 135 aircraft under the terms of these operations specifications. All aircraft make/model/series (M/M/S) identified have been weighed in accordance with the procedures for establishing empty weight and balance.
- b. The certificate holder is authorized to use individual aircraft weights outlined in the certificate holder's empty weight and balance program for the aircraft listed in Table 1 below.

Table 1 – Individual Aircraft Weights

Aircraft M/M/S	Weighing Interval	Weight and Balance Control Program
LEONARDO-AW169	36 MONTHS	OM-A 5.3.2

- c. The certificate holder is authorized under 14 CFR Part 135, § 135.185(b)(2) to use fleet aircraft weights outlined in the certificate holder's weight and balance control program for the aircraft listed in Table 2 below.

Table 2 – Fleet Aircraft Weights

Aircraft M/M/S	Weighing Sampling Interval	Weight and Balance Control Program
LEONARDO-AW169	36 MONTHS	OM-A 5.3.2

Note: Document references by volume, chapter, etc.

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15.31 H101 Terminal Instrument Procedures - Helicopter

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Operations Specifications

H101 . Terminal Instrument Procedures - Helicopter

HQ Control: 06/07/2002

HQ Revision: 01b

a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct terminal instrument operations using the procedures and minimums specified in these operations specifications, provided one of the following conditions is met:

- (1) The terminal instrument procedure used is prescribed by these operations specifications.
- (2) The terminal instrument procedure used is prescribed by 14 CFR Part 97, Standard Instrument Approach Procedures.
- (3) At U.S. military airports, the terminal instrument procedure used is prescribed by the U.S. military agency operating the airport.
- (4) If authorized foreign airports, the terminal instrument procedure used at the foreign airport is prescribed or approved by the government of an ICAO contracting state. The terminal instrument procedure must meet criteria equivalent to that specified in either the United States Standard for Terminal Instrument Procedures (TERPS) or ICAO Document 8168-OPS, Procedures for Air Navigation Services-Aircraft Operations (PANS-OPS), Volume II.
- b. If Applicable, Special Limitations and Provisions for Instrument Approaches at Foreign Airports.

(1) Terminal instrument procedures may be developed and used by the certificate holder for any foreign airport, provided the certificate holder makes a determination that each procedure developed is equivalent to U.S. TERPS or ICAO PANS-OPS criteria and submits to the FAA a copy of the terminal instrument procedure with supporting documentation.

(2) At foreign airports, the certificate holder shall not conduct terminal instrument procedures determined by the FAA to be "not authorized for United States air carrier use." In these cases, the certificate holder may develop and use a terminal instrument procedure provided the certificate holder makes a determination that each procedure developed is equivalent to U.S. TERPS or ICAO PANS-OPS criteria and submits to the FAA a copy of the terminal instrument procedure with supporting documentation.

(3) When operating at foreign airports where the metric system is used and the minimums are specified only in meters, the certificate holder shall use the metric operational equivalents in the following tables for both takeoff and landing operations. (N/A = Not Applicable)

Table 1		Table 2		
RVR Conversion		Meteorological Visibility Conversion		
Feet	Meters	Statute Miles	Meters	Nautical Miles
300 ft	75 m	¼ sm	400 m	¼ nm
400 ft	125 m	3/8 sm	600 m	3/8 nm

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500 ft	150 m	1/2 sm	800 m	1/2 nm
600 ft	175 m	5/8 sm	1000 m	5/8 nm
700 ft	200 m	3/4 sm	1200 m	7/10 nm
1000 ft	300 m	7/8 sm	1400 m	7/8 nm
1200 ft	350 m	1 sm	1600 m	9/10 nm
1600 ft	500 m	1 1/8 sm	1800 m	1 1/8 nm
1800 ft	550 m	1 1/4 sm	2000 m	1 1/10 nm
2000 ft	600 m	1 1/2 sm	2400 m	1 3/10 nm
2100 ft	650 m	1 3/4 sm	2800 m	1 1/2 nm
2400 ft	750 m	2 sm	3200 m	1 3/4 nm
3000 ft	1000 m	2 1/4 sm	3600 m	2 nm
4000 ft	1200 m	2 1/2 sm	4000 m	2 2/10 nm
4500 ft	1400 m	2 3/4 sm	4400 m	2 4/10 nm
5000 ft	1500 m	3 sm	4800 m	2 6/10 nm
6000 ft	1800 m			

(4) When operating at foreign airports where the published landing minimums are specified in RVR, the RVR may not be available, therefore the meteorological visibility is reported. When the minimums are reported in meteorological visibility, the certificate holder shall convert meteorological visibility to RVR by multiplying the reported visibility by the appropriate factor, shown in Table 3. The conversion of reported meteorological visibility to RVR is used only for Category I landing minimums, and shall not be used for takeoff minima, CAT II or III minima, or when a reported RVR is available.

Table 3
 [RVR = (reported meteorological visibility) X (factor)]

AVAILABLE LIGHTING	DAY	NIGHT
High Intensity approach and runway lighting	1.5	2.0
Any type of lighting installation other than above	1.0	1.5
No lighting	1.0	N/A



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15.32
Airports

H102 Basic Instrument Approach Procedure Authorizations - All



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H102 . Basic Instrument Approach Procedure Authorizations -
All Airports

HQ Control: 11/22/2000
HQ Revision: 030

The certificate holder is authorized to conduct the following types of instrument approach procedures and shall not conduct any other types.

Instrument Approach Procedures (Other Than ILS & MLS) Non-Precision Approaches Without Vertical Guidance	Instrument Approach Procedures (Other Than ILS & MLS) Precision-Like Approaches With Vertical Guidance	Precision Approach Procedures (ILS, MLS & GLS)
GPS	RNAV (GPS)	ILS
LOC		
LOC/DME		
RNAV (GPS)		
RNAV (VOR/DME)		
VOR		
VOR/DME		

b. Conditions and Limitations .

- (1) All the approaches approved by this Operations Specification must be published in accordance with Title 14 of the Code of Federal Regulations (14 CFR) Part 97 or the foreign State authority.
- (2) Approach procedures listed in column 1 of this Operations Specification must be trained and conducted in accordance with an approved procedure that assures descent will not go below Minimum Descent Altitude (MDA) unless the required visual references for continuing the approach are present.
- (3) Approach procedures listed in column 2 of this Operations Specification authorize the certificate holder to conduct instrument approach procedures approved with vertical guidance that provide a precision-like approach and are to be trained using an approved method that allows descent to a published decision altitude (DA).



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15.33 H103 Straight-In Category I Non-Precision Approach Procedures - All Airports

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H103 . Straight-In Category I Non-Precision Approach Procedures - All Airports

HQ Control: 11/22/2000

HQ Revision: 030

a. Except as provided in this paragraph, the certificate holder shall not use any Category I IFR landing minimum lower than that prescribed by any applicable published instrument approach procedure. The IFR landing minimums prescribed in this paragraph are the lowest authorized (other than Airborne Radar approaches) for use at any airport. Provided that the fastest approach speed used in the final approach segment is less than 91 knots, the certificate holder is authorized to conduct straight-in instrument approach procedures using the following:

(1) The published Category A minimum descent altitude (MDA) or decision height (DH), as appropriate.

(2) One-half of the published Category A visibility/RVR minimum or the visibility/RVR minimums prescribed by this paragraph, whichever is higher.

b. Straight-In Category I Nonprecision Approach Procedures. The certificate holder shall not use an IFR landing minimum for straight-in nonprecision approach procedures, lower than that specified in the following table. Touchdown Zone (TDZ) RVR reports, when available for a particular runway, are controlling for all approaches to and landings on that runway. (See NOTE 7.)

Approach Light Configuration	NONPRECISION APPROACHES				
	HAT (See NOTES 1, 2, & 3)	Helicopters Operated at Speeds of 90 kts or Less (see NOTE 6)		Helicopters Operated at Speeds More Than 90 Knots	
		Visibility In SM.	TDZ RVR In Feet	Visibility In SM.	TDZ RVR In Feet
No Lights	250	3/8	2000	1	5000
ODALS or MALS or SALS	250	3/8 (See NOTE 5)	1600 (See NOTE 5)	3/4	4000
MALSR or SSALR or ALSF-1 or ALSF-2	250	1/4 (See NOTE 5)	1600 (See NOTE 5)	1/2 (See NOTE 4)	2400 (See NOTE 4)
DME ARC any light configuration	500	3/4	4000	1	5000

NOTE 1: For NDB approaches with a FAF, add 50 ft. to the HAT.

NOTE 2: For NDB approaches without a FAF, add 100 ft. to the HAT.

NOTE 3: For VOR approaches without a FAF, add 50 ft. to the HAT.

NOTE 4: For NDB approaches, the lowest authorized visibility is 3/4 and the lowest RVR is RVR 4000.

NOTE 5: For NDB approaches, the lowest authorized visibility is 3/8 and the lowest RVR is RVR 2000.

NOTE 6: A visual descent gradient of 6 degrees or more is required and must be used when operating with these minimums.

NOTE 7: The Mid RVR and Rollout RVR reports (if available) provide advisory information to pilots.

The Mid RVR report may be substituted for the TDZ RVR report if the TDZ RVR report is not

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available.

c. Special Limitations and Provisions for Instrument Approach Procedures at Foreign Airports. If the certificate holder is authorized operations at foreign airports, the following criteria apply.

(1) Foreign approach lighting systems equivalent to U.S. standards are authorized for both precision and nonprecision approaches. Sequenced flashing lights are not required when determining the equivalence of a foreign lighting system to U.S. standards.

(2) For straight-in landing minimums at foreign airports where an MDA or DH is not specified, the lowest authorized MDA or DH shall be obtained as follows:

(a) When an obstruction clearance limit (OCL) is specified, the authorized MDA or DH is the sum of the OCL and the touchdown zone elevation (TDZE). If the TDZE for a particular runway is not available, threshold elevation shall be used. If threshold elevation is not available, airport elevation shall be used. For nonprecision approaches, the MDA may be rounded to the next higher interval of 10 foot increment.

(b) When an obstacle clearance altitude (OCA)/obstacle clearance height (OCH) is specified, the authorized MDA or DH is equal to the OCA/OCH. For nonprecision approaches, the authorized MDA may be expressed in intervals of 10 feet.

(c) The HAT or HAA used for nonprecision approaches shall not be below those specified in subparagraph a. The HAT or HAA used for precision approaches shall not be below those specified in subparagraph b.

(3) When only an OCL or an OCA/OCH is specified, visibility and/or RVR minimums appropriate to the authorized HAA/HAT values determined in accordance with subparagraph e.(2) above will be established in accordance with criteria prescribed by U.S. TERPS.

(4) When conducting an instrument approach procedure outside the United States, the certificate holder shall not operate an aircraft below the prescribed MDA or continue an approach procedure below the DH, unless the aircraft is in a position from which a normal approach to the runway of intended landing can be made and at least one of the following visual references is clearly visible to the pilot:

- (a) Runway, runway markings, or runway lights.
- (b) Approach light system (in accordance with 14 CFR Section 91.175(c)(3)(i)).
- (c) Threshold, threshold markings, or threshold lights.
- (d) Touchdown zone, touchdown zone markings, or touchdown zone lights.
- (e) Visual glide path indicator (such as, VASI, PAPI).
- (f) Any other feature which clearly identifies the landing surface.

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15.34 H104 Helicopter Offshore Instrument Operations: Offshore Standard Approach Procedure (OSAP), Airborne Radar Approach (ARA), and Helicopter En Route Descent Area (HEDA) Operations



Operations Specifications

H104. Helicopter Offshore Instrument Operations: Offshore Standard Approach Procedure (OSAP), Airborne Radar Approach (ARA), and Helicopter En Route Descent Area (HEDA) Operations HQ Control: 04/10/2018
HQ Revision: 030

Table 1 - Authorized Helicopter Offshore Instrument Operations

Helicopter M/M/S	RNAV System/Radar			Offshore Operations	Additional Capabilities	Lowest Authorized Altitude	Lowest Authorized Visibility	Remarks Limitation and Condition
	Make	Model/HW Part	Software Part/Ver. #					
LEONARDO- AW169	Telephonics (Radar) Esterline (RNAV System)	RDR-1600 CMA-3024	N/A	OSAP, HEDA	None	200 MSL	3/4 SM	Expires 1 year from date of issuance. Lowest authorized altitude based on RA, NOT MSL. OSA Delta 30 Only, no parallel offset

- (1) Descent must be entirely over water.
- (2) Unless otherwise authorized by this operations specification, the certificate holder must not use any other IFR operation.
- (3) The certificate holder must not use a minimum descent altitude (MDA) or visibility below the authorized values in Table 1 above.
- (4) Descent below the MDA is not authorized whenever any of the following conditions exist:
 - (a) Any obstruction within a lateral distance of 0.5 NM from the final approach course of an OSAP.
 - (b) Any obstruction within a lateral distance of 1 NM from the final approach course of an ARA.

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(c) Any obstruction detected in the HEDA by onboard approved equipment, if not visually confirmed.

(d) A radio altimeter (RA) is not installed or is inoperative.

(e) Surface mapping radar is not installed or is inoperative.

(5) The lowest altitude used for IFR flight in any HEDA must not be lower than 400 ft above the surface.

(6) The airborne navigational equipment required to be used, including RA and weather radar (WX) with a ground mapping mode, must be approved for IFR operations.

(7) The required airborne equipment must provide the appropriate levels of availability, accuracy, continuity of function, and integrity for the operation.

(8) The operation has an approved source(s) of weather.

(9) The helicopter must be equipped with one or more independent navigation system(s) suitable for navigating the helicopter along the route to be flown within the degree of accuracy required for ATC and:

(a) It can be shown that the helicopter is equipped with at least one other independent navigation system suitable, in the event of loss of the navigation capability of the single independent navigation system at any point along the route, for proceeding safely to a landing location and completing an instrument approach or offshore instrument operation; and

(b) The helicopter has sufficient fuel so that the flight may proceed safely to a suitable landing location by use of the remaining navigation system, complete an instrument approach or offshore instrument operation, and land.

c. Aircraft Proprietary Automated System. Use of an aircraft proprietary automated system is authorized contingent upon the following conditions:

(1) The certificate holder's helicopters are properly modified in accordance with means approved by the FAA.

(2) The certificate holder has made revisions to its General Maintenance Manual (GMM), inspections covering respective regulatory maintenance, and inspection programs to capture instructions for continued airworthiness (ICA) requirements.

(3) The certificate holder has made revisions to its approved training program to establish a training and testing program for pilots that will be using the new system.

(4) The certificate holder will establish a means for the flightcrew to readily identify before flight which helicopters have the enhanced proprietary automated system capability.

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(5) The certificate holder has made revisions to the General Operations Manual (GOM) and flight deck checklist covering any procedural changes when using the automated approach system.

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15.35 H105 Alternate Airport IFR Weather Minimums



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H105 . Alternate Airport IFR Weather Minimums

HQ Control: 12/19/2019

HQ Revision: 040

a. The certificate holder is authorized to derive alternate airport weather minimums from Table 1 below, according to the limitations and provisions of this operations specification. In no case shall the certificate holder use an alternate airport weather minimum lower than any applicable minimum derived from this table.

Table 1 - Alternate Airport IFR Weather Minimums

Approach Facility Configuration	Ceiling	Visibility
For airports with at least one operational navigational facility providing a straight-in nonprecision approach procedure, or a CAT I precision approach procedure, or, when applicable, a circling maneuver from an IAP.	A ceiling derived by adding 200 ft to MDA(H) or DA(H), as applicable.	1 statute mile (sm) or 1600 m but never less than the minimum visibility for the approach to be flown.

b. Special Limitations and Provisions.

(1) The certificate holder must not use an alternate airport weather minimum other than any applicable minimum derived from Table 1. The certificate holder must not use any Global Positioning System (GPS)-based instrument approach procedure (IAP) unless the certificate holder is authorized to conduct GPS-based IAP and meets the requirements in subparagraph b(5).

(2) In determining alternate airport weather minimums, the certificate holder must not use any published IAP that specifies that alternate airport weather minimums are not authorized.

(3) All conditional forecast elements below the lowest applicable operating minimums must be taken into account. Additives are applied only to the height value (H) and rounded to the next 100-ft value (if not a multiple of 100) to determine the required ceiling.

(4) When dispatching a flight under the provisions of the minimum equipment list (MEL), those MEL limitations affecting instrument approach minimums must be considered in determining alternate minimums.

(5) Use of GPS-Based IAP Minimums at an Alternate Airport. The certificate holder may use GPS-based IAP minimums at an alternate airport with the rotorcraft make, model, and series (M/M/S) listed in Table 2 below. If no authorizations appear in Table 2, GPS-based IAP minimums are not authorized at an alternate airport. Examples of GPS-based IAP include GPS, Area Navigation (RNAV) (GPS), and RNAV (Required Navigation Performance (RNP)). Use of GPS-based IAP minimums at the departure, en route, or destination alternate airport is authorized in the U.S. National Airspace System (NAS) and in any foreign State where GPS-based (or other Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS)-based, including Satellite-based Augmentation

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System (SBAS)-based) approaches are authorized for alternate planning as determined by the applicable Aeronautical Information Publication (AIP).

Table 2 - GPS-Based IAP Authorizations

Rotorcraft M/M/S	Conditions and Limitations	Remarks
LEONARDO-AW169	Subparagraph b(5)(e)(iii)	
LEONARDO-AW169	Subparagraph b(5)(e)(iv)	

(a) Before the certificate holder is authorized to plan for the lines of minimums specified below, the certificate holder must be approved to conduct GPS-based IAP under operations specification H102, Basic Instrument Approach Procedures Authorizations - All Airports, if applicable; operations specification H122, Special Instrument Procedures for Rotorcraft Operations; and operations specification H123, Class 1 Navigation Using Area or Long-Range Navigation Systems with WAAS for Rotorcraft RNP 0.3 En Route and Terminal Operations, if applicable.

(b) The certificate holder with either a Technical Standard Order (TSO)-C129() or a TSO-C196() navigation system must perform a preflight receiver autonomous integrity monitoring (RAIM) prediction for the airport where the GPS-based IAP will be flown. The certificate holder must also ensure that the conventional approach (at destination) can be flown without reliance on GPS. The certificate holder must check Notices to Airmen (NOTAMs) as part of the preflight planning activities.

(c) The certificate holder with either a TSO-C145() or a TSO-C146() navigation system must review appropriate Aeronautical Information Services (AIS) and NOTAMs for wide area augmentation system (WAAS) service outages.

(d) The certificate holder may use suitable RNAV systems for flight planning at an alternate airport, provided planned availability of the substitute means of navigation is confirmed (e.g., NOTAMs and RAIM prediction for use of GPS and NOTAM/AIS checks for use of WAAS). The certificate holder may plan for a conventional approach at the destination and may plan to use a substitute means of navigation based on GPS at the alternate airport, not including substitution for the navigation aid providing lateral guidance on the Final Approach Segment (FAS), unless otherwise authorized. For example, the certificate holder may use GPS to substitute for an out-of-service Very High Frequency Omni-directional range (VOR) that supports an instrument landing system (ILS) Missed Approach Procedure (MAP) at an alternate airport (unless the procedure is NOTAM'd "not authorized").

(e) The certificate holder may use GPS-based IAP with the rotorcraft M/M/S listed in Table 2 according to the conditions and limitations in subparagraphs b(5)(e)(i) through (iv), as indicated in the "Conditions and Limitations" column for each rotorcraft M/M/S.

(i) The certificate holder must have a navigation system, either a TSO-C129() or a TSO-C196(), that includes fault detection and exclusion (FDE) capability to utilize GPS-based IAP at either the destination or an alternate (not both). At the alternate, if not equipped with

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barometric vertical navigation (baro-VNAV) the certificate holder must only plan to use lateral navigation (LNAV) (or circling) minimum descent altitude (height) (MDA(H)).

(ii) The certificate holder must have a navigation system, either a TSO-C129() or a TSO-C196(), that includes FDE capability and is equipped with baro-VNAV to utilize GPS-based IAP at either the destination or an alternate (not both). At the alternate, the certificate holder may plan to use LNAV (or circling) MDA(H) or LNAV/vertical navigation (VNAV) decision altitude (height) (DA(H)) if using baro-VNAV.

(iii) The certificate holder must have a navigation system, either a TSO-C145() or a TSO-C146(), and may utilize GPS-based IAP at both the destination and an alternate. At the alternate, if not equipped with and using baro-VNAV, the certificate holder must only plan to use LNAV (or circling) MDA(H).

(iv) The certificate holder must have a navigation system, either a TSO-C145() or a TSO-C146(), equipped with baro-VNAV, to utilize GPS-based IAP at both the destination and an alternate. At the alternate, the certificate holder may plan to use LNAV (or circling) MDA(H) or LNAV/VNAV DA(H) if using baro-VNAV.

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15.36 H106 IFR Standard Takeoff Minimums, Helicopter Operations



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**H106 . IFR Standard Takeoff Minimums, Helicopter
Operations**

**HQ Control: 10/17/2002
HQ Revision: 02b**

The standard takeoff minimums are defined as 1/2 statute mile visibility or RVR 2400 for helicopters. RVR reports, when available for a particular runway, shall be used for all takeoff operations on that runway. All takeoff operations, based on RVR, must use RVR reports from the locations along the runway specified in this paragraph.

- a. When a takeoff minimum is not published, the certificate holder may use the standard takeoff minimum and any lower than standard takeoff minimums authorized by these operations specifications. When standard takeoff minimums or greater are used, the Touchdown Zone RVR report, if available, is controlling.
- b. When a published takeoff minimum is greater than the standard takeoff minimum and an alternate procedure (such as a minimum climb gradient compatible with aircraft capabilities) is not prescribed, the certificate holder shall not use a takeoff minimum lower than the published minimum. The Touchdown Zone RVR report, if available, is controlling.

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15.37 System

H112 Instrument Approach Operations Using an Area Navigation

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Operations Specifications

H112 . Instrument Approach Operations Using an Area Navigation System

HQ Control: 06/26/1998

HQ Revision: 020

The certificate holder is authorized to conduct Category I published RNAV instrument approach procedures using area navigation systems to the airports and runways approved for such operations in Title 14 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) Part 97 or these operations specifications and shall conduct all such operations in accordance with the provisions of these operations specifications.

a. Authorized Aircraft and Equipment. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct instrument approach operations using the following aircraft and area navigation systems.

Aircraft M/M/S	Area Navigation Systems (Manufacturer/Model)
LEONARDO-AW169	Leonardo / 6F4620AS0400

b. Special Limitations.

- (1) The certificate holder shall not conduct any operation authorized by this paragraph, unless the certificate holder's approved training program provides training in the equipment and special procedures to be used.
- (2) A pilot-in-command shall not conduct operations authorized by this paragraph until that pilot has successfully completed the certificate holder's approved training program. The pilot must be certified as qualified (by one of the certificate holder's check airmen or an FAA inspector) for instrument approach operations using the installed area navigation system.
- (3) During the initial 6 months of operation with a particular aircraft and area navigation system combination, the certificate holder shall not use IFR approach and landing minimums, for that particular aircraft system combination, lower than 200 feet and 1/2 statute mile above the lowest MDA/DH and visibility/RVR minimums authorized for instrument approaches and landings at that airport using area navigation systems.

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3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

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DATE: 2023.06.01 07:39:26 -05:00

HeliService USA LLC

H112-2
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



**15.38 H113 Special Terminal Area IFR Rotorcraft Operations in Class G
Airspace--Nonscheduled Passenger and All-Cargo Operations**



U.S. Department
of Transportation
Federal Aviation
Administration

Operations Specifications

**H113. Special Terminal Area IFR Rotorcraft Operations in Class G
Airspace--Nonscheduled Passenger and All-Cargo Operations**

**HQ Control: 11/08/1999
HQ Revision: 020**

The certificate holder is authorized to conduct nonscheduled passenger and all-cargo (scheduled and nonscheduled) special terminal area IFR rotorcraft operations in Class G airspace specified in accordance with the limitations and provisions of this paragraph. The certificate holder shall not conduct any other special terminal area IFR operations under this operations specification.

- a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct these operations provided that the certificate holder determines that:
- (1) The airport is served by an authorized instrument approach procedure.

(2) The airport has an approved source of weather.

(3) The airport has a suitable means for the pilot-in-command to acquire air traffic advisories and the status of airport services and facilities.

(4) The facilities and services necessary to safely conduct IFR operations are available and operational at the time of the particular operation.
- b. The certificate holder is authorized to designate and use an alternate or diversionary airport which will involve terminal area IFR operations in Class G airspace provided that at the time of any operation to that alternate or diversionary airport, the certificate holder determines that the provisions specified in subparagraphs a(1) through (4) are met.

HeliService USA LLC

H113-1
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J

U.S. Department
of Transportation
Federal Aviation
Administration

Operations Specifications

1. The Certificate Holder applies for the Operations in this paragraph.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Hall, Matthew, Principal Operations
Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/8/2026,
[2] AMENDMENT #: 0
DATE: 2026.01.08 09:07:52 -06:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.
Digitally signed by RUSSO, PAUL CHRISTOPHER on behalf of
Paul Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2026.01.08 10:47:22 -06:00

HeliService USA LLC

H113-2
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



15.39 H117 Straight-in Category I Precision Instrument Approach Procedures - All Airports

U.S. Department
of Transportation
Federal Aviation
Administration

Operations Specifications

H117 . Straight-in Category I Precision Instrument Approach Procedures - All Airports HQ Control: 11/22/2000
HQ Revision: 000

a. Except as provided in this paragraph, the certificate holder shall not use any Category I IFR landing minimum lower than that prescribed by any applicable published instrument approach procedure. The IFR landing minimums prescribed in this paragraph are the lowest authorized (other than Airborne Radar approaches) for use at any airport. Provided that the fastest approach speed used in the final approach segment is less than 91 knots, the certificate holder is authorized to conduct straight-in precision instrument approach procedures using the following:

(1) The published Category A minimum descent altitude (MDA) or decision height (DH), as appropriate.

(2) One-half of the published Category A visibility/RVR minimum or the visibility/RVR minimums prescribed by this paragraph, whichever is higher.

b. Straight-In Category I Precision Approach Procedures. The certificate holder shall not use an IFR landing minimum for straight-in precision approach procedures lower than that specified in the following table. Touchdown zone RVR reports, when available for a particular runway, are controlling for all approaches to and landings on that runway. (See NOTE 2.)

Precision Approaches		Full ILS (See NOTE 1), MLS, or PAR			
Approach Light Configuration	HAT	Helicopters Operated at Speeds of 90 Knots or Less		Helicopters Operated at Speeds More Than 90 Knots	
		Visibility In SM.	TDZ RVR In Feet	Visibility In SM.	TDZ RVR In Feet
No Lights or ODALS or MALS or SSALS	200	3/4	3500	3/4	4000
MALSR or SSALR or ALSF-1 or ALSF-2	200	1/4	1600	1/2	2400
MALSR with TDZ and CL or SSALR with TDZ and CL or ALSF-1/ALSF-2 with TDZ and CL	200	1/4	1600	1/2	1800

NOTE 1: A full ILS requires an operative LOC, GS, and OM or FAF. A precision or surveillance radar fix, an NDB, VOR, DME fix, or a published minimum GSIA fix may be used in lieu of an outer marker.

NOTE 2: The Mid RVR and Rollout RVR reports (if available) provide advisory information to pilots. The Mid RVR report may be substituted for the TDZ RVR report if the TDZ RVR report is not available.

c. Special Limitations and Provisions for Instrument Approach Procedures at Foreign Airports. If the certificate holder is authorized operations at foreign airports, the following criteria apply.

(1) Foreign approach lighting systems equivalent to U.S. standards are authorized for both precision and nonprecision approaches. Sequenced flashing lights are not required when determining the equivalence of a foreign lighting system to U.S. standards.

HeliService USA LLC

H117-1
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



U.S. Department of Transportation Federal Aviation Administration	Operations Specifications
(2) For straight-in landing minimums at foreign airports where an MDA or DH is not specified, the lowest authorized MDA or DH shall be obtained as follows: (a) When an obstruction clearance limit (OCL) is specified, the authorized MDA or DH is the sum of the OCL and the touchdown zone elevation (TDZE). If the TDZE for a particular runway is not available, threshold elevation shall be used. If threshold elevation is not available, airport elevation shall be used. For nonprecision approaches, the MDA may be rounded to the next higher interval of 10 foot increment. (b) When an obstacle clearance altitude (OCA)/obstacle clearance height (OCH) is specified, the authorized MDA or DH is equal to the OCA/OCH. For nonprecision approaches, the authorized MDA may be expressed in intervals of 10 feet. (c) The HAT or HAA used for nonprecision approaches shall not be below those specified in subparagraph a. The HAT or HAA used for precision approaches shall not be below those specified in subparagraph b. (3) When only an OCL or an OCA/OCH is specified, visibility and/or RVR minimums appropriate to the authorized HAA/HAT values determined in accordance with subparagraph e (2) above will be established in accordance with criteria prescribed by U.S. TERPS. (4) When conducting an instrument approach procedure outside the United States, the certificate holder shall not operate an aircraft below the prescribed MDA or continue an approach procedure below the DH, unless the aircraft is in a position from which a normal approach to the runway of intended landing can be made and at least one of the following visual references is clearly visible to the pilot: (a) Runway, runway markings, or runway lights. (b) Approach light system (in accordance with 14 CFR Section 91.175(c)(3)(i)). (c) Threshold, threshold markings, or threshold lights. (d) Touchdown zone, touchdown zone markings, or touchdown zone lights. (e) Visual glide path indicator (such as, VASI, PAPI). (f) Any other feature which clearly identifies the landing surface.	
HeliService USA LLC	H117-2 Amdt. No: 0
Certificate No.: ZS0A760J	



U.S. Department
of Transportation
Federal Aviation
Administration

Operations Specifications

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Matthew L Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1]EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/31/2023, [2] AMENDMENT #: 0
DATE: 2023.05.31 06:35:41 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.06.01 07:39:26 -05:00

HeliService USA LLC

H117-3
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



15.40 H118 Category I IFR Landing Minimums - Circle-to-Land Approach Maneuver

U.S. Department
of Transportation
Federal Aviation
Administration

Operations Specifications

H118 . Category I IFR Landing Minimums - Circle-to-Land Approach Maneuver

HQ Control: 11/22/2000

HQ Revision: 000

a. Except as provided in this paragraph, the certificate holder shall not use any Category I IFR landing minimum lower than that prescribed by any applicable published instrument approach procedure. The IFR landing minimums prescribed in this paragraph are the lowest authorized (other than Airborne Radar approaches) for use at any airport. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct circling maneuvers using the following:

b. Circling Maneuvers. The certificate holder shall not conduct circling maneuvers when the ceiling is less than 1000 feet or the visibility is less than 3 statute miles, unless the pilot-in-command has satisfactorily completed an approved training program for the circling maneuver or satisfactorily completed a flight check for the circling maneuver. The certificate holder shall not use a speed during the circling maneuver which is slower than the approved Instrument Flight Minimum Speed (V_{min}) specified in the FAA approved Rotorcraft Flight Manual. When conducting an instrument approach procedure which requires a circling maneuver to the runway of intended landing, the certificate holder shall not use a landing minimum lower than the minimum prescribed for the applicable circling maneuver or a landing minimum lower than specified in the following table, whichever is higher. The lowest authorized IFR landing minimum for instrument approaches which require a circling maneuver to the runway of intended landing shall be determined for a particular aircraft by using the speed category appropriate to the highest speed used during the circling maneuver.

Speed Category	HAA	Visibility in statute miles
less than 91 kts	350	1
91 to 120 kts	450	1
121 to 140 kts	450	1 1/2
141 to 165 kts	550	2
above 165 kts	1000	3

c. Special Limitations and Provisions for Instrument Approach Procedures at Foreign Airports. If the certificate holder is authorized operations at foreign airports, the following criteria apply.

(1) Foreign approach lighting systems equivalent to U.S. standards are authorized for both precision and nonprecision approaches. Sequenced flashing lights are not required when determining the equivalence of a foreign lighting system to U.S. standards.

(2) For straight-in landing minimums at foreign airports where an MDA or DH is not specified, the lowest authorized MDA or DH shall be obtained as follows:

(a) When an obstruction clearance limit (OCL) is specified, the authorized MDA or DH is the sum of the OCL and the touchdown zone elevation (TDZE). If the TDZE for a particular runway is not available, threshold elevation shall be used. If threshold elevation is not available, airport elevation shall be used. For nonprecision approaches, the MDA may be rounded to the next higher interval of 10 foot increment.

(b) When an obstacle clearance altitude (OCA)/obstacle clearance height (OCH) is specified, the authorized MDA or DH is equal to the OCA/OCH. For nonprecision approaches, the authorized MDA may be expressed in intervals of 10 feet.

HeliService USA LLC

H118-1
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



U.S. Department
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Operations Specifications

(c) The HAT or HAA used for nonprecision approaches shall not be below those specified in subparagraph a. The HAT or HAA used for precision approaches shall not be below those specified in subparagraph b.

(3) When only an OCL or an OCA/OCH is specified, visibility and/or RVR minimums appropriate to the authorized HAA/HAT values determined in accordance with subparagraph e.(2) above will be established in accordance with criteria prescribed by U.S. TERPS.

(4) When conducting an instrument approach procedure outside the United States, the certificate holder shall not operate an aircraft below the prescribed MDA or continue an approach procedure below the DH, unless the aircraft is in a position from which a normal approach to the runway of intended landing can be made and at least one of the following visual references is clearly visible to the pilot:

- (a) Runway, runway markings, or runway lights.
- (b) Approach light system (in accordance with 14 CFR Section 91.175(c)(3)(i)).
- (c) Threshold, threshold markings, or threshold lights.
- (d) Touchdown zone, touchdown zone markings, or touchdown zone lights.
- (e) Visual glide path indicator (such as, VASI, PAPI).
- (f) Any other feature which clearly identifies the landing surface.

HeliService USA LLC

H118-2
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



U.S. Department
of Transportation
Federal Aviation
Administration

Operations Specifications

1. Issued by the Federal Aviation Administration.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Matthew L. Hall, Principal Operations Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/31/2023, [2] AMENDMENT #: 0
DATE: 2023.05.31 06:35:48 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by Paul C Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2023.06.01 07:39:27 -05:00

HeliService USA LLC

H118-3
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



U.S. Department
 of Transportation
 Federal Aviation
 Administration

Operations Specifications

H122. Special Instrument Procedures for Rotorcraft Operations

HQ Control: 02/03/2016

HQ Revision: 010

- a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct special instrument approach procedure (IAP), departure procedure and Standard Terminal Arrival (STAR) operations specified by airport and procedure name, as listed in Table 1 of this operations specification.

Table 1 - Authorized Airports, Procedures and Rotorcraft

Airport Identifier (ICAO)	Procedure Name, ORIG or AMDT NO.	Airport State	Rotorcraft M/M/S	Limitations and Provisions
IN68; Richmond, IN/Reid Hospital	COPTER RNAV (GPS) 31, ORIG	IN	LEONARDO-AW169	
IN68; Richmond, IN/Reid Hospital	HUGEL ONE DEPARTURE (RNAV) (OBSTACLE)	IN	LEONARDO-AW169	
00OI; Dayton, OH/Miami Valley Hospital	COPTER RNAV (GPS) 35, ORIG	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
00OI; Dayton, OH/Miami Valley Hospital	CUSEC ONE DEPARTURE (RNAV) (OBSTACLE)	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
00H4; Troy, OH/Upper Valley Medical Center	COPTER RNAV (GPS) 20, ORIG	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
00H4; Troy, OH/Upper Valley Medical Center	CUMES ONE DEPARTURE (RNAV) (OBSTACLE)	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
01OH; Middletown, OH/Atrium Medical Center	COPTER RNAV (GPS) 31, ORIG	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
01OH; Middletown, OH/Atrium Medical Center	JISVI ONE DEPARTURE (RNAV) (OBSTACLE)	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
2OH5; Dayton, OH/Childrens Medical Center	COPTER RNAV (GPS) 33, ORIG	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
2OH5; Dayton, OH/Childrens Medical Center	JOXIB ONE DEPARTURE (RNAV) (OBSTACLE)	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
23OH; St. Marys, OH/Joint Township Memorial Hospital	COPTER RNAV (GPS) 32, ORIG	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
23OH; St. Marys, OH/Joint Township Memorial Hospital	CUREK ONE DEPARTURE (RNAV) (OBSTACLE)	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
OH69; Hillsboro, OH/Highland District Medical	COPTER RNAV (GPS) 27, ORIG	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
OH69; Hillsboro, OH/Highland District Medical	CISER ONE DEPARTURE (RNAV) (OBSTACLE)	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
OH81; Springfield, OH/Springfield Regional Medical Center	COPTER RNAV (GPS) 19, ORIG	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	
OH81; Springfield, OH/Springfield Regional Medical Center	JOPTO ONE DEPARTURE (RNAV) (OBSTACLE)	OH	LEONARDO-AW169	

HELISERVICE USA LLC

 H122-1
 Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



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Operations Specifications

b. Additional Requirements. The following operations specifications may be required for the authorization of specific procedures in this operations specification, H122.

(1) The certificate holder must be authorized H102, Basic Instrument Approach Procedure Authorizations—All Airports. The “type” of approach authorized in H122 must be authorized in H102.

(2) Operations specifications H112, Instrument Approach Operations Using an Area Navigation System; H113, Special Terminal Area IFR Rotorcraft Operations in Class G Airspace - Nonscheduled Passenger and All-Cargo Operations; and/or H121, Special Terminal IFR Rotorcraft Operations in Class G Airspace—Scheduled Passenger Operations, may be required.

c. Required Training. Flightcrews must be trained in accordance with the certificate holder’s training program before conducting any operations authorized by this operations specification.

1. The Certificate Holder applies for the Operations in this paragraph.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Hall, Matthew, Principal Operations
Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 3/4/2026,
[2] AMENDMENT #: 0
DATE: 2026.03.04 09:05:02 -06:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.

Digitally signed by RUSSO, PAUL CHRISTOPHER on behalf of
Paul Russo, Dir. of Operations, Part 135
DATE: 2026.03.04 17:41:05 -06:00

HELISERVICE USA LLC

H122-2
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



15.42 H123 Class I Navigation Using Area or Long-Range Navigation Systems with WAAS for Rotorcraft RNP 0.3 En Route and Terminal Operations



U.S. Department
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Federal Aviation
Administration

Operations Specifications

H123. Class I Navigation Using Area or Long-Range Navigation Systems with WAAS for Rotorcraft RNP 0.3 En Route and Terminal Operations HQ Control: 03/07/2016
 HQ Revision: 000

a. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct Class I navigation in en route and terminal area operations using area navigation (RNAV) or long-range navigation systems (LRNS) approved by this paragraph, provided the special limitations and provisions of this operations specification are met. Except as provided in these operations specifications, the certificate holder must not conduct any other operation using RNAV or LRNS for RNP 0.3 en route or terminal operations.

b. Rotorcraft and Navigation Equipment. The certificate holder is authorized to conduct Class I navigation en route and terminal using the following rotorcraft and navigation systems.

Table 1 - Rotorcraft, RNAV Equipment, and RNP 0.3 Authorization

Rotorcraft M/M/S	Compliant RNAV System(s) and Software			Navigation Specification(s)	Additional Capabilities	Limitations and Provisions
	Manufacturer	Model/ HW Part #	Software Part/ Version/ Revision Number			
LEONARDO- AW169	Leonardo	EDCU Part # 6F4630V00352	Phase 6 or Newer	RNP 0.3	N/A	

c. RNAV Authorization for domestic routes. RNAV equipment that meets the performance necessary to fly en route and terminal RNP 0.3 routes are authorized in Table 1.

d. Bundling and Authorized Rotorcraft/Equipment. In Table 1, under the Navigation Specification(s) column, RNP 0.3 may be combined with Advanced RNP or RNP 0.3 with Radius to Fix (RF) or RNP 0.3 only (without the Advanced RNP option). As a minimum for Advanced RNP, the certificate holder must be qualified for the following Advanced RNP capabilities: scalability, RF, and parallel offset. Additionally, the Advanced RNP certificate holder must have adequate continuity for the operation.

e. Additional Capabilities. Fixed Radius Transitions (FRT) and/or Time of Arrival Control (TOAC) may be selected in Table 1 under Additional Capabilities for those who qualify for Advanced RNP.

f. Special Limitations and Provisions. The certificate holder must comply with the following limitations and provisions when conducting any operation authorized by this paragraph.

(1) The certificate holder must not conduct such operations unless the certificate holder's approved training program provides training for the equipment and special procedures to be used.

(2) Except when navigation is performed under the supervision of a properly qualified check airman, any pilot used in operations authorized by this paragraph must be qualified in accordance with the certificate holder's approved training program for the navigation system being used.

HELISERVICE USA LLC

H123-1
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J



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Operations Specifications

(3) Rotorcraft operations in the continental United States using RNP 0.3 routes requiring GPS with WAAS augmented equipage must be within air traffic control (ATC) communication. If the RNAV or the LRNS fails, notify ATC as soon as possible.

Note: Some routes may require surveillance capability as determined by ATC.

(4) Rotorcraft operations in Alaska using RNP 0.3 routes requiring GPS with WAAS augmented equipage must be within ATC communication. If the RNAV or the LRNS fails, notify ATC as soon as possible.

Note: Some routes may require surveillance capability as determined by ATC.

1. The Certificate Holder applies for the Operations in this paragraph.
2. These Operations Specifications are approved by direction of the Administrator.



Digitally signed by Hall, Matthew, Principal Operations
Inspector (EA65)
[1] EFFECTIVE DATE: 3/18/2026,
[2] AMENDMENT #: 0
DATE: 2026.03.18 10:28:59 -05:00

3. I hereby accept and receive the Operations Specifications in this paragraph.
- Digitally signed by LEGGETT, ZACHARY, Chief Pilot,
Part 135
DATE: 2026.03.19 12:54:05 -05:00

HELISERVICE USA LLC

H123-2
Amdt. No: 0

Certificate No.: ZS0A760J

16 **APPENDIX B - FORMS AND RECORDS**

16.1 **General**

16.2 **Complete Flight Manifest**



N652LA : Leg 1

Team:

Configuration: Default

Total Weight: 3525.2

Current CG: 5313.4

Weight Pass

CG Pass

View CG Envelope

Equipment

Departed	09/08/2023 13:19	NOW
Arrived	09/08/2023 13:19	NOW
Origin	KOQU	
Destination		
IFR Leg	☐ NO	
Revenue Leg	☐ NO	
Tax Leg	☐ NO	
Block OFF		
Block ON		
Hoist Start Time		
Hoist Stop Time		
Hoist Cycles (Leg)		
Fuel Onload		
Landing Fuel		
Highest Obstacle		
Passengers	0	
PIC	Scoville, Marc	84
SIC	Other	
A (Row 1)	Other	
B (Row 1)	Other	
C (Row 1)	Other	
D (Row 1)	Other	
A (Row 2)	Other	
B (Row 2)	Other	
C (Row 2)	Other	
D (Row 2)	Other	
Cargo Hook		
Cargo Compartment		
Fuel: Main		* in kg

SAVE

SAVE/ADD LEG

SAVE/CLOSE



[illegible]

16.4.1 Onshore PFRA

Draft Careflight

Warn Score: 50 Fail Score: 100

Crewmembers

Pilot has < 6 months Single Pilot or HAA Experience	5	☐
Pilot has < 6 months experience at current base/program	5	☐
Pilot has < 100 flight hours in make/model	4	☐
Pilot's last flight was > 30 Days	5	☐
Pilot's last NVG flight was > 30 days	5	☐
Pilot's last instrument approach was > 30 Days	5	☐
Pilot is on 8th (or greater) consecutive shift	5	☐
Pilot or Med Crew flight experience < 50 HNVGO's	3	☐
One or both Med Crew < 2 years HAA	2	☐
One or both Med Crew is not NVG Qualified/Current	4	☐
New Med Crew/ Pilot Mix (< 1 year HAA All Crew)	8	☐
Flight crew has flown > 3 Flights during their current shift	5	☐

Aircraft

Operational Autopilot	-1	☐
MEL item that increases pilot/crew workload and/or affects patient care	2	☐



MEL Item expires in less than 24 hours (Select time of expiration) Select an option	0	☐
A/C Weight within 5% of Max Certified Weight	3	☐
A/C Weight within 100 lbs/50kgs of max HOG	3	☐
Primary Aircraft not utilized	5	☐

Flight Request

Request Turned down for weather by another aircraft	5	☐
Medical/Patient Flight	4	☐
Scene Flight	4	☐
Specialty Flight (NICU & PICU, Balloon Pumps)	4	☐
Medical Hazard- Transport of a Positively (or possibly) infected patient.	5	☐
Public Relations Flight	4	☐
Flight in mountainous terrain (91.511 defined)	5	☐
Unaided night VFR flight with no NVG onboard or NVG Ops not authorized (conditional flight release required except for Training)	5	☐
Planned completion time of flight past 12th hour of duty day	4	☐
Fuel requirements less than a) VFR - 91.151 or 135.209 plus 10 minutes or b) IFR - 91.167 or 135.223	150	☐
New (AIRBORNE) Assignment: Risk factors selected take into consideration: 1) Diversion to a new assignment or 2) Change in destination	4	☐



New (AIRBORNE) Assignment: Risk factors selected take into consideration: 1) Diversion to a new assignment or 2) Change in destination

4

☐


Flight Conditions

Ceiling within 500 ft of company minimums and trending down during planned flight time	5	☐
Visibility within 2 miles of company minimums and trending down during planned flight time	5	☐
Temp/Dew Point within 4 degree F spread and decreasing	5	☐
Wind > 30 kts or spread > 15 kts	5	☐
Moderate Turbulence	2	☐
Severe Turbulence	5	☐
Weather Associated with Convective SIGMET within 20 miles of route	8	☐
Landing surface has snow or ice or moving water	4	☐
Forecasted icing conditions along route	5	☐
Low lighting conditions exist; Moon Illumination <50% and ceiling is broken or greater	3	☐
Flight taking place between 01am- 05am	4	☐
Forecasted medium/moderate bird activity along route	4	☐
Flight Rules: VFR	0	☐
Flight Rules: IFR	0	☐
Flight Rules: VFR/IFR Mix	0	☐
Operations in or around a TFR	3	☐



Additional Risk Factors	0	☐
First Responder Scene	20	☐
Active Shooter or Active Crime Scene	20	☐

Turndown

Weather - Below VFR	100	☐
Weather - Below IFR	100	☐
Weather - Thunderstorms	100	☐
Weather - Ice	100	☐
Scheduled Maintenance	100	☐
Unscheduled Maintenance	100	☐
Insufficient duty time available	100	☐
Aircraft Range inadequate	100	☐
Aircraft performance or equipment inadequate	100	☐
Med Crew declined flight request	150	☐
Other	100	☐

Pilot Comments

SCORE: 0

NEW FORM

CANCEL

SAVE

16.4.2 Offshore PFRA



Crewmember

PIC has < 6 months SAR Experience	5	☐
SIC has < 6 months SAR Experience	5	☐
HHO has < 6 months SAR Experience	5	☐
Medic has < 6 months SAR Experience	5	☐
PIC has < 100 flight hours in make/model	4	☐
SIC has < 100 flight hours in make/model	4	☐
PIC's last flight was > 30 days	5	☐
SIC's Flight was > 30 days	5	☐
PIC's last NVG flight was > 30 days	5	☐
SIC's last NVG flight was > 30 days	5	☐
PIC is on 8th (or greater) consecutive shift	5	☐
SIC is on 8th (or greater) consecutive shift	5	☐
Any Crew: flight experience < 50 HNVGO's	5	☐
Any Crew: < 2 Years SAR/HAA Experience	5	☐
Any Crew: Not NVG Qualified/Current	5	☐
New Crew Mix (All Crew < 1 year SAR/HAA Experience)	10	☐
3rd or greater flight during shift	5	☐

Aircraft

Operational Autopilot	-1	☐
MEL item that increases pilot/crew workload and/or affects patient care	2	☐



A/C Weight within 5% of Max Certified Weight (>4560)	3	☐
A/C Weight within 100lbs/50kgs of max HOG	3	☐
Primary Aircraft not utilized	5	☐

Flight Request

Request Turned down for weather by another aircraft	5	☐
Is a medical/patient flight	4	☐
Scene Flight	4	☐
Offshore Vessel Flight	5	☐
Offshore Vessel Flight- Night	10	☐
Offshore Hoist Response	8	☐
Offshore Hoist Response- Night	12	☐
Medical Hazard: Transport of a positively (or possibly) infected patient	4	☐
Public Relations Flight	2	☐
Flight in mountainous terrain (91.511 defined)	3	☐
Unaided night VFR flight with no NVG on board or NVG Ops not authorized (conditional flight release required except for training)	10	☐
Planned completion time of flight past 12th hour of duty day	5	☐
Fuel Requirements less than a) VFR - 91.151 or 135.209 plus 10 minutes or b) IFR - 91.167 or 135.223	150	☐
New (AIRBORNE) Assignment: Risk factors selected take into consideration: 1) Diversion to a new assignment or 2) Change in destination	4	☐

Flight Conditions



Flight Conditions

Ceiling within 500ft of company minimums and trending down during planned flight time	5	☐
Visibility within 2 miles of company minimums and trending down during planned flight time	5	☐
Temp/Dew Point within 4 degree F spread and decreasing	5	☐
Wind > 30 knots or spread > 15 knots	5	☐
Moderate Turbulence	2	☐
Severe Turbulence	5	☐
Weather associated with Convective SIGMET within 20 miles of route	8	☐
Landing Surface has snow or ice or moving water	4	☐
Forecasted icing conditions along route	5	☐
Low Lighting Conditions exist: Moon Illumination <50% and ceiling is broken or greater	3	☐
Flight taking place between 01am and 05am	5	☐
Forecasted medium/moderate bird activity along route	4	☐
Flight Rules: VFR	0	☐
Flight Rules: IFR	0	☐
Flight Rules: VFR/IFR Mix	0	☐
Operations in or around a TFR	3	☐
Additional Risk Factors	0	☐



First Responder to scene	20	☐
Active Shooter or Active Crime Scene	20	☐

Turndown

Weather- Below VFR (unable IFR)	100	☐
Weather- Below IFR	100	☐
Weather- Thunderstorms	100	☐
Weather- Icing	100	☐
Scheduled Maintenance	100	☐
Unscheduled Maintenance	100	☐
Insufficient Duty time available	100	☐
Aircraft Range inadequate	100	☐
Aircraft performance or equipment inadequate	100	☐
Crew Declined Flight Request	100	☐
Other	100	☐

Pilot Comments

Close Flight (Turn Down): ☐

Digitally Sign: ☐

SCORE: 0

NEW FORM

CANCEL

SAVE



16.5 Digital AirWare (DA)

16.5.1 Daily Flight Log

AIRCRAFT INFORMATION									
Date: MM/DD/YYYY		Aircraft: Aircraft		W&B CALCULATED: ☐		AIRWORTHINESS CHECK COMPLETED: ☐			
ACTT (Forward):		TQ Event (Forward):		Landings (Forward):		Run on Landing (Forward):			
ACTT (To Add):		TQ Event (To Add):		Landings (To Add):		Run on Landing (To Add):			
ACTT (Ending):		TQ Event (Ending):		Landings (Ending):		Run on Landing (Ending):			
ENGINE #1 INFORMATION									
ENG#1 (Forward):		Cycles (Forward):		Starts (Forward):		N2 (Forward):		NP/NF (Forward):	
ENG#1 (To Add):		Cycles (To Add):		Starts (To Add):		N2 (To Add):		NP/NF (To Add):	
ENG#1 (Ending):		Cycles (Ending):		Starts (Ending):		N2 (Ending):		NP/NF (Ending):	
ENGINE #2 INFORMATION									
ENG#2 (Forward):		Cycles (Forward):		Starts (Forward):		N2 (Forward):		NP/NF (Forward):	
ENG#2 (To Add):		Cycles (To Add):		Starts (To Add):		N2 (To Add):		NP/NF (To Add):	
ENG#2 (Ending):		Cycles (Ending):		Starts (Ending):		N2 (Ending):		NP/NF (Ending):	
HOIST INFO									
HOIST: None									
Cycles Start:	Cycles To Add:	Cycles End:	Hobbs Start:	Hobbs To Add:	Hobbs End:				
OIL SERVICE									
Engine Oil Added: 0.00z		Hydraulic Oil Added: 0.00z		Transmission Oil Added: 0.00z		TR G/B Oil Added: 0.00z			

16.5.2 Power Assurance/VOR Check



ENGINE DATA POWER CHECK		
	ENGINE # 1	ENGINE # 2
N1		
N2		
TOT		
TORQUE		
ENGINE OIL TEMP		
ENGINE OIL PRESSURE		
TRANS TEMP		
TRANS PRESS		
PWR ASSURANCE		
PRESS ALT / OAT c		
VOR CHECK		
	No. 1 BEARING ERROR	No. 2 BEARING ERROR
VOR STATION:		

16.6 HeliService Form M-01 Aircraft Maintenance Log (AML)

16.7 HeliService Form M-03 MEL Extension Request Form



HeliService Form M03

MEL Extension FAA Notification Form

MEL Discrepancy Control Number:		FAA Notification Date:			
Aircraft Registration Number:		Aircraft Make and Model:			
Aircraft Serial Number:		Discrepancy Cat:		ATA:	
Original Deferral Date:		Extension Date:			
Discrepancy:					
Reason For Extension:					
Proposed Corrective Action/Estimated Time for Troubleshooting:					
Backordered Parts P.O. Numbers:		Estimated ETA on Parts:			
Submitted By:		Date:			
Director of Maintenance:		Date:			

16.8HeliService Form M-05 Operation/Structural/Mechanical Interruption Part 1

[illegible]

Initiator Name / Certificate Number / Date:

HeliService USA Form M05			
Operation Service Difficulty Report			
Structural Difficulty Report			
Mechanical Interruption Report Form			
(Reference FAR 135.415/417)			
Part 2 – Mechanic submits when determined			
IDENTIFICATION OF FAILED PART AND/OR SYSTEM. Include all available information pertaining to the failed part and/or system (ie. P/N, S/N, Times, Cycles, Location, Manufacturer, etc.)			
Part Number	Serial Number	Description	Location/System
Total Time	Total Cycles	Date Installed	Manufacturer
Other Pertinent Details:			

Apparent Cause of Failure:

Corrective Action and/ or Emergency Action Taken:

Initiator Name / Certificate Number / Date:

Certificate #ZS0A760J
Rev. Original
Date: 24 March 2023

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16.10 HeliService Form M-09 Paper Log Form



HeliService USA Paper Log Form M09		
Registration No.	Aircraft Serial Number	
Aircraft Hours	Landings	Hoist Cycles
#1 Engine Hours	#1 Engine Cycles	#1 Engine Cycles
#2 Engine Hours	#2 Engine Cycles	#2 Engine Cycles
Item #		Discrepancy
		Corrective Action
Signature, Certificate No. and Date:		
DIP Completed by:		
Signature, Certificate No. and Date:		
Item #		Discrepancy
		Corrective Action
Signature, Certificate No. and Date:		
DIP Completed by:		
Signature, Certificate No. and Date:		
Item #		Discrepancy
		Corrective Action
Signature, Certificate No. and Date:		
DIP Completed by:		
Signature, Certificate No. and Date:		

16.11 HeliService Form M-11 Quality Control WO Checklist



HeliService Form M-11

Aircraft Work Order QC/QA Checklist

Aircraft Reg: _____ Work Order No.: _____ Date: _____

Inspected By: _____

1. Work Order Documentation

- ☐ Work order identifies aircraft, task cards, and maintenance references.
- ☐ Applicable task cards attached and legible.
- ☐ Task cards reference current OM-A and OEM instructions.
- ☐ Latest OM-A/OEM revisions used.
- ☐ Parts/materials traceability documented.

2. Execution of Tasks

- ☐ Tasks carried out I/A/W OM-A procedures.
- ☐ Tasks comply with OEM instructions.
- ☐ Deviations documented with approved Engineering Orders/concessions.
- ☐ Tools/equipment calibrated and in date.

3. Signatures & Approvals

- ☐ Each task card signed by certifying technician.
- ☐ Dual inspections where required signed off.
- ☐ Final release signed by authorized certifying staff.

4. Records & Release

- ☐ Work order closed with no undocumented open/deferred items.
- ☐ Discrepancies corrected and signed off.
- ☐ All required documents attached (e.g., test reports, certs).
- ☐ Aircraft release completed I/A/W OM-A.

5. Final QA Verification

- ☐ QA audit completed and checklist signed.
- ☐ Findings/non-conformances rectified.
- ☐ Final QA sign-off by authorized personnel.

QA Auditor Name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____



Signature:	Certificate Number:
------------	---------------------

- The number of helicopters that the certificate holder uses to provide helicopter air ambulance services and the base locations of the helicopters.
- The number of flights and hours flown during which helicopters operated by the certificate holder were providing helicopter air ambulance services.

- The number of patients transported and the number of patient transport requests for a helicopter providing air ambulance services that were accepted or declined by the certificate holder and the type of each such flight request (such as scene response, inter-facility transport, and organ transport).
- The number of accidents, if any, involving helicopters operated by the certificate holder while providing air ambulance services and a description of the accidents.
- The number of hours flown under IFR by helicopters operated by the certificate holder.
- The number of hours flown at night by helicopters operated by the certificate holder.
- The number of incidents, if any, in which a helicopter was not directly dispatched and arrived to transport patients but was not utilized for patient transport.

Reports must be submitted for each calendar year on a template provided by the FAA. Reports must be submitted not later than 30 calendar-days following the close of the calendar year.



17 APPENDIX C - ELECTRONIC SIGNATURES AND ELECTRONIC RECORD KEEPING

17.1 Introduction

This Appendix provides standards and guidance for electronic signatures, electronic recordkeeping, and electronic manual systems utilized in 14 CFR Part 135 operations. Electronic recordkeeping systems/programs are used to generate and store many types of records (e.g., pilot records, general operations manual, training manual, etc.). This Appendix describes acceptable means for HeliService USA, to utilize electronic signatures, electronic recordkeeping.

17.2 Electronic Signature Authorization – Maintenance

Electronic signatures for maintenance logbooks, airworthiness release, and maintenance performed as applicable to 14 CFR Part 43-43.9 and 43.11 required maintenance entries.

HeliService USA, will be employ the use of Digital Signatures with in the Digital AirWare program. These signatures are in a controlled format and will be utilized by the maintenance technicians for maintenance logbooks, maintenance performed and return to service statements as applicable to 14 CFR Part 43-43.9 and 43.11 required maintenance entries. The pilots will also utilize the same system for proper deferral of approved Minimum Equipment List and Non-Essential Furnishing items, and certain inspections sign offs, I.E. Engine Power Checks, pre-flight checks, as well as Security and Attachment Checks.

1. Signature Uniqueness:

- a. The Digital AirWare program utilizes a digital signature system through the use of Secure Sockets Layer (SSL) technology secure encrypted format that requires a unique login password to access the program. The user will be authenticated by means of a user's unique password, created by the user within the Digital AirWare program, when signing off a maintenance record.
- b. The authorized personnel kept on file will have to log into Digital AirWare individually, and set up the system for their digital/Electronic signature. Once they have entered their information, and have entered in their Certificate numbers, their information will be saved on file and will be accessible only to them by encrypted password, to the unique individual applying their signature.
- c. HeliService USA will have all technicians and pilots enrolled in The Digital AirWare Maintenance Tracking System Electronic/Digital Signature Program.
- d. A listing of names of all authorized personnel granted rights to electronic signatures will be controlled by the Maintenance Manager as provided by the Director of Operations.

2. Means to convey the signatory's intent to sign:

- a. All users will be prompted by the system prior to affix a digital signature to a record. An Electronic Signature screen will populate in Digital AirWare with the users name and the statement "By Clicking Below, You Are Certifying the Item Is Accurate & Complete". The signatory is required to enter their unique password before clicking the Electronically Sign



block to authenticate.

b. Digital AirWare sign-off blocks:

- i. Mechanic Signature: used by the person performing the maintenance action on the aircraft. This is the approval for the return to service sign off.
- ii. QC (Quality Control) Signature: Used by the person completing the Dual Inspection Program (DIP) security and attachment check as outlined in the HeliService USA General Operations Manual.

c. Personnel Responsibilities:

- i. AMT's: HeliService USA AMT's can sign off the Mechanics Signature and QC Signature blocks for both scheduled and unscheduled maintenance tasks. The Mechanic and QC signatures must be completed by different individuals for each individual discrepancy or task.
- ii. Pilot's: HeliService USA Pilots can sign off the Mechanic Signature for performance of pilot authorized tasks only (deferrals, Engine Power assurance, VOR checks etc.). A pilot can sign off the QC Signature for discrepancies and tasks as part of the DIP function.

3. Notification of signed record or document:

- a. Upon signing the record, the signatory's name, certificate number, date and time of signing will be listed in the appropriate sign off block at the bottom of the Digital AirWare program discrepancy page or work order item. The Digital AirWare program discrepancy or work order item will mark the item with a green icon and a status completed advisory, indicating the item has been signed. This will serve as notification that the signature has been affixed.

4. Signature association:

- a. Each signature in the Digital AirWare program is linked to an individual record. The signature is performed on the same screen as the individual record below the individual discrepancy/task description and corresponding corrective action. The user is able to review all information prior to signing the individual record.
- b. All signature information is permanently linked to the individual record in the Digital AirWare program, with an encrypted digital signature with a date and time stamp affixed to each individual Log entry, discrepancy, and work order for the item being signed.

5. Retrievable and Traceable:

- a. All signature items are retrievable and traceable through Digital AirWare by all active employees. All maintenance electronic Log pages, Discrepancies pages and work orders contain a date and time, mechanic name and certificate number, IP address and event time and date stamp.
- b. All signed documents may be traced in the Digital AirWare program via the systems log, History section of the Electronic Flight and Maintenance Log page, discrepancies page and work order items.

6. Permanent and unalterable:

- a. All digitally signed items are permanently attached to the individual record in the Digital AirWare program. The Digital AirWare program does not allow any alterations to that



original record unless it is resigned. Once a record is digitally signed it remains in the system as the original document with a date and time stamp and the individuals IP address.

7. Security Protocols and Prevention of Unauthorized Access and Modification:

- a. The Director of Maintenance will provide the listings of all HeliService USA personnel authorized for the use of digital signatures in Digital AirWare to the Maintenance Manager. The Maintenance Manager is designated as the Digital AirWare administrator, who will activate all authorized users with permissions in Digital AirWare.
- b. The Digital AirWare program requires a unique login password to access the system. This login password is a password created and controlled by the user. The user will be authenticated by means of the user's unique password, created by the user within the Digital AirWare program, when signing off a maintenance record.
- c. Upon termination or voluntary separation of an employee from HeliService USA the Maintenance Manager will remove that user's login ID from the Active User list in Digital AirWare restricting their access to the Digital AirWare program.
- d. When a signature is affixed to a record, the Digital AirWare program will prevent any modification or alteration to that record as follows:
 - i. Digital AirWare program does not allow any alterations to that original record unless it is resigned. Once a record is digitally signed it remains in the system as the original document with a date and time stamp and the individuals IP address.
 - ii. Once an edit or alteration to a record is made, the Digital AirWare program will require a new digital signature to be recorded against the individual record with a new date and time stamp and the individuals IP address.
 - iii. Once a record is completed and closed, that record is permanently stored inside of the Digital AirWare system and the original record cannot be modified or altered in the system files.

8. Correctable:

- a. Upon completion of the Flight and Maintenance log. It is possible to correct the entry in the event an error has occurred. The Flight and Maintenance Log page will be selected as Un-complete Log book and the amended entry will be made under the amended entry section of that log page.
- b. All edited signed documents will have a new attached digital signature to the item to identify the last person making an edit. The Digital AirWare Systems Log and the document being edited will reflect the new digital signature of person performing the editing.

9. Archivable:

- a. See Electronic Record keeping process in this appendix for maintenance records.

10. Control private keys and access codes:

- a. The authorized user of Digital AirWare is the only party that can set up their unique login password and the unique password is under sole custody of the user at all times.

11. Policies and Procedures:

- a. Regulatory compliance - To meet the requirements of 14 CFR 43 paragraphs 43.9 and 43.11 the corrective action section for discrepancy, work order and flight/maintenance log pages



in Digital AirWare will contain the following:

- i. A complete description of the work performed
 - ii. The name(s) of the person(s) performing the work if other than the person completing the mechanic portion of the Digital AirWare electronic signature
 - iii. For inspections requiring record entry per 14 CFR Part 43 paragraph 4:11, the appropriate 43:11(a)(4), (5),(6) or (7) statement.
 - iv. The date and aircraft total time of completion of the maintenance is provided by attachment to the Digital AirWare discrepancy, work order and flight/maintenance log pages.
- b. System description - Electronic signatures listed herein are signatures whose purpose is identical to that of a handwritten signature or any other form of signature currently accepted or approved by the FAA.
- i. How the Process is used: Upon completion of maintenance, the person performing the maintenance and approving the work as authorized by 14 CFR Part 43 paragraph 43.7 will review the corrective action to ensure it meets regulatory requirements (as detailed in "regulatory compliance" paragraph above) and will then complete the mechanic portion of the Digital AirWare electronic signature area. By clicking "Electronically Sign" when completing this process, the authorized individual certifies that the particular task/corrective action is approved for return to service.
 - ii. Hardware and software capabilities: Hardware to be utilized will be any electronic computing device with an internet connection that supports the software below.
 - iii. Software to be utilized is a web browser that is compatible with the web based Digital AirWare program.
 - iv. Responsible Personnel:
 1. The Director of Maintenance has the overall responsibility for the integrity and security of the electronic signature system and is responsible for controlling access to the system.
 2. The Maintenance Manager has the authority and responsibility for modifying, revising, and monitoring the electronic signature process. The Maintenance Manager is responsible for ensuring the process is followed by all appropriate personnel.
 - v. Defined users: Any certificated pilot or mechanic employed by HeliService USA that is performing a maintenance function to an aircraft governed by HeliService USA Operations Specifications.
 - vi. Training and user instructions: All users will receive training prior to first use of the electronic signature process. A presentation will be stored on HeliService USA SharePoint drive to allow for standardized training and reference material for future use. In the event a change to the process is required, training will be evaluated based on the extent of the change, and the change and any necessary training will be communicated via a Maintenance Information Letter
 - vii. System support: Software support is by Digital AirWare. Hardware support is



provided by the HeliService USA IT team.

- viii. Quality Control (QC) and auditing: Quality control and auditing will be performed by Maintenance Manager through normal defined processes as detailed in Chapter 11 of the HeliService USA General Operations Manual. In the event that an unauthorized individual attempts to utilize an electronic signature or upon discovery of an abnormality within the process, the Maintenance Manager will be notified immediately.
- ix. Process changes require FAA acceptance prior to implementation.
 - 1. Any revision to this electronic signature process shall be submitted by the Director of Maintenance (or their designee) to the FAA prior to implementation.
 - 2. Changes to this Appendix of the General Operations Manual may be tracked by the procedures outlined in the Preface of this General Operations Manual.

17.3 Electronic Recordkeeping Systems - Maintenance

1. System Description

- a. System facilities, hardware, and software
 - i. Electronic maintenance records are stored in two locations:
 - 1. The HeliService USA SharePoint drive.
 - 2. Stored within the Digital AirWare program, the electronic maintenance tracking software, accessible through any computer (desktop, laptop) or portable electronic device that has internet access and supports PDF and Digital AirWare.
- b. Identification of the records maintained and stored on the system.
 - i. Electronic records listed herein are either:
 - 1. Electronically generated maintenance records that have been electronically signed, or
 - 2. Paper versions that have been verified to be original authentic documents that have been converted to PDF.
 - ii. The following electronic records are stored in PDF on the HeliService USA SharePoint drive:
 - 1. Maintenance records.
 - 2. Maintenance log entries.
 - 3. Daily Aircraft Flight and Maintenance Logs.
- c. Identification of which electronic records utilize electronic signature process.
 - i. For a listing of electronic records that utilize an electronic signature process, refer to Paragraph E.2 of this Appendix.

2. Security:



- a. Each electronic record that is electronically generated by the Digital AirWare program is stored in two locations:
 - i. One copy is converted to a PDF that allows for preservation and prevents alteration and is saved in the HeliService USA SharePoint drive.
 - ii. One copy is retained within the Digital AirWare program as part of the original Digital AirWare transaction that generated the record.
- b. Each electronic record that has been electronically converted to a PDF from a paper version is stored in two locations:
 - i. One copy is saved in the HeliService USA SharePoint drive,
 - ii. One copy is retained within the Digital AirWare program as an attachment to the appropriate Digital AirWare transaction that tracked the maintenance.
- 3. Authenticity and prevention of unauthorized access or data corruption.
 - a. HeliService USA SharePoint stored records:
 - i. Only specific individuals are authorized to upload an electronic record to the HeliService USA SharePoint Drive. When an individual uploads an electronic record, their name is listed with the electronic record, under the properties section and details section of the document.
 - b. Digital AirWare stored records:
 - i. Access to records within the Digital AirWare program is controlled by individual users, username and password as well as user defined roles based upon the employee's role within the company. Any files that are electronically signed are controlled through the electronic signature control process. Any paper versions that have been converted to PDF and then uploaded will have the employee's name listed next to the uploaded record.
 - c. Authorized individuals for granting permissions within the HeliService USA SharePoint site and the Digital AirWare program include the following:
 - i. Director of Maintenance or designee
 - ii. Maintenance Manager
 - d. Individuals not authorized to upload or generate electronic records are denied the ability to do so. This also inhibits their ability to delete or modify files. In the event of discovery of an unauthorized individual to access and/or make entries into the electronic recordkeeping system the Maintenance Manager will be notified immediately.
- 4. Quality control (QC) and auditing
 - a. Verification of record accuracy.
 - i. To ensure the accuracy and integrity of records maintained on the recordkeeping system, aircraft maintenance records will be audited through our maintenance control and quality improvement processes.
 - b. Verification of backup integrity.
 - i. The electronic records are backed up as detailed in this Section. These backups duplicate the data across different company servers. Data integrity and consistency across the servers is continuously monitored by the HeliService USA IT team.



- c. Verification of changes requiring electronic signature.
 - i. Any document that has been electronically signed cannot be altered. If a correction is required, either a new document must be generated and electronically signed by the person performing the correction. The correction document will be stored electronically per the detailed process in this Appendix. Or the electronic Daily Aircraft Flight and Maintenance Logs may be amended on the Amendments section and saved as a new document.
 - d. Persons responsible for verification:
 - i. The Maintenance Manager is responsible for the QC process and for verification of records.
5. Maintenance support and backup measures:
- a. Continuous backup's are performed on multiple servers on which electronic records are stored at HeliService USA's principle business address, as well as a data center/co-location facility.
 - b. Records are backed up on multiple company servers at various locations; electronic records are accessible at any time in the event one server is unavailable. This is further enhanced by duplication of maintenance records between the HeliService USA SharePoint drive and the Digital AirWare program.
6. Procedures for making required records available to FAA and NTSB personnel
- a. All electronic records listed in this Section will be made available to FAA and NTSB personnel upon request. Maintenance records are accessible on the HeliService USA SharePoint drive. FAA will be given read only access rights to Digital AirWare.
7. Training and user instructions:
- a. Maintenance and flight operations personnel authorized access to maintenance records will be trained via PowerPoint tutorials and/or hands- on training by one or more of the following individuals:
 - i. Director of Maintenance or designee
 - ii. Maintenance Manager or designee
 - iii. Trained Authorized Maintenance personnel
8. Persons with authorized access: Authorized company personnel have access to maintenance records stored on the HeliService SharePoint drive and in the Digital AirWare program via unique usernames and passwords.
- a. The following personnel have authorization to view maintenance electronic records:
 - i. All Flight Operations personnel.
 - ii. All Maintenance personnel.
 - b. The following personnel have authorization to upload maintenance electronic records converted from paper versions:
 - i. Director of Maintenance
 - ii. Maintenance Manager
 - iii. AMT's
 - c. The following personnel have authorization to generate new records and view existing



maintenance records within the Digital AirWare program:

- i. All Flight Operations personnel
 - ii. All Maintenance personnel
 - d. All authorized individuals are granted authorization through the HeliService USA SharePoint drive or by their role within the Digital AirWare program.
9. Responsible Personnel:
- a. The Director of Maintenance has the overall responsibility for the integrity and security of the maintenance electronic recordkeeping system and is responsible for controlling access to the system.
 - b. The following personnel have the authority and are responsible for modifying the electronic recordkeeping system as well as responsible for ensuring accurate entry of data into the system:
 - i. Director of Maintenance
 - ii. Maintenance Manager
10. Transferring data to another system:
- a. If electronic maintenance records are required to be transferred to another system, the current system would be maintained concurrently while the transfer is completed and the integrity of the information is verified in the new system.
11. Continuity of data between legacy and electronic systems:
- a. Legacy maintenance records that are paper versions are maintained for up to two years or until work has been superseded by other work (whichever occurs first), at which point they are discarded. Paper maintenance records stored in the legacy system are retained at HeliService USA headquarters and are available for review at that location.
12. Continuity of data for outsourced maintenance providers:
- a. Outsourced maintenance providers will provide HeliService USA with paper versions of maintenance records. These will be stored electronically as provided in this section.
13. Maintenance record transfer:
- a. Upon sale or transfer of an aircraft the electronic records will be provided to the purchaser of the aircraft in either electronic format or will be printed and provided in paper format at the request of the purchaser.
14. Electronic authentication, signature, validation, or endorsement:
- a. Electronic signature processes for maintenance records are covered in Paragraph 17.2 of this Appendix.
15. Changes to the system require FAA approval or acceptance prior to implementation:
- a. Any revision to this electronic recordkeeping system shall be submitted by Director of Operations (or their designee) to the FAA prior to implementation.
 - b. Changes to this Appendix of the General Operations Manual may be tracked by the procedures outlined in the Preface of this General Operations Manual.

17.4 Electronic Signature Authorization - Pilot Records



17.4.1 Purpose

To establish standards for the use and management of digital signatures on operational, maintenance, training, and regulatory records in accordance with FAA AC 120-78B.

17.4.2 Scope

Applies to all HeliService USA personnel who are authorized to sign electronic documents related to 14 CFR Part 133 and 135 operations.

17.4.3 Definitions

- **Digital Signature:** A secure, cryptographic signature using a public/private key infrastructure (PKI), validating signer identity and ensuring content integrity.
- **Electronic Signature:** A broader category of digitally captured intent to sign, including typed names, scanned images, or clicks.
- **Authentication:** Verification of signer identity using credentials and access controls.

17.4.4 Policy Requirements

17.4.4.1 Signature Tool and Authentication

- **Adobe Acrobat** is the authorized platform for applying digital signatures.
- Each signer has a unique digital certificate linked to their identity.
- Adobe and Complete Flight ensure intent via “Click to Sign” prompts and applies encryption to ensure authenticity.

The Director of Operations, Chief Pilot, Instructor Pilots, and Check Pilots are designated as authorized signatories for pilot training records and evaluation records under HeliService USA’s approved training program. Each signatory may execute only those documents for which they have direct responsibility and authority, as defined in company manuals and FAA-approved curriculums. All electronic signatures shall be applied using secure, company-approved systems that uniquely identify the signer, capture the date and time of execution, and provide a complete audit trail to ensure authenticity, integrity, and compliance with 14 CFR Part 135 and Operations Specification A025.



17.4.4.2 Intent and Binding

- Signatures clearly indicate intent to approve or certify.
- Adobe binds the signature to the signed document, making changes traceable.

17.4.4.3 Security and Integrity

- Adobe certificate-based digital signatures are tamper - evident.
- Any changes to the document invalidate the existing signature and require re-signing.

17.4.4.4 Non-Repudiation and Auditability

- Adobe logs record signers ID, timestamps, and certificate status.
- Signature data will be retained in Adobe accounts and made available for audit upon request.

17.4.4.5 Document Storage and Redundancy

- All digitally signed records will be stored in **FleetPlan** and **SharePoint** concurrently.
- FleetPlan serves as the primary operations and document control system, SharePoint functions as a secure backup and reference archive.
- Access is role-restricted, and version control is enforced across both systems.

17.4.4.6 Corrections and Version Control

- Any required correction must be performed on a new document version, which must be signed anew.
- Prior versions and associated signature logs will be retained in both FleetPlan and SharePoint for auditing.

17.4.5 Authorization and System Documentation



- All digital signing processes, tools, and storage practices are documented in this manual and the OM-D.
- This policy aligns with OpSpec A025 and FAA AC120-78B guidance.

17.4.6 Training

- All personnel using Adobe digital signatures will complete formal training on signature process, storage protocols, and security responsibilities.
- Training records are digitally archived in FleetPlan and Share Point.

17.4.7 Discontinuation of Use

- If digital signature use, Adobe, tools are discontinued, HSUSA will notify its FSDO and submit a transition plan for FAA review, as required under AC 120-78B.
- The plan will include archival procedures and legacy record preservation.

17.4.8 Oversight and Review

- The DO/Chief Pilot ultimately hold the responsibility of ensuring regulatory compliance and oversight. Additionally:
 - The Safety Management System (SMS) and QA functions will oversee digital signature integrity, access control, and document security compliance.
 - Reviews will occur annually or after any system change.

17.4.8.1 Policy Statement

HeliService USA employs secure electronic signature processes in accordance with Operations Specification A025 to execute and manage operational, training, and maintenance records.

Record Type	Authorized Signatory Roles	System Used	Notes
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Dispatch Releases	Director of Operations, Chief Pilot, PIC, or Designee	Adobe	Signatory must be operationally controlling the flight.
Pilot Training Records	Director of Operations, Chief Pilot, Instructor Pilots, Check Pilots	Adobe	Only for training events or checks they conducted/oversaw.
Pilot Evaluation Records	Chief Pilot, Instructor Pilots, Check Pilots	Adobe	Must reflect evaluation conducted per OM-D.
Airworthiness Releases	Director of Maintenance, Authorized Maintenance Personnel	Digital Airware	Must be signed by certificated mechanic or repairman with approval.
Maintenance Actions	Director of Maintenance, Authorized Maintenance Personnel	Digital Airware	Must comply with FAA-approved maintenance program.

All electronic signatures are applied using secure, authenticated systems that uniquely identify the signer, capture the date and time of execution, maintain a tamper-evident audit trail, and preserve the integrity and accessibility of records for FAA inspection. Only individuals listed on the company's current **Electronic Signature Authorization List** are permitted to sign, and each signature must be within the scope of the signer's assigned duties and regulatory authority under 14 CFR Parts 133 and 135.

17.4.9 Digital Signature System Training

17.4.9.1 Purpose

To ensure all authorized personnel are competent in using Adobe Acrobat for digital signatures and properly storing and retrieving signed documents in FleetPlan and SharePoint.

17.4.9.2 Applicability

This training is mandatory for all personnel authorized to digitally sign documents or manage digital records under Part 133 and 135 operations, including Check pilots, Instructor pilots, maintenance staff, quality assurance, dispatchers, and admin.



17.4.9.3 Training Modules

17.4.9.3.1 Module 1

General Digital Signature Awareness (All Users)

Duration: .25 hour

Delivery: Web-based (CBT) or in-person

Content:

- FAA AC 120-78B key requirements
- Legal standing of digital signatures
- Types of signatures (digital vs. electronic)
- Signature intent and non-repudiation

Tamper-evident design and security expectations

17.4.9.3.2 Module 2

Adobe Acrobat Digital Signing (Signers Only)

Duration: .25 hours

Delivery: In-person or internet based meeting with workstation practice

Content:

- Installing and configuring digital ID certificates
- Creating and applying Adobe digital signatures
- Document version control and signature re-application
- Using signature validation tools
- Common errors and troubleshooting (certificate expired, invalid signature)
- Re-signing after document modification
- Examples: MEL sign-off, hoist checklist, training record sign-off

Practical Exam: Sign, invalidate, and re-sign a document scenario in Adobe

Record: Certificate of completion stored in FleetPlan

17.4.9.3.3 Module 3

Document Storage and Workflow (Admin/Records Staff)

Duration: .25 hours

Delivery: Live or recorded instructional session

Content:

- FleetPlan document control and upload protocol
- Time Frame for uploads to be completed post training.
 - Within 24 hours of training activity.
- Document tagging, version tracking, and signature log access



- SharePoint file redundancy protocols
- Folder permissions and role-based access
- Archival vs. active document handling
- Discontinuance backup and migration procedures

Task Demo: Upload and validate a digitally signed document into FleetPlan and SharePoint

Checklist: Completed by training supervisor and archived

17.4.9.3.4 Module 4

Security, Corrections, and Audit (QA/Management/IT)

Duration: .25 hour

Delivery: Small group briefings

Content:

- Account and certificate management
 - Deactivating credentials
 - Chain of custody protocols
 - Log review and discrepancy reporting
 - Responding to FAA audits or requests
 - Correction and invalidation policy
- Audit Simulation:** Review of signature logs and record chain
- Record:** Log of attendance in SharePoint

17.4.9.4 Currency and Recurrent Training

- **Initial:** Prior to first use
- **Recurrent:** Every 24 months or when the software/system is updated
- **Remedial:** As directed by QA for observed non-compliance

17.4.9.5 Documentation and Oversight of Training

- Training rosters and certificates maintained in FleetPlan and Share Point concurrently.
- Internal audits to validate correct signature and storage practices.
- Training Program reviewed annually or after FAA guidance updates.

17.4.10 Electronic Recordkeeping Systems- Pilot Records

1. System Description
 - a. System facilities, hardware, and software
 - i. Electronic maintenance records are stored in two locations:
 1. HeliService USA FleetPlan
 2. The HeliService USA SharePoint drive.
 - b. Identification of the records maintained and stored on the system.



- i. Electronic records listed herein are either:
 1. Electronically generated maintenance records that have been electronically signed, or
 2. Paper versions that have been verified to be original authentic documents that have been converted to PDF.
 - ii. The following electronic records are stored in PDF on the Fleet Plan and HeliService USA SharePoint drive:
 1. Pilot Records.
 2. Currency Certificates.
 3. Training Certificates.
2. Security:
 - a. Each electronic record that is generated is stored in two locations:
 - i. HeliService USA FleetPlan.
 - ii. HeliService USA SharePoint Drive.
 - b. Each electronic record that has been electronically converted to a PDF from a paper version is stored in two locations:
 - i. HeliService USA FleetPlan.
 - ii. HeliService USA SharePoint Drive.
3. Authenticity and prevention of unauthorized access or data corruption.
 - a. HeliService USA SharePoint stored records:
 - i. Only specific individuals are authorized to upload an electronic record to the HeliService USA SharePoint Drive. When an individual uploads an electronic record, their name is listed with the electronic record, under the properties section and details section of the document.
 - b. Fleet Plan Stored Records:
 - i. Access to records within the Fleet Plan program is controlled by individual users, username and password as well as user defined roles based upon the employee's role within the company. Any paper versions that have been converted to PDF and then uploaded will have the employee's name listed next to the uploaded record.
 - c. Authorized individuals for granting permissions within the HeliService USA SharePoint site and the Fleet Plan program include the following:
 - i. Director of Operations
 - ii. Chief Pilot
 - d. Individuals not authorized to upload or generate electronic records are denied the ability to do so. This also inhibits their ability to delete or modify files. In the event of discovery of an unauthorized individual to access and/or make entries into the electronic recordkeeping system the Director of Operations and Chief Pilot will be notified immediately.
4. Quality control (QC) and auditing
 - a. Verification of record accuracy.
 - i. To ensure the accuracy and integrity of records maintained on the recordkeeping system, the Chief Pilot, Training Officer and Check Airman will be audited through



- our pilot record control and quality improvement processes.
- b. Verification of backup integrity.
 - i. The electronic records are backed up as detailed in this Section. These backups duplicate the data across different company servers. Data integrity and consistency across the servers is continuously monitored by the HeliService USA IT team.
 - c. Verification of changes requiring electronic signature.
 - i. Any document that has been electronically signed cannot be altered. If a correction is required, either a new document must be generated and electronically signed by the person performing the correction. The correction document will be stored electronically.
 - d. Persons responsible for verification:
 - i. The Chief Pilot or Training Officer is responsible for the QC process and for verification of records.
5. Maintenance support and backup measures:
- a. Continuous backup's are performed on multiple servers on which electronic records are stored at HeliService USA's principle business address, as well as a data center/co-location facility.
 - b. Records are backed up on multiple company servers at various locations; electronic records are accessible at any time in the event one server is unavailable. This is further enhanced by duplication of pilot records between the HeliService USA SharePoint drive and the FleetPlan program.
6. Procedures for making required records available to FAA and NTSB personnel
- a. All electronic records listed in this Section will be made available to FAA and NTSB personnel upon request. Pilot records are accessible on the FleetPlan and HeliService USA SharePoint drive. FAA will be given read only access rights to Fleet Plan.
7. Training and user instructions:
- a. Maintenance and flight operations personnel authorized access to maintenance records will be trained via PowerPoint tutorials and/or hands- on training by one or more of the following individuals:
 - i. Director of Maintenance or designee
 - ii. Maintenance Manager or designee
 - iii. Trained Authorized Maintenance personnel
8. Persons with authorized access: Authorized company personnel have access to Pilot Records stored on the HeliService SharePoint drive and in the FleetPlan program via unique usernames and passwords.
- a. The following personnel have authorization to view Pilot electronic records:
 - i. All Flight Operations personnel.
 - ii. All Pilots.
 - b. The following personnel have authorization to upload maintenance electronic records converted from paper versions:
 - i. Chief Pilot



- ii. Training Officer
 - iii. Check Airmen
 - c. The following personnel have authorization to generate new records and view existing records.
 - i. Chief Pilot
 - ii. Training Officer
 - iii. Check Airmen
 - d. All authorized individuals are granted authorization through the HeliService USA SharePoint drive or by their role within the Fleet Plan program.
- 9. Responsible Personnel:
 - a. The Chief Pilot has the overall responsibility for the integrity and security of the pilot recordkeeping system and is responsible for controlling access to the system.
 - b. The following personnel have the authority and are responsible for modifying the electronic recordkeeping system as well as responsible for ensuring accurate entry of data into the system:
 - i. Chief Pilot
 - ii. Training Officer
- 10. Transferring data to another system:
 - a. If electronic maintenance records are required to be transferred to another system, the current system would be maintained concurrently while the transfer is completed and the integrity of the information is verified in the new system.
- 11. Continuity of data between legacy and electronic systems:
 - a. Legacy maintenance records that are paper versions are maintained for up to two years or until work has been superseded by other work (whichever occurs first), at which point they are discarded. Paper pilot records stored in the legacy system are retained at HeliService USA headquarters and are available for
- 12. Changes to the system require FAA approval or acceptance prior to implementation:
 - a. Any revision to this electronic recordkeeping system shall be submitted by Director of Operations (or their designee) to the FAA prior to implementation.
 - b. Changes to this Appendix of the General Operations Manual may be tracked by the procedures outlined in the Preface of this General Operations Manual.



18 APPENDIX D - CONTINUING AUTHORIZATION FERRY FLIGHT PROGRAM

18.1 Preface

18.1.1 Overview

Pursuant to FAR 21.197 & 21.199 HeliService USA has developed this Continuing Authorization Ferry Flight Program (CAFP) Manual to provide guidance for evaluating the necessity of authorizing a Special Ferry Permit (Ferry Permit) in the event an aircraft has sustained physical damage or has inoperative/malfunctioning equipment. This manual will provide guidance for Maintenance Technicians and Pilots on the procedures to be followed, for determining aircraft airworthiness and flight limitations/restrictions that apply by the issuance of a Special Ferry Permit.

The contents and approval of this manual are applicable to all HeliService USA aircraft as granted in Operations Specification D084. The procedures and limitations given in this program will be strictly adhered to.

18.1.2 Purpose

The intent of this Continuing Authorization Ferry Flight Program is to allow the flight of an aircraft that may not meet applicable airworthiness requirements but is capable of safe flight for the purpose of flying the aircraft to a base where authorized maintenance personnel may perform the required maintenance or alterations necessary to bring the aircraft back to an airworthy state.

The necessity of a maintenance ferry flight occurs as a result of deficiencies occurring at remote locations beyond HeliService USA's repair capability which renders the aircraft ineligible for revenue service but capable of safe flight to a location where repairs can be made.

This document also covers situations where the aircraft has to be flown to a repair facility to comply with an Airworthiness Directive (if allowed in accordance with the airworthiness Directive) that cannot be performed by HeliService USA or the discrepancy must be repaired at a maintenance facility due to required tooling and/or equipment. The procedures in this manual will be used to determine if a Special Flight Permit will be allowed to be issued.

HeliService USA will not operate an aircraft to which an AD applies except in accordance with the requirements of that AD. Therefore, if an AD requires compliance before further flight, with no provision for the issuance of special flight permit, the operation of the specified aircraft will not be permitted.

Note: Any aircraft involved in an accident or incident may not be ferried prior to a release by the juridical NTSB office and notification to the local FAA District Office.

Note: This manual is not intended and will not be used for an aircraft one engine out ferry operations.



Note: This manual is not intended for international flight requirements.

18.1.3 Control

The Director of Maintenance is the primary administrator of the revisions to the Continuing Authorization Ferry Flight Program (CAFP).

Revisions to this program will be the responsibility of the Director of Maintenance and is subject to approval by the Certificate Holders District Office (CHDO) prior to implementation.

18.1.4 Distribution

The latest revision of this manual will be stored and maintained on the HeliService USA SharePoint drive. All HeliService USA Pilots and Mechanics will have access to this location through HeliService USA computers to facilitate compliance, as referenced in HeliService USA's General Operations Manual.

18.1.5 Training

For the purpose of training and use of the CAFP program, all Aviation Maintenance Technicians and Aviation Managers are required to read and understand the CAFP manual and procedures, familiarization and understanding of the processes involved for initiating and completing all applicable Ferry Permit forms. At the completion of CAFP program training, all Aviation Maintenance Technicians are required to sign and date a record of training.

Any new hire AMT's will be required to complete CAFP training during new employee on board processing. All completed training records involving the CAFP program will be kept in a master training file located in the Director of Maintenance's office. For the purposes of utilizing any outside repair facility or vendor, a copy of the CAFP manual will be made available for review and compliance via printed or electronically.

18.2 Abbreviations & Definitions

18.2.1 Abbreviations

AAOC - Aviation Administrative on Call

AMOC - Administrative Maintenance on Call

AMT - Aviation Maintenance Technician

CG - Center of Gravity

CHDO - Certificate Holding District Office

CP - Chief Pilot

DO - Director of Operations

DOM - Director of Maintenance



FAA - Federal Aviation Administration

FARs - Federal Aviation Regulations

GOM - General Operations Manual

IAS - Indicated Airspeed

IAW - In Accordance With

IFR - Instrument Flight Rules

IMC - Instrument Meteorological Conditions

KIAS - Knots Indicated Airspeed (NOTE: all airspeeds quoted in the Manual are KIAS unless labeled otherwise.)

LZ - Landing Zone

MEL - Minimum Equipment List

OEI - One Engine Inoperative

OOS - Out of Service

OpSpecs - Operations Specifications

PIC - Pilot in Command

RFM - Rotorcraft Flight Manual

SPVFR - Single Pilot under Visual Flight Rules

VFR - Visual Flight Rules

18.2.2 Definitions

The following terms are used throughout this Manual and are defined as follows;

Airworthiness: Two conditions must be met for an aircraft to be considered airworthy

1. i.The aircraft must conform to its type certificate (design) or property altered state.
2. ii.The aircraft must be in condition for safe operation

NOTE: IF EITHER OF THESE CONDITIONS ARE NOT MET, THE AIRCRAFT WOULD BE CONSIDERED NOT AIRWORTHY.

Attachment: The visual examination should include component mounting points and condition of locking. This may be accompanied by a "feel" test (manual force applied to the part to reveal a fault in the assembly).

Check: Examinations in the form of comparisons with stated standards for the purpose of verifying condition, accuracy and tolerance

Condition: The visual examination should check the general external appearance of the part (distortion, fractures, cracks, scratches, corrosion, signs of over-heating, wear, etc.).

Functional Test: This test is used to ascertain that a system or component is functioning properly in all aspects in conformance with minimum acceptable design specifications. This test may require the use of supplemental ground support equipment or bench test equipment.

Inspection: Utilizing acceptable methods, techniques and practices to determine physical condition and



detect defects.

Leaks: The visual examination should reveal any signs of leakage or fluid loss. Special attention must be given to the drain holes, unions, junctions and the piston rods of hydraulic actuators.

Leaks: The visual examination should reveal any signs of leakage or fluid loss. Special attention must be given to the drain holes, unions, junctions and the piston rods of hydraulic actuators.

Maintenance: Inspection, overhaul, repair, preservation, and the replacement of parts, but excludes Preventative Maintenance.

No Abnormal Play: Except where otherwise stated, play is not measured; however, an abnormal amount of play may sometimes be found by moving a part manually in both directions.

Operational Test: Operation of aircraft components, appliances or systems to evaluate function performance while installed in the aircraft.

Safe For Flight: Aircraft that does not meet the applicable airworthiness requirements but is capable of flight for the purposes of flying the aircraft to a base where maintenance can be performed and flown under special conditions and limitations.

Test: Operation of aircraft components, appliances or systems to evaluate function.

18.3 Duties and Responsibilities

18.3.1 Director of Maintenance

Responsibility:

The Director of Maintenance is responsible for determining that the affected component, system or airframe damage will allow the safe accomplishment of a one-time direct ferry flight to a repair facility. The Director of Maintenance will coordinate with the Director of Operations as to whether or not the aircraft may be ferried in accordance with the proper performance data and safe operation procedures as required in the aircraft flight manual.

Duties:

1. Informs all individuals with operational control responsibility of the aircraft status.
2. Ensures that the aircraft is inspected or evaluated for the discrepancy or damage in accordance with manufacturers or FAA approved procedures.
3. Ensures compliance with maintenance procedures, Airworthiness Directives, Mandatory service bulletins, service letters and applicable 14 CFR's.
4. Ensures all maintenance technicians are currently qualified, authorized and trained on the types of aircraft for which are being approved.
5. Ensures that any inoperative system or component found does not have an effect with an interrelationship with any item discrepancy that may have been deferred in accordance with



HeliService USA's approved Minimal Equipment List program.

6. Issuance of the HeliService USA's Continuing Authorization Ferry Flight Form, Ferry Permit Form M-08
7. Notifying the local CDHO Primary Maintenance Inspector within 3 working days that a Ferry Form has been issued.

Primary Designee/Authority Delegation:

In the absence of the Director of Maintenance, the Maintenance Manager shall be the primary designee and shall assume these duties.

18.3.2 Director of Operations

Responsibility:

The Director of Operations is responsible for determining whether or not the aircraft may be ferried in accordance with the proper performance data and safe operation procedures as pertaining to the discrepant component, system or airframe damage. The Director of Operations will coordinate with the Director of Maintenance as to the aircraft's mechanical soundness and safe Condition for the intended flight.

Duties:

1. Relay any pertinent information to the pilot in command of the affected Ferry Flight.
2. Issue any extra flight restrictions as required for the intended flight that are above what is called out in this manual.

Primary Designee/Authority Delegation:

In the absence of the Director of Operations, the Chief Pilot (CP) shall be the primary designee and shall assume these duties.

18.3.3 Aircraft Maintenance Technician (AMT)

Responsibility: The Maintenance Technicians will be responsible for the inspecting of discrepant systems or components and for evaluating damage to the aircraft utilizing the appropriate aircraft/engine maintenance manuals, supplemental type certificates, and FAA approved procedures. Contract Maintenance Technicians/Repair Stations may be utilized in accordance with HeliService USA General Operations Manual and will perform the same responsibilities as stated above and perform the same duties as stated in 1.3 Section B.

All Aircraft Maintenance Technicians/Repair Stations will be properly certificated, trained and current with the maintenance procedures for the type of aircraft for which they are to inspect and evaluate.

The certificated mechanic or repairman may only certify the work for which he or she is employed.

Duties:



1. Perform the required inspections of the discrepant system/component or evaluate any damage.
2. Inform the Director of Maintenance of the findings of the inspections for the discrepant system or component and/or the evaluation of damage.
3. Upon Receiving the HeliService USA Continuing Authorization Ferry Flight Form, Ferry Permit Form M-08, the Maintenance Technician will make an entry on the form and in Digital AirWare or Form M-09 to certify that the aircraft is in safe condition for its intended flight.

Note: The use of photographs will be essential in the reporting of any damage and will be submitted to the Director of Maintenance for further review.

18.3.4 Pilot in Command (PIC)

Responsibility:

The Pilot in Command is responsible for determining what the component or system failure is, and to determine if the item is capable of being deferred by the aircraft's approved Minimum Equipment list. In the case of suspected damage, the Pilot in Command will perform a firsthand assessment of the damage and document in the AML, along with appropriate notifications IAW the GOM.

Duties:

1. The Pilot in command will notify as soon as practicable, the Director of Maintenance or Maintenance Manager of the component, system failure or damage sustained to the aircraft.
2. In the event of damage to an aircraft, the Pilot in Command will relay to the DOM or MM the discrepancy or extent of damage. Photos, if applicable, should be sent to help understand the extent of any damage or a discrepancy.
3. Review the Continuing Authorization Ferry Flight Form, Ferry Flight Permit M-08, and the special flight restrictions contained in it. Ensure that the aircraft weight and balance calculations, and fuel calculations for the intended flight are correct.

18.4 Evaluating an Aircraft

18.4.1 Discrepancies

18.4.1.1 Reporting a Discrepancy

In the event that the pilot in command has experienced a component /system failure or damage to the aircraft in flight and has landed in a remote area, The PIC shall:

1. Determine which system is affected by the failure or damage
2. Refer to the aircrafts approved Minimum Equipment List to see if the discrepancy can be deferred.
3. If the discrepancy cannot be deferred, the Pilot in Command will notify the Director of Maintenance of the component/system failure to the aircraft.
4. Relay any pertinent information from the RFM that pertains to the effects of airworthiness.
5. The PIC will enter the discrepancy in the aircraft discrepancy section of Digital Airware or



HeliService USA Paper Log Form M-09 if necessary.

6. Place the aircraft out of service in accordance with the operational procedures in HeliService USA's General Operations Manual.

Example: "Upon completion of hydraulic servo test, number 2 hydraulic servo light illuminated and would not extinguish."

18.4.1.2 Inspection of a Discrepancy

The DOM will dispatch a qualified AMT to the aircraft location to evaluate the aircraft condition. The AMT shall make every effort to troubleshoot and attempt to repair the component/system issues. If all attempts to repair the issue have been exhausted and it is determined that tooling and/or parts that are required are not available to repair the aircraft, the AMT will:

1. Inspect the aircraft in accordance with the manufactures maintenance manual, Structural Repair Manual, Instructions for continued airworthiness or any other FAA approved procedures for the component/system failure or damage.
2. Inspect the aircraft for possible hidden damage, to include but not limited to items as broken fluid lines, broken electrical connections, missing hardware, cracks etc. that have an effect upon the discrepant component/system or damage to ensure aircraft mechanical soundness.
3. Provide all findings of the inspections to the DOM in verbal and if electronic, pictorial form.
4. The Director of Maintenance will determine if any maintenance actions need to be accomplished on the affected component / system prior to approving a one-time direct ferry flight for the aircraft to return to a base where repairs or replacements can be accomplished.

Note: Only qualified Aviation Maintenance Technicians (AMT) are permitted and authorized to evaluate aircraft condition or accomplish any on sight repairs that may be required.

18.4.1.3 Determining if an Aircraft is Safe for Flight

The Director of Maintenance will consult with the aircraft/engine manufacturers Technical Representative for further information and evaluation of the discrepancy, and to assist in determining that the aircraft can be flown in a safe for flight condition. A letter of no technical objection from the manufacturer will be requested if determined that it is needed.

In the event of damage to the aircraft, HeliService USA will adhere to the aircraft structural repair manual and Advisory Circular 43.13- 1B. The Director of Maintenance will consult with the aircraft manufacturer's Technical Representative for technical documentation for a temporary repair if needed, and follow their recommendations. The use of Metallic tape (speed tape) is an example.

18.4.2 Airworthiness Directives

18.4.2.1 Airframes and Engines



HeliService USA will comply with all applicable airworthiness directives prior to flight.

If an Airworthiness Directive is issued against an aircraft that cannot be accomplished at the HeliService aircraft base due to special tooling, training, or maintenance level requirements, then the DOM will issue a ferry permit for the aircraft to be flown to a repair facility which can perform work. The aircraft ferry permit will not be issued if the AD states otherwise and must be complied with prior to flight.

The Director of Maintenance will contact the Aircraft/Engine Manufacturer to which the Airworthiness Directive applies to acquire supporting documentation for any flight restrictions, if not stated in the AD, prior to the issuance of a Special Ferry Permit. The Director of Maintenance will document any restrictions that may apply on the HeliService USA Ferry Flight Form M-08.

18.4.2.2 Accessories

If an Airworthiness Directive is for a product (accessory), not the aircraft or engine, and does not provide for operation during ferry flight, the product cannot be operated during ferry flight, if the aircraft can be safely operated without the product. A ferry permit may be issued stating that the product may be inoperative in flight.

18.5 Issuance of HeliService Ferry Flight Form M-08

18.5.1 Authorization of a Ferry Permit

The DOM will confer with the Director of Operations or designee to assess the operational risks of a one-time flight after the determination is made the aircraft meets the ferry permit requirements of this manual. This discussion will be the final step prior to the Director of Maintenance issuing the ferry flight under this CAFP.

The Director of Maintenance will fill out the HeliService USA Ferry Permit Form M-08 located in appendix A. The form will contain the following information:

1. Aircraft type, Registration Number and Date
2. The aircraft discrepancy.
3. The departure location of the aircraft
4. The Destination location
5. The list of limitations and restrictions that apply. (See 18.5.2)

18.5.2 Limitations and Restrictions

The following Limitations and Restrictions will always be applied:

1. Issuance of the HeliService USA Ferry Permit Form M-08 will only be authorized for aircraft listed on HeliService USA's Operations Specifications D-085.
2. HeliService USA's Operation Specification D084 will be carried onboard the aircraft.
3. All flights shall be conducted to avoid areas having heavy air traffic and to avoid cities, towns,



villages and congested areas or any other area where flights might create hazardous exposure to persons or property.

4. Any Airworthiness Directive pertinent to the make and model of aircraft that requires compliance must be complied with before the ferry flight is initiated unless the AD specifies that the aircraft can be ferried to a location where the requirements of that specific can be accomplished, unless the Airworthiness Directive states otherwise.
5. The aircraft must be inspected or evaluated according to procedures in this manual and HeliService USA OMA by a properly certified maintenance technician.
6. A properly certified maintenance technician will document in the aircraft's discrepancy section of Digital AirWare (or HeliService Paper Log Form M-09 if necessary), that the aircraft is safe for the intended flight.
7. Any Specific maintenance actions that are deemed necessary, will be performed and recorded in the discrepancy section and transferred to the electronic Flight and Maintenance log page.
8. Only Pilots and personnel essential to operations of the aircraft shall be carried aboard during ferry flights where the aircraft's flight characteristics may be appreciably changed or its operation in flight substantially affected, in accordance with Operations Specifications D084.
9. Any aircraft involved in an accident or incident may not be ferried prior to a release by the responsible NTSB office and notification to the local FAA District Office.
10. Aircraft operated under this authorization may not meet the airworthiness requirements of foreign countries. A special flight permit does not authorize the operation of aircraft over countries other than the United States without permission of that country.
11. The intended flight will be conducted under VFR day conditions only. The flight shall be made by the most direct and expeditious route consistent with the aircraft operating limitations and weather.

18.5.3 Conveyance of HeliService USA Ferry Permit Form M-08

The Director of Maintenance will complete and sign the Ferry Permit Form M-08 and send the completed form to the PIC and AMT.

The form may be transmitted by one of the following ways:

1. Delivered by hand in paper form.
2. The Form will be sent electronically via an email attachment through HeliService USA email and viewed on the Electronic Flight Bag.
3. Verbally (in extremely rare instances).

Note: In the rare event a permit is issued verbally, all required maintenance actions and flight restrictions will be discussed with the PIC and AMT. The Director of Maintenance will ensure that all requirements are understood. The Copy of the OpSpecs D084 in the aircraft may be used as the approval for the Ferry Flight Release. The original Ferry Flight Permit will be kept with the aircraft permanent records in accordance with HeliService USA OMA.



Both the PIC and AMT will review the form and ensure that all the requirements of the HeliService USA Ferry Flight Form M-08 meet the requirements of Operations Specification D084.

18.5.4 Logbook Requirements

The AMT will enter the following in the aircraft discrepancy in Digital AirWare (or HeliService Paper Log Form M-09 if necessary), and transfer to the electronic Flight and Maintenance log after the M-08 has been reviewed by the pilot and AMT:

1. All maintenance actions performed.
2. All specific maintenance actions as listed on the HeliService USA Ferry Permit Form M-08.
3. The result of the aircraft inspection.
4. Followed by the statement "This aircraft has been inspected and has been found safe for the intended flight in accordance with HeliService USA Special Flight Permit dated XX/XX/XXXX."

Example: #2 hydraulic system inspected, completed ground operational check, found the #1 & #2 Hydraulic systems are indicating safe operational pressures in accordance aircraft manufactures maintenance manual chapter XX. This aircraft has been inspected and has been found safe for the intended flight in accordance with HeliService USA Special Flight Permit dated XX/XX/XXXX.

18.5.5 Ferry Flight Departure

Prior to an aircraft one-time ferry flight, the pilot will ensure the following is complied with in accordance with the Continuing Authorization Ferry Flight Program, Rotorcraft Flight Manual and FARs:

1. Ensure all conditions, limitations and provisions listed in OpSpecs D084 have been met.
2. Ensure there is sufficient fuel quantity onboard to allow for a safe one-time ferry flight.
3. Ensure to be mindful of airspeed limitations restrictions if applied.
4. Ensure Aircraft weight & balance, (CG) Center of Gravity checks have been completed.
5. Ensure that the minimum aircraft systems or equipment required to accomplish one-time flight are operative prior to flight.
6. Ensure all required entries & forms have been completed and reviewed prior to accomplishing one-time ferry flight.

When the PIC has determined all items are in order they will proceed with the flight departure procedures in accordance with HeliService USA's General Operations Manual.

18.6 HeliService USA Ferry Permit Form M-08

Page 1 of 2:



HeliService Ferry Permit Form M-08

Aircraft Type: (1) Aircraft Registration Number: (2) Date: (3)

This Ferry Flight Authorization shall be scanned and attached to the Electronic Flight and Maintenance Log in Digital AirWare, which becomes a permanent part of the aircraft records.

Reference the Special Flight Permit Program, and Operations Specifications, D084, "Special Flight

☒ Permit with Continuous Authorization to Conduct Ferry Flights" for additional information.

(4)	(5)	(6)
_____	_____	_____
(Departure Location)	(Destination Location)	(Airways or Routing)
With the following unairworthy discrepancy: (7)		
(8)	(9)	
_____	_____	
(Destination)	(Date)	

The following limitations and restrictions apply:

1. This authorization only applies to the aircraft listed on Operation Specification, Paragraph D085.
2. This authorization permits an aircraft to be moved to a repair facility to perform work required by an airworthiness directive unless the airworthiness directive states otherwise.
3. The aircraft has been inspected or evaluated according to procedures in Chapter 9 of HeliService USA 135 General Operations Manual and the Continuing Authorization Flight Program by a properly rated technician and has been documented in Digital AirWare or Form M-09 that the aircraft is safe for the intended flight.
4. Only Pilots and persons essential to operations of the aircraft shall be carried aboard during ferry flights where the aircraft flight characteristics may have been appreciably changed or its operation in flight substantially affected, in accordance with Operations specifications, D084.
5. Any aircraft involved in an accident or incident may not be ferried before it is released by the NTSB and the local FAA District Office is notified.
6. Aircraft operated under this authorization may not meet the airworthiness requirements of foreign countries.

The following additional conditions or limitations are imposed:

☐ VFR	☐ No carriage of persons other than essential crew	☐ Other operational limitation
(10)		
☐ The following maintenance actions are deemed necessary and must be recorded in the maintenance logbook in accordance with HeliService USA Continuing Authorization Flight Program.		
(11)		
☐ The unairworthy discrepancy noted above has been evaluated and is released from maintenance for one-time ferry flight pending satisfactory completion and documentation of any maintenance or inspections items listed above.		
(12)	(13)	(14)
_____	_____	_____
(Signature of Authorized Individual)		

Certificate # ZS0A760J



HeliService Ferry Permit Form M-08

Block Instructions

Note: Items marked ★ pertain to the Authorized Individual(s) only.

- Item (1) Enter the aircraft Type.
- Item (2) Enter the aircraft registration number.
- Item (3) Enter the date of the Special Flight Permit request. Item (4) Enter the location the aircraft will depart.
- Item (5) Enter the desired location to have the aircraft reposition. Item (6) Enter the route that will be used (direct).
- Item (7) Enter the discrepancy that prevents the aircraft from being airworthy.
- Item (8) ★ Enter the location that will terminate the special flight permit.
- Item (9) ★ Enter the date the special flight permit will expire.
- Item (10) ★ Use this block to document any further operational limitations, if any, required to conduct the ferry flight.
- Item (11) ★ Use this block to document any further maintenance actions, if any, to conduct the ferry flight.
- Item (12) ★ Enter the signature of the authorized individual approving the special flight permit.
- Item (13) ★ Enter the date the special flight permit is approved.
- Item (14) ★ Enter the time the special flight permit is approved.

